

Wakefield District

Local Plan 2036

Planning Growth and Protecting Places



Volume 1

Development Strategy, Strategic and Local Policies

Adopted 24 January 2024



Foreword

We want our district to be safe, attractive, prosperous, resilient, carbon neutral and sustainable; supporting a healthy, active and high quality of life.

To achieve this we face significant challenges associated with climate change, loss of biodiversity, ecological crisis and economic uncertainty. The Council is committed to addressing these challenges through concerted, co-ordinated effort and actions set out in a number of our key plans.

The Wakefield District Local Plan is an important corporate document providing the statutory land use planning framework to deliver sustainable development and a sustainable future.

The Plan will require the district's rich historic, cultural and natural heritage, diverse wildlife, habitats and landscape, Green Belt and open spaces to be protected and enhanced. Improved standards of design and management will improve the quality of the built and natural environment, and secure biodiversity net gain.

New development and investment will need to be sustainable, ensuring the benefits are spread across the district, supporting urban renaissance, regeneration and less advantaged communities. The Plan will address our housing and employment needs and reinforce the character of places. Sustainable patterns of living will support distinctive, vibrant, creative and well-designed places, with balanced communities, improved transport infrastructure and people living healthy, active lifestyles.

Together our plans and working closely with our partners, residents, business and developers will help meet the challenges and deliver the future we aspire to.



Councillor Denise Jeffery
Leader of the Council

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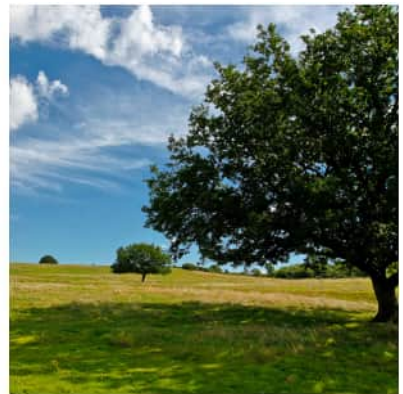
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Purpose



1 Purpose

Statutory Development Plan

- 1.1** The Wakefield District Local Plan is the Council of the City of Wakefield Metropolitan District's statutory development plan, in accordance with the Planning and Compulsory Purchase Act 2004. It sets out the Council's planning policies for securing growth, investment, sustainable development and improving the environment in the district. The policies seek to improve economic, social and environmental wellbeing, delivering successful places, businesses and people.
- 1.2** The scope of the plan provides an ambitious, comprehensive planning policy framework to:
- Deliver sustainable, healthy communities;
 - Deliver sustainable development;
 - Address climate change;
 - Promote a low carbon economy and technologies;
 - Promote active travel and lifestyles;
 - Promote high quality, well designed places;
 - Secure inclusive growth;
 - Safeguard and improve the environment; and
 - Provide for the objectively assessed need for sustainable development.

The policies in the statutory development plan should be read as a whole.

- 1.3** The previous Local Development Framework development plan documents have been replaced, namely:
- Core Strategy, adopted April 2009
 - Development Policies, adopted April 2009
 - Central Wakefield Area Action Plan, adopted June 2009
 - Waste, adopted December 2009
 - Site Specific Policies, adopted September 2012
 - Policies Map, adopted September 2012
 - Leisure, Recreation and Open Space, adopted January 2017
 - Retail and Town Centre, adopted January 2017
 - Policies Map, adopted January 2017

Supplementary Planning Documents

- 1.4** The existing supplementary planning documents remain in place, namely:
- Street Design Guide, adopted January 2012
 - Wakefield City Centre Urban Design Framework, adopted October 2017
 - Wakefield District Residential Design Guide, adopted January 2018

Supplementary Planning Guidance

- 1.5** The supplementary planning guidance associated with the Unitary Development Plan First Alteration is no longer relevant and is withdrawn, namely:
- Development Proposals in Health and Safety Executive Consultation Zones (SPG4)
 - Sustainable Development Guide (SPG5)
 - Affordable Housing (SPG6)

Neighbourhood Planning

1.6 The following civil parish areas and neighbourhood areas have been designated:

- Walton Parish, designated January 2013 (Neighbourhood Plan 'Made' (Adopted) April 2016)
- Crofton Parish, designated October 2013
- Badsworth Parish, designated June 2015
- Ackworth Parish, designated November 2015
- Wrenthorpe Neighbourhood Area, designated September 2019

Document Structure

1.7 The Wakefield District Local Plan is published in two volumes, with associated Policies Map. Volume 1 includes the development strategy, strategic policies and local policies including district-wide, non-settlement specific allocation policies and designations. Volume 2 includes settlement specific local allocation policies. The Policies Map consists of the following maps:

- Area-wide maps showing the district-wide and settlement specific site allocation policies and designations.
- Inset Maps showing policies, allocations and designations within town centres
- Safeguarding Map showing coal resources and petroleum licence areas
- Hot Food Takeaway Exclusion Map
- Housing Viability Value Areas Map

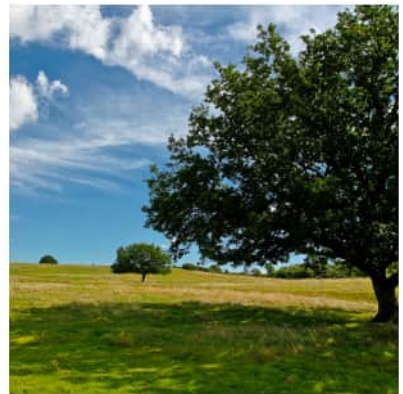
1.8 The Policies Map should always be read in conjunction with Volumes 1 and 2. It should be used when checking site allocation policies and determining planning applications.

1.9 An interactive version of the Local Plan and Policies Map is available to link between relevant policies and detailed mapping for specific sites and policies. All of the Local Plan documents and the Policies Map can be accessed from the Council's website: www.wakefield.gov.uk/localplan

1.10 Printed reference copies are available to view at the libraries across the district and at Wakefield One Customer Access Point.

1.11 If you require any assistance in accessing this document or would like to talk to a planning officer about the Wakefield District Local Plan, please contact the Spatial Policy Group on (01924) 306417, or Council Contact Centre (24 hrs) 03458 506 506.

Context



2 Context

National and Regional Framework

- 2.1** The Local Plan has been prepared in the context of the government's National Planning Policy Framework and national planning practice guidance, as well as the Leeds City Region Strategic Economic Plan and Strategic Economic Framework. The plan needs to be flexible enough to deal with uncertainty, particularly relating to climate change and the advances in technology, with the increasing, sometimes disruptive, impact on society and business.

Key Evidence

- 2.2** The Council has kept the matters relating to plan-making under review and the policies in the Local Plan have been informed by relevant, up-to-date and proportionate evidence. The key evidence is listed here and is available on the Council's Planning Policy web pages:

- Housing Technical Paper October 2020
- Wakefield Strategic Housing Market Assessment March 2016
- Wakefield Strategic Housing Market Assessment Update September 2019
- National Housing Space Standards Need Assessment for Wakefield October 2020
- Wakefield Local Plan - Residential Viability Evidence Base December 2019
- Gypsy, Traveller and Travelling Showperson Accommodation Assessment October 2018
- Employment Land Need Assessment October 2020
- Strategic Employment Land Availability Assessment October 2020
- Wakefield Local Plan – Commercial Viability Evidence Base August 2020
- Employment Land Supply Position Statement November 2018
- Wakefield Industrial Market Assessment March 2018
- Wakefield Office Market Assessment March 2018
- Wakefield Retail, Leisure and Town Centre Study - Quantitative Need Assessment Update November 2018
- Town Centre Floorspace Surveys and Recommendations April 2018
- Wakefield Retail, Leisure and Town Centre Study August 2013
- Wakefield Waste Evidence Base Report July 2018
- Settlement Technical Paper January 2008
- Playing Pitch Strategy Assessment Report Update January 2020
- Playing Pitch Strategy and Action Plan September 2016
- Green Belt Assessment Methodology and Findings October 2020
- Green Belt Review Technical Paper October 2020
- Green Belt Review Exceptional Circumstances Statement October 2020
- Safeguarded Land Information Note December 2018
- Wakefield Draft Green Space Technical Document October 2019
- Sequential and Exception Tests Technical Paper October 2020
- Sustainability Appraisal Scoping Report October 2017
- Sustainability Appraisal Report 2020
- Habitat Regulations Assessment Screening Report October 2020
- Wakefield Heritage Impact Assessment Methodology July 2019
- Heritage Impact Assessments of sites July 2019
- Positive Buildings Report- Wakefield Sites July 2019
- Wakefield Landscape Character Assessment October 2004
- Wakefield Historic Landscape Character Assessment of Wakefield District 2017

- City Fields Masterplan 2017
- Pontefract Vision and Delivery Plan 2018
- Aire River Growth Corridor Masterplan and Delivery Plan 2018
- Knottingley Strategic Development Framework 2018
- Knottingley and Ferrybridge Masterplan 2020
- Wakefield Climate Change Action Plan 2020
- West Yorkshire Local Aggregates Assessment November 2018
- West Yorkshire Waste Needs Assessment Capacity Gap Analysis 2017
- West Yorkshire Connectivity Plan 2020
- West Yorkshire Rail Vision 2020
- West Yorkshire Plus Transport Fund Programme 2018
- Leeds City Region Housing Market Areas July 2016
- Leeds City Region Strategic Employment Land Review October 2016
- Leeds City Region Energy Strategy and Delivery Plan November 2018
- Leeds City Region Green and Blue Strategy and Delivery Plan November 2018
- Leeds City Region Statement of Common Ground March 2020
- Leeds City Region Statement of Cooperation for Local Planning Revised 2018

Sustainability Appraisal

- 2.3** The Local Plan has been informed by a sustainability appraisal, which is available to view on the Council's website. The Council has prepared a Sustainability Appraisal Scoping Report and Sustainability Appraisal Report. The policies carried forward from the Local Development Framework (LDF) were subject to sustainability appraisal as part of the LDF process. These appraisals have been reviewed and new and amended policies have been subject to sustainability appraisal as the Local Plan has progressed.

High Speed Rail

- 2.4** The Department for Transport working with HS2 Ltd were promoting a new high speed rail line between London and the North. This included HS2 Phase 2b providing a rail link between Birmingham and Leeds. If the new high speed rail line is confirmed through a hybrid bill to be submitted to Parliament (work currently paused), construction could start in the plan period. The HS2 Phase 2b safeguarded alignment goes through Wakefield District, running northwards to the west of Hemsworth, east of Crofton, west of Altofts, over the M62 at Newmarket towards Leeds. The Local Plan incorporates the currently safeguarded alignment of HS2 Phase 2b. The policies in the Local Plan recognise the significance of HS2 and seek to safeguard the potential economic benefits and minimise environment impacts based on the current proposals.

District Profile

- 2.5** The district has much in common with other urban areas, but its location, history and economic development give the area its locally distinct characteristics. The district covers 350 square kilometres and forms one of the five metropolitan districts which make up West Yorkshire, within the Leeds City Region. Situated to the south of Leeds, east of Kirklees, with Barnsley and Doncaster metropolitan districts adjoining to the south and Selby which is predominantly rural, lying to the east.

- 2.6** The district occupies a strategic location astride the M1, M62, A1 and the main East Coast rail line. This and its proximity to Leeds make it highly accessible and able to play a significant and prominent role in the city region. The influence of Leeds as a centre for employment, shopping, leisure, culture and other services is strong, but there are also important links with other adjoining districts, notably Barnsley, Doncaster and Kirklees.
- 2.7** The Context Map shows the district area, main settlements, transport routes and neighbouring districts.

Map 1 Context Map

Wakefield District

Local Plan 2036

Planning Growth and Protecting Places

Context Map

Key to Symbols

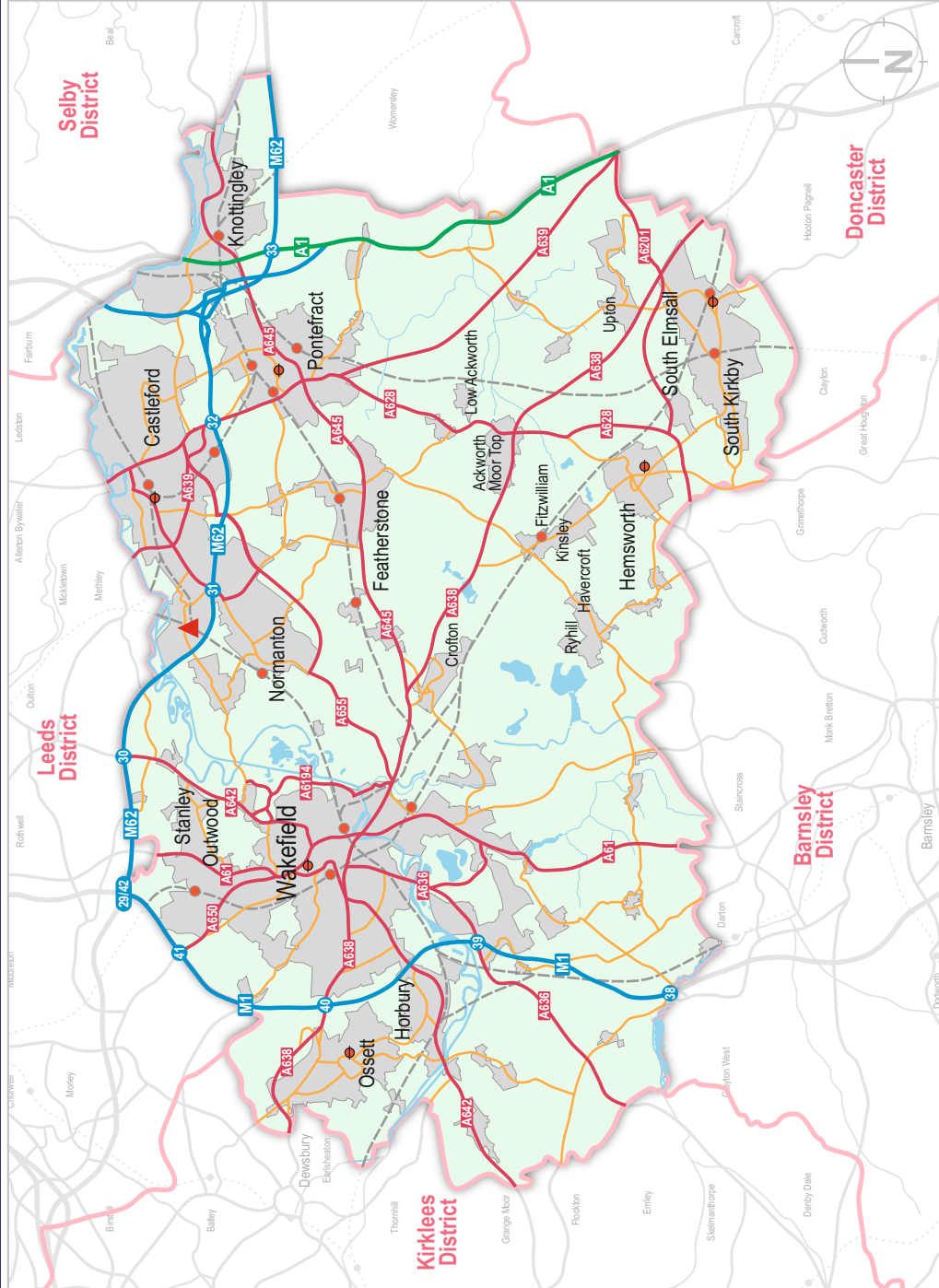
- District Boundaries
- Built Up Areas
- Rural Areas

Road Hierarchy

- Motorway
- Trunk Road
- Principal Road
- Mixed Priority Road
- Railway
- Rail Stations
- Bus Stations
- ▲ Rail Freight Terminal
- Important Navigable Waterway

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Urban Areas

- 2.8** The West Yorkshire conurbation consists of a number of cities, large towns and smaller urban settlements of different sizes separated by tracts of open land of varying width. Wakefield District is typical of this type of urban form. In addition to Wakefield, the main urban centre, the district contains a further thirteen settlements of between 5,000 and 40,000 population and many villages and smaller settlements, each with its own identity, character and role.
- 2.9** The north of the district is largely urban and is dominated in the west by Wakefield city. Wakefield was the county town of the old West Riding and the headquarters for the former West Yorkshire Metropolitan County. The city's long history of different industries has left a legacy of historic buildings and structures. These, as much as anything else, give the city its distinctive character, provide accommodation for many of its current businesses and help to attract people to visit it. Unlike some of its neighbours, it has never been dependent on one form of activity. Agricultural markets, woollen manufacture, coal mining and engineering, as well as public administration, have all been important at various times. This has given the city a diverse and wide range of services, which have enabled it to exert a greater influence and attraction than its size alone would suggest. It still serves as the main centre for jobs, shopping, leisure, culture, health and other services for much of the district and is still an important administrative centre. However, there is a continuing need for the city to evolve as a high quality, well designed, successful place and destination for people to live, work and enjoy. Investment in the city, including major developments at Kirkgate, Trinity Walk, Westgate and the Waterfront, highway and public realm improvements have proved successful steps in this process. Opportunities still exist to revitalise the civic quarter, including introducing new uses to the historic core and developing the cultural offer. Similarly, there are opportunities for further development at the Waterfront, building on the success of The Hepworth art gallery as a catalyst for regeneration.
- 2.10** The towns of Ossett and Horbury lie to the west of Wakefield whilst the urban area of Stanley/Outwood adjoins to the north. Ossett in particular had a long association with the woollen industry. Nowadays, all three settlements provide local employment and services, but have also become commuter settlements for Leeds. This particularly applies to Stanley/Outwood which has grown significantly in recent decades.
- 2.11** The Five Towns, comprising Castleford and Pontefract, which are identified as Principal Towns, and the smaller towns of Normanton, Knottingley and Featherstone, are located in the north-east of the district, astride the M62 and A1. These settlements share strong historic, economic and cultural links based around the growth and subsequent decline of coal mining and other industries.
- 2.12** Castleford, the second largest settlement in the district, has experienced the decline of its chemical industry, following the earlier loss of its coal mining base. There are significant opportunities for regeneration, particularly close to the town centre, along the south bank of the River Aire, where large areas of brownfield land are available. The town centre still needs investment and regeneration. In recent years a major new leisure, employment and retailing development has taken place at Glasshoughton close to M62 Junction 32. A Housing Zone has been established on the River Aire corridor to assist the delivery of new homes.
- 2.13** Pontefract has developed over several centuries into an important local centre, which grew around the medieval castle. It still retains much of its market town atmosphere and role. There continues to be a need to improve and regenerate parts of the centre, as well as retaining and enhancing its historic character. The former Prince of Wales Colliery site to the north of the town centre is being redeveloped for housing and employment. Confectionery continues to be an important and

expanding source of employment in the town and surrounding area. Pontefract is likely to continue to be an attractive place to live and a leisure and cultural destination. Improvements to the local transport network with improved links and rail services are important.

- 2.14** Normanton is a former coal mining settlement which has seen the development of extensive new industrial estates to the east of the town and areas of new housing. The town's existing uses provide a district centre function and there is the opportunity for new employment, commercial and residential development opportunities to reinforce the centre. Improvements to the local transport network are also important, with improved links to other cities and towns.
- 2.15** Featherstone is also a former coal mining settlement and home to Featherstone Rovers rugby league football club. The town has developed historically in a way which has divided the town centre from the areas in which people live. The Wakefield - Pontefract railway line severs the town to the north and the A645 (Wakefield/Pontefract Road) severs much of the town to the south. An opportunity exists to remodel the town through an urban extension with new housing, local centre, primary school, green infrastructure and improvements to the local transport network.
- 2.16** Knottingley lies on the eastern edge of the district to the east of the A1. The area's last colliery at Kellingley closed in 2015. The former Ferrybridge Power Station site with new multi-fuel power generation capacity is located to the north west. Knottingley developed largely as a result of the presence of the Aire and Calder Navigation, which passes through the town. The chemical and glass industries have also been an important part of the local economy. Glass industries continue to provide an important source of employment. Knottingley's location and form mean that parts of it are somewhat isolated. Waterways, railway lines and industry have combined to create a loose-knit structure and make movement throughout the town difficult. The regeneration of Knottingley is a priority and the Council has approved the Knottingley and Ferrybridge Masterplan. Further interventions in the town may be considered as part of any future plan update.
- 2.17** The legacy of the industrial past is being tackled as the Five Towns develop new roles, including the Wakefield Europort development, one of the main distribution locations in the region with direct rail services to mainland Europe via the Channel Tunnel, the continued development of the logistics sector, the Castleford Skills College and the Glasshoughton regional leisure complex, including Xscape and designer outlet village.
- 2.18** The South East of the district includes the towns of Hemsworth and South Elmsall/South Kirkby together with a number of smaller, isolated settlements whose development has been associated with the former coal mining industry. None of these are large enough to provide a wide range of facilities. The area has links with Doncaster and Barnsley and has relied on these centres, as well as Leeds and Wakefield, for jobs and services. New job opportunities are emerging in the music and entertainment sector, promoted through Production Park and the Academy of Live Technology, as well as continued expansion and innovation in the logistics sector. Much of the urban fabric is old and in need of refurbishment and there are pockets of housing which have shown market failure.

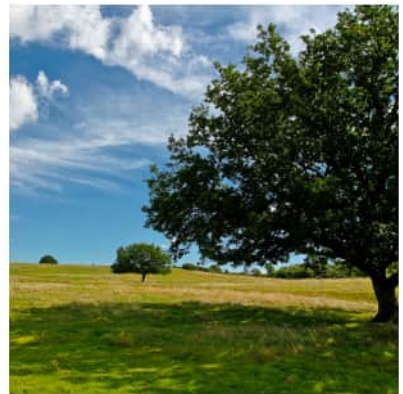
Rural Areas

- 2.19** Though designated a metropolitan area, 68% of Wakefield District lies within the Green Belt, most of which is rural in character, concentrated mainly in the south. These rural areas are largely in agricultural use, interspersed with parkland associated with large estates and are populated by a series of Local Service Centres and Villages set within open countryside, some of which have grown into larger settlements, mainly as a result of former coal mining activity. None of the district is 'remote' as nowhere is more than a mile or two from a settlement offering some level of services. However, some rural areas, particularly in the South East, suffer from poor connection by public

transport to larger centres offering a range of jobs and services. The rural area includes major visitor attractions – Nostell Priory house and park, the National Mining Museum and the West Yorkshire Sculpture Park.

- 2.20** The Authority Monitoring Report contains detailed information about the district. It includes indicators showing how the characteristics of the district compare to the region and country as a whole.

Related Strategies



3 Related Strategies

3.1 The Local Plan aligns with and supports the delivery of a range of related strategies at the national, regional and local level, including:

1. National

- Climate Change Act
- A Green Future Our 25 Year Plan to Improve the Environment
- Clean Growth Strategy
- Infrastructure Delivery Plan
- Industrial Strategy
- Transport Investment Strategy
- Inclusive Transport Strategy
- Road to Zero Strategy
- High Speed Rail HS2 Phase 2b
- Resources and Waste Strategy
- Environment Act

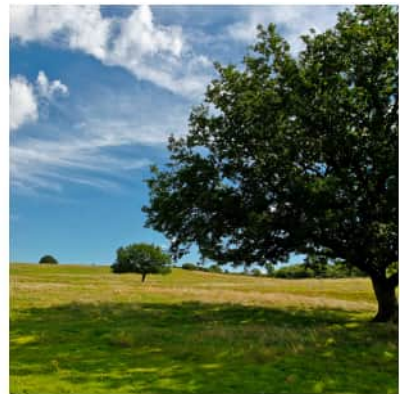
2. Regional – Leeds City Region

- Strategic Economic Plan
 - i. Priority 1 Growing Business
 - ii. Priority 2 Skilled People Better Jobs
 - iii. Priority 3 Clean Energy and Environmental Resilience
 - iv. Priority 4A Housing and Regeneration
 - v. Priority 4C Flood Alleviation
 - vi. Priority 4D Enterprise Zones
- West Yorkshire Transport Strategy
- West Yorkshire Bus Strategy
- West Yorkshire Rail Strategy
- West Yorkshire Plus Transport Fund
- West Yorkshire Local Transport Plan
- Leeds City Region HS2 Growth Strategy
- Leeds City Region Connectivity Strategy
- Leeds City Region Energy Strategy and Delivery Plan
- Leeds City Region Green and Blue Infrastructure Strategy and Delivery Plan
- Leeds City Region Strategic Economic Framework
- Leeds City Region West Yorkshire Mass Transit Vision
- Transport for the North Strategic Plan for North of England

3. Local

- Wakefield District Economic Strategy
- Wakefield Local Transport Strategy
- Wakefield Active Lifestyles Strategy
- Wakefield Playing Pitch Strategy
- Wakefield Climate Change Action Plan
- Creative Wakefield Framework 2020-2025

Vision



4 Vision

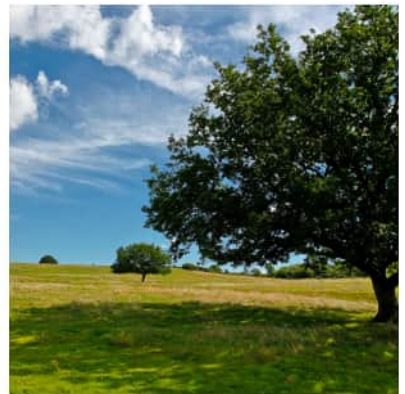
Vision

Wakefield District will be safe, attractive, prosperous, resilient, low carbon and sustainable; supporting a high quality of life. The district will be making a significant contribution to the prosperity and culture of Leeds City Region. Residents, businesses and visitors will benefit from innovation, new technology and inclusive economic growth, taking advantage of the district's connectivity to places across the region, the North and beyond. Wakefield District will be a place where all businesses and communities succeed.

The district's rich historic, cultural and natural heritage, diverse wildlife, habitats and landscape, Green Belt and open spaces will be protected and enhanced. Improved standards of design and management will improve the quality of the built and natural environment, and secure biodiversity net gain.

New development and investment will be sustainable, ensuring the benefits are spread across the district, supporting urban renaissance, regeneration and less advantaged communities. It will address our housing and employment needs and reinforce the character of places. Sustainable patterns of living will support distinctive, vibrant, creative and well-designed places, with balanced communities, improved transport infrastructure and people living healthy, active lifestyles.

Development Principles and Strategy



5 Development Principles and Strategy

Development Principles

5.1 The Wakefield District Local Plan embodies the Garden City development principles, published by the Town and Country Planning Association, and these will be incorporated in policies, masterplans and development proposals, to deliver sustainable, high quality places. Development will embrace the natural environment, offer high quality affordable housing and locally accessible work in engaging, healthy and sociable communities:

- Land value capture for the benefit of the community;
- Strong vision, leadership and community engagement;
- Long-term stewardship of assets;
- Affordable mixed-tenure homes and housing types;
- A wide range of jobs within easy commuting distance of homes;
- Well designed homes with gardens, combining the best of town and country to create healthy communities;
- Development that enhances the natural environment, providing a comprehensive green infrastructure network and net biodiversity gains, using Building for a Healthy Life, zero-carbon and energy-positive technology to ensure climate resilience;
- Strong cultural, recreational and shopping facilities in walkable, vibrant, sociable neighbourhoods; and
- Integrated and accessible transport systems, with walking, cycling and public transport designed to create streets for people and be the most attractive forms of local transport.

In addition, development will embrace, safeguard and enhance the historic environment.

5.2 The principles of Active Design, devised by Sport England and the principles of Streets for People, developed by West Yorkshire Combined Authority, will be incorporated in policies, masterplans and development proposals, to deliver sustainable, well designed, high quality places. Active Design Principles support healthy lifestyles through design and masterplanning of development. Sport England, in partnership with Public Health England, has produced the Active Design Guidance. The ten principles of Active Design are:

Foundational Principles

- **Activity for all.** All environments should be accessible to all users and should support sport and physical activity across all ages, ethnicities, genders, and abilities, enabling everyone to be active and build long-term active habits and behaviours. This is essential for the delivery of all the principles of Active Design and is its foundational principle.

Supporting Active Travel

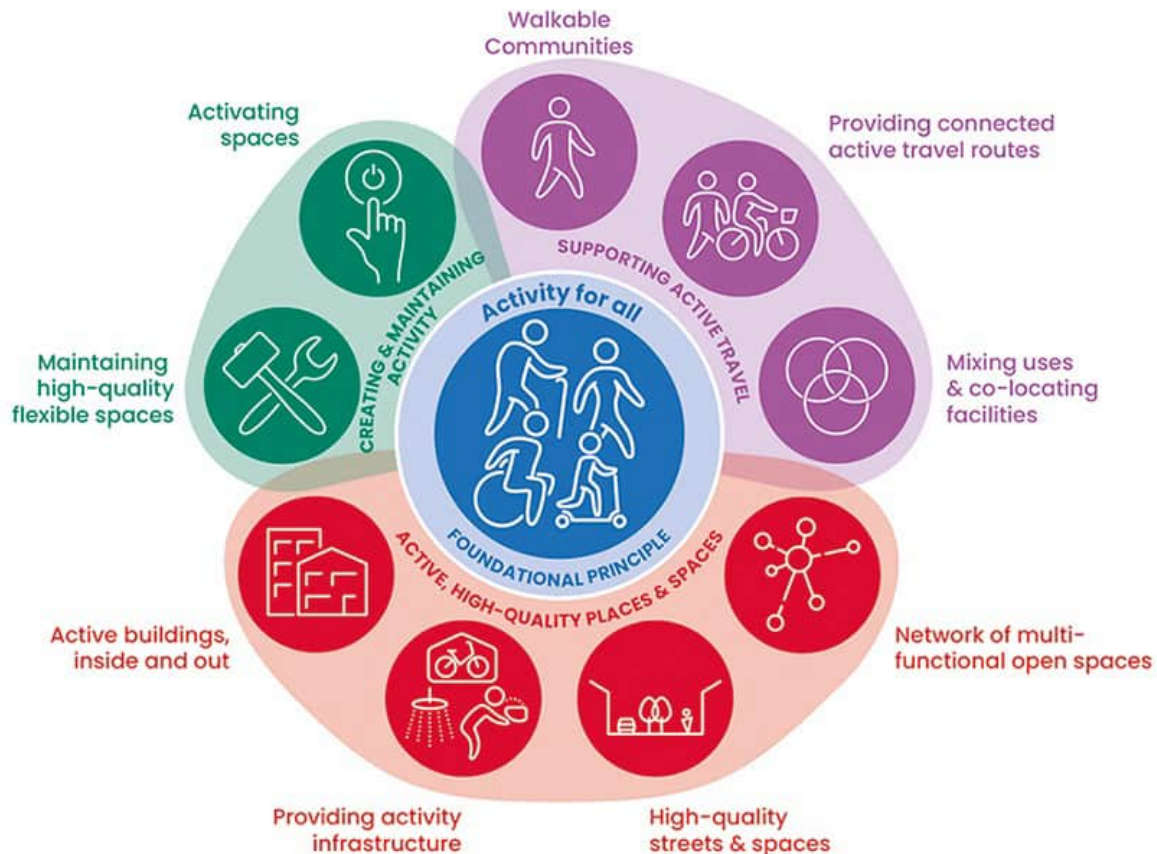
- **Walkable communities.** Facilities for daily essentials and recreation should be within easy reach of each other by active travel means, making it more likely that people will make the journey by using active travel modes (defined in Theme 1). Good active travel connections should be provided to extend the range of services that are accessible while remaining physically active.
- **Providing connected walking & cycling routes.** Encourage active travel for all ages and abilities by creating a continuous network of routes connecting places safely and directly. Networks should be easy to use, supported by signage and landmarks to help people find their way.

- **Mixing uses and co-locating facilities.** The co-location and concentration of retail, community and associated uses to support linked trips should be promoted. A mix of land uses should be promoted that avoid the uniform zoning of large areas to single uses. People are more likely to combine trips and use active travel to get to destinations with multiple reasons to visit. Places with more variety, higher densities, and a mix of uses also reduce the perception of distance when travelling through spaces. They also generate the critical mass of travel demand to better support public transport services.
- **Network of multifunctional open spaces.** Accessible and high quality open space should be promoted across cities, towns and villages to provide opportunities for sport and physical activity, as well as active travel connections and natural or civic space for people to congregate in and enjoy.
- **High quality streets & spaces.** Streets and outdoor public spaces should be active environments in their own right. They should be safe, attractive, functional, prioritise people and able to host a mix of uses, with durable, high quality materials, street furniture in the right places and easy-to-use signage. High quality streets and spaces encourage activity, whereas poor quality streets and spaces are much less likely to be used to the same degree.
- **Providing activity infrastructure.** Infrastructure to enable sport, recreation and physical activity to take place should be provided across all contexts including workplaces, sports facilities and public space, to facilitate activity for all.
- **Active buildings, inside and out.** Buildings we occupy shape our everyday lives, both when users are inside and outside. Buildings should be designed with providing opportunities for physical activity at the forefront, considering the arrival experience, internal circulation, opportunities to get up and move about, and making the building an active destination.

Creating and Maintaining Activity

- **Maintaining high quality flexible spaces.** Spaces and facilities should be effectively maintained and managed to support physical activity. These places should be monitored to understand how they are used, and flexible so that they can be adapted as needed.
- **Activating spaces.** The provision of spaces and facilities which can help to improve physical activity should be supported by a commitment to activate them, encouraging people to be more physically active and increasing the awareness of activity opportunities within a community.

Figure 1 Sport England Active Design Principles



5.3 Wakefield Council, in collaboration with the West Yorkshire Combined Authority, has devised 'Streets for People' expanding the assessment methodology provided by Healthy Streets, devised for Transport for London, with the aim of delivering places that people will want to spend time as well as helping to shift the focus for travel away from the private car. This is achieved through a variety of measurable outcomes, such as reducing vehicular traffic and noise, improving air quality and providing suitable green infrastructure together with appropriate seating for pedestrians. Healthy Street Principles sets out the key elements necessary for public spaces to improve people's health, which are the same as those needed to make urban places socially and economically vibrant and environmentally sustainable. The Streets for People principles are:

1. Easy to cross
2. Greener streets for people
3. Places to stop and rest
4. Not too noisy
5. People will choose to walk, cycle and use public transport
6. People feel safe
7. Interest and amenities
8. People feel relaxed

5.4 The development principles draw heavily on the need for the behavioural change necessary to support sustainable development and meet the challenges arising from climate change, which is and will have a global impact. As far as they can the development principles seek to ensure new development helps towards achieving the United Nation's Global Goals for sustainable development and the United Kingdom's binding commitment to be carbon neutral by 2050.

Figure 2 UN Sustainable Development Goals



- 5.5** Wakefield Council declared a Climate Emergency in May 2019, has pledged to become a carbon neutral organisation by 2030 and to work towards a carbon neutral district by 2038. The Council has prepared a Climate Change Action Plan to help it achieve this commitment.
- 5.6** Furthermore, the Council acknowledges and welcomes the use of the Six Capitals concept to support the delivery of sustainable development. The Six Capitals concept helps organisations to make more sustainable decisions by thinking beyond the traditional financial balance sheet and valuing the wide range of resources society both relies and impacts on – natural, social, human, manufactured, intellectual and financial capital. The aim is that by measuring the full impact of their decisions, organisations will make more sustainable, long term choices.
- 5.7** Natural England’s Green Infrastructure Framework identifies how green infrastructure can support wellbeing, biodiversity and flood management amongst its benefits and relates to a range of policies in the Plan. It provides advice and guidance on how to develop and design green infrastructure, of all scales, in developments.

Development Strategy

5.8 The spatial development strategy reflects the:

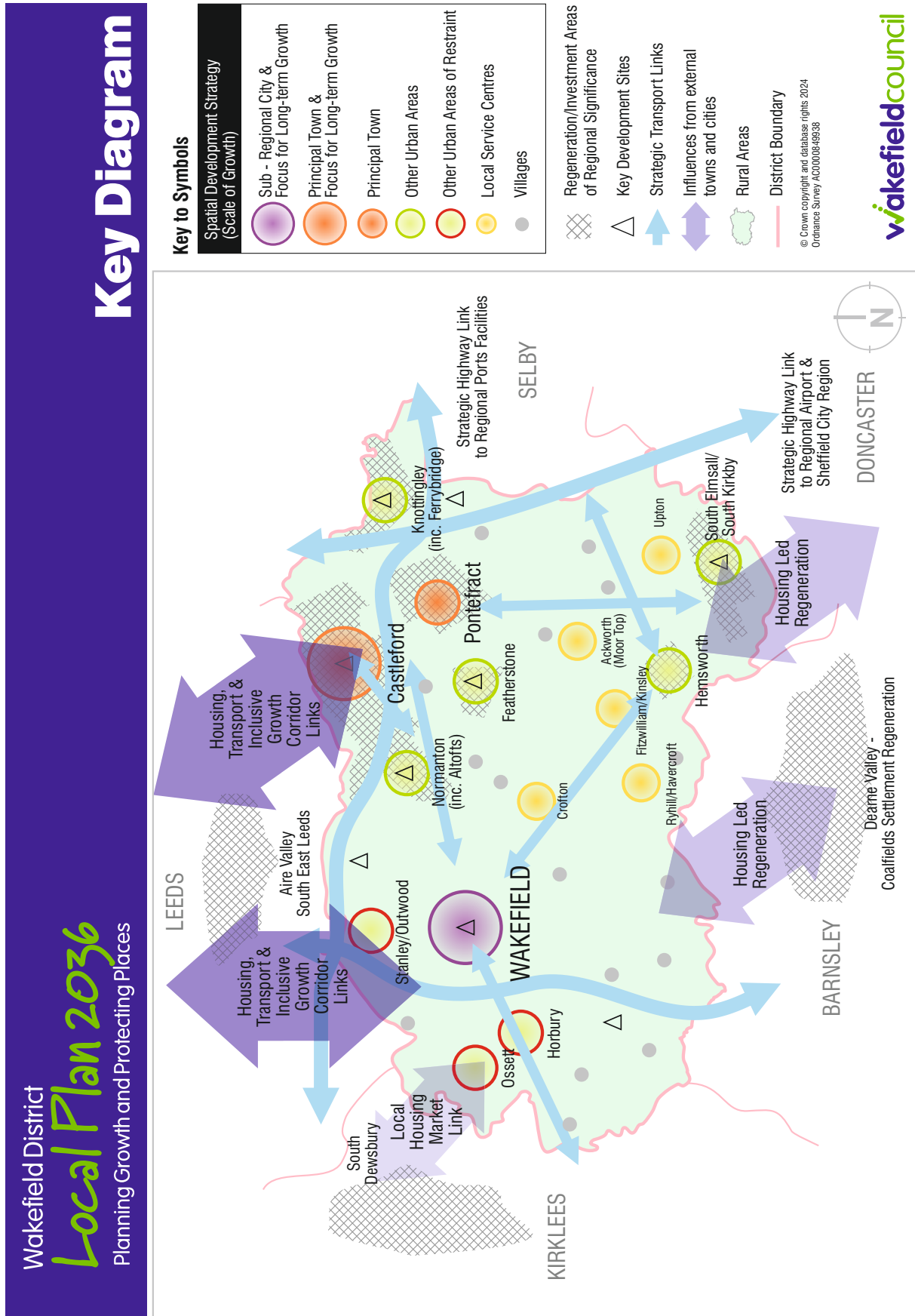
- Role Wakefield district plays in the Leeds City Region, its links with and the influence of large settlements outside the district such as Leeds, Barnsley, Doncaster, Kirklees and Sheffield;
- Ambitions of the Council's Objectives, Economic Development Strategy, urban renaissance and regeneration priorities;
- Spatial Vision and Development Principles; and
- Strategic links of transport, housing and economy into and out of the district.

5.9 The Key Diagram illustrates the position of Wakefield district in the sub-region, showing surrounding council areas, key development sites, regeneration/investment areas of regional significance, and strategic links which provide the context for and give a spatial expression to the development strategy.

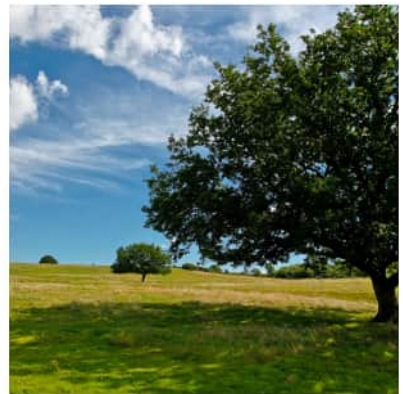
5.10 The spatial development strategy continues to focus most new development in and around existing urban areas, identified in earlier development plans. The focus is on promoting development in sustainable locations aligned to urban areas, well located to the rail network, particularly where urban renaissance and regeneration remains a priority. The scale of development reflects settlement size, function and opportunities for regeneration and sustainable growth. The Local Plan identifies new strategic development associated with Featherstone, Knottingley, South Elmsall and South Kirkby.

5.11 The majority of policies in the Local Development Framework Leisure, Recreation and Open Space Local Plan, and the Retail and Town Centre Local Plan, both adopted in January 2017, have been carried forward into the Local Plan. Policies in the other Local Development Framework documents have been carried forward, amended as appropriate, where they continue to provide an appropriate local planning framework, in the context of the National Planning Policy Framework. New policies were introduced where it was necessary to establish a new local planning framework.

Map 2 Spatial Development Strategy Key Diagram



Strategic Policies



6 Strategic Policies

6.1 The strategic policies set out the overall pattern, scale and quality of development to deliver the development principles and spatial development strategy for the district. The policies are grouped under the National Planning Policy Framework strategic themes, shown below, covering all land uses including the presumption in favour of sustainable development. The policies are necessary to address the strategic priorities for the district, including any cross-boundary matters.

- a. Housing, Employment, Retail, Leisure and Commercial Development
- b. Infrastructure
- c. Community Facilities
- d. Natural, Built and Historic Environment and Climate Change

6.2 Policies in Volume 1 should be considered alongside policies in Volume 2 and the Policies Map.

a) Housing, Employment, Retail, Leisure and Commercial Development

6.3 In accordance with the National Planning Policy Framework and national planning practice guidance the following strategic policies support the presumption in favour of sustainable development; define the role and function of places; establish the scale and location of growth; make provision for a sufficient supply of homes, including mix and affordability; support a strong, competitive economy; and support town centres.

Presumption in Favour of Sustainable Development

Policy SP1

Presumption in Favour of Sustainable Development

When considering development proposals, the Council will take a positive approach reflecting the presumption in favour of sustainable development contained in the National Planning Policy Framework. It will work proactively with applicants to find solutions which mean that proposals can be approved wherever possible, and to secure development that improves the economic, social and environmental conditions in the area.

Planning applications that accord with the policies in the development plan (including, where relevant, policies in neighbourhood plans) will be approved without delay, unless material considerations indicate otherwise.

Where there are no development plan policies relevant to the application or the policies which are most important for determining the application are out of date at the time of making the decision the Council will grant permission, unless material considerations indicate otherwise, unless:

- a. The application of policies in the National Planning Policy Framework protecting areas or assets of particular importance provides a clear reason for refusing the development proposed; or
- b. Any adverse impacts of granting permission would significantly and demonstrably outweigh the benefits, when assessed against the policies in the National Planning Policy Framework taken as a whole.

The Role and Function of Places

- 6.4** The settlement hierarchy identifies the role and function of places, reflecting the range of services, level of employment opportunities and how accessible places are. The settlement hierarchy was established in the Local Development Framework Core Strategy in 2009. The Settlement Technical Paper sets out the appraisal methodology and shows how settlements have been ranked in order of preference, in terms of their size and role within the context of the district and sub region; their suitability to accommodate new plan-led growth and development; and their accessibility to jobs and services. There has not been a significant change to the role and function of places in the district and the settlement hierarchy has been carried forward into the Local Plan. The updated settlement appraisal table is in Appendix 1.
- 6.5** The Sub Regional City of Wakefield is the prime settlement in the district where significant numbers live, work and shop and also provides important leisure, education, health, cultural activities and facilities for the district. The Principal Towns of Castleford and Pontefract are the main local focus for shopping, leisure, education, health and cultural activities and facilities. Other Urban Areas also provide these services and facilities at a reduced scale. Local Service Centres provide lower levels of services and facilities. Villages are small settlements with very limited, if any, service provision.
- 6.6** The Council has approved the Knottingley and Ferrybridge Masterplan which identifies a significant mixed use development site for housing and employment between Knottingley and the M62 motorway. The site requires the link road element of the Knottingley Sustainable Transport Package to be delivered in full. It remains the long-term ambition of the Council to bring forward the wider area of development at Knottingley and the Council will consider how best to achieve this in any future Plan update.
- 6.7** A number of small settlements in the district are not large enough to be classified as ‘Villages’ in the settlement hierarchy in policy SP2. These comprise of:
- Small settlements not in the Green Belt which are listed in policy LP1 Housing in Rural Areas
 - Small settlements in the Green Belt where limited infill housing development may be acceptable which are listed at paragraph 8.3 in this volume of the plan
- 6.8** Local policy LP1 sets out how proposals for housing development will be assessed in these settlements. These are shown on the Policies Map and listed in Chapter 8 of the Local Plan.

Policy SP2

Settlement Hierarchy

Urban Areas	Local Service Centres	Villages
Wakefield - Sub Regional City	Ackworth Moor Top	Badsworth
Castleford - Principal Town	Crofton	Darrington
Pontefract - Principal Town	Fitzwilliam/Kinsley	Hall Green
Featherstone	Ryhill/Havercroft	High & Low Ackworth
Hemsworth	Upton	Kirkhamgate
Horbury		Middlestown
Knottingley/Ferrybridge		Netherton
Normanton/Altofts		North Featherstone
Ossett		Notton
South Elmsall/South Kirkby		Sharlston
Stanley/Outwood		South Hiendley
		Streethouse
		Thorpe Audlin
		Walton
		West Bretton
		Woolley

Location of Development

- 6.9** The development strategy identifies the places where most development should take place and those where development should be limited in order to create sustainable communities, based on their role and function.
- 6.10** Policy SP3 sets out the broad policy framework for delivering the spatial development strategy; recognising the characteristics of the district, the distinctive histories and characters of places, the priorities for urban renaissance, regeneration and inclusive growth.
- 6.11** Special Policy Areas are areas that are considered suitable for more than one use, or need to be developed in the context of a primary use supported by ancillary or complementary uses, and where proposals are often important for the regeneration of the wider area. They have been identified in previous development plans for the district and have proved to be a successful mechanism for bringing forward sustainable, mixed use development often over large areas.

Policy SP3

Location of Development

To deliver the spatial development strategy, based on the settlement hierarchy, the broad spatial framework for the location and scale of development is:

- a. Most new development, including most housing, employment, retail and mixed use development, will take place within the Urban Areas taking advantage of existing services and high levels of accessibility. Significant amounts of development will be located in the Sub Regional City of Wakefield, the Five Towns and the South East, with a particular focus on the regeneration of Castleford, Featherstone, Knottingley, Normanton and South Elmsall/South Kirkby. In other Urban Areas, such as the south east of the district, the scale of development will reflect settlement size and function, the need for regeneration and to tackle locally high levels of deprivation. Specific Employment Site allocations will be made in close proximity to the strategic road network to accommodate market need for such sites in full over the plan period;
- b. New retail, leisure, office, cultural and tourist facility development will be located within Wakefield city centre and other town centres and in identified Special Policy Areas where consistent with site specific policies, the spatial development strategy and national planning policy, taking advantage of existing services and high levels of accessibility;
- c. In Local Service Centres the scale of development will be appropriate to the size of the settlement, meet the identified local community needs of the settlement and its immediate area and help create a balanced sustainable community;
- d. In settlements identified as Villages only small scale development will take place where it helps to meet identified local needs within the existing boundaries of the settlement;
- e. In other settlements not washed over by the Green Belt development will be strictly limited to meeting identified local needs within the existing boundaries of the settlement;
- f. In the Green Belt, development will conform to Local Plan and national planning policy relating to the Green Belt.

Safeguarded Land

- 6.12** To ensure the Green Belt boundary lasts beyond the plan period some land has been safeguarded on the edge of settlements. The land is not required for development during the plan period as other suitable development sites have been identified. Any update of the Local Plan which includes an assessment of the suitability of safeguarded land for development will include consideration of the sustainability and suitability of these sites for allocation.
- 6.13** National planning policy requires the impact of removing land from the Green Belt to be offset through compensatory improvements to the environmental quality and accessibility of remaining Green Belt land. The sites listed below are removed from the Green Belt and designated as safeguarded land by this plan. It is not possible to secure compensatory improvements to the Green Belt for these sites unless they are allocated in a future plan and planning permission for development granted. Any update of the Local Plan which allocates any of the sites listed below for development will need to set out in site policies the requirement to secure compensatory improvements to the Green Belt in conformity with local or national planning policy at that time.

Table 1 Sites Removed from the Green Belt and Designated as Safeguarded Land by this Plan

Reference	Site Name
SL01	Land at Asdale Road, Durkar
SL02	Land at Ferry Lane, Stanley
SL04	Land off Spittal Hardwick Lane, Pontefract
SL05	Land between A628 & Barnsley Road, Hemsworth
SL08	Land at Woodhouse Common, Normanton
SL09	Land off Lingwell Gate Lane, Outwood

Policy SP4

Safeguarded Land

Areas of safeguarded land have been identified on the edge of settlements which may be suitable to meet longer term development needs for housing or employment land. Within these areas shown as Safeguarded Land on the Policies Map, development will be restricted to that which is necessary for the operation of existing uses together with such temporary uses that will not prejudice the possibility of long term development. Permanent development on safeguarded land shall only be considered through the process of preparing and updating the Wakefield District Local Plan.

Housing

- 6.14** National planning policy seeks to support the government's objective of significantly boosting the supply of homes and ensuring this is reflected in local plans. Local plans should ensure that a sufficient amount and variety of land comes forward to ensure that identified needs are met, including those for groups with specific requirements. The minimum number of homes needed should be identified using the standard method in national planning practice guidance. Guidance is clear that actual housing need may be higher than the amount identified using the standard method. Additional evidence with regard to housing need and the housing requirement is set out in the Strategic Housing Market Assessment 2016 and the 2019 Update and in the Housing Technical Paper.

Scale and Distribution of Additional Housing

- 6.15** The distribution of new housing reflects the spatial development strategy with the overall intention of creating sustainable settlements. A number of the largest housing allocations and Special Policy Areas in the plan will deliver housing into the later years of the plan period and, in some cases, continue to deliver in the years after the plan period finishes.
- 6.16** There are a number of local housing policies in Chapter 7 of Volume 1 of the Local Plan that should be considered alongside development proposals, where relevant, including LP1 Housing in Rural Areas, LP2 Accessible Housing Standards, LP3 Minimum Space Standards for Homes, LP4 Sub-Division and Multiple Occupation of Homes including Student Housing, LP5 Residential Development in Town Centres, LP45 The Effect of Development on Public Services, and LP48 Requirements for Open Space in New Housing Development. Other more general development management policies will also be relevant to individual proposals.

Policy SP5

Scale and Distribution of Additional Housing

The Local Plan allocates land to accommodate the housing requirement for the 19 year period from 2017-18 to 2035-36. The housing requirement is set at 1,400 homes a year (equating to 26,600 homes over the 19 year period set out above). This will be met by the development of allocated sites, continued provision of homes on land with extant planning permission in the early part of the plan period and from future windfall housing development on sites without planning permission at the time of adoption. To accommodate this source a windfall allowance will be applied later in the plan period.

A five year supply of specific, deliverable sites will be maintained at all times. The five year supply throughout the plan period will be calculated using the housing requirement of 1,400 homes a year, taking into account any shortfall or oversupply of homes against this since the start of the plan period in 2017-18.

1. The scale and distribution of the housing requirement will be as follows:
 - a. The largest number of additional houses will be built in the Sub Regional City of Wakefield, with similar numbers in the Principal Town of Castleford. As a Sub Regional City, it is expected the Urban Area of Wakefield, including its suburbs will accommodate about 20% of the district's housing requirement. As a Principal Town with extensive areas of previously developed land in need of regeneration Castleford is also expected to accommodate about 20%. Pontefract will be expected to accommodate less growth, about 10%, reflecting the extensive residential development that has occurred in the town in recent years;
 - b. Of the other Urban Areas identified in the settlement hierarchy, the towns of Featherstone, Hemsworth, Knottingley, Normanton and South Elmsall/South Kirkby will be the main focus of new housing growth, reflecting their status as sustainable settlements, their relative size and function and the need for urban regeneration. In the towns of Horbury,

Ossett and Stanley/Outwood growth will be more constrained in order to ensure a sustainable development pattern. Together these settlements are expected to accommodate about 40% of the district's housing requirement;

- c. Limited numbers of additional houses will be built in Local Service Centres to meet the needs of the settlement and its immediate area and to help create sustainable communities. Together these settlements are expected to accommodate up to 8% of the district's housing requirement, reflecting their position in the settlement hierarchy, their relative size and function and their limited capacity to accommodate growth within the context of the spatial development strategy;
 - d. In Villages limited amounts of additional houses will be built to meet local needs up to a maximum scheme size of 10 dwellings, provided that development fills the whole land parcel or site and complies with density and design policies. To reflect the need to meet local housing requirements these settlements are expected to accommodate up to 2% of the housing requirement;
 - e. In settlements below the Village category of the settlement hierarchy and not in the Green Belt, housing proposals will be of very limited scale and only permitted where they meet identified local community needs;
 - f. In the Green Belt, housing development will only be permitted where it conforms to local and national Green Belt policy.
2. When proposing the change of use of a building to residential use in Villages, smaller settlements and rural areas, developers will need to demonstrate that proper consideration has been given to employment and community uses as well as residential.
3. Proposals for residential development will achieve a net residential density of:
- a. At least 50 homes a hectare in Wakefield city centre and Castleford and Pontefract town centres and within a 500 metre radius of rail and bus station public transport hubs;
 - b. At least 40 homes a hectare throughout the rest of the Wakefield, Castleford and Pontefract Urban Areas;
 - c. At least 30 homes a hectare in other Urban Areas, Local Service Centres, Villages and in the Green Belt.

In circumstances where individual site characteristics dictate and are justified, a lower density may be acceptable.

6.17 The housing requirement is set as a net figure which means completions are additions to the housing stock net of any losses as a result of clearance and changes of use.

6.18 The indicative housing trajectory shows how the capacity for and potential levels of house building incorporated into the Local Plan compare to the housing requirement. It will be updated in the Authority Monitoring Report to show and monitor progress towards meeting the housing requirement for the district. It shows the number of homes built each year since the beginning of the plan period and the expected rate of completions year by year for the remainder of the plan period from deliverable planning permissions, allocations and the windfall allowance. The trajectory also demonstrates that a five-year supply of specific, deliverable housing sites is in place as required by national planning policy. A second trajectory shows similar information for brownfield or previously developed land.

6.19 A table showing the delivery profile of housing sites included in the Local Plan is in Appendix 2.

Figure 3 Local Plan Housing Trajectory

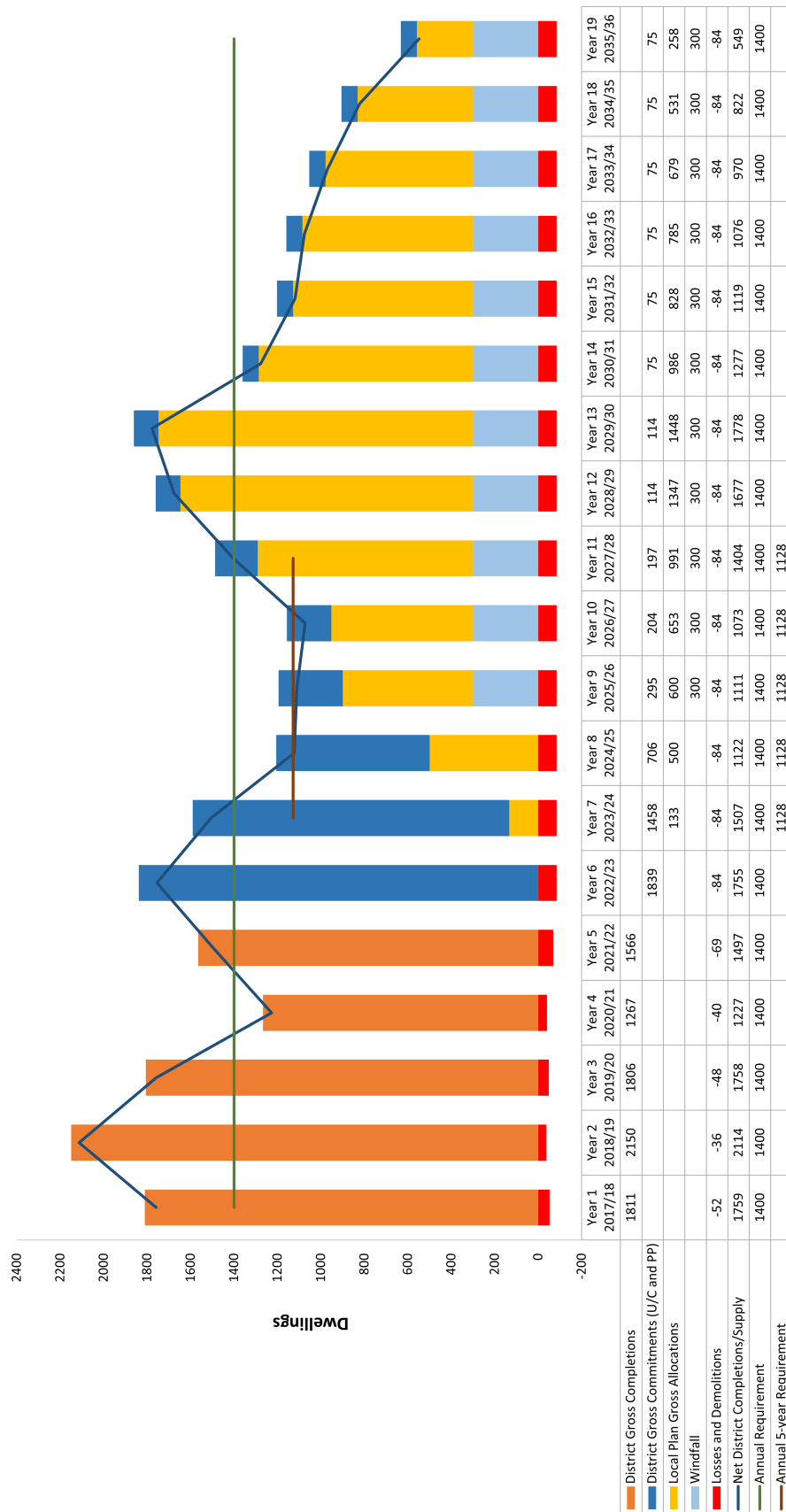
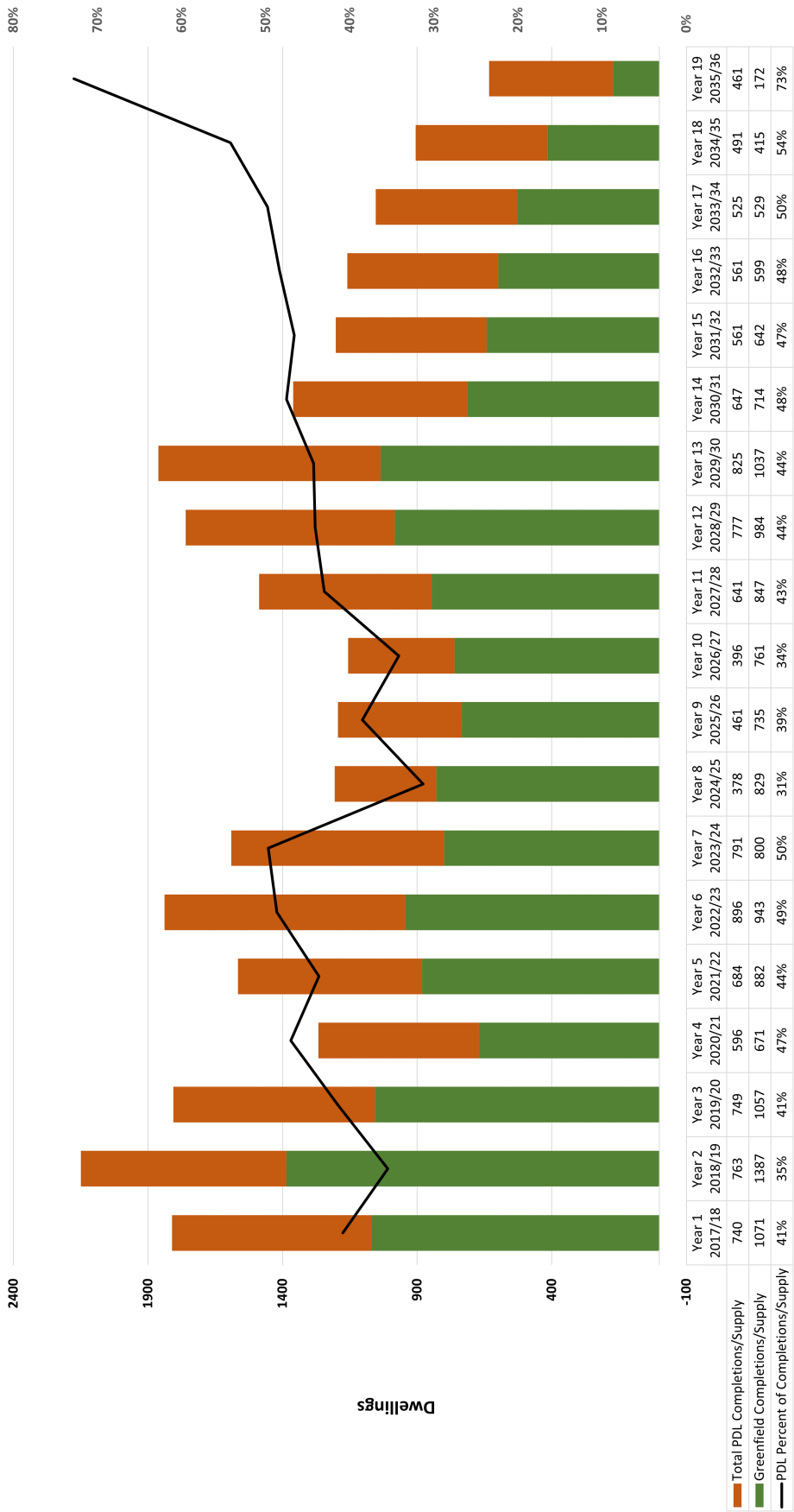


Figure 4 Total Supply and Completions on Previously Developed Land



6.20 The Local Plan does not provide a housing supply that meets the requirement over the full plan period (2017/18 – 2035/36). The housing trajectory identifies a net supply of 25,594 homes against the net requirement of 26,600 homes leading to a shortfall of 1,006 homes over the plan period. This is a small shortfall which will occur towards the end of the plan period. It is likely windfalls will occur in the future which will compensate and possible that a proportion of the 1,153 homes that are estimated to be delivered after the end of the plan period in the trajectory may come forward earlier. The plan is also likely to be updated well before this shortfall has any impact. The whole plan housing supply is set out in detail in the housing phasing tables in Appendix 2 and summarised below.

Table 2 Whole Plan Housing Supply 2017/18 to 2035/36

Supply Component	Number of Homes
Gross Completions 2017/18 - 2022/23	8,600
Gross Commitments at 1st April 2023	5,376
Windfall Allowance 2023/24 - 2035/36	3,300
Local Plan Allocations capacity at 1st April 2023	9,739
Gross Whole Plan Supply	27,015
Losses and Demolitions 2017/18 - 2035/36	-1,421
Net Whole Plan Supply	25,594
Net Whole Plan Requirement	26,600
Shortfall	-1,006

6.21 The table below sets out the five year supply calculation including the requirement and the deliverable housing supply over the five-year period. The requirement is based on distributing the over-supply in the district from the initial years of the plan period over the relevant five-year period to reduce the requirement. The five-year supply calculation is based on the period 2023/24 – 2027/28 and the supply reflects the phasing of sites set out in Appendix 2 of this volume. In future years, if extant permissions are known at the base year of the relevant five-year period, the windfall allowance will only be applied in years 4 and 5.

Table 3 Five Year Supply Calculation 2023/24 – 2027/28

	Five-Year Housing Requirement	Explanation	Number of Homes
A	Housing Requirement	1,400 homes a year x 5	7,000
B	5% buffer	5% buffer brought forward from later in the plan period as required by national planning policy	350
C	Oversupply	The oversupply of completions in relation to the Housing Requirement over the period 2017/18 – 2022/23 distributed over the five-year period	-1,710
D	Total five-year requirement	Sum of A to C above	5,640

	Five-Year Supply Components	Explanation	Number of Homes
E	Deliverable Planning Permissions	Capacity from planning permissions expected to deliver in the five-year period (including a 15% deduction on relevant types of permissions to allow for possible non-delivery)	2,860
F	Local Plan Allocations	Capacity from Local Plan allocations that deliver housing (as set out in the phasing tables in Appendix 2)	2,877
G	Windfall Allowance	3 years of a windfall allowance of 300 homes a year to reflect planning permissions likely to be granted in the five-year period not currently accounted for in the supply	900
H	Gross Deliverable Supply in Five-year period	Sum of E to G above	6,637
I	Losses and Demolitions Allowance	84 per year to allow for conversions and demolitions of existing homes	-420
J	Net Deliverable Supply in Five-year period	H - I	6,217
	Difference between Requirement and Net Deliverable Supply	J - D	577
	Number of Years Deliverable Supply based on five-year Requirement	$J \div D \times 5$	5.5

6.22 National policy states that local planning policy should make as much use as possible of previously developed land. Local plans should also ensure that low density housing development is avoided and that developments make optimal use of the potential of sites. In particular densities in city and town centres and in other locations well served by public transport, around railway and larger bus stations for example, should be subject to significant uplift. The Council considers bus station public transport hubs in the district to be Wakefield, Castleford and Pontefract bus stations.

6.23 The National Planning Policy Framework requires development plans and brownfield registers must identify 'land to accommodate at least 10% of their housing requirement on sites no larger than one hectare' unless there are strong reasons this cannot be achieved. For Wakefield, based on policy SP5 above, this means that 2,660 homes need to be identified through the development plan and brownfield register on sites below 1 hectare over the plan period. The plan achieves this through allocations on smaller sites and commitments that will be completed in the plan period.

6.24 The maximum scheme size set out in policy SP5 of 10 dwellings in Villages will be applied flexibly taking account of the need to ensure effective use of land.

Housing Mix, Affordability and Quality

6.25 A range of homes should be provided in terms of their size, type and tenure in order to ensure that mixed and balanced communities are created and sustained across the district.

6.26 The Council's latest Strategic Housing Market Assessment Update, published in 2019 sets out an annual net imbalance of 646 affordable dwellings a year. It confirms that there is still a considerable need for affordable housing in the district which requires a local policy response. The Local Plan Viability Evidence report recommends that a variable approach is adopted to the provision of

affordable housing in the district with different levels of affordable housing provision required in different areas based on the viability of the local housing market. These zones are called Housing Viability Value Areas. Only in particular circumstances will the Council consider deviations from the levels of affordable housing set out in this policy. Such applications will be considered through the application of national planning policy, planning practice guidance and policy LP7 Viability Review.

- 6.27** The Strategic Housing Market Assessment Update 2019 sets out that, based on evidence of need in Wakefield, affordable housing provision should be made up of 65% for rent and 35% for intermediate affordable home ownership. The National Planning Policy Framework requires local plans to specify types of affordable housing required and expect this to be met. It also states that, subject to some exemptions, plans should expect at least 10% of the total number of homes on major developments be available for affordable home ownership. The 10% affordable home ownership requirement can only be satisfied in Housing Viability Value Area 1 where 30% of homes will be affordable. In Housing Viability Value Areas 2 to 4 the different levels of affordable provision they require to ensure development is viable would mean the 10% affordable home ownership provision would significantly prejudice the ability to meet the affordable housing needs of specific groups in the district as evidenced in the Strategic Housing Market Assessment Update. Therefore the 10% affordable home ownership requirement will not apply in Housing Viability Value Areas 2 to 4.

Policy SP6

Housing Mix, Affordability and Quality

All proposals for housing, including those affecting the existing housing stock, will be of a high quality and design and contribute to creating mixed and balanced communities. This will be achieved by providing housing to meet the need for market and affordable homes, including specialist homes for older people, students, people with disabilities, service families, people who rent their homes and people wishing to commission or build their own homes. Housing will also need to be of the right size, type, and tenure to meet local needs. Evidence of need is set out in the Strategic Housing Market Assessment and any associated studies.

- a. All proposals for housing must provide a broad mix of homes suitable for different household types and will show how they reflect the district's changing household composition in the types of homes they provide, taking into account local evidence. On large strategic sites (60 homes or 2 hectares or more) the housing mix shall reflect the local need for different types of specialist housing, for different sizes of home, price and different types of tenure. For smaller sites, the mix of housing shall contribute to the creation of mixed communities having regard to local community needs and the existing mix of housing in the locality.
- b. Proposals for additional housing, including those for a mix of uses, above the identified size thresholds set out below, must maximise the provision of affordable housing and provide at least the percentage of affordable housing required, in accordance with the Housing Viability Value Area they are located within.

In the Housing Viability Value Areas identified on the Policies Map the following levels of affordable housing must be provided:

Housing Viability Value Area 1 - 30% of homes will be affordable

Housing Viability Value Area 2 - 20% of homes will be affordable

Housing Viability Value Area 3 - 10% of homes will be affordable

Housing Viability Value Area 4 - 0% of homes will be affordable

These homes must meet identified local community needs for different forms of affordable tenure. Affordable provision will be made up of 65% for rent and 35% for intermediate affordable home ownership. The types of tenures considered affordable are defined in the National Planning Policy Framework. In Housing Viability Value Area 1 at least 10% of the total number of homes on major developments should be provided as affordable home ownership tenures (unless the exceptions set out in the National Planning Policy Framework apply). Affordable homes will be provided on the application site, unless off site provision or a financial contribution of broadly equivalent value can be robustly justified by the applicant. When assessing the acceptability of these alternative options a key consideration will be if the approach would contribute to the creation of mixed and balanced communities.

Where affordable housing provision is required, based on the Housing Viability Value Areas set out in this policy, a threshold of 10 or more homes or a site area of 0.5 hectares or more will be applied.

Actions proposed to improve the quality or make efficient use of the district's housing stock must contribute to sustainable development. Proposals which involve the redevelopment of existing housing must comply with the Local Plan spatial development strategy and policies.

Specialist Housing

- 6.28** A more diverse supply of specialist housing is required across the district. This includes, but is not limited to, homes for older people, people with disabilities and people wishing to commission or build their own homes. The Strategic Housing Market Assessment Update 2019 sets out the need for a number of different types of supported and specialist housing in the district.
- 6.29** The different types of specialist accommodation for older people referred to in the policy are defined in national planning practice guidance on Housing for Older and Disabled People. These definitions are not definitive and new models of housing for older people may evolve. Planning judgement will be required when considering which use class specific market accommodation proposals for older people are in.

Policy SP7

Specialist Housing

Proposals for specialist housing for older people and people with physical and learning disabilities will be supported where they are located in accessible locations with access to regular public transport and other facilities and services such as retail and health provision, subject to the effect of the development on public services. Self-build and custom build housing and co-housing will be supported in principle, subject to conformity with the wider development plan.

With regard to market accommodation for older people age restricted general market housing, retirement living or sheltered housing and extra care housing or housing with care is considered as being in use class C3 and relevant housing policies in the Local Plan will be applied to such proposals. Residential care home and nursing home accommodation (including end of life/hospice care and dementia care home accommodation) is considered as being in use class C2 and relevant housing policies in the Local Plan will not be applied to such proposals.

Build to Rent Housing

- 6.30** Build to Rent is a new form of housing recognised and defined in national planning policy. It is purpose built housing that is typically 100% rented although it can form part of larger multi-tenure developments on the same site. Proposals should include provision of affordable private rent housing and offer longer tenancy agreements, be professionally managed and in single ownership and management control. Evidence in the Strategic Housing Market Assessment Update 2019 demonstrates there is a need to diversify and improve the private rented sector stock in the district.

Policy SP8

Build to Rent Housing

The development of build to rent schemes will be supported, particularly in Wakefield Sub-Regional city and the Principal Towns, usually as part of larger mixed tenure schemes. They will provide a mix of unit sizes and types to meet local needs. Evidence of need will be set out in Strategic Housing Market Assessments and associated studies.

Build to Rent Schemes will require a legal agreement setting out that:

1. The whole development is and remains under common ownership and management control for a minimum of either 20 years or, where specifically justified and appropriate, an alternative covenant period that shall be agreed with the Council;
2. Operators must offer tenancies of three years to all tenants, with tenants having the option to terminate at one month's notice, after the first six months, without a break fee being payable. Where a tenant requests a shorter tenancy, this should be accommodated;
3. Operators must offer rent certainty for the period of the tenancy, the basis of which should be made clear to the tenant before a tenancy agreement is signed, including any annual increases which should always be formula-linked;
4. On-site management will be provided with a daily presence for apartment schemes. Other types of provision will have appropriate management arrangements set out in the legal agreement;
5. Operators must have a complaints procedure in place and be a member of a recognised ombudsman scheme and a member of the Council's Responsible Landlord Scheme;
6. An annual statement must be submitted to the Council setting out the approach being used to let affordable units, their ongoing status and demonstrating how the scheme is meeting the overall affordable housing level required by the planning permission;
7. All the homes must remain as Build to Rent for the covenant period agreed under part 1 of this policy;
8. All the units must be self-contained, let separately and not sublet.

Schemes above the Council's affordable housing size thresholds should provide affordable private rent housing. A benchmark level of 20% of homes should be provided as affordable private rent subject to any viability assessment and recognition that a site's location with regard to the Housing Viability Value Areas shown on the Policies Map may have an impact on viability.

Affordable private rent dwellings will be:

- At a rent that is at least 20% less than the private market rent (inclusive of service charges) for an equivalent dwelling on the site but no less than the Local Housing Allowance for that property;
- Maintained as affordable private rent in perpetuity unless the provisions set out below apply;
- Distributed throughout the development and physically indistinguishable from the market rent homes in terms of quality and size;
- Occupied by eligible households having regard to household income levels and local rent levels; and
- Advertised on the Council's choice based letting system.

The following mechanisms are to be utilised if the operator seeks to change the tenure of units prior to the expiration of the covenant period agreed under part 1 of this policy, and subject to presenting robust evidence and a compelling case to the Council:

- Where the operator seeks to sell a market rent unit before the covenant period agreed under part 1 of this policy has expired, the operator will be required to pay over a sum equal to the number of weeks remaining on the agreed covenant period, multiplied by the weekly rent at the time of the proposed sale, which will be increased annually according to Retail Price Index to the end of the covenant period. This claw back sum must be used by the Council for the provision of affordable housing across the district.
- Where the operator seeks to sell an affordable private rent unit a claw back must be paid which will be used by the Council for the provision of affordable housing across the district. This claw back will be calculated using the market value of the unit and the percentage rental discount that had been applied. This percentage discount will be applied to the sale price of the unit and this will be the claw back sum.
- Where the operator seeks to convert an affordable private rent unit to a market rent unit the operator must agree to a 20 year covenant period or, where specifically justified and appropriate, an alternative covenant period that shall be agreed with the Council for that unit to remain as a market rent unit and a claw back will have to be paid. This claw back will be the difference between the value of the property as a market rent unit and its value as an affordable private rent unit. The market rent unit value will be the difference between the capitalised value of the market rent unit for 20 years (or other agreed covenant period) and its reversionary value upon freehold sale on expiry of the 20 year covenant period (or other agreed covenant period). The affordable private rent value will be the capitalised value of the property subject to an affordable private rent in perpetuity. The Council must use these funds for affordable housing provision within the district.

On schemes that include a mix of Build to Rent and open market sales units, this policy only applies to the Build to Rent element. With regard to affordable housing requirements, any open market element on schemes including build to rent provision will be considered separately under the Council's market affordable housing policy (SP6).

Gypsy, Traveller and Travelling Showperson Accommodation

- 6.31** Housing and planning legislation and policy place a duty on councils to provide accommodation for Gypsies, Travellers and Travelling Showpeople.
- 6.32** The Wakefield District Gypsy, Traveller and Travelling Showperson Accommodation Assessment 2018 provides the published evidence about the Gypsy and Traveller pitch requirements. The assessment indicates there are 66 pitches in the district accommodating 59 households. The Council runs a Gypsy and Traveller site at Heath, providing permanent accommodation for 38 family pitches. The remaining pitches identified in the assessment are provided on 14 privately owned sites which benefit from permanent or temporary planning permission, a planning application pending or are unauthorised. The assessment indicates there is a need for 112 pitches, for the five year period to 2023. For the period from 2023 to 2036 there is a need for an additional 52 pitches.
- 6.33** The accommodation assessment has reviewed evidence of unauthorised encampment activity over the period 2014 to 2018. There is a requirement to develop 10 transit pitches, which could accommodate up to 20 caravans.
- 6.34** The Council has reviewed the accommodation requirements for Travelling Showpeople, based on the Wakefield District Gypsy, Traveller and Travelling Showperson Accommodation Assessments 2016 establishing a requirement for 76 plots during the Plan period. There are 16 privately operated Travelling Showperson sites in the district, providing 82 plots. The sites provide for accommodation and storage of equipment.

- 6.35** The Council has made significant progress in meeting the requirements of national policy and legislation. Policy SP9 provides a policy framework for positively determining planning applications for permanent Gypsy, Traveller and Travelling Showperson accommodation. The Local Plan incorporates 17 Gypsy and Traveller sites, making provision for 152 permanent pitches, against a need for 164 permanent pitches over the Plan period. The allocated sites also make provision for 6 transit pitches, against a need for 10 transit pitches. Therefore, the Local Plan includes a 5.2-year supply of Gypsy and Traveller pitches, as set out in Examination evidence document EX.WDC93.
- 6.36** The Local Plan also incorporates 16 Travelling Showperson sites making provision for 82 plots, against a need for 76 plots over the Plan period. There is a 6.2-year supply of plots, with provision of 82 against a 5 year supply need of 66, as set out in Examination evidence document EX.WDC70.
- 6.37** The Council will continue to work with local communities and Gypsies, Travellers and Travelling Showpeople to maintain a local evidence base for assessing accommodation needs and monitor the provision of permanent accommodation both in this district and adjoining areas through the Authority Monitoring Report. This will allow the Council to further consider accommodation needs in the Local Plan. The Council's assessment of need for Travelling Showpeople accommodation dates from 2016. As such there is a need for the Council to update the Travelling Showpeople evidence and undertake an early review of Policy SP9 in relation to Travelling Showpeople.

Policy SP9

Gypsy, Traveller and Travelling Showperson Accommodation

1. The Local Plan makes provision for Gypsy, Traveller and Travelling Showperson accommodation to meet identified needs. There is an identified need of 164 permanent pitches for Gypsy and Traveller accommodation during the Plan period. There is a need to provide 10 Gypsy and Traveller transit pitches. There is an identified need of 76 plots for Travelling Showperson accommodation during the Plan period. Opportunities to provide additional accommodation will be considered in the context of the criteria set out below and in future plans.
2. Land is allocated to accommodate 152 permanent Gypsy and Traveller pitches, 6 transit pitches and 82 Travelling Showperson plots.
3. Proposals for Gypsy, Traveller and Travelling Showperson accommodation on unallocated sites will be permitted, where the proposed development:
 - a. Is consistent in terms of location and size with Local Plan and national planning policy;
 - b. Is accessible to shops, schools and health facilities by public transport, on foot or by cycle;
 - c. Is reasonably accessible to services and will not cause traffic congestion or safety problems;
 - d. In the case of Travelling Showperson sites, the site includes sufficient space for storage and maintenance of equipment and the parking and manoeuvring of all vehicles associated with the occupiers; and
 - e. The site is capable of being provided with adequate on-site services for water supply; power; drainage; sewage disposal and waste disposal facilities.

Employment and Commercial Development

- 6.38** National planning policy is clear that significant weight should be placed on the need to support economic growth and improve productivity. The Wakefield District Economic Strategy 2018-2023 details the themes, actions and key projects the Council and partners will facilitate and undertake in order to ensure Wakefield's economy continues to grow and prosper. The strategy aims to promote 'thriving businesses' by increasing the number of new firms in high value sectors with a focus on growth and innovation in the creative and digital and logistics sector. 'Thriving people' will be promoted with a strong focus on skills development and lifelong learning and interventions to ensure that communities across the district, especially the most deprived, are connected effectively to new economic opportunities. 'Thriving places' will be delivered by continuing to deliver housing growth whilst focusing on improving quality and affordability, improving and supporting town centres and improving public transport linkages and digital infrastructure. Policy SP10 incorporates the aims of national policy and the Economic Strategy to ensure the Local Plan has a clear economic vision to deliver sustainable economic growth.
- 6.39** Changes driven by new technology, innovation, automation, artificial intelligence, customer power and choice, convenience and individualism are increasingly shaping employment as well as the location and demand for employment land. There is a growing need for people and businesses to be agile to adapt to these changes and this posed challenges for understanding and identifying employment land requirements in the Local Plan. The logistics sector has experienced significant change in recent years, becoming more complex and fragmented with the emergence of e-commerce and last mile delivery and collection facilities in or near urban areas. The rise of electronic retailing and internet shopping has been a key driver of last mile logistics, impacting on the final part of a product journey to the customer.
- 6.40** The traditional model of large national and regional distribution centres is being supplemented with a network of smaller facilities serving a variety of functions to provide greater flexibility, choice and convenience. The options for moving products between these facilities is varied and evolving. The land requirements for these facilities are also evolving and the Local Plan needs to accommodate a range of facilities:
- local fulfilment centres (acting as a link between national and regional distribution centres and the customer by sorting orders and preparing them for delivery);
 - click and collect (enabling customers to select a location to collect, such as lockers at train stations, filling stations, shopping centres, and offices); and
 - collect in store (retail stores are increasingly being used as a delivery location).
- 6.41** The amount of floorspace occupied by last mile logistics is expected to increase significantly, particularly in or near urban areas. In response to the competition for this land, which is also sought after for other uses, new property market solutions are starting to emerge, including intensification through multi-storey logistics premises and co-location with other uses.
- 6.42** The Local Plan policies provide opportunities for well located e-commerce activities in the district, including prime Employment Sites near to the strategic road network and Urban Areas, able to accommodate a range of unit sizes; existing Employment Zones and retail parks in urban areas, for a range of facilities; town centres and Special Policy Areas promoting mixed use, where small collection facilities could be incorporated.
- 6.43** Prime land is identified on Employment Sites allocated in the Local Plan with good access to the strategic road network and local labour supply in the nearby Urban Areas within the district, but also in neighbouring areas, which will be the main focus for inward investment and development of e-commerce, manufacturing and logistics facilities and modern industrial practices.

- 6.44** There are a number of local employment and commercial development policies in Chapter 7 of Volume 1 of the Local Plan that should be considered alongside development proposals, where relevant, including LP6 Protecting Employment Land and LP22 New Office Space in Wakefield City Centre. Other more general development management policies will also be relevant to individual proposals.

Policy SP10

Local Economy

1. The Local Plan allocates 508 hectares of developable land for employment use. In addition, as of 1 April 2022, other sources of delivery and supply provide a further 119 hectares, providing a total of 627 hectares of land for employment use over the plan period (numbers are rounded). All this land is allocated for employment uses E(g)(ii) Research and development of products or processes, E(g)(iii) Industrial processes, B2 General Industrial and B8 Storage and Distribution). Ancillary offices associated with these uses will be acceptable on this land.
2. The economic performance of the district will be improved by:
 - a. Providing and safeguarding an adequate supply and variety of land and buildings for employment uses which match employment need and will facilitate inclusive growth across the district, particularly in areas of highest deprivation and in designated Enterprise Zones and Spatial Priority Areas identified in the Leeds City Region Strategic Economic Plan and any successor documents;
 - b. Increasing business productivity, based on higher skills levels, improved educational attainment and greater innovation;
 - c. Creating good quality, skilled jobs and inclusive growth with increased earnings (especially for the low paid);
 - d. Future proofing existing industries at the same time as ushering in new ones, notably in e-commerce logistics, cultural, digital and creative industries and advanced manufacturing;
 - e. Encouraging the development of high quality office led developments in Wakefield city centre;
 - f. Promoting the development of clusters of economic activity, specifically in the logistics and distribution, food and drink and digital and IT sectors;
 - g. Supporting business start-ups, new enterprise and business incubation units in the main urban areas in accordance with the spatial development strategy and in larger industrial estates, and also including homeworking;
 - h. Improving access to employment opportunities by public transport, particularly from the Five Towns and South East of the district;
 - i. Promoting the district as a place to invest;
 - j. Providing new infrastructure for employment development;
 - k. Strengthening and diversifying the urban and rural economy;
 - l. Encouraging new facilities and accommodation for tourists.
3. New employment development will be well located to the Urban Areas of the district within:
 - a. Allocated Employment Sites which are undeveloped sites mainly in prime locations which meet market needs and have good access to the strategic road network;
 - b. Special Policy Areas which are areas allocated for mixed use development which can include employment uses on some sites (where set out in the site specific policy);
 - c. City and town centres, particularly on allocated development sites (where set out in the site specific policy);
 - d. Employment Zones which are designated areas of established employment use, where sites and buildings could be redeveloped and where some vacant land is still available.

In particular:

- i. Commercial offices will be located within:

- Wakefield city centre and in Castleford and Pontefract town centres, particularly on allocated development sites where developers will need to consider the scope for including an element of office floor space in proposals for mixed use development;
- The Special Policy Area SPA14 'Calder Park, Wakefield', which is allocated for development as an office and business park and which meets the need for out of centre office development in the district;
- ii. Light and General Industrial activities will be located within:
 - Urban Areas set out in the spatial development strategy on previously developed land, allocated Employment Sites and in Special Policy Areas, where the site specific policy supports such uses, or existing Employment Zones;
- iii. Warehousing and distribution and advanced manufacturing activities will be located within:
 - Employment Site allocations proposed for this type of use in close proximity to the Strategic Road Network;
 - Existing Employment Zones which are suitable for this type of use, making best use of opportunities for redevelopment, particularly of older stock no longer suited to modern industrial requirements;
 - Special Policy Areas where the site specific policy supports such uses;
- iv. The Special Policy Area SPA18 'Calder Grove, Land at Junction 39 M1 Durkar, Wakefield' will be developed to include an Advanced Manufacturing Park;
- v. For sites which are accessible by rail and/or waterways, developers should make full use of these forms of transport.
- 4. Proposals for energy generation and battery storage facilities should be located, wherever possible, on vacant areas within Employment Sites or Employment Zones. Such proposals, within Employment Sites or Employment Zones, that are on sites or premises in current use will need to satisfy the relevant requirements of the Protecting Employment Land policy (LP6).
- 5. In Local Service Centres, Villages, smaller settlements and rural areas employment development will be of an appropriate scale and create or retain local jobs to reduce the need to travel, diversify the rural economy, and promote sustainable communities.

6.45 The provision of additional well located employment land is essential to the districts future economic prosperity and to achieve the aims of the Economic Strategy. The Local Plan ensures a sufficient supply of suitable employment land that is available, capable of being developed and provides a variety of sites to meet the differing needs of the local economy identified in the Economic Strategy. This supply should be sufficient to ensure that local businesses have the opportunity to expand or relocate within the district and to encourage and facilitate inward investment at all scales.

6.46 Analysis demonstrates there is a diverging market in terms of warehousing and distribution with strong demand for very large units as major distribution companies and retailers re-engineer processes based on integrated, increasing automated regional and national distribution centres, alongside strong demand for medium sized units close to consumer markets for local distribution and last mile deliveries. Automation and artificial intelligence will enable better use of internal space and land with potentially an opportunity and demand for taller buildings. Opportunities may exist for intensifying, refurbishing and redeveloping of existing older industrial estates in prime locations for the emerging markets. Market signals indicate demand continues to focus on the M62 and A1 corridors and the plan recognises this in its employment allocations.

6.47 The employment need for the district over the plan period is 625 hectares as set out in the evidence base taking into account the removal of the ecommerce logistics and advanced manufacturing uplift of 41 hectares (see document EX.WDC102: Employment Land Need and Supply Update for details).

The plan identifies a supply of 627 hectares to accommodate this need. Policy SP10 sets out that 508 hectares of developable land is allocated for employment use over the plan period. This is made up of:

- 189 hectares carried forward from the Local Development Framework, of which 101 hectares is prime land.
- 319 hectares of land newly allocated in the plan on Employment Sites and within Special Policy Areas, of which 289 hectares is prime land.

6.48 Additionally, as of 1st April 2022, other sources of delivery and supply provide a further 119 hectares of developable land for employment use over the plan period. This is made up of:

- 36 hectares of completions between 2017/18 and 2021/22;
- 66 hectares under construction;
- 17 hectares with planning permission

6.49 As such 627 hectares of developable land for employment use are identified over the plan period (all numbers are rounded).

6.50 In addition to allocating new Employment Sites for development, the Local Plan also protects existing areas of employment development some of which are designated as Employment Zones. The redevelopment of sites in these zones for employment purposes will generally be supported. Additionally, there are some areas within these zones that are still to be developed.

6.51 Any proposals for non-employment use developments on Employment Sites, Employment Zones and within Special Policy Areas where the site specific policy proposes employment uses will need to conform with the local policy LP6 Protecting Employment Land.

Retail and Town Centres

Wakefield Retail, Leisure and Town Centres Study - August 2013 Updated November 2018

- 6.52** GVA was appointed in February 2013 to prepare a district-wide Retail, Leisure and Town Centres Study. The study was prepared to inform the Local Development Framework Retail and Town Centre Local Plan, which was adopted by the Council in 2017. The study established shopping and leisure patterns, reviewed the vitality and viability of the main centres, assessed future quantitative and qualitative need, and provided strategic advice on future needs and an appropriate development strategy. In addition to establishing where local residents visited for specific retail goods, the household survey was also structured to obtain information on where people presently go to pursue their main leisure activities (cinema, ten-pin bowling, health and fitness, eating out and socialising). An assessment was also undertaken in relation to the relative balance between the supply of office floorspace and development land and the requirements projected over the Local Plan period. This informed the town centre hierarchy adopted in the Local Development Framework Retail and Town Centre Local Plan, town centre boundaries, primary shopping areas, primary shopping frontages, and the allocation of development sites within some town centres to provide for quantitative need identified as well as qualitative improvements linked with the regeneration of certain centres.
- 6.53** Since the Retail, Leisure and Town Centres Study 2013 there have been changes in the retail floorspace provision both within the district and the wider West Yorkshire Area. There have been changes in the way people shop for convenience and comparison goods, including the on-going influence of internet shopping. How shoppers undertake their grocery shopping has changed and there is increasing attractiveness of discount food stores such as Lidl and Aldi. There have been changes in retail commitments, with some permissions built out and some having lapsed. There is also a significant recent out of town permission in Castleford, associated with the Castleford Tigers Rugby League stadium development, which includes convenience, comparison and food and drink. The 2013 study considered needs up to 2026 and recommended an update of the evidence after 5 years in 2018. The Local Plan must consider need up to 2036, there have been changes to the way housing need is calculated, and the focus of development for the Local Plan has changed from the Core Strategy. Therefore, it was considered necessary to update the retail evidence for the Local Plan including shopping patterns to establish the need to plan for convenience and comparison. The town centre boundaries, primary shopping areas and primary shopping frontages were adopted in 2017. An update to the Town Centre Floorspace Survey was carried out in 2018 and made recommendations for amendments to the primary shopping area and primary shopping frontage in Wakefield, and the primary shopping area in Castleford. All other town centre boundaries, primary shopping areas and primary shopping frontages remain unchanged. The Council commissioned a separate office study to support the Local Plan.
- 6.54** The quantitative need assessment update 2018 was carried out by GVA and concluded that there is no need to plan for significant further convenience or comparison shopping during the plan period, in view of recent completions and commitments and changes to shopping patterns, except in Ossett. Here, trading performance of existing stores has increased since the 2013 study and it remains the case that a modest amount of additional convenience goods floorspace could be provided (circa 900m²) if the town was able to increase its market share via the provision of a new store. However, in order to protect the health of the town centre, this approach should only be pursued where the new floorspace is provided in a central location which can maintain and enhance the centre. Forecast comparison goods floorspace capacity in Ossett is very modest with no requirement to plan for any increase in provision. A town centre site was identified in the Local Development Framework Retail and Town Centre Local Plan 2017 to accommodate this need. However, the site is no longer available for redevelopment and no alternative site is available to deliver this in a central location.

- 6.55** National planning policy sets out that policies and decisions should support the role that town centres play at the heart of local communities, by taking a positive approach to their growth, management and adaptation. Planning policies should define a network and hierarchy of town centres and promote their long-term vitality and viability – by allowing them to grow and diversify in a way that can respond to rapid changes in the retail and leisure industries, allows a suitable mix of uses (including housing) and reflects their distinctive characters.
- 6.56** Promoting the diversification of other town centre uses such as leisure, entertainment, offices, arts, culture, tourism facilities and housing, particularly as part of mixed-use developments, whilst retaining a strong and high quality retail core, is important for maintaining the vitality and viability of existing centres and for supporting the process of urban renaissance. The Local Plan will aim to create attractive, successful and accessible city and town centres across the district with a range of high quality retail, cultural and leisure opportunities available to enhance the quality of life for residents and visitors, by encouraging development of an appropriate type and scale in city and town centres.
- 6.57** Policies in the Local Plan seek to ensure that town centres are an attractive place to live, work, visit and invest. The policies in the Local Plan seek to focus new main town centre uses and appropriate other uses within existing centres in sustainable locations, allowing for the diversification of centres to support regeneration, investment, and the creation of new job opportunities. Diversification of town centres will be important in responding to changes in shopping habits such as online retailing and click and collect, and to increase opportunities for leisure and cultural experiences to support town centre vitality and viability. As part of this diversification, town centres also provide opportunities for new residential development in sustainable locations, with good access to facilities and services and public transport links.
- 6.58** The Local Plan establishes a settlement hierarchy to guide the scale and location of new development within the district over the Plan period. This is reflected in the Retail Hierarchy, which sets out all the centres in the district to be considered when carrying out a sequential test and an impact assessment and provides an indication of their relevant status. A sequential approach will be used to focus main town centre uses within existing centres to support vitality, viability and diversification. However, the sequential approach will not be applied to small scale proposals for main town centre uses of 300m² gross external floor space or less, including small scale rural offices. This makes provision for local shops, facilities and services to serve the day to day needs of the community and supports sustainable rural communities. The application to small scale rural offices or other small scale rural development will be a cumulative figure for the site that will take into account previous development covered by the sequential test.
- 6.59** 300m² relates closely to the floorspace limit applied for Sunday trading purposes, as well as the Council's view about what constitutes a local shop. The threshold of 300m² is intended to exclude the need for assessments for small shops and leisure development. Small shops and leisure uses of up to 300m² are facilities that are considered to serve the day-to-day needs of their immediate locality. Above 300m² the Council considers the development would serve more than day-to-day needs and should, therefore, be located in a town centre. The sequential approach would apply in relation to the Retail Hierarchy. A similar threshold should apply to define other small scale rural development, based on the size of rural development approved around the district outside of centres, which is typically between 200–300m².
- 6.60** There are a number of local retail and town centre policies in Chapter 7 of Volume 1 of the Local Plan that should be considered alongside development proposals, where relevant, including LP8 Retail Development in Town Centres, LP9 Large Retail Development on the Edge of Town Centres, LP10 Impact Assessment, LP11 Non-Retail Development in Primary Shopping Frontages

and LP12 Hot Food Takeaways. There are also a number of other specific local policies for Wakefield City Centre and Pontefract Town Centre in Chapter 7. Other more general development management policies will also be relevant to individual proposals.

Policy SP11

Retail and Town Centres

Wakefield city centre is and will remain the largest and dominant centre in the district, performing a sub-regional role. Castleford and Pontefract will remain important retail centres serving the Five Towns area. Other designated town centres will continue to provide shopping facilities for localised catchments. Development will take place at a scale appropriate to the size, role and function of the settlement. To guide this approach a Retail Hierarchy has been defined.

Within town centres the Council will encourage and co-ordinate private and public sector investment and action. The emphasis will be on exploiting the opportunities for better quality retail development, improving the urban environment, provision of housing, ancillary leisure and social facilities, and promoting the heritage, advantages and attractiveness of town centres. Priority will be given to the needs of pedestrians, followed by cyclists, public transport users and then motorists.

City and town centres will provide a range of main town centre uses to promote choice and diversity, whilst retaining a strong retail core. Proposals shall support the vitality and viability of the city and town centres. Main town centre uses will be located within the town centres as shown on the Policies Map, and then in accordance with the sequential test as set out in national planning policy. The town centre is defined by the Primary Shopping Area in the Sub-Regional City, Principal Towns and Main Towns, for the purposes of the sequential approach to retail development.

The sequential approach will not be required for small scale proposals for main town centre uses of 300m² gross external floorspace or under. In the case of small scale rural offices or other small scale rural development this will be a cumulative figure for the site that will take into account previous development for uses covered by the sequential test.

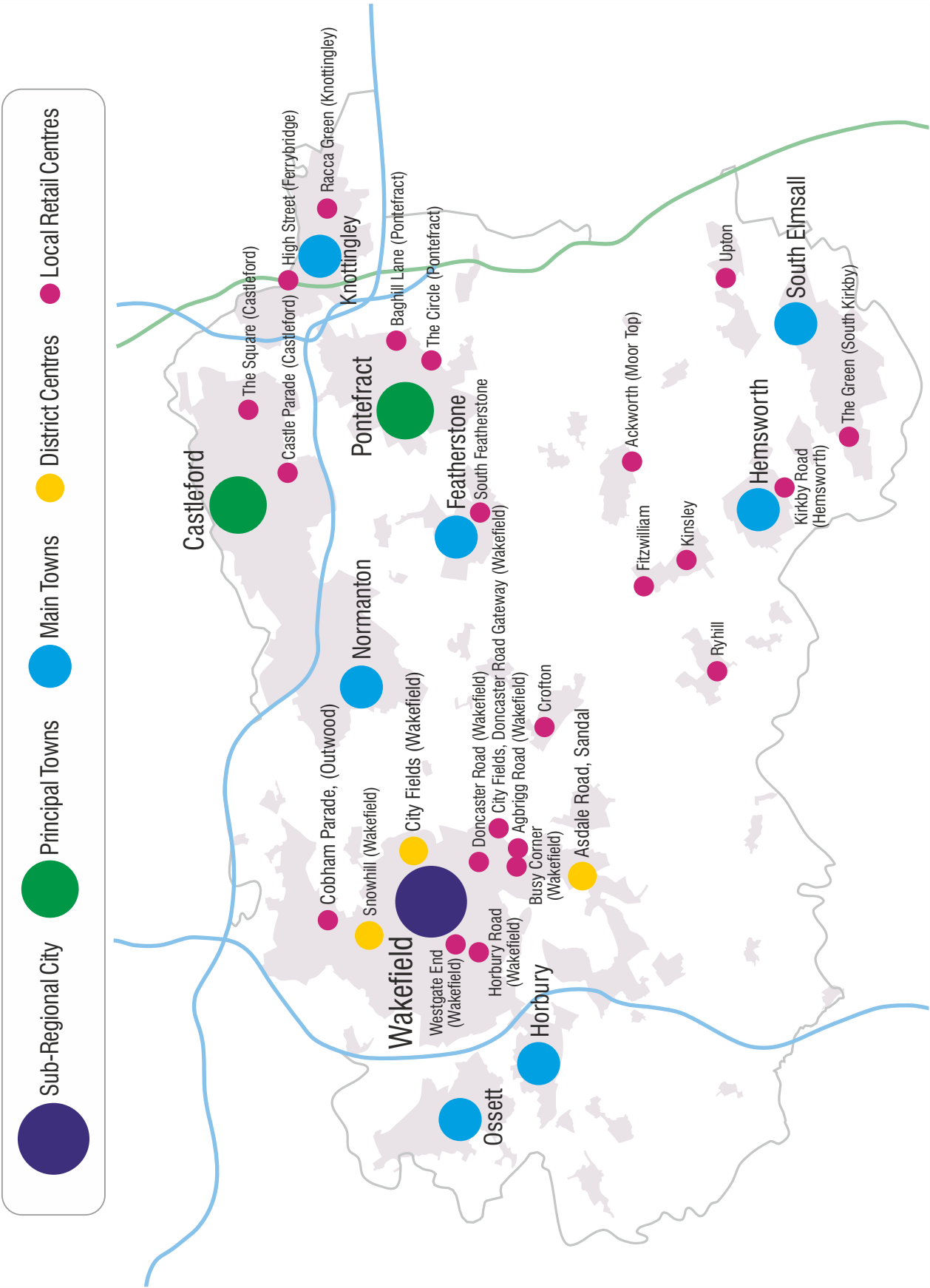
Out of centre retail and town centre related uses will only be permitted where they meet the requirements of national planning policy.

6.61 The following table sets out the Retail Hierarchy and Map 3 shows the spatial distribution of the town centres in the Retail Hierarchy.

Table 4 Retail Hierarchy

Centre Type	Location	Description
Sub-Regional City	Wakefield	Largest and dominant retail centre performing a sub-regional role for comparison, main food shopping, financial and professional services; offices; entertainment, sport and leisure; arts, culture and tourism facilities; further and higher education; and health services.
Principal Towns	Castleford, Pontefract	Important retail centres serving the Five Towns area for main food shopping, day to day convenience and comparison shopping. The focus for the local provision of financial services; offices; entertainment and leisure facilities; arts, culture and tourism facilities, further education; and health services.
Main Towns	Normanton, Featherstone, Knottingley, Ossett, Horbury, Hemsworth, South Elmsall	Provide day to day convenience and comparison shopping facilities, financial services, food and drink, leisure and health services for localised catchment.
District Centres	Asdale Road (Sandal), City Fields (Wakefield) [Not yet Built], Snowhill (Wakefield)	Provide a range of shopping for everyday needs. The local focus for basic financial services, food and drink, leisure and health services.
Local Retail Centres	Westgate End (Wakefield), Horbury Road (Wakefield), Busy Corner (Wakefield), Doncaster Road (Wakefield), Agbrigg Road (Wakefield), City Fields - Doncaster Road Gateway (Wakefield) [Not Yet Built], Castle Parade (Castleford), The Square (Castleford), Baghill Lane (Pontefract), The Circle (Pontefract), South Featherstone (Featherstone) [Not yet built], Ackworth (Manor Top), Cobham Parade (Outwood), Racca Green (Knottingley), Kirkby Road (Hemsworth), The Green (South Kirkby), High Street (Ferrybridge), Crofton, Fitzwilliam, Kinsley, Ryhill, Upton	Provide for top-up shopping and local services particularly food and drink.

Map 3 Distribution of Town Centres



Leisure

- 6.62** The term 'leisure' covers a range of activities which require a variety of facilities. Leisure facilities provide for the cultural, sport and recreational needs of the community and include uses such as theatre, cinema, museums and galleries, sport facilities and leisure centres, open space and countryside, heritage and tourism. Main visitor attractions in the district include The Hepworth Museum and Gallery, Theatre Royal, National Coal Mining Museum, Yorkshire Sculpture Park, Nostell Priory, Xscape, Diggerland, Pontefract Racecourse, Pontefract Castle, and Sandal Castle.
- 6.63** The provision of high quality, well maintained recreational facilities is essential for the health and wellbeing of the district's residents. To be sustainable facilities need to be provided locally and be easily accessible to communities. The Council is seeking to get a diverse and balanced mix of activities and facilities across the district to meet the needs of residents and visitors. Most new leisure, cultural and visitor facilities will be located within urban areas taking advantage of existing services and high levels of accessibility. Suitable sites for major facilities such as sports hubs, leisure centres with swimming pools or stadia cannot always be found in urban areas, in which case they should be located at the edge of the urban area and be accessible by public transport. In Local Service Centres, Villages and smaller settlements development must be appropriate to the size of the settlement, meet identified needs and help create a balanced and sustainable community. A few exceptions include location or resource specific attractions and activities such as heritage sites, sailing lakes and outdoor sport facilities.
- 6.64** There are a number of local policies relating to leisure, recreation and open space in Chapter 7 of Volume 1 of the Local Plan that should be considered alongside development proposals, where relevant, including LP24 Strategic Leisure Corridors, LP25 Leisure Opportunity Areas, LP26 Recreational Use of Watercourses, LP28 Green and Blue Infrastructure, LP46 Open Space, LP47 Open Space in New Development, LP48 Requirements for Open Space in New Housing Development, LP49 Protected Areas of Open Land and LP50 Sports Facilities. Other more general development management policies will also be relevant to individual proposals.

Policy SP12

Leisure, Recreation and Open Space

1. Good quality, well maintained leisure, recreation and open space facilities will be secured to address identified deficiencies and to meet the needs of local communities. Key measures include:
 - a. Improving facilities for health and fitness in central Wakefield and in urban areas such as Sun Lane leisure centre and pool in Wakefield, Minsthorpe leisure centre and pool in South Elmsall, and the Five Towns leisure centre and pool in Pontefract;
 - b. Providing access to green spaces and green infrastructure to promote health and mental well-being particularly through environmental enhancements and increasing links for walking and cycling;
 - c. Protecting and improving sports facilities and playing pitches, including creating Sports Hubs at key sites such as Pontefract Park, Spring Mill Ossett and Thornes Park Wakefield;
 - d. Encouraging community use of school sports facilities and the co-location of leisure facilities so different types of open space, sport and recreation can be located next to each other and in close proximity to other community facilities for education and health;
 - e. Supporting initiatives which enable or improve access to growing healthy food such as community food growing initiatives and allotments.
2. The provision of leisure and recreation facilities will be of a scale appropriate to the type and size of settlement. Generally new leisure, cultural and visitor facilities will be located within town

centres or urban areas and be accessible by walking, cycling and public transport. These facilities include cinemas, restaurants, drive-through restaurants, bars and pubs, night clubs, casinos, health and fitness centres, indoor bowling centres, bingo halls, theatres, museums, galleries, concert halls, hotels and conference centres.

b) Infrastructure

- 6.65** The following strategic policies promote healthy and safe communities, sustainable transport and streets for people; make provision for minerals, waste and energy generation; and support the provision of high quality digital communications infrastructure.
- 6.66** Providing housing and employment opportunities alone is not sufficient to create sustainable communities. There is a need to provide the necessary supporting infrastructure, including utility services, transport, schools, health and energy. These services are provided by a range of organisations, but there is a need to integrate this provision to meet the needs of existing communities, and those of the future.
- 6.67** An integrated approach to infrastructure provision is essential for Wakefield Council and its partners to fulfil their place shaping role. The Local Plan sets out a number of strategic infrastructure and investment proposals, particularly in relation to transport and individual allocations, to identify where infrastructure will be provided as part of new development. The Council prepared Infrastructure Delivery Plan Evidence in support of the Local Development Framework Site Specific Policies Local Plan 2012 and the Community Infrastructure Levy 2016. This evidence has been updated during the course of preparing the Local Plan to identify the infrastructure required to support the delivery of the growth set out in the plan, what funding sources are available, and where there may be funding gaps. The Local Plan Infrastructure Study also considers infrastructure funding through developer contributions, including the Community Infrastructure Levy and Section 106 agreements. Developer contributions have also been taken into account through the Local Plan viability evidence.
- 6.68** It is important to note that gaps in infrastructure will not always be met by the Council. Many organisations, both public and private, are involved in infrastructure delivery. The aim of the Local Plan in this context is to attempt to bring these strands together, to co-ordinate investment, as far as possible, in land use terms. Equally it should not be assumed that landowners and developers will always be able to fill these gaps as part of new developments, although they should contribute to wider infrastructure investments where justified and be related in scale and kind to the development.

Transport

- 6.69** Ensuring homes, jobs, shops, facilities and services are accessible by good quality, safe and convenient transport is essential to achieving sustainable development. Satisfying travel needs for individuals and businesses whilst reducing the need to travel, particularly by car, and promoting less environmentally damaging forms of transport is also essential to sustainability. Increasing the proportion of journeys made by public transport, cycling, and walking benefits all sections of society. It provides a means of reducing delay, costs, greenhouse gas emissions, pollution and accidents, conserving resources and sustaining balanced communities that might otherwise become restricted to those with access to a car. Travel planning will have an increasingly important role to play in supporting sustainable modes of travel.
- 6.70** Investment in the transport network is crucial for securing sustainable economic growth and communities. Improvements are required and identified for the cycle, footway, local and strategic highway, rail and waterway networks. The Council will work closely with National Highways, Canal and River Trust, Transport for the North and the West Yorkshire Combined Authority to deliver the transport investment necessary to deliver the Council's inclusive growth ambitions. The Council will work to secure the upgrade of the A1 Redhouse to Darrington to motorway standard; the introduction of managed motorway M62 junctions 30 to 32a; and the development and delivery of the two Leeds City Region Inclusive Growth Corridors between the Five Towns and Leeds, and between Barnsley, Wakefield and Leeds. A new mass transit system for West Yorkshire, being developed by the Combined Authority, will be a key element, linking communities with a quick and reliable service and integrated with cycling, walking, bus and rail.
- 6.71** The Vision of the Local Plan is for sustainable patterns of living to support distinctive, vibrant and well designed places, with balanced communities, improved transport infrastructure and people living healthy, active lifestyles. The Development Principles and Strategy seek to deliver integrated and accessible transport systems, with walking, cycling and public transport designed to create streets for people and be the most attractive forms of local transport. These reflect the objectives of national planning policy, the West Yorkshire Emissions Reduction Pathway, the West Yorkshire Connectivity Plan, the West Yorkshire Rail Vision, and the West Yorkshire Transport Strategy 2040. Research and advice has been published in recent years, including: "Green Streets" issued by the West Yorkshire Combined Authority and Yorkshire West Local Nature Partnership in 2015; "Transport for New Homes Project Summary and Recommendations", issued by the Foundation for Integrated Transport in 2018; "Better planning, better transport , better places", issued the Chartered Institute of Highways and Transportation in 2019; and "Net Zero Transport" issued by The Royal Town Planning Institute in 2021. These provide useful guidance for incorporating appropriate transport solutions to deliver sustainable patterns of living, alongside a reduction in transport based carbon emissions.
- 6.72** In 2017 the government published its first Cycling and Walking Investment Strategy, which sets out an ambition to make cycling and walking the natural choices for shorter journeys or as part of a longer journey. Local Cycling and Walking Infrastructure Plans (LCWIPs) form part of the Strategy and set out a new, strategic approach to identifying cycling and walking improvements required at the local level. They enable a long-term approach to developing cycling and walking networks so that the government's objectives can be achieved.
- 6.73** The first phase of the Wakefield LCWIP covers:
- An initial area of cycling network development in north and south Wakefield;
 - A Core Walking Zone in Wakefield city centre; and
 - Lists of potential infrastructure improvements for walking and cycling.

- 6.74** West Yorkshire Combined Authority have recently finalised their Bus Services Improvement Plan, which forms the basis of an enhanced partnership with bus operators and district councils. This identifies where properties are within 400 metres of a bus stop with access to a core bus network of high frequency services (four buses per hour Monday to Saturday daytime). The Bus Services Improvement Plan aims to increase access to the core bus network, taking account of the local circumstances. This, or any subsequent replacement, will be used to inform transport assessments and travel plans for new development in the district.
- 6.75** There are a number of local policies relating to transport in Chapter 7 of Volume 1 of the Local Plan that should be considered alongside development proposals, where relevant, including LP27 Access and Highway Safety and LP34 Electric Vehicle Charging Infrastructure. Transport Schemes are shown on the Policies Map. District wide Transport Schemes affecting more than one settlement are set out in Chapter 8 of Volume 1 of the Local Plan. Settlement specific Transport Schemes can be found in Volume 2 of the Local Plan. Other more general development management policies will also be relevant to individual proposals.

Policy SP13

Sustainable Transport

Accessibility to jobs and services by sustainable transport is key to building sustainable communities in the district and creating a competitive and efficient labour market within the sub-region. Priority will be given to locating development and directing investment to improve access to job opportunities between Leeds and Wakefield districts, reconnecting communities in the South-East of the district to Wakefield and the Five Towns, encouraging efficient public transport and tackling congestion in the Urban Areas, particularly in Wakefield and Pontefract.

New development will be located in accordance with the spatial development strategy so that the need to travel is reduced and essential travel needs can be met by the use of transport modes other than the private car. Transport assessments and travel plans will be required for all major planning applications. In particular development will be located where:

- a. It can be served by alternative modes of transport other than the car, such public transport, walking and cycling;
- b. The traffic generated can be accommodated by existing or known improvements to highways and where it will not result in an unacceptable impact on highway safety, or severe residual cumulative impacts on the road network;
- c. In the case of residential development, it is within convenient walking distance of essential local facilities and where possible is within 400 metres of existing or proposed public transport services;
- d. It makes best use of existing transport networks and has regard to future transport investment proposals, so as to enhance the viability of public transport services, such as the West Yorkshire Transport Strategy 2040 - partnership working between West Yorkshire Combined Authority, district councils and the Association of Bus Operators in West Yorkshire and the Leeds City Region Transport Strategy. Where appropriate investment and delivery will be coordinated with Sheffield City Region, taking account of relevant Sheffield City Region transport strategies;
- e. It will improve accessibility to jobs and services for those without access to a car and those from disadvantaged groups and areas, and those who make a positive choice not to travel by car;
- f. Development which generates a large number of passenger movements shall be located in Wakefield city centre, in other town centres in the main urban areas or at locations which provide convenient access on foot, by cycle and public transport.

The number and proportion of journeys by public transport, cycling and on foot will be increased by:

- g. Creating integrated, safe and attractive public transport, cycling and footpath networks across the district in support of the Local Cycling and Walking Infrastructure Plan and the District Cycle Network Plan;
- h. Giving priority to buses, cyclists and pedestrians over the private car, particularly in urban areas;
- i. Promoting the integration of cycling and walking with public transport as part of longer journeys;
- j. Improving the frequency, reliability and quality of public transport services and infrastructure in support of the West Yorkshire Bus Strategy 2040;
- k. Giving priority to investment in public transport infrastructure and services in areas where public transport accessibility is poor (such as rural areas and settlements in the South East of the district and particularly their connection with settlements in the Five Towns area, urban extensions and Employment Sites);
- l. Giving priority to Urban Areas, notably Wakefield and Pontefract, where congestion reduces public transport efficiency; and
- m. Improving bus stopping facilities in support of the commitments and specifications of the West Yorkshire Bus alliance and Bus Strategy 2040.

Policy SP14

Transport Network

The ability to move goods is particularly important given Wakefield District's strategic position on the national motorway, rail, waterway networks and its links with regional facilities, such as Doncaster Sheffield Robin Hood Airport and Humber Ports. This gives the district a distinct advantage for logistics, warehousing and distribution. Efficient access for goods and services is also a key factor in supporting the vitality of urban areas. In order to achieve a balanced and integrated transport network which makes the most efficient and effective use of road, rail and water transport, consistent with the priorities identified in the Strategic Economic Plan and West Yorkshire Transport Strategy 2040:

- a. Targeted improvements to the highway network will relieve traffic congestion and new roads will open up development sites. The needs of cars will be balanced with other road users to reflect the function of the road/needs of different places/communities to influence travel choices through demand management;
- b. Investments in the transport network will include support for the regeneration of Wakefield city centre and addressing the legacy of sub-standard infrastructure in the former coalfields areas, particularly in the south-east of the district;
- c. Development proposals will have access to the appropriate category of road to ensure that traffic can be accommodated safely and conveniently. Improvements to the highway network will be used to manage traffic effectively, relieve congestion and give priority to buses, in particular schemes at:
 - i. Knottingley Sustainable Transport Package, Knottingley;
 - ii. South Featherstone Link Road, Ackworth Featherstone and Pontefract;
 - iii. Broad Lane Improvement Scheme, South Kirkby;
 - iv. Denby Dale Road M1 Junction 39, Wakefield;
 - v. Ings Road, Wakefield;
 - vi. A650 Newton Bar Roundabout, Wakefield.
- d. Improvements to the rail network will include improving capacity, journey times and quality of public transport links between the urban centres in the district, Leeds City Region and South Yorkshire, particularly to Wakefield and Leeds city centre at peak times;
- e. The statutory rail undertaker will be consulted where development is likely to result in a material increase in the volume, or a material change in the character of traffic using a level crossing over a railway, or impact upon rail infrastructure. A full transport assessment and mitigation measures will be required for development that may increase the level of pedestrian and/or

vehicular usage at a level crossing. The developer shall assess the impacts any development could have upon the railway infrastructure and provide for appropriate mitigation and funding for improvements;

- f. Better use will be made of the inland waterway and rail networks in the district, including the Aire & Calder and Calder and Hebble navigation and the regional rail/road transfer facility at Wakefield Europort. Opportunities will be taken to link major freight movement origins and destinations to the rail network. Developments which generate large volumes of freight traffic or involve the transport of bulk materials will include, or be located close to, inter-modal transfer facilities, rail freight facilities or wharves and make use of rail or water for freight movements, wherever practical. Sites which are used or suitable for inter-modal transfer facilities, rail freight facilities and the loading and unloading of water-borne freight will be protected for these uses and water and rail freight connections to existing industrial sites will be retained wherever possible and the development of new inter-modal transfer facilities, new rail sidings and rail freight facilities and new wharves will be encouraged. There are significant opportunities to import seaborne aggregates from the Humber towards sites in the district and large development sites next to the waterways shall consider the use of the waterway for the import of construction materials;
- g. High quality, safe cycle, footpath and bridleway networks will be safeguarded and extended to provide opportunities to reduce the number of short car journeys and for cycling, walking and riding for recreation in the countryside. Disused railway lines and waterways across the district, including the former Barnsley Canal, will be protected from other forms of development to safeguard their potential to be reinstated to their former use for commercial or leisure purposes or to extend the cycling or footpath networks.

6.76 The Local Road Network Schemes referred to in part c of policy SP14 are indicative safeguarded alignments, which will be subject to further assessment and evaluation work before construction. The Policies Map and allocations confirm that these are safeguarded alignments rather than the final scheme.

Policy SP15

Influencing the Demand for Travel

The Council will work with neighbouring councils and relevant national, regional and sub-regional agencies to develop a co-ordinated long term approach to manage the demand for travel. The spatial development strategy seeks to maximise the use of sustainable modes of travel – public transport, walking and cycling and reduce the need to travel by concentrating development in city/town centres. The strategy is supported by the District Wide Parking Standards set out in the Street Design Guide Supplementary Planning Document. Alongside this strategy, the Council will influence the demand for travel through:

- a. Managing the amount of car parking in new development through the application of parking standards in the Street Design Guide Supplementary Planning Document, which require minimum parking levels for residential development and maximum parking levels for industrial and commercial development;
- b. Reducing car parking provision on city/town centre sites where public car parking or alternative modes of transport are available, particularly in Wakefield city centre, and Pontefract and Castleford town centres;
- c. Reducing long stay parking (other than at railway stations and park and ride sites) and transfer spaces to short stay, where appropriate;

- d. Introducing park and ride facilities on major transport routes in association with public transport service improvements and measures which give priority to public transport in the use of road-space;
- e. Securing local and area wide Travel Plans to reduce the number of single occupancy car trips generated by or attracted to new development working in partnership with relevant organisations including National Highways and West Yorkshire Combined Authority.

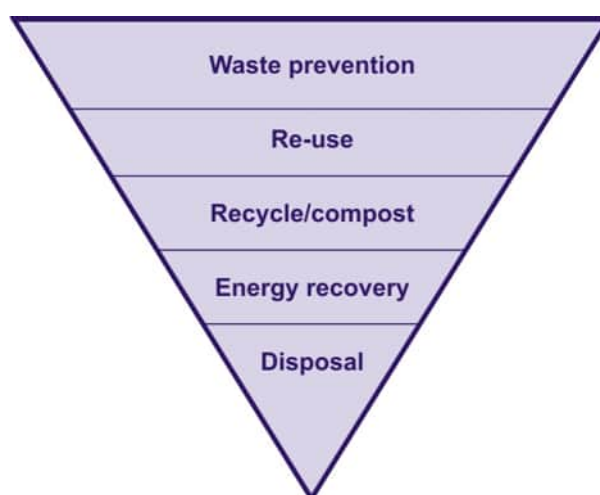
Waste

6.77 Waste has traditionally been seen as a by-product of living, to be disposed of by the cheapest possible method, normally direct to landfill without pre-treatment. In the drive to achieve sustainable development, this approach is no longer acceptable. It is essential that greater emphasis is placed on avoiding waste production and managing waste produced in the most sustainable way, making use of waste as a resource and only disposing of the residue that has no value.

6.78 The EU Waste Framework Directive (2008/98/EC) sets out five categories of waste management in order of priority in the 'Waste Hierarchy' (see the figure below): Prevention, Preparing for Re-Use, Recycling, Other recovery, Disposal. This has been incorporated in to the Waste Management Plan for England (January 2021) and the National Planning Policy for Waste (October 2014). The hierarchy encourages the movement of waste up the waste hierarchy, with positive environmental effects. The waste management hierarchy has been reflected in waste planning policy for the district:

- Waste prevention means to reduce the amount of waste produced
- Re-use means to use products and materials again for the same or a different purpose;
- Recycling and composting which seeks to recover resources from waste;
- Energy recovery where value can be recovered by producing energy from waste; and
- Disposal where waste should be disposed of only if none of the above offers an appropriate solution.

Figure 5 Waste Management Hierarchy



6.79 National planning policy on waste management is set out in National Planning Policy for Waste 2014. The Council's aim for sustainable waste management is that an adequate range of waste management facilities should be provided to ensure that waste is treated and disposed of in a sustainable and environmentally acceptable way, balancing the economic, social and environmental needs of the district, and moving waste up the hierarchy. The following policy provides the strategic framework for achieving sustainable waste management.

6.80 There are a number of local policies relating to waste management in Chapter 7 of Volume 1 of the Local Plan that should be considered alongside development proposals, where relevant, including LP42 Location of Other Waste Management Facilities, LP43 New Waste Management Facilities and LP44 Waste Facilities within Development. Sites allocated for waste management are shown on the Policies Map and are set out in Chapter 8 of Volume 1 of the Local Plan. Other more general development management policies will also be relevant to individual proposals.

Policy SP16

Strategic Approach to Waste Management

The Council will work with its partners including the Environment Agency, the West Yorkshire Combined Authority, other local authorities, the waste industry and community groups to ensure the integration of strategies and proposals for sustainable and environmentally effective waste management, having regard to cross-boundary issues, including waste movement and location of facilities in adjacent areas; working collaboratively with other waste planning authorities to provide a suitable network of facilities to deliver sustainable waste management to meet the identified needs of the district.

1. Waste will be managed in accordance with the principles of the waste management hierarchy in the following order:
 - i. Prevention;
 - ii. Preparing for re-use;
 - iii. Recycling;
 - iv. Other recovery;
 - v. Disposal.
2. Proposals for waste management facilities to deal with all forms of waste arisings within the district will be considered based on the following general principles:
 - a. Moving the management of all waste streams up the waste hierarchy;
 - b. Promoting opportunities for on-site management and processing of waste where it arises, including Construction Waste, Demolition and Excavation Waste, and Agricultural Waste and other waste arisings;
 - c. Achieving the objectives and targets for recycling/recovery for waste set out in the Council's Municipal Waste Management Strategy;
 - d. Achieving regional, sub-regional, local authority and neighbourhood self-sufficiency, at the lowest practicable level for the waste stream concerned;
 - e. Promoting opportunities to co-locate facilities together and with complementary activities (reflecting the concept of resource recovery parks) subject to there being no significant adverse effects.

Waste Management Capacity

- 6.81** The Council's Municipal Waste Management Strategy 2003 provided for a number of waste management facilities to enable the move away from landfill disposal, towards more sustainable means of dealing with waste arisings. This was reflected in the Local Development Framework Waste Development Plan Document 2009. The following facilities identified within these plans and strategies have now been completed:
- South Kirkby Strategic Waste Management Facility for managing municipal waste, household waste recycling and commercial and industrial waste recovery.
 - Household Waste Recycling Facilities at Denby Dale Road, Wakefield and Flass Lane, Glasshoughton.
- 6.82** At present residual waste is still managed at Welbeck landfill site, Normanton.
- 6.83** The implementation of the Municipal Waste Management Strategy has supported the target of 52% recycling of household waste produced in the district.
- 6.84** The Waste Evidence Base Report (2018) provides data on the total amount of waste produced (known as waste arisings), and how waste is currently managed, along with the future requirements for increased capacity/new waste management facilities. The West Yorkshire Combined Authority

Waste Needs Assessment Capacity Gap Analysis Model, 2017, and the Environment Agency waste data interrogators have been used to identify current waste arisings and waste management, estimated waste forecasts during the plan period and the estimated capacity gap for different types of waste to 2036. This is set out in detail in the evidence base report.

6.85 The following types of waste have been considered in the Local Plan:

- **Municipal Waste:** household waste and any other wastes collected by Wakefield Council (or their agents) as waste collection authority such as from municipal parks and gardens waste and commercial or industrial premises and waste resulting from the clearance of fly-tipped materials;
- **Commercial and Industrial Waste:** broadly, commercial waste is classified as waste arising from wholesalers, catering establishments, shops and offices (in both the public and private sectors) while industrial waste is waste arising from factories and industrial premises. Neither of these categories includes consideration of wastes from the construction, demolition and excavation sectors (see below);
- **Inert/Construction, Demolition and Excavation Waste:** waste generated from site construction or refurbishment, demolition or excavation. Includes material such as rubble, metals, wood, glass etc;
- **Hazardous Waste:** materials that possess one or more of the hazardous properties set out in the Hazardous Waste Directive such as oils, pesticides and chemicals;
- **Agricultural Waste:** i.e. waste from farming, forestry, horticulture and similar activities.

Baseline Waste Arisings

6.86 The following table sets out the total waste arisings by type in Wakefield in 2015. The largest category of waste arisings was commercial and industrial waste (619,439 tonnes) followed by construction, demolition and excavation (300,113 tonnes) and then municipal waste (191,633 tonnes).

Table 5 Waste Arisings by Type in Wakefield district 2015 (Source Waste Data Flow)

Type of Waste	Waste Arisings (Tonnes)
Municipal Waste	191,633
Commercial and Industrial Waste	619,439
Construction, Demolition and Excavation Waste	300,113
Hazardous Waste	53,626
Agricultural Waste (leaving farm units)	1,178
Waste Water Treatment	27,186
Total	1,193,175

Waste Forecasts

6.87 Economic growth, population growth and increasing numbers of households will all have an impact on the amount of waste that is produced within Wakefield over the plan period. The Council will need to ensure that there is an appropriate level of infrastructure and services to support future growth needs within the district, including the need to manage existing and future waste arisings. The WYCA Waste Needs Assessment Capacity Gap Analysis Model (2017) enables future capacity

gap analysis to be calculated based on a combination of Growth Scenarios – no growth, median growth or maximum growth - and Behaviour Scenarios – baseline behaviour, median recycling or maximum recycling.

6.88 The Local Plan is planning for an up-lift on top of the household projections to 1,400 new homes per year, which is linked to ambitions for jobs growth. Therefore, the assumption applied for growth is **Maximum Growth**. Wakefield is currently achieving the 2020 target of 50% recycling for municipal waste and the target in the contract for the municipal waste management facilities is for a maximum of 10% landfill. However, there has not been a comparable scale of investment in the commercial side of waste management in recent years. Therefore, the behaviour assumption applied is **Median Recycling** which includes the assumption of median landfill.

6.89 Based on these assumptions the forecast waste arisings 2017-2036 are as follows:

Table 6 Forecast Waste Arisings by Type in Wakefield district, 2017-2036 (Source: West Yorkshire Combined Authority Waste Needs Assessment Capacity Gap Model, 2017)

Type of Waste	Waste Arisings, Tonnes Per Year							
	2017	2018	2019	2020	2021	2026	2031	2036
Municipal Waste	172,953	173,958	174,910	175,824	176,701	181,169	185,288	188,862
Commercial and Industrial Waste	627,743	630,896	634,443	638,194	642,631	669,590	691,775	712,961
Construction, Demolition and Excavation Waste	304,127	305,664	307,383	309,200	311,350	324,410	335,159	345,424
Hazardous Waste	45,332	45,559	45,816	46,086	46,407	48,354	49,956	51,486
Agricultural Waste	1,178	1,178	1,178	1,178	1,178	1,178	1,178	1,178
Total	1,151,333	1,157,255	1,163,730	1,170,482	1,178,267	1,224,701	1,263,356	1,299,911

6.90 The forecasts predict that there will be a progressive increase in the overall waste arisings over the plan period with an increase in most types of waste.

Current Waste Management

6.91 Existing waste deposits by waste management site type for 2016 are set out in the table below. Of the total 1,492,933 tonnes of waste deposited at facilities in Wakefield, 40% was received by material recycling facilities. The two other major waste management site types in Wakefield are inert landfill, which accounts for 14% of total waste deposits, and non-hazardous landfill which accounts for 17% of total waste deposits.

Table 7 Waste Deposits in Wakefield district by Management Site Type 2016 (Source: Environment Agency Waste Data Interrogator, 2016 data)

Waste Management Site Type	Waste Deposits (Tonnes)
Landfill	458,636

Waste Management Site Type	Waste Deposits (Tonnes)
Metal Recycling Facilities	36,341
On/In land (recovery)	8,508
Transfer (household waste recycling, clinical waste transfer, hazardous waste transfer, non-hazardous waste transfer)	146,505
Treatment (biological, inert, materials recycling facilities, non-hazardous waste, electronic equipment)	811,047
Use of Waste (construction)	31,896
Total	1,492,933

Landfill Capacity

- 6.92** There are currently four operational landfill facilities in Wakefield – two inert landfill facilities and two non-hazardous landfill facilities (based at four sites). The largest landfill facility in Wakefield, which only accepts non-hazardous waste, is the Welbeck landfill site, near Normanton. In 2017, the remaining void capacity at these sites was 995,619m³ inert landfill and 1,540,000m³ non-hazardous landfill capacity (at Welbeck) (WYCA Waste Needs Assessment Capacity Gap Model, 2017). At present residual waste is still managed at Welbeck landfill site, Normanton.
- 6.93** Welbeck landfill site was due to close in 2018, but planning permission was granted in September 2018 (18/00754/WAS, 6 September 2018) to extend the non-hazardous deposit period of Welbeck from May 2018 to end December 2023. Restoration with imported soils is due to be finished by 2025.

Municipal Waste

- 6.94** Municipal waste is currently managed at household waste recycling facilities Denby Dale Road, Wakefield and Flass Lane, Glasshoughton and at South Kirkby Strategic Waste Management Facility.

Commercial and Industrial Waste

- 6.95** There are a number of existing commercial and industrial waste management facilities operating within the district: these include cullet (i.e. waste glass) treatment plants in Knottingley operated by Berryman and glass recycling as part of the Ardagh Glass operations in Knottingley. Other operations include taking packaging waste from supermarkets to regional distribution centres (e.g. Asda) using empty delivery vehicles on their return – a process known as backhauling. At the distribution centres, the waste is sorted and bundled together ready to be sent for recycling, commercial and industrial waste recovery. Commercial and Industrial waste is also managed at South Kirkby Municipal Waste Management facility.

Construction Demolition and Excavation Waste

- 6.96** Whilst there is little information available about how this waste is managed at district level, it can be assumed that a large proportion of the construction, demolition and excavation waste produced is recycled, whilst a proportion will also be deposited at landfill sites, for uses such as site engineering and capping. Waste policies encourage on-site recycling of this material wherever possible.

Hazardous Waste

6.97 Hazardous Waste arisings in the district in 2015 were 53,626 tonnes. In 2016, Wakefield exported 52,067 tonnes of hazardous waste and imported 46,713 tonnes of hazardous waste, making it a net exporter of hazardous waste.

Agricultural Waste Arisings

6.98 Agricultural waste arisings in Wakefield are predominantly managed on-site. Of the 1,178 tonnes leaving farm units this will predominantly be treated as commercial and industrial wastes (e.g. plastics etc).

Current Waste Movements In and Out of Wakefield

6.99 As set out earlier, waste arisings in 2015 totalled 1,193,175 tonnes. Waste deposits in the same year amounted to 1,492,933 tonnes. This indicates that Wakefield deals with a significant amount of waste that is being brought into the district. Inevitably, there is also a proportion of waste generated in Wakefield that is exported, to other parts of the Yorkshire and Humber region, or outside of the region, for treatment or disposal. Through Duty to Cooperate and the West Yorkshire Combined Authority, the Council continues to liaise with neighbouring authorities and other authorities in the Leeds City Region about cross boundary waste movements. Duty to Cooperate also takes place with other Waste Planning Authorities beyond the City Region where cross boundary movements occur. However, in general authorities are seeking to be as self-sufficient as possible, in accordance with national planning policy.

Capacity Gap and Need for Waste Management Facilities

6.100 The following table shows the capacity gap for waste management facilities by waste management route over the plan period from 2017-2036, based on the Waste Needs Assessment Capacity Gap Model.

Table 8 Summary of Wakefield Predicted Waste Management Capacity Gap by Waste Management Route 2036

Waste Management Route	Tonnes per annum
Composting	13,888
Energy from Waste	40,235
Hazardous Landfill	2,224
Hazardous Treatment	18,459
Incineration No Energy Recovery	1,128
Inert Landfill	222,475
Mechanical Biological Treatment	3,548
Non-Hazardous Landfill	6,026
Refuse Derived Fuel, Autoclave, Mechanical Heat Treatment or Similar	0
Recycling	425,519
Recycling Construction, Demolition and Excavation	5,980
Recycling Metals	879
Treatment	20,577

- 6.101** Discussions have taken place with the Council's Strategic Waste Management Service, and Planning Environment and Enforcement about how the capacity gaps might impact on the existing Council managed facilities in the district and other non-Council managed facilities.

Composting

- 6.102** The capacity gap for composting by 2036 is predicted to be 13,888 tonnes per year. Composting currently takes place at the Council's Strategic Municipal Waste Management facility at South Kirkby, where the capacity for in vessel composting is 20,000 tonnes per annum. The Council currently exports some waste for composting to facilities in Doncaster during the summer months, due to a current capacity gap of 6-8,000 tonnes per annum. However, there is sufficient composting capacity here to deal with this capacity gap, by increasing operational capacity. Therefore, there was no requirement to identify an additional site in the Local Plan.

Energy from Waste

- 6.103** The capacity gap for Energy from Waste by 2036 is predicted to be 40,235 tonnes per year. In respect of Commercial and Industrial waste, this should be separated out according to the waste hierarchy. Ferrybridge has the capacity to accept the refuse derived fuel (RDF) that is left at the end of this process. Ferrybridge has two fully operational multifuel energy from waste plants with an approximate capacity of 1.45 million tonnes per annum to manage refuse derived fuel.
- 6.104** South Kirkby Strategic Municipal Waste Management facility is not yet operating at full capacity and therefore, has further capacity to deal with municipal, and commercial and industrial waste, which can then be sent to Ferrybridge for RDF. Therefore, there was no need to plan for any further capacity for this waste management route in the Local Plan.

Hazardous Waste

- 6.105** Whilst Wakefield is currently a net exporter of hazardous waste, the relatively small volume of hazardous waste arising in Wakefield, and the specialist facilities required to treat this, mean that self-sufficiency is not a realistic/viable option. This type of waste stream is best dealt with at a more strategic level. This means that it is likely that an element of hazardous waste arising in Wakefield will continue to be exported and managed at facilities outside the district. Where exports exceed 100 tonnes per year, Duty to Cooperate has been undertaken, which indicates that there is continued capacity for exports to be managed during the plan period.

Inert Construction, Demolition and Excavation Landfill

- 6.106** The predicted capacity gap for inert landfill by 2036 is 222,475 tonnes per year. This should be recovered on site as a secondary aggregate, wherever possible. Void space in Wakefield for this is currently limited to Nostell Quarry and Rudd Quarry. Darrington Quarry and Greenfield Road, Altofts are in Mineral Safeguarding Areas and may be worked for primary aggregates in the future, which would result in a potential void space for inert landfill for future restoration. The disposal of this is cost driven and is typically disposed of close to source, so further future disposal may be exported to void space close to the district boundary in North Yorkshire or Doncaster. As such, it was not considered necessary to identify any further capacity for this waste management route.

Mechanical Biological Treatment

- 6.107** The predicted capacity gap for Mechanical Biological Treatment by 2036 is 3,548 tonnes per year. This is a relatively small quantity, for which there is further capacity at South Kirkby to accommodate this by increasing operational capacity. Therefore, there was no need to plan for any further provision through the Local Plan.

Non-hazardous Landfill

6.108 The predicted capacity gap for non-hazardous landfill by 2036 is 6,026 tonnes per year. This relates to residual waste and is a relatively small capacity gap resulting from the closure of Welbeck in 2023. There is the possibility that the permission for Welbeck may be extended beyond this time, if there is a need for further deposits to complete the restoration of the site. If this is not the case, the quantities are relatively small and may need to be managed through cross boundary movements at other former quarry sites, close to the district boundary, where there are permissions and permits to manage such waste. Therefore, it was considered that there was no need to plan for any additional capacity in the Local Plan.

Recycling Municipal and Commercial and Industrial Waste

6.109 The capacity gap by 2036 for this type of waste will be approximately 426,398 tonnes per annum. Government guidance suggests that a 50,000 tonne strategic recycling facility would require 1-2 hectares. This indicates that in the region of 8 hectares may be required to accommodate this capacity gap. However, there is some further capacity to manage municipal, and commercial and industrial waste at South Kirkby Strategic Municipal Waste Management facility, but it is likely that a further facility would be needed to manage the whole amount. This could be accommodated through a further extension at South Kirkby, or a separate facility within an employment allocation. Waste management policies in the Local Plan support this approach, without the need to identify a specific site through the Local Plan.

Local Authority Collected Recycling of Construction, Demolition and Excavation

6.110 The capacity gap by 2036 for this type of waste is estimated to be approximately 5,980 tonnes per year. This is a relatively small amount of waste and there should be some capacity to deal with this at Welbeck and Bottomboat. Further provision could be made within an employment allocation if required. However, this is usually market driven, which will influence whether waste is exported, or managed within the district. Therefore, there was no requirement to plan for any additional capacity in the Local Plan, and waste management policies in the Local Plan will enable a planning application to come forward if necessary.

Treatment

6.111 The capacity gap for this type of waste is estimated to be approximately 20,577 tonnes per annum by 2036. This is mostly chemical treatment of sewage sludge by Yorkshire Water, who would make further provision for this as required.

Other

6.112 Other waste relates to sorting for recycling as secondary aggregates. Facilities for this could be permitted on Employment Sites or Zones as a general industrial activity (B2 use) and therefore, would not require further specific sites to be identified at this time.

Conclusion

6.113 There is further operational capacity at South Kirkby for municipal, and commercial and industrial waste management. However, further capacity, in addition to that at available at South Kirkby, will need to be made for commercial and industrial waste. South Kirkby will continue to be identified for municipal and commercial and industrial waste management. Welbeck will continue to be protected for commercial and industrial waste management and for inert and non-hazardous landfill. Further capacity for commercial and industrial and construction, demolition and excavation waste could be accommodated through a planning permission on an employment allocation.

Waste Management Facilities

Policy SP17

Waste Management Facilities

Seeking to be as self-sufficient as possible in managing all waste arising in the district, further waste management capacity will be provided to meet identified needs through:

- a. The protection and possible expansion of South Kirkby strategic municipal waste management facility where it meets local and national planning policy;
- b. Supporting appropriate applications in employment areas where they meet local and national planning policy and would not have an unacceptable adverse impact on existing or planned neighbouring development; and
- c. Existing landfill sites.

Existing sites for waste management, as shown on the Policies Map, have been carried forward from the Local Development Framework and will be protected unless it can be demonstrated that there is no longer a need for the facility, or where capacity can be met elsewhere in the district.

Proposals for development within or adjacent to an existing, or planned waste management facility, regardless of whether they are identified on the Policies Map, will be required to demonstrate that the proposed development does not prevent, hinder or unreasonably restrict the operation of the waste development.

New development for sensitive receptors within 250 metres of certain higher risk permitted activities, such as combustion operations, incinerators, composting operations, anaerobic plants and existing landfill operations will not be permitted, unless it can be demonstrated that any adverse impacts can be properly mitigated against.

Residual Waste

6.114 Although the focus of the Local Plan is on the re-use, recycling, composting, and the recovery of value from waste, there will always be a need for some residual waste management capacity, i.e. that part of the waste stream that cannot otherwise be re-used, recycled, composted or recovered. Historically, residual waste in Wakefield has been disposed of in landfill sites, most notably Welbeck. In meeting the need for continued (albeit reduced) landfill capacity, this should be met at Welbeck. The existing landfill site at Welbeck will be safeguarded for continued landfill use. Due consideration will need to be given to the site's proximity to the River Calder and the Aire and Calder canal, as well as to ensure there are no unacceptable adverse effects on the nearby Scheduled Monument and its setting (Knights Templar Preceptory at Newland) and the adjacent Southern Washlands Nature Reserve. In managing residual wastes, the use of advanced treatment technologies will also be encouraged. Other applications for residual waste management facilities will be considered against national planning policy and Local Plan policies. Wherever possible, co-location of such facilities with other waste management uses will be encouraged.

Policy SP18

Managing Residual Waste

To meet capacity needs priority will be given to the development of facilities to manage/dispose of residual waste at existing waste management sites within the district. Landfill capacity will be safeguarded as a means of final disposal of residual waste at Welbeck landfill site, Normanton.

Other Types of Waste

Construction, Demolition and Excavation Waste

6.115 The on-site re-use and recycling of construction, demolition and excavation waste will be encouraged wherever possible, in accordance with government policy. No specific sites have been identified for the management of construction, demolition and excavation waste in the district, as it is usually market driven. Proposals may come forward on mineral extraction sites and landfill sites for this type of waste management. All proposals will be assessed against national planning policy and Local Plan policies.

Hazardous Waste

6.116 The management of hazardous waste is considered most appropriately planned for at a strategic or sub-regional level. The provision of facilities for dealing with hazardous waste is generally market led and dealt with by large-scale specialist facilities to deal with specific types of waste. This makes it difficult to plan for. No specific sites have been identified for the management of hazardous waste in the district and proposals will be assessed against national planning policy and Local Plan policies. The Council will continue to work with neighbouring authorities and Leeds City Region to provide sufficient capacity to manage hazardous waste at the West Yorkshire level.

Agricultural Waste

6.117 Agricultural waste should be managed on-site, wherever possible, and any smaller quantities of waste which cannot be managed on-site will form part of the commercial and industrial waste type. To facilitate the management of agricultural waste, where appropriate, on-site facilities should be provided through the re-use of redundant farm buildings and associated land. No specific sites have been identified for the management of agricultural waste in the Local Plan and proposals will be assessed against national planning policy and Local Plan policies.

Minerals

6.118 National planning policy states that minerals are essential to support sustainable economic growth and our quality of life. It is therefore important that there is a sufficient supply of material to provide the infrastructure, buildings, energy and goods that the country needs. However, since minerals are a finite natural resource, and can only be worked where they are found, it is important to make best use of them to secure their long-term conservation. The Council is part of the West Yorkshire Aggregate Working Party which published the annual Local Aggregate Assessment for West Yorkshire.

Primary Aggregates

6.119 The principal minerals currently extracted in the district are sand and gravel, limestone and clay. The Magnesian Limestone to the east of the district provides potential for crushed rock. It is important that known mineral resources are not sterilised by other forms of development. The Local Plan protects permitted reserves (Mineral Reserves) and also safeguards known economically viable deposits of minerals from sterilisation for future working (Mineral Safeguarding Areas). The Local Plan also safeguards areas of minerals processing, handling and distribution.

Secondary Aggregates

6.120 Government policy aims to maximise the opportunities where wastes can be recycled and materials can be recovered for use as secondary aggregates. Waste and Minerals Policies in the Local Plan provide a policy framework for developers to recycle construction and demolition wastes and recovery of secondary and other minerals on reclamation sites. Establishing recycling centres to provide secondary aggregate materials close to sources and local markets will be encouraged where there are good transport links and they can operate in an environmentally acceptable way.

Coal

6.121 The Coal Measures Series provides an abundance of resources across the district. However, deep mining no longer takes place within the district and deep mining and colliery spoil disposal are unlikely to be significant developments in the future. Any future potential for coal extraction lies in the extensive shallow coalfield which covers most of the district. Shallow coal extraction by opencast methods is most likely to occur before some other form of development takes place on a site, whether greenfield or previously developed, during reclamation of a brownfield site and/or remediation of a former colliery working or tip site. Shallow coal extraction can provide an opportunity to work other economic minerals, such as fireclay and brick clay. It is also important to avoid unnecessary sterilisation of coal and associated mineral resources by other forms of development where these can be extracted, within a reasonable timescale and in an environmentally acceptable way or where local or community benefits clearly outweigh the likely impacts to justify the grant of planning permission. Proposals must also comply with government guidance.

Other Minerals

6.122 Other minerals that occur in the district in economic quantities include the fireclays and brick clays and sandstones within the extensive Coal Measures series and the Basal Permian Sands. Current extraction is mainly confined to clays for local brick making. Existing permitted reserves and working sites indicate the extent of current mineral interest in non-aggregate minerals and are shown as Mineral Reserves on the Policies Map. In some cases, e.g. fireclay, economic minerals may be won alongside energy minerals. In other cases the extension to existing workings may be more sustainable and economically acceptable than working new sites. In the past, the Plan area has

also been a supplier of building stone. In future, there may be a need to reopen faces of some of these historic quarries in order to provide materials to repair historic buildings in and around the District.

Land Reclamation

6.123 In the past the environment of much of the district has been damaged by coal mining and other industrial activity which have left a legacy of pollution, contamination and dereliction. In recent years progress has been made. Dereliction has been cleared, land restored and new environmental assets have been created. The Council will work with partners to ensure that remaining areas of contamination and dereliction are reclaimed as far as possible, taking account of the value of former mineral extraction sites for biodiversity and seeking to achieve a net gain for biodiversity.

Protecting Mineral Resources and Reserves

6.124 The Local Plan establishes the broad approach to the protection of mineral resources and support for mineral production. Further Local Policies provide detailed criteria for assessing proposals for mineral extraction, alongside national planning policy to ensure that any proposal for extraction is acceptable environmentally, that controls are in place to minimise disturbance whilst extraction is in progress and that a satisfactory restoration scheme is agreed before work begins, with particular attention given to creating new wildlife habitats, geological conservation, the need for public access and extended aftercare. Known Mineral Reserves and Mineral Safeguarding Areas are identified on the Policies Map.

6.125 There are a number of local policies relating to minerals development in Chapter 7 of Volume 1 of the Local Plan that should be considered alongside development proposals, where relevant, including LP37 Mineral Extraction, LP38 Mineral Safeguarding, LP39 Proposals for the Exploration and Appraisal of Hydrocarbons (Oil and Gas), LP40 Proposals for Commercial Production of Hydrocarbons and LP41 Coal Extraction. Minerals designations are shown on the Policies Map and are set out in Chapter 8 of Volume 1 of the Local Plan. Other more general development management policies will also be relevant to individual proposals.

Policy SP19

Minerals

In conjunction with other minerals planning authorities within West Yorkshire, the Council will seek to contribute to the maintenance of a landbank of at least seven years supply for sand and gravel reserves and 10 years supply for crushed rock, as calculated through the Local Aggregates Assessment. The Council will also seek to maintain an adequate and steady supply of other industrial minerals:

1. Mineral Safeguarding Areas: Where there are known limestone, brick clay, fireclay, building stone, sand and gravel and coal resources of economic value, these have been identified on the Policies Map and will be protected from development that could result in their sterilisation. This applies equally to sites allocated for non-mineral development where economically viable reserves exist.
2. Mineral Reserves: Existing mineral reserves throughout the district with planning permission for ash and shale, limestone, clay, and sand and gravel, have been identified on the Policies Map and will be protected from inappropriate development that could result in their sterilisation.
3. Safeguarding Areas for Minerals Production: Are planned and potential sites for: the bulk transport, handling and processing of minerals; the manufacture of concrete and concrete products; and the handling, processing and distribution of substitute, recycled and secondary

aggregate material. These have been identified on the Policies Map and will be protected from development for alternative uses.

4. Aggregates and Other Minerals:

- a. Working of mineral resources from land reclamation schemes may provide secondary aggregates and other minerals in association with restoration and/or development wherever practicable and environmentally acceptable;
- b. Sustainable transport will be used wherever practicable in connection with mineral extraction, particularly existing railheads and the wharf at Pioneer Way/Whitwood;
- c. The district includes areas where land reclamation is required, particularly on older colliery workings. Land Reclamation sites have been identified on the Policies Map at the former Prince of Wales Colliery Spoil Tip, Pontefract; the former West Riding Colliery Spoil Tip, Castleford; Welbeck Landfill Reclamation site, Normanton; the former Bottom Boat Spoil Tip, Stanley; and the former Household Waste Recycling Site, Ossett. Land reclamation will be supported and limited extraction will be acceptable where it enables reclamation;
- d. Mineral extraction before development commences will be acceptable, particularly where the development would result in a considerable extension to an urban area, provided the extraction is carried out in a reasonable timescale and in an environmentally acceptable manner.

The contribution to the supply of alternative materials for use as secondary aggregates will be maximised by securing opportunities for recycling, processing and transfer of materials wherever practicable and environmentally acceptable.

Communications

6.126 National planning policy sets out that advanced, high quality and reliable communications infrastructure is essential for economic growth and social well-being. Planning policies and decisions should support the expansion of electronic communications networks, including next generation mobile technology (such as 5G) and full fibre broadband connections. Policies should set out how high quality digital infrastructure, providing access to services from a range of providers, is expected to be delivered and upgraded over time; and should prioritise full fibre connections to existing and new developments (as these connections will, in almost all cases, provide the optimum solution). Some types of development may require greater connectivity speeds above those delivered by current Building Regulation standards and the relevant infrastructure should be included in the development. The following policy will ensure that the growth and development set out in the Local Plan will fully take account of this requirement in the interests of long term sustainable development.

6.127 New development should protect existing digital infrastructure. As well as supporting new infrastructure, successful functioning of existing digital infrastructure should be protected from detrimental impacts from new development. Such infrastructure includes existing telecommunication apparatus, microwave links and switching stations. It will also be important to ensure that new buildings do not prevent residents from accessing strong and unbroken television reception.

Policy SP20

Digital Infrastructure

To support economic growth and social wellbeing in Wakefield District now and in the future, development proposals will:

- a. achieve high quality, mobile and broadband digital connectivity at the appropriate level for the development;
- b. ensure that sufficient ducting space for future digital connectivity infrastructure is provided;
- c. prioritise full fibre open access connections to existing and new development;
- d. meet requirements for mobile connectivity within the development and take appropriate mitigation measures to avoid reducing mobile connectivity in surrounding areas;
- e. avoid or mitigate detrimental impacts on successful functioning digital infrastructure; and
- f. support the effective use of the public realm (such as street furniture and bins) and rooftops to accommodate well-designed and located mobile digital infrastructure.

c) Community Facilities

Community Facilities and Services

6.128 Community facilities and services are essential to the quality of life for the district's residents. It is important that good quality services are available locally. This reduces the need for people to travel to obtain essential services, particularly benefiting the less mobile and more deprived members of society. This aim is supported by the spatial development strategy which encourages local facilities and services on an appropriate scale to be provided in all but the smallest settlements. Working in partnership with other providers and the voluntary sector, the Council will seek to ensure that community facilities and services are provided in the most effective and accessible way. In rural communities, existing services must be protected as much as possible, as their loss can have major impacts on communities. The National Planning Policy Framework lists examples of community facilities, such as local shops, meeting places, sports venues, open spaces, cultural buildings, public houses and places of worship. However, part 3 of Policy SP21 does not relate to open space. Policy LP46 provides more specific criteria relating to the safeguarding of open space.

6.129 There are a number of local policies relating to community facilities in Chapter 7 of Volume 1 of the Local Plan that should be considered alongside development proposals, where relevant, including but not limited to LP45 The Effect of Development on Public Services, LP47 Open Space in New Development and LP50 Sports Facilities. Other more general development management policies will also be relevant to individual proposals. Where community facilities and services will be delivered as part of an allocation, this has been set out in the site specific policy in Volume 2 of the Local Plan. Similarly, site policies identify where replacement facilities will be required to mitigate the impact of development.

Policy SP21

Community Facilities and Services

1. Good quality community facilities and services will meet the needs of local communities and benefit the less mobile or more deprived members of the community. Community facilities and services will be provided in locations which ensure needs are met in the most effective and accessible way.
2. Community facilities and services will be required to be of an appropriate scale to the type and size of settlement and shall be accessible by walking, cycling and public transport. Higher level services that serve large numbers of people such as hospitals, secondary schools and colleges will be located in urban areas. In Local Service Centres and Villages appropriate community facilities and services will be provided in order to meet:
 - a. The need to increase the level of local community facilities, such as community centres, sport facilities and public open space;
 - b. The need to provide accessible health care facilities such as doctors surgeries and pharmacies;
 - c. The need to improve access to nurseries, primary and secondary schools;
 - d. The need for local services such as village store, post office, or public house.
3. Given the important role of community facilities and services in all settlements, development proposals will not result in the loss of an existing community facility or service unless:
 - a. Satisfactory alternative provision is made; or
 - b. There are cumulative community benefits identified as part of regeneration schemes; or
 - c. It can be demonstrated that the facility is no longer needed.

d) Natural, Built and Historic Environment and Climate Change

6.130 The following strategic policies support protecting the Green Belt; conserving and enhancing the natural, built and historic environment, including well-designed places; and meeting the challenge of climate change.

Green Belt

6.131 A Green Belt review was undertaken as part of the plan-making process and justification for this is set out in Local Plan evidence documents, in line with the National Planning Policy Framework, case law and best practice. Paragraph 6.12 and policy SP4 set out the approach to Safeguarded Land to maintain the Green Belt boundary beyond the plan period.

6.132 Development in the Green Belt will be assessed against the National Planning Policy Framework and local policies set out in the Local Plan for limited infilling and extensions to settlements and buildings within it. The Green Belt will be maintained through designation on the Policies Map. Other particularly relevant strategic policies include SP3 Location of Development, SP4 Safeguarded Land and SP5 Scale and Distribution of Additional Housing. Relevant local policies in Chapter 7 of Volume 1 include LP1 Housing in Rural Areas and LP62 Existing Uses in the Green Belt. Other more general development management policies will also be relevant to individual proposals in the Green Belt.

Green Belt Compensatory Measures

6.133 National planning policy states that where it has been concluded it is necessary to release land from the Green Belt for development, the Local Plan should set out ways in which the impact of removing land from the Green Belt can be offset through compensatory improvements to the environmental quality and accessibility of remaining Green Belt land. Compensatory improvements could include:

- New or enhanced green infrastructure;
- Woodland planting;
- Landscape and visual enhancements (beyond those needed to mitigate the immediate impacts of the proposal);
- Improvements to biodiversity, habitat connectivity and natural capital;
- New or enhanced routes for walking, cycling and horse riding; and
- Improved access to new, enhanced or existing recreational and playing field provision.

6.134 Work on the Wakefield District Local Plan included engagement with landowners to identify potential compensatory improvements which could be secured. The published Specific Green Belt Compensatory Improvements Note EX.WDC07a provides relevant illustrative material at the time of a planning application. Proportionate consideration was given to the following during the plan-making process and these will be finalised at the time a planning application is submitted:

- Land ownership of Green Belt land, in relation to both land which has been released for development, and that which may be most suitable for compensatory improvements;
- The scope of works that would be needed to implement the identified improvements, such as new public rights of way, land remediation, natural capital enhancement or habitat creation and enhancement, and their implications for deliverability;
- The appropriate use of planning conditions and Section 106 agreements, to secure the improvements where possible. Section 106 agreements may be used to secure long-term maintenance of sites.

6.135 Where compensatory improvements are not deliverable directly in relation to the site, compensatory improvements may occur on other Green Belt land. These would preferably be within the locality of the site, and these could be on other designations identified in the Wakefield District Local Plan, for example: Strategic Leisure Corridors, Public Rights of Way, Wildlife Habitat Network, Leisure Opportunity Areas, Sports Facilities and Open Space, Local Wildlife Sites, Local Nature Reserves, Local Geological Sites, Registered Parks and Gardens, Ancient Woodlands, and Land Reclamation.

6.136 Some of these may coincide with other strategies being implemented by the Council such as the White Rose Forest, the Northern Forest, Nature Recovery Strategy, Rights of Way Improvement Plan, Playing Pitch Strategy. These also overlap with other developer contributions that may already be identified as being required as part of an allocation or at the time of development such as public open space contributions (where this may be delivered offsite), improvements to accessibility and linkages with Strategic Leisure Corridors, Public Rights of Way or with Biodiversity Net Gain.

Policy SP22

Green Belt

The general extent of the Green Belt will remain unchanged.

A review of the Green Belt boundaries will only be undertaken in association with the Wakefield District Local Plan in order to inform the identification of sites for delivering growth that is consistent with the spatial development strategy.

Only in exceptional circumstances where there is an overriding need to accommodate what would otherwise be inappropriate development, which cannot be met elsewhere and where Green Belt land offers the most sustainable option, will land be taken out of the Green Belt.

Where land is removed from the Green Belt for development, the impact will be offset through compensatory improvements to the quality of the environment and accessibility of the remaining Green Belt. This may be achieved by:

- Creating green infrastructure such as recreational green spaces and landscaped zones;
- Creating green corridors to provide pedestrian, cycling and bridleway links with adjoining areas of countryside, green infrastructure and recreational open space;
- Creating wildlife habitat, woodland and other ecological enhancements, and
- Making provision for appropriate management of new infrastructure, corridors, habitats and species on adjoining land.

Design, Safety and the Local Environment

6.137 Good design is a key aspect of sustainable development, creates better places in which to live and work and helps make development acceptable to communities. Improving our places through raising the quality of the built environment is an important objective of the plan and is key to the wider regeneration of the district. The policy requires places to be designed to accord with Active Design and Streets for People Principles. The Development Principles section (Chapter 5 of the Plan) summarise the Active Design and Streets for People Principles which are expected to be incorporated into masterplans and development proposals to meet that requirement.

6.138 The following policy sets out the strategic approach to conservation and enhancement of the natural, built and historic environment, including landscapes and green infrastructure and other design matters which affect environmental quality. It sets out a clear starting point for local policies in Chapter 7, which develop the positive strategy further in relation to specific environmental characteristics, protected places and district-wide allocations and designations.

Policy SP23

Design, Safety and the Local Environment

The design of buildings and spaces will be improved and opportunities for crime reduced. The district's historic, built environment, landscape features and wildlife habitats will be protected and enhanced. They contribute to the local distinctiveness and character of the district. In all parts of the district, new development will:

1. Incorporate sustainable buildings, spaces and landscaping of high quality design which;
 - a. Are appropriate to their location in terms of scale and density;
 - b. Protects and enhances local character and distinctiveness taking local building traditions into account;
 - c. Takes the different landscape character across the district, including the Calder Valley, the Northern Coalfield areas, the Went River Basin, the Limestone Escarpment and the south-east and south-west coalfield areas into account.
2. Be designed to accord with Active Design principles and Streets for People principles as set out in Chapter 5 of the Plan;
3. Create safe and secure environments that reduce the opportunities for crime in all parts of the district;
4. Conserve and enhance the district's historic assets and their contribution to the local distinctiveness and character of the district, in a manner which will also help in their management, understanding and enjoyment. Development proposals must seek to avoid or minimise any conflict with a heritage asset's conservation. This will be in accordance with their significance, particularly of Scheduled Monuments, archaeological sites and landscapes, Conservation Areas, Listed Buildings, Registered Parks and Gardens, Historic Landscapes and Battle Sites and those assets which are at risk;
5. Protect and enhance the district's biological and geological diversity and green infrastructure including the need to increase tree cover across the district, safeguard designated sites of international, national, regional and local importance, ancient woodland and other ecological assets, including priority habitats and species;
6. Minimise the risk from all forms of pollution and contamination for existing and future occupants, the wider community and the environment, particularly within the defined Air Quality Management Areas;
7. Bring about improvements to the local environment including the reclamation of derelict or degraded land, and providing new green infrastructure where appropriate;
8. Help reduce fossil fuel dependency, by promoting designs which incorporate energy efficiency and renewable energy generation technology.

Mitigating and Adapting to Climate Change and Efficient Use of Resources

6.139 Mitigating and adapting to climate change, including moving to a low carbon economy is one of the key requirements for achieving environmentally sustainable development. The Climate Change Act 2008 created a legally binding target to reduce the net UK carbon emissions to at least 80% below 1990 levels by 2050; and contribute to global emission reductions to limit global temperature rise to as little as possible above 2°C. Under the Paris Agreement 2015 the UK is committed to following a decarbonisation pathway that aims to limit the global average temperature increase to 1.5°C, while ensuring it is held to “well below” 2°C, by taking steps reflecting its “highest possible ambition”. In June 2019 the UK passed the Climate Change Act 2008 (2050 Target Amendments) Order to revise the Climate Change Act carbon emission reduction target to “at least 100%” by 2050 (‘net zero’), in line with the advice of the Committee on Climate Change. Section 19 (1A) of the Planning and Compulsory Purchase Act 2004 (as amended by Section 182 of the Planning and Act 2008) places a legal duty on the Council to address climate change through local plan policy and planning decisions. In particular, it states that “development plan documents must (taken as a whole) include policies designed to secure that the development and use of land in the local planning authority’s area contribute to the mitigation of, and adaptation to, climate change”.

6.140 The Council declared a Climate Emergency in May 2019 which committed the Council to:

- Pledge to make Wakefield Council a Carbon Neutral organisation before 2030, taking into account both production and consumption emissions;
- Request that the Council’s Cabinet develops and reports back to Council within six months the specific emergency plans and actions needed to reach this target;
- Support and work with all other relevant agencies towards making the entire area zero carbon within the same timescale;
- Call on central government to provide the funding and powers to make this possible;
- Work with other governments (both within the UK and internationally) to determine and implement best practice methods to limit global warming to less than 1.5°C;
- Continue to work with partners across the Wakefield District and region to deliver this new goal through all relevant strategies and plans.

6.141 Therefore, in relation to the final bullet point, the Local Plan will assist in delivering the Council’s Climate Emergency resolution and Climate Emergency Action Plan.

6.142 National planning policy states that the planning system should support the transition to a low carbon future in a changing climate, taking full account of flood risk and coastal change. It should help to: shape places in ways that contribute to radical reductions in greenhouse gas emissions, minimise vulnerability and improve resilience; encourage the re-use of existing resources, including the conversion of existing buildings; and support renewable and low carbon energy and associated infrastructure. Plans should take a proactive approach to mitigating and adapting to climate change, taking into account the long-term implications for flood risk, coastal change, water supply, biodiversity and landscapes, and the risk of overheating from rising temperatures. Policies should support appropriate measures to ensure the future resilience of communities and infrastructure to climate change impacts, such as providing space for physical protection measures, or making provision for the possible future relocation of vulnerable development and infrastructure.

6.143 The state of the local environment affects quality of life. It is necessary to ensure that new development does not increase the adverse effects of climate change on existing neighbours and future occupants and takes account of likely impacts, especially the increased risk from flooding.

The Local Plan can make a significant contribution to protecting people and the environment from the potential adverse effects of climate change by controlling the type and location of new development.

Climate Change and Flood Risk

6.144 Climate change is the biggest threat to our future. In recent years floods, storms and droughts have shown how vulnerable the UK is to the weather. Climate change means more extreme weather events will become more frequent and destructive. Recent flood activity has caused widespread damage in the Wakefield District and is likely to be repeated. Development in inappropriate locations such as flood plains or areas where there are shortages of water will exacerbate the problems associated with climate change. In order to avoid problems in the future it is essential to ensure that development is located away from areas at risk such as flood plains and is resilient to climate change.

6.145 Impacts of climate change are:

- An increased flood risk will be caused by wetter winters, greater storminess and rising sea levels.
- Strain on the availability of water for people and ecosystems brought on by longer, drier, hotter summers and aggravated by development where water resources are scarce.
- Although it is expected that summers will get drier, when it does rain it will be stormy with heavy downpours. Land cannot absorb heavy rain fast enough, resulting in localised, severe flash flooding.
- An increase in air pollution and water pollution can be triggered by longer, hotter summers.

6.146 Climate change is already having a significant impact on the increased risk of flooding in some places. Development can exacerbate flood risk in downstream areas by impeding the flow or storage of flood water or by causing increased run-off. Development with large areas of non-porous hard standing also exacerbate flood problems, as they impede surface absorption of heavy rain bursts and should be avoided.

6.147 The Environment Agency Flood Zone maps in appendix 4 show areas at high 1% annual probability (1 in 100 annual probability) Flood Zone 3; medium 0.1 % annual probability (1 in 1,000 annual probability) Flood Zone 2; and low <0.1 % annual probability (<1 in 1,000 annual probability) Flood Zone 1 risk of flooding. The Environment Agency update maps quarterly which can be found on-line. National planning policy requires a sequential approach to be adopted to identifying sites for development in plans and when determining planning applications to take account of flood risk. Wakefield, Calderdale and Kirklees Councils, and the Environment Agency have completed a Strategic Flood Risk Assessment (SFRA) (2016) of the three districts which identifies in more detail the degree of flood risk in different locations. The SFRA 2016 maps are shown in appendix 5. Together, the most up-to-date versions of these sources have been used to identify sites for development in the Local Plan and should be used when preparing detailed flood risk assessments to inform planning decisions.

6.148 Wakefield District drains into four major catchments of the Rivers Calder, Aire, Dearne and Don. The Aire and Calder flow eastwards, joining at Castleford, where they form the northern district boundary. An extensive area south of Pontefract is drained by the River Went, which flows into the River Don. The River Dearne and Frickley Beck form the southern boundary of the district. The river corridors are important for their amenity value and the wildlife they support. However, significant areas of land in the Aire, Calder and Went river valleys have a high risk from flooding, including parts of Wakefield and Castleford which are also areas offering significant redevelopment opportunities. National planning policy requires a sequential test to be applied to all development

proposals to steer development to areas with the lowest probability of flooding. An exception test must be met before some types of development can be permitted in a high risk zone. Ensuring flood risk can be managed effectively is an important consideration when identifying suitable sites for development, particularly housing.

Sustainable Drainage

6.149 Sustainable drainage systems are designed to control surface water run off close to where it falls and mimic natural drainage as closely as possible. They provide opportunities to reduce the causes and impacts of flooding, remove pollutants from urban run-off at source and combine water management with green space with benefits for amenity, recreation and wildlife. The Council will promote sustainable drainage systems with support from the Environment Agency. Developers will normally be expected to fund sustainable drainage systems and their future management, which will be secured by planning condition or obligation. The Council has worked with other West Yorkshire Authorities to update and align the drainage policies in the Local Plan.

Efficient Use of Resources

6.150 To be sustainable, development must be energy-efficient, minimise the use of scarce resources and adopt sustainable construction principles. Local Policies set out how new developments will be expected to achieve this taking into consideration the requirements of Building Regulations and national planning policy and guidance.

Renewable Energy

6.151 Energy from renewable sources makes an important contribution to reducing greenhouse gas emissions which are the main cause of global warming and climate change. The promotion and use of renewable energy resources is now a key element of national planning policy and guidance and is an important aspect of sustainable development. Development of renewable energy sources and renewable energy generation schemes will be encouraged where appropriate. The Planning and Energy Act 2008 allows development plan policies to impose reasonable requirements for a proportion of energy used in development in their area to be energy from renewable sources and/or to be low carbon energy from sources in the locality of the development. Therefore, new development will also be expected to identify opportunities for development to draw its energy supply from decentralised, renewable or low carbon energy supply systems to contribute to a reduction in carbon emissions in development. This could take various forms including solar panels, photo-voltaic cells, and ground source heat pumps incorporated into buildings, or district heating and cooling where technically feasible and financially viable. Energy storage and electric vehicle charging will also be important in addressing climate change as technology continues to advance.

6.152 Ferrybridge Power Station is currently a major employer in the district and plays an important role in energy production. Recent development at Ferrybridge Power Station has been focused on alternative technologies which generate energy from renewable/low carbon fuel sources.

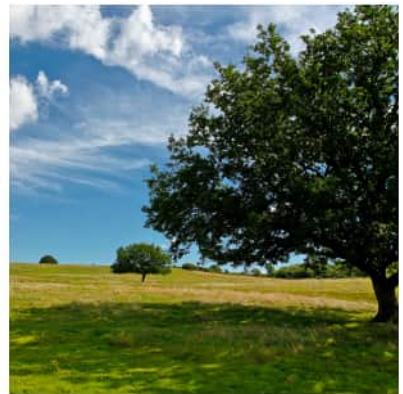
6.153 Policy SP24 sets out the strategic approach to mitigating and adapting to climate change and the efficient use of resources, however, other policies in the Local Plan relating to design, transportation and land use will also address climate change to achieve sustainable development. Local policies of particular relevance in Chapter 7 of Volume 1 include LP29 Flood Risk, LP30 Drainage, LP31 Protection and Improvement of Watercourses and Flood Defences, LP32 Renewable Energy, LP33 Sustainable Construction and Efficient Use of Resources, LP34 Electric Vehicle Charging Infrastructure, LP35 Assessment of Applications for Renewable Energy Generation Developments, LP36 District Heating and Cooling Infrastructure, LP70 Protection of Agricultural Land and LP71 Soil Conservation. Other more general development management policies will also be relevant to individual proposals.

Policy SP24

Mitigating and Adapting to Climate Change and Efficient Use of Resources

1. In order to be sustainable, development must minimise the impact and mitigate the likely effects of climate change on existing and future occupants, the wider community and the environment and minimise the use of natural resources.
2. This will be achieved by:
 - a. Avoiding unacceptable levels of flood risk, particularly in areas of high flood risk such as the Calder River Valley, the Went River Basin, and river tributaries in the south east of the district;
 - b. Requiring all new development proposals to include climate change resilient design to reduce reliance on existing flood defence infrastructure into the future;
 - c. Taking measures to reduce carbon emissions and adapt to climate change during the construction and operation of new developments through, for example, orientation, layout, design and material selection;
 - d. The prudent and efficient use of natural resources including energy, water, soil and the best and most versatile agricultural land and the use of re-used and recycled materials;
 - e. Proactively managing surface water through the promotion of sustainable drainage techniques and positive land management;
 - f. Through the provision of multi-functional green infrastructure, which can reduce urban heat islands, manage flooding and help species adapt to climate change; and
 - g. By making positive progress towards achieving "good" status or potential under the Water Framework Directive in the district's surface and ground water bodies.
3. In order to contribute to the UK 2050 net zero carbon emissions target and the objectives of the Council's Climate Emergency Resolution and Action Plan the Council will:
 - a. Encourage the development of new sources of renewable energy generation where there is no adverse environmental impact or harm to nearby communities;
 - b. Encourage all development to incorporate energy from decentralised and renewable, or low carbon sources. All developments of 0.5 hectares or more in site area, or 10 or more dwellings, or 1,000m² or more floor area for employment, commercial, leisure and community development (including conversions) will be required to incorporate on-site renewable energy generation capacity, unless it is not feasible or viable or there are demonstrable alternative decentralised and renewable, or low carbon sources.

Local Policies



7 Local Policies

7.1 The following Local Policies apply on a district-wide basis and set out more detail to manage and guide specific types of development in different locations. These policies should be applied in conjunction with strategic policies when considering planning applications. As with the Strategic Policies, these policies are grouped under the National Planning Policy Framework strategic themes, shown below, covering all land uses including the presumption in favour of sustainable development.

- a. Housing, Employment, Retail, Leisure and Commercial Development
- b. Infrastructure
- c. Community Facilities
- d. Natural, Built and Historic Environment and Climate Change

Policies in Volume 1 should be considered alongside policies in Volume 2 and the Policies Map.

a) Housing, Employment, Retail, Leisure and Commercial Development

Housing

7.2 Strategic policy SP5 sets out the need for housing in the district over the plan period and where it is expected additional housing will be located in order to achieve sustainable development. There is also a need for the provision of a range of housing types providing accommodation for people in various circumstances at different times in their lives and with specialist needs due to disability and/or age. It is also important that new housing provides adequate internal space and facilitates different sections of the local community living together amicably. Strategic policies SP6 Housing Mix, Affordability and Quality, SP7 Specialist Housing and SP8 Build to Rent are relevant to these matters.

Housing in Rural Areas

7.3 Principles governing the location and distribution of housing are set out in the strategic policies SP3 on the Location of Development and SP5 on the Scale and Distribution of Additional Housing. Most new housing is focused on the district's Urban Areas, though smaller amounts of housing are acceptable in Local Service Centres and Villages. There are also a number of settlements and groups of buildings in the district which are not within the Green Belt but are too small to be classed as Villages. The spatial development strategy aims to limit the scale of new housing in these places within the confines of each settlement. The Local Plan aims for limited housing development to take place in rural settlements to meet identified local needs or maintain the viability of local services. The spatial development strategy therefore allows for limited infill in small settlements not within the Green Belt to meet identified local community needs. There are also a number of small settlements in the Green Belt across the district, where infill boundaries have been identified, these are shown on the Policies Map and listed in Chapter 8 of the Local Plan. When considering housing proposals in the Green Belt part 2 of the policy below should be applied.

Policy LP1

Housing in Rural Areas

1. In small settlements not within the Green Belt housing proposals shall be limited to meet identified local community needs where it comprises of:
 - a. Closing a small gap in an otherwise built-up frontage to an existing road; or
 - b. The redevelopment or sub-division of an existing residential curtilage; or
 - c. The sub-division of an existing dwelling; or
 - d. The change of use or redevelopment of a non-residential building where this would not result in a loss of local employment or service provision.

The following settlements are small settlements not in the Green Belt:

Ackton, Featherstone

Bottomboat, Wakefield

Great Cliff, Crigglestone

Kirkthorpe

Newmillerdam

New Sharlston,

Bleakley, Notton

Oakenshaw, Crofton

Development proposals must fall wholly within the confines of the settlement. In very exceptional cases a slightly larger development may be permitted if this would lead to the sustainable recycling of a brownfield site bringing positive overall benefit to the settlement.

2. In the Green Belt housing proposals will not be regarded as inappropriate where they are for:
 - a. Limited infilling within the infill boundary of Green Belt settlements as shown on the Policies Map, which closes a small gap in an otherwise built-up frontage to an existing road, and are meeting identified local community needs. The development must fall wholly within the confines of the infill boundary; or
 - b. The extension or alteration of a building provided that it does not result in disproportionate additions over and above the size of the original building; or
 - c. The replacement of a home, provided the new building is not materially larger than the one it replaces; or
 - d. Limited infilling or the partial or complete redevelopment of previously developed land, whether redundant or in continuing use (excluding temporary buildings), which would:
 - i. not have a greater impact on the openness of the Green Belt than the existing development; or
 - ii. not cause substantial harm to the openness of the Green Belt, where the development would re-use previously developed land and contribute to meeting an identified affordable housing need within the Wakefield district boundary; or
 - e. The re-use of a building provided that the building is of permanent and substantial construction.

Accessible Housing Standards

- 7.4** National planning policy is clear that the needs of groups with specific housing requirements should be addressed. Wakefield has an ageing population and also has significant amounts of residents who have had their health and mobility affected by the industrial legacy of coal mining and other heavy industries. The Strategic Housing Market Assessment Update published in 2019 sets out the evidence of need for the introduction of accessible housing standards in Wakefield and has been used to formulate the policy below. The National Planning Policy Framework states that where evidence of a need for accessible housing exists this can only be met by the introduction of the requirements M4(2) and/or M4(3) of the optional requirements in the Building Regulations.
- 7.5** All major housing developments will be expected to provide accessible housing that complies with optional building regulations M4(2)A and M4(2)B for accessible and adaptable dwellings and M4(3)A and M4(3)B for wheelchair user accessible dwellings. In some instances sites may clearly not be suitable for people with mobility issues. Applications for such sites would need to provide a clear justification as to why the policy is not appropriate and should not be applied.

Policy LP2

Accessible Housing Standards

New build residential developments over 0.5 hectare or 10 or more homes should include the following proportions of accessible homes:

- 9% of homes which meet the standard set in requirement M4(2) of volume 1, Part M of the Building Regulations 'accessible and adaptable dwellings'.
- 3% of homes which meet the standard set in requirement M4(3) of volume 1, Part M of the Building Regulations 'wheelchair user accessible dwellings'. The M4(3) standard should be applied only to those homes where the Council is responsible for allocating or nominating a person to live in that home.

Where the number of homes provided by a development means that the percentage requirements for M4(2) and/or M4(3) homes generate less than one dwelling:

- if the figure generated is 0.5 to 0.99 of a home this should be rounded up to one home
- if the figure generated is below 0.5 of a home, then the home does not need to be provided.

On all sites percentage requirements will be rounded up or down as appropriate.

Where the scale of development would generate more than one accessible home, based on the requirements of this policy, the mix of sizes, types and tenures of accessible housing should reflect the mix of sizes, types and tenures of the development as a whole as closely as possible (unless there is evidenced need for additional accessible housing in one particular tenure).

The required number and mix of accessible homes should be clearly illustrated on submitted plans and controlled via planning condition.

Where it can be robustly justified using evidence that site specific factors, such as site topography, make a site unsuitable for M4(2) and/or M4(3) compliant homes, the requirements of this policy should not apply.

Minimum Space Standards

- 7.6** National planning practice guidance is clear that local planning authorities can require the use of the Nationally Described Space Standard for internal space in new dwellings. The Council considers that there is a need for the introduction of the standard in Wakefield and this will not impact on viability to the extent that development will not come forward.

Policy LP3

Minimum Space Standards for Homes

All new homes will comply with the Technical Housing Standard setting out the Nationally Described Space Standard for internal space in new dwellings. This will apply across all tenures. The standard requires that:

- a. The dwelling provides at least the gross internal floor area and built-in storage area set out in the table below;
- b. A dwelling with two or more bed spaces has at least one double (or twin) bedroom;
- c. In order to provide one bed space, a single bedroom has a floor area of at least 7.5m² and is at least 2.15m wide;
- d. In order to provide two bed spaces, a double (or twin bedroom) has a floor area of at least 11.5m²;
- e. One double (or twin bedroom) is at least 2.75m wide and every other double (or twin) bedroom is at least 2.55m wide;
- f. Any area with a headroom of less than 1.5m is not counted within the Gross Internal Area unless used solely for storage (if the area under the stairs is to be used for storage, assume a general floor area of 1m² within the Gross Internal Area);
- g. Any other area that is used solely for storage and has a headroom of 900-1500mm (such as under eaves) is counted at 50% of its floor area, and any area lower than 900mm is not counted at all;
- h. A built-in wardrobe counts towards the Gross Internal Area and bedroom floor area requirements, but should not reduce the effective width of the room below the minimum widths set out above. The built-in area in excess of 0.72m² in a double bedroom and 0.36m² in a single bedroom counts towards the built-in storage requirement;
- i. The minimum floor to ceiling height is 2.3m for at least 75% of the Gross Internal Area.

Minimum gross internal floor areas and storage (m²)

Number of Bedrooms (b)	Number of Bed Spaces (Persons)	1 Storey Dwellings	2 Storey Dwellings	3 Storey Dwellings	Built-in Storage
1b	1p	39 (37)*			1.0
	2p	50	58		1.5
2b	3p	61	70		2.0
	4p	70	79		
3b	4p	74	84	90	2.5
	5p	86	93	99	
	6p	95	102	108	

Number of Bedrooms (b)	Number of Bed Spaces (Persons)	1 Storey Dwellings	2 Storey Dwellings	3 Storey Dwellings	Built-in Storage
4b	5p	90	97	103	3.0
	6p	99	106	112	
	7p	108	115	121	
	8p	117	124	130	
5b	6p	103	110	116	3.5
	7p	112	119	125	
	8p	121	128	134	
6b	7p	116	123	129	4.0
	8p	125	132	138	

* Where a one person flat has a shower room rather than a bathroom, the floor area may be reduced from 39m² to 37m².

Proposals for the development of student accommodation and houses in multiple occupation will not be subject to the Nationally Described Space Standard. Such development should, however, reflect the Nationally Described Space Standard with appropriate adjustments to address the particular characteristics of these types of development.

It should be noted that:

- i. The Gross Internal Area of a dwelling is defined as the total floor space measured between the internal faces of perimeter walls that enclose the dwelling. This includes partitions, structural elements, cupboards, ducts, flights of stairs and voids above stairs. The Gross Internal Area should be measured and denoted in square metres (m²).
- ii. If the area under the stairs is to be used for storage, assume a general floor area of 1m² within the Gross Internal Area.
- iii. The standards are organised by numbers of storeys to take account of extra circulation space needed for stairs between floors.

Homes in Multiple Occupation

- 7.7** The Council recognises that shared accommodation provides a cost effective way for many people to access a home. However occasionally amenity issues can occur in parts of the district and it is also important that residents are able to access public transport and local facilities. The district may also see an increase in the number of homes being developed for students. Again this type of accommodation can sometimes lead to amenity issues and it is also important that students are able to access learning facilities easily and sustainably. With regard to this policy access to regular public transport means a location that has a bus service every 15 minutes within a 400 metre radius as the crow flies.

Policy LP4

Sub-Division and Multiple Occupation of Homes including Student Housing

The conversion or change of use of existing homes and buildings in other uses to shared accommodation including houses in multiple occupation will be supported where:

- a. The existing home or building is capable of conversion without causing harm to the amenities of future occupants, neighbours and the wider area; and
- b. In the case of an existing home, it can be demonstrated there is an established lack of demand for the single family use of the property concerned; and
- c. The development will not lead to or increase an existing over-concentration of such uses in the area; and
- d. Adequate provision is made for external communal areas and bin storage and collection. On-site car parking and cycle storage facilities should be provided unless it can be demonstrated that the site is sustainably located with access to regular public transport or is within a 400 metre walking distance of a defined town centre; and
- e. For student accommodation, appropriate learning facilities are accessible by walking and cycling or regular public transport.

Purpose built shared accommodation, including student provision, will be supported where the criteria set out in c. to e. above are satisfied and any amenity issues identified can be resolved or adequately mitigated both in terms of the residents of the new development and for users of surrounding buildings and businesses.

Residential Development in Town Centres

- 7.8** Strategic policy SP11 Retail and Town Centres provides additional context for development in town centres, including residential development. Town centres are very sustainable locations with good access to services and facilities and good public transport provision. They also often contain development sites that are previously developed and existing buildings that can be converted at high densities. As such they are excellent locations for residential development. Additionally, more people living in town centres can help to support retail and other functions in the centre including the evening economy and can encourage the use of public transport and car free living.

Policy LP5

Residential Development in Town Centres

Proposals for residential uses within defined town centres, as set out on the Policies Map, will be supported subject to the following:

- a. Affordable housing shall be provided in accordance with policies set out in the Local Plan;
- b. In Primary Shopping Areas and Primary Shopping Frontages residential development will only be permitted on upper floors and shall not prejudice existing established uses;
- c. Proposals shall protect the character of the centre, and the local street scene;
- d. Proposals shall retain and enhance the design and heritage features of buildings conserving those elements which contribute to the significance of heritage assets;
- e. Proposals shall protect the amenity of existing residents and future occupiers of the proposed residential use in accordance with amenity and design policies in the Local Plan;
- f. Proposals shall include the provision of space for the storage of sustainable modes of transport such as bicycles and, where appropriate, electric vehicle charging points;
- g. Space for vehicular parking shall be provided in accordance with the current parking standards;
- h. Access shall not cause problems of highway or pedestrian safety; and
- i. Appropriate provision shall be made for refuse storage and collection.

Employment Land

- 7.9** Strategic policy SP10 Local Economy sets out the importance of the provision of new and protection of existing employment land in the district. Strategic policy SP14 sets out the important role of the Transport Network in supporting sustainable economic development. Economic growth is a key objective for the district focusing on the creation of good jobs, raised productivity and higher level skills to facilitate better incomes and wellbeing.

Policy LP6

Protecting Employment Land

Land within Employment Zones (established areas in employment use), Employment Sites (land allocated in this Local Plan for employment use development) and in Special Policy Areas (where the Local Plan designates a specific area for employment use), which are shown on the Policies Map, shall continue to be occupied primarily by or be developed for employment use. Proposals for development or re-development for employment uses in these areas will generally be supported.

On land or premises within Employment Zones, Employment Sites or Special Policy Areas (where the Local Plan designates a specific area for employment use) planning applications for alternative uses will need to demonstrate there is no reasonable prospect of the site being utilised for an employment use by providing robust evidence that:

- a. Other employment land is available in the locality which is suitable in terms of quality and quantity so as not to prejudice opportunities for local employment uses; and
- b. Suitable alternative provision has been made to accommodate any existing occupiers of the site or premises subject to the planning application, and
- c. The site or premises cannot satisfactorily support employment use because, for example, it is not viable or cannot be adequately accessed; and/or
- d. Appropriate marketing has taken place which shows that the site or premises are not in demand for employment use; and
- e. Existing neighbouring uses are not restricted by the introduction of new uses and the amenities of the new occupiers are not compromised by existing neighbouring uses; and
- f. The proposal would not result in environmental, amenity or traffic problems; and
- g. If located in an Employment Zone or an established area of employment uses in a Special Policy Area a mix of uses is retained, including a proportion which generates employment.

Employment Sites located outside of Local Plan settlement boundaries will not usually be suitable for residential development.

If the planning application is for energy generation or battery storage facilities on a vacant site criteria a to d above will not apply.

- 7.10** The above policy seeks to protect the district's employment land by applying policies to favour employment use in these areas. Where a proposal for a change of use complies with the Use Class Order policy LP6 will not apply.
- 7.11** Most of the Employment Zones and areas within Special Policy Areas identified for employment are close to city and town centres and provide job opportunities close to where people live. They are a valuable source of employment land and buildings and an important location for small businesses and industries, especially those just starting up or growing. In some of these zones, there are strong redevelopment pressures for other uses, notably residential. In order to maintain a reasonable balance between jobs and homes, and reduce the need to travel, employment land should be offered a degree of protection.

- 7.12** Employment Sites are predominantly green field sites, often deleted from the Green Belt, allocated to meet the need for employment land over the plan period. It is important every opportunity is provided for these sites to accommodate employment uses before alternative uses can be considered on them in order to ensure sustainable development is achieved in the district.
- 7.13** Around the district there are a number of sites in employment use which do not have any specific notation in the Local Plan. They contribute to the sustainability of the settlements in which they are located by providing jobs and reducing the need to travel. It is expected that these sites should retain their existing use, or conform to the predominant use of the surrounding area. Proposals for development, re-development and change of use which affect employment areas without specific notation will be considered on merit, having due regard to the Local Plan policies and supporting statements, particularly those relating to sustainability. Whilst the re-use of brownfield land for housing is a high national priority this has to be balanced against sustaining settlements and local jobs, particularly in small rural settlements with limited employment opportunities.

Reviewing Development Viability

- 7.14** Where up-to-date policies have set out the contributions expected from development, planning applications that fully comply with them should be assumed to be viable. It is up to the applicant to demonstrate whether particular circumstances justify the need for a viability assessment at the application stage. National planning practice guidance provides examples of a limited number of circumstances where this may be relevant.
- 7.15** The Local Plan is supported by up-to-date viability evidence which has been carried out in accordance with national planning policy and guidance, and has considered the viability of different types and scales of development across the district. Therefore, the Council will only accept a viability assessment in support of a planning application in limited circumstances.
- 7.16** Where a viability assessment is submitted to accompany a planning application, this should be based upon, and refer back to, the viability assessment that informed the plan; and the applicant should provide evidence of what has changed. The weight to be given to a viability assessment is a matter for the decision maker, and any viability assessment should reflect the government's recommended approach to defining key inputs as set out in national planning practice guidance.
- 7.17** National planning practice guidance states that plans should set out circumstances where review mechanisms may be appropriate, as well as clear process and terms of engagement regarding how and when viability will be reassessed over the lifetime of the development, to ensure policy compliance and optimal public benefits through economic cycles. Policy compliant means development which fully complies with up-to-date plan policies.
- 7.18** Where contributions are reduced below the requirements set out in policies, to provide flexibility in the early stages of a development, there should be a clear agreement of how policy compliance can be achieved over time. The relevant triggers and the terms of viability review will be clearly set out in a Section 106 agreement accompanying a planning application. Such review may include, but would not be limited to: Early Stage Viability Review within two years of the date of permission being granted; Late Stage Viability Review which is triggered when 75 per cent of the units in a scheme are sold or let (or a period agreed by the Council); or Mid Term Reviews prior to implementation of phases for larger phased schemes. As the potential risk to developers is already accounted for in the assumptions for developer return in viability assessment, realisation of risk does not in itself necessitate further viability assessment, or trigger a review mechanism. Review mechanisms are not a tool to protect a return to the developer, but to strengthen local authorities' ability to seek compliance with relevant policies over the lifetime of the project.
- 7.19** The Local Plan sets out minimum requirements for a number of public benefits through new development, such as affordable housing, public open space, renewable energy and community facilities and services. The Council has had a Community Infrastructure Levy in place since April 2016. The Council also uses Section 106 Legal Agreements to secure some developer contributions not covered by the Community Infrastructure Levy, such as public open space and affordable housing. The viability evidence supporting the Local Plan should be used to understand whether circumstances justify a viability appraisal in support of an application.

Policy LP7

Viability Review

National planning policy provides examples of a limited number of circumstances where it may be relevant for the applicant to demonstrate whether particular circumstances justify the need for a viability assessment at the application stage. Where the applicant can demonstrate that particular circumstances justify the need for a viability assessment, the Council will use review mechanisms to ensure policy compliance and optimal public benefits through economic cycles. This will allow increases in Section 106 contributions to reflect changes in the value of a development from the date of planning permission to specific stages of the development programme. Viability assessment and review will be carried out at the applicant's expense.

For applications that do not meet the minimum requirement for developer contributions at the point at which the application is submitted the relevant triggers and the terms of the review will be clearly set out in the Section 106 agreement. Increased contributions secured towards delivering a policy compliant development may be sought through on site provision or offsite commuted sums, depending on what is deemed to be most appropriate at the time for the provision being sought.

The review mechanism will not be used to reduce the base level of developer contributions which are required as part of the planning permission. This will require a new or modified planning permission.

Retail and Town Centres

- 7.20** Strategic policy SP11 Retail and Town Centres, sets out that main town centre uses will be located within the town centres as shown on the Policies Map. Retail development should take place at a scale appropriate to the size, role and function of the settlement, in-line with the Retail Hierarchy. National planning policy requires local planning authorities to apply a sequential test to planning applications for main town centre uses that are not in an existing centre and are not in accordance with an up-to-date plan.

Retail

- 7.21** Primary Shopping Areas within town centres are shown on the Policies Map: Inset Maps where retail development will be encouraged and permitted. For the purpose of the sequential test and impact assessment the Primary Shopping Area defines the 'centre' in the Sub-regional City, Principal Towns and Main Towns. The centre boundary defines the 'centre' for District Centres and Local Retail Centres.

Policy LP8

Retail Development in Town Centres

Primary Shopping Areas are defined on the Policies Map for the Sub-Regional City, Principal Towns and Main Towns in the Retail Hierarchy. Retail development will be encouraged and permitted in the Primary Shopping Areas of town centres and within other centres defined within the Retail Hierarchy, or sites allocated for retail use, as defined on the Policies Map.

- 7.22** It may not always be possible to locate new large retail outlets within the defined primary shopping area. In those instances, such development will be permitted on the edge of the Primary Shopping Area. They should be within reasonable walking distance and well connected to the existing retail area. The aim should be to enable new development to function as extensions to centres.

Policy LP9

Large Retail Development on the Edge of Primary Shopping Areas

Large retail outlets (food stores and retail warehouses) which cannot be accommodated within the Primary Shopping Areas of centres as shown on the Policies Map will be permitted on the edge of these areas provided that the development:

- a. Lies within the existing settlement boundary as defined on the Policies Map;
- b. Is readily accessible by people who rely on public transport, whether as shoppers or prospective members of the workforce; and
- c. Does not involve land allocated for other uses, unless there is no reasonable prospect of it being used for the allocated use, or the land is allocated for retail use.

Development will be subject to local planning, traffic and environmental considerations, will provide customer choice and reflect the individuality of the centres.

- 7.23** The National Planning Policy Framework advises that when assessing applications for retail and leisure development outside of town centres, which are not in accordance with an up-to-date plan, local planning authorities should require an impact assessment if the development is over a proportionate, locally set floorspace threshold. This should include assessment of:

- the impact of the proposal on existing, committed and planned public and private investment in a centre or centres in the catchment area of the proposals; and
- the impact of the proposal on town centres vitality and viability, including local consumer choice and trade in the town centre and wider area retail catchment (as applicable to the scale and nature of the scheme).

7.24 The Local Plan identifies a number of centres across the district, and in accordance with the National Planning Policy Framework, seeks to support their viability and vitality. Due to the relatively small size of town centres in Wakefield district, it is considered appropriate to set impact thresholds below the default threshold in the National Planning Policy Framework. The policy below sets out the floorspace thresholds that apply locally for these centres.

Policy LP10

Impact Assessment

An impact assessment will be required for retail and leisure proposals which are outside of a centre, as defined on the Policies Map, and not in accordance with the Local Plan. This shall include the criteria for a town centre impact assessment set out in national planning policy.

The following minimum gross external floorspace thresholds will apply (including the creation of a mezzanine floor):

- 700 m² for assessing the impact of proposals on Sub-regional City, Principal Towns and Main Towns.
- 300 m² for assessing the impact of proposals on the District Centres and Local Retail Centres.

Proposals that are likely to have a significant adverse impact on defined centres will not be supported.

7.25 It is considered that retail development of less than 700 m² would not have an adverse impact on these categories of town centres in the district. The threshold of 700 m² for Sub-Regional City, Principal Towns and Main Towns excludes small shops but includes small supermarkets. 700 m² has been used by the Council as a benchmark for determining what is considered a large retail outlet, in its edge of centre policy and a minimum unit size for subdividing larger units in edge of centre retail development. It has been used in conditions attached to planning permissions for edge of centre retail warehouse parks in Wakefield, Castleford and Pontefract.

7.26 300 m² relates closely to the floorspace limit applied for Sunday trading purposes, as well as the Council's view about what constitutes a local shop. The threshold of 300 m² is intended to exclude the need for assessments for small shops and leisure development. Small shops and leisure uses of up to 300 m² are facilities that are considered to serve the day-to-day needs of their immediate locality. Above 300 m² the Council considers the development would serve more than day-to-day needs and should, therefore, be located in a town centre. The sequential approach would apply and the impact on nearby district and local centres should be assessed given the relatively small size of town centres in Wakefield District.

7.27 Primary Shopping Frontages are also defined within the Primary Shopping Areas, the aim is to ensure that changes of use within the Primary Shopping Frontages of town centres take place without undermining their shopping function. However, as a result of the introduction of Use Class E through the changes to the Use Classes Order in 2020, and the changes to the General Permitted Development Order in 2021, it will be more challenging to maintain a predominantly retail frontage in Primary Shopping Frontages.

Policy LP11

Non-Retail Development in Primary Shopping Frontages

Primary Shopping Frontages are defined on the Policies Map within the Primary Shopping Areas in the Sub-Regional City, Principal Towns and Main Towns in the retail hierarchy that contain predominantly retail uses and where further retail uses will be focused to retain the vitality and viability of the retail core.

Within the Primary Shopping Frontage proposals for non-retail uses will be permitted at ground floor provided that:

- a. Within each continuous Primary Shopping Frontage the predominant use (51% of the total frontage length) remains retail (E(a));
- b. The proposed use will provide an active daytime frontage that will diversify and improve town centre provision to support the vitality and viability of the Primary Shopping Area; and
- c. Existing neighbouring uses are not restricted by the introduction of new uses and the amenities of the new occupiers are not compromised by existing neighbouring uses.

Development will be subject to local planning, traffic and environmental considerations, will provide customer choice and reflect the individuality of the centres.

Hot Food Takeaways

- 7.28** During the last decade the consumption of food away from the home has increased by 29% with the number of takeaways or fast food outlets increasing dramatically. Research conducted in 2007 as part of the government foresight project "Tackling Obesity - future choices" has suggested that these social and environmental trends could be contributing to rising levels of overweight and obese people in the UK. Public Health England's "Healthy People, Healthy Places" programme launched in November 2013 supports the government's place based approach to health. Its priority is to improve the nation's health through better planning and design to reduce the impact of a poor physical and natural environment. Briefing Paper "Obesity and the environment briefing: regulating the growth of fast food outlets" addresses the opportunities to limit the number of fast food outlets (especially near schools) and to make fast food healthier.
- 7.29** Wakefield Council and its partners in Wakefield Together are committed to improving the health of the district's residents. There is no single solution to this issue as there are many contributing factors. However, the planning process can influence choices over food/diet. School children in the district are consuming too many takeaway meals. Children of all ages who eat more than two takeaways a week are also less likely to eat fruit and vegetables frequently and more likely to drink fizzy beverages, crisps and sweets/chocolate. Most secondary school pupils would like to eat a healthier diet but are less likely to if they eat takeaways on two or more days a week. Primary school pupils that eat takeaways on two or more days a week are more likely to want to eat a healthier diet, as reported in the School Health and Wellbeing Survey, 2017. 73% of adults would like to eat a healthier diet (Wakefield District Health and Lifestyle Survey, 2018). Diet is also identified as one of the factors across the age groups which participants believed most influence your health, after mental health.
- 7.30** 47% of primary school pupils and 44% of secondary pupils walk or cycle to school in the district (School Health and Wellbeing Survey, Wakefield District 2017). On these journeys there is the temptation to purchase this type of food on the way to/from school and at lunch times, whether or not children are accompanied by an adult. However, there are limited opportunities for primary school children to leave school at lunchtime. The aim of the Hot Food Takeaway policy is to restrict the number and location of hot food takeaways, especially close to secondary schools, to aid healthy

eating choices for all meals. Secondary schools are usually found in residential areas, therefore, restricting opening hours of a takeaway premises within an exclusion area would not meet the policy below, as the option would remain as an evening meal choice, resulting in the same health impact.

- 7.31** 400 metres is recognised as an acceptable distance for people who do not have mobility issues to walk to access services or facilities. It is a convenient walking distance for children attending school.

Policy LP12

Hot Food Takeaways

Proposals for hot food takeaways (use class sui generis) located within a 400 metre radius of secondary schools, as indicated on the Policies Map, will not be supported unless they are within a town centre, as defined by the Retail Hierarchy associated with Policy SP11 set out in Table 4. With regard to Wakefield city centre, the boundary of the Primary Shopping Area shall be used when applying this policy.

In the case of Villages, listed in the Local Plan settlement hierarchy and identified on the Policies Map, proposals will be considered on their merits. There may be a case for hot food takeaways in Villages, which are likely to be some distance from other settlements/facilities. Consideration shall be given to the proximity to local schools and other village facilities. Locations near to village shops/services will be preferable.

- 7.32** The Use Classes Order defines hot food takeaways as ‘for the sale of hot food where consumption of that food is mostly undertaken off the premises’. In some cases judgement may be required as to whether a proposal is a hot food takeaway. In these cases it may be useful to consider the proposed layout of the scheme as a guide to its primary function. When doing this consideration should be given to:
- The proportion of space designated for hot food preparation and other servicing in relation to designated customer circulation space. It would be expected that a hot food takeaway would have much more space dedicated to hot food preparation and servicing than for customer circulation; and/or
 - The number of tables and chairs to be provided for customer use. It would be expected that there would only be minimal number of tables and chairs in a hot food takeaway.
- 7.33** Where hybrid proposals are received in a Hot Food Takeaway Exclusion Area (HFTEA), which include a distinct, separate hot food takeaway, the hot food takeaway will not be supported. For example, a proposal for an E(b) restaurant that has a separate hot food takeaway unit included that provides a takeaway service should not be supported (these operations will often have a separate entrance from that to the restaurant element of the proposal).
- 7.34** Where it is considered necessary to conclude that a proposal is a hybrid use of an E(a) shop and a hot food takeaway, such as a drive through coffee shop for example, or an E(b) restaurant and a hot food takeaway such as, a burger outlet with an extensive takeaway element for example (which may often have a drive through) policy LP12 would apply if they are located in a Hot Food Takeaway Exclusion Area. In these circumstances the hot food takeaway element of the proposal should not be supported.
- 7.35** Where proposals are received in a Hot Food Takeaway Exclusion Area for a range of uses that include hot food takeaway unit(s), such as for a new local centre for example, the hot food takeaway unit(s) should not be supported. If a proposal lies partially within a Hot Food Takeaway Exclusion Area it should be treated as if it lies wholly within it with regards to the application of this policy. It

should also be noted that, according to national planning policy, drive-through restaurants are a main town centre use that would be subject to a sequential approach and provide an assessment of impact above the locally set thresholds.

Development and Design for Wakefield City Centre

- 7.36** The policies in this section are specific to Wakefield city centre and should be applied in conjunction with other relevant policies in the Local Plan. Strategic policies of particular relevance include SP10 Local Economy, SP12 Leisure Recreation and Open Space, SP13 Sustainable Transport, SP14 Transport Network, SP15 Influencing the Demand for Travel and SP23 Design, Safety and the Local Environment.
- 7.37** Wakefield city centre has a thriving evening economy which contributes to the liveliness of the city centre and attracts large numbers of people, especially on weekends. The design and layout of all new development should follow the policy guide 'Secured by Design', a police initiative to encourage the development industry to adopt crime prevention measures in new developments. The Local Plan includes policies to ensure that the principles of Secured by Design are incorporated into all new development. The intention of this is to raise standards and design-out the potential for crime. Good management practices at licensed venues are required and the co-ordination of services/action delivered by public agencies. Proposals for new venues will be considered through the determination of planning and licensing applications. Premises which have a late night license, which includes the sale of alcohol, have a requirement for door supervision. Planning and licensing applications will involve consulting with key stakeholders and agencies, such as the police, city centre management and members of the public.

Policy LP13

The Evening Economy in Wakefield City Centre

Proposals for new/refurbished nightclubs, public houses, restaurants, cafes, bars and music venues must be accompanied by a statement detailing measures to establish and maintain a safe and secure environment in and around such premises.

- 7.38** High quality design is fundamental to creating a distinctive and vibrant city of national and international significance. The Council adopted the Wakefield City Centre Urban Design Framework Supplementary Planning Document (SPD) in October 2017. All development within Wakefield city centre as defined by the City Centre Inset Map Boundary must take account of this guidance. The purpose of the design Framework is to promote, support and establish quality places for living, working and playing within Wakefield city centre. The aim is to promote opportunities for innovation and high quality spaces within the city that are rooted in a holistic vision for Wakefield.
- 7.39** The Emerald Ring is a key project that has created a complete ring around the city and redirected traffic from going through the city centre. Policy ER01 in Volume 2 lists the roads with current traffic restriction. The road has been redeveloped into a continuous tree-lined urban boulevard providing links between the city centre and the countryside, including surrounding areas. In order to make the city centre largely car free and pedestrian friendly traffic is also restricted into and along streets within the Emerald Ring; and pedestrian and cycle access has been prioritised by providing cycle lanes and crossing points along the route. These measures will help make the streets safer and improve access to the city centre by means other than the private car, such as cycling and walking. This should lead to a reduction in the number of journeys made by car into the city centre and associated congestion.

- 7.40** The following policy is designed to be flexible to enable traffic restrictions to be applied on a street to street basis to meet the overall objective of reducing through traffic within the Emerald Ring to meet future city centre ambitions. The policy aims to make sure that new development within the vicinity of the Emerald Ring relates well to the streetscene and is fully integrated with the wider public realm, so that the Emerald Ring feels safe and is well used by people of all ages. Development should be orientated so it faces the street and avoids dead frontages by providing active uses or entrances (e.g. cafes, shops and restaurants) at the ground floor level to add variety to the streetscene and facilitate pedestrian movement.
- 7.41** The Emerald Ring and its relationship to the wider road hierarchy/pedestrian and cycle network is illustrated on the Policies Map: Wakefield City Inset Map, Plan No. 2 (Road Hierarchy) and Wakefield City Inset Map, Plan No. 3 (Pedestrian and Cycle Routes).

Policy LP14

Emerald Ring Design Principles in Wakefield City Centre

The Emerald Ring will continue to be constructed and maintained in accordance with the following design principles:

- a. It will be a tree-lined road or street;
- b. There will generally be an absence of continuous central reservations;
- c. There will be provision for pedestrians/cyclists alongside the street;
- d. There will be pedestrian/cyclist crossing points at grade;
- e. Roundabouts will, wherever possible, be replaced by signal controlled junctions.

Development in the vicinity of the Emerald Ring will be constructed in accordance with the following design principles:

- i. Buildings will be constructed up to the back of footways, avoiding large areas of car parking between the road/footway and buildings;
- ii. Frontages to the Emerald Ring will generally be active at ground level;
- iii. Proposals shall conserve those elements which contribute to the significance of the numerous designated and non-designated heritage assets along its route.

- 7.42** Car parking facilities and motor vehicles will be directed towards more strategic locations along the road network to facilitate access, encourage multi-purpose trips and improve car parking management. As a result, there will be opportunities to rationalise existing car parking spaces especially surface car parks to free up land for development. The policy following aims to reduce long stay commuter car parking and increase short stay parking for shoppers and visitors using the city centre in line with the city centre parking strategy and local transport plan. Long stay car parking will be directed to locations outside the Emerald Ring.
- 7.43** New multi-storey car parks have been provided at Merchant Gate and Trinity Walk. A further multi-storey car park is planned for Ings Road Special Policy Area. In most cases, car parks should be located either within basements or on the upper floors to improve safety and preserve active frontages at ground floor level.

Policy LP15

Number and Location of Car Parks in Wakefield City Centre

The total number of public car parks in Wakefield city centre will be reduced and replaced with a smaller number of larger facilities. Long-stay car parks will be located around/outside the Emerald Ring with good accessibility to the city centre. Short-stay car parking will be located within the Emerald Ring.

In the case of residential development, car parks within the Development Sites and Special Policy Areas must be located underground or at ground level so as to secure safety and reduce the built footprint of the development.

- 7.44** Re-development of the city centre and the creation of the Emerald Ring provides an opportunity to improve pedestrian access and connectivity to neighbouring commercial and residential areas. The area of the city centre within the Emerald Ring has been declared a pedestrian priority zone where pedestrians and cyclists have priority over motor vehicles. A network of cycle and pedestrian routes is also being developed to more effectively link the city centre with surrounding residential suburbs and countryside. The proposed pedestrian and cycle routes including existing ones in central Wakefield are shown on the Policies Map: Wakefield City Inset Map, Plan No. 3 (Pedestrian and Cycle Routes).
- 7.45** Where the proposed development forms part of an existing or proposed cycle/pedestrian route, developers will be required to make a financial contribution towards its provision and ensure it forms an integral part of its design. It should also take into account the principles of the Emerald Ring where appropriate. Cycle and pedestrian routes should be well lit and adjacent developments should provide good surveillance to achieve safe and secure access through central Wakefield. This policy will help reducing traffic and improving community safety and health.
- 7.46** Pedestrian and cycle routes will be funded through a combination of developer contributions and public sector monies from the local transport plan and other sources. The amount of contribution from developers will be secured through a Section 106 agreement. Additional sources of funding towards the provision and maintenance of new pedestrian and cycle routes will also be sought from grant funding and the local transport plan.

Policy LP16

Development of Pedestrian and Cycle Routes in Wakefield City Centre

Pedestrian and cycle routes shown on the Policies Map: Wakefield City Inset Map, Plan No.3 (Pedestrian and Cycle Routes) will be protected, developed and enhanced. Proposals for development on sites that include cycle or pedestrian routes must:

- a. Ensure that the cycle or pedestrian route is incorporated and designed into the scheme; and
- b. Either build the route or make a financial contribution towards the provision of the route.

Cycle and pedestrian routes will be well lit and adjacent developments shall provide good surveillance to achieve safe and secure access through central Wakefield.

- 7.47** The skyline of the city is dominated by the clock tower of Wakefield Town Hall and the spires of St Johns Church, All Saints Cathedral and Wakefield County Hall. At 75 metres (247 feet) tall, the 500-year-old crocheted spire of All Saints Cathedral is the highest in Yorkshire. The historic towers and spires are not only local landmarks but also buildings of exceptional architectural and historic

interest. They also reflect the status and prosperity of the city during the eighteenth and nineteenth centuries. Due to their size and elevated position the historic spires and towers are visible from various viewpoints across central Wakefield and beyond. Key views of the spires and towers within central Wakefield are shown on the Policies Map: Wakefield City Inset Map, Plan No.5 (Landmarks, Vistas & Views).

- 7.48** New development must respect the character of the historic skyline and important views of the spires and towers, particularly where it significantly exceeds the height of its surroundings or is located on a prominent skyline ridge. This should reinforce the identity of the city centre and help create distinctive relationships between the spires, towers and new buildings. Applicants will need to provide the detailed visual appraisal as part of a design and access statement that accompanies the planning application that is likely to affect strategic views of the skyline and key vistas.

Policy LP17

Wakefield City Centre Skylines and Strategic Views

One of Wakefield's most valuable assets is its historic and distinctive skyline. Strategic views of the skyline within central Wakefield will be protected, maintained and where possible enhanced. Proposals for development will not be supported that would obstruct or detract from the city's skyline and/or strategic views of the spires and towers of All Saints Cathedral, Wakefield Town Hall, St John's Church and Wakefield County Hall particularly from the following key viewpoints identified on the Policies Map: Wakefield City Inset Map, Plan No.5 (Landmarks, Vistas & Views).

- a. The entrances/forecourts of Kirkgate and Westgate railway stations and the bus station;
- b. The approaches/crossings of the Emerald Ring by the main arterial routes;
- c. The Hepworth Wakefield Gallery.

Where development is likely to affect the city's skyline and/or strategic views of the spires and towers, developers must submit a visual appraisal of their proposals showing how it will make a positive contribution to the character and appearance of the skyline and preserve important views of the spires and towers.

- 7.49** Vistas create clear visual links between different places. Central Wakefield has several significant vistas (as shown on the Policies Map: Wakefield City Inset Map, Plan No.5 (Landmarks, Vistas & Views)) around the spires and towers. It is important that new development (including signage and advertisements) does not detract from these vistas.

Policy LP18

Wakefield City Centre Vistas

Key vistas of the spires and towers and other historic civic buildings within central Wakefield will be protected, maintained and where possible enhanced. Proposals for development will not be supported (including signage and advertisements etc) where they would obstruct or detract from important vistas within the city centre, especially the following (as shown on the Policies Map: Wakefield City Inset Map, Plan No.5 (Landmarks, Vistas & Views)):

- a. The civic buildings viewed up Wood Street;
- b. Wakefield Town Hall viewed from George Yard and Crown Yard;
- c. All Saints Cathedral viewed from Bread Street;
- d. The cathedral viewed from Wood Street;
- e. The cathedral and precinct viewed from Little Westgate;

- f. The cathedral and precinct viewed from Lower Kirkgate;
- g. St John's Church viewed from Wentworth Street.

7.50 The following policy identifies the sites that will be suitable for landmark development and sets out the detailed requirements that will need to accompany planning applications for landmark or tall buildings. The aim is to create eye catching and distinctive landmark buildings at key gateway locations and sites (as shown on the Policies Map) that substantially enhance the character and legibility of the surrounding area and the skyline of the city centre. Landmark development will be expected to achieve the highest environmental standards in terms of energy efficiency, design and sustainable construction, and should be located within areas of good public transport accessibility, such as bus corridors and railway stations.

7.51 Landmark buildings are defined as those that stand out from their immediate and surrounding context by virtue of their design, size, or other characteristics (i.e. mark a key gateway or vista into the city centre and include distinctive/illuminating features of special interest). It is important that landmark buildings work well at ground floor level and do not create blank or uninteresting fronts.

7.52 Tall buildings are defined as, “buildings which are substantially taller than their neighbours and/or which significantly change the skyline”. In the right locations, tall buildings can enhance the quality of the skyline and act as a catalyst for regeneration by giving an area a stronger focus and identity. Landmark/tall buildings can also provide points of orientation or focal points that are visible far away and mark areas of civic importance to help people navigate around the city centre. On the other hand, tall buildings could potentially have a negative impact on the character and appearance of the city and its skyline due to their height, profile and scale.

7.53 It is essential that full account is taken of the impact which the development of these areas will have upon the character and setting of Wakefield's historic assets and key views across the city centre.

7.54 At the specified locations, development proposals will need to have regard to the following specific landscape/townscape features:

- Junction of Marsh Way and Northgate – Wentworth Terrace Conservation Area and views of the cathedral;
- Junction of Marsh Way, Peterson Road and Kirkgate – views of the cathedral from Kirkgate station;
- Chantry Bridge/junction of A61 (Barnsley Road) and A638 (Doncaster Road) – views of cathedral, Waterfront Conservation Area, Chantry Bridge and Chapel and Packhorse Bridge (sites of archaeological significance) and river Calder/Calder and Hebble Navigation;
- Junction of Denby Dale Road and Ings Road – views of cathedral and Ings Beck; and
- Former Westgate Station – views of County Hall, Lower Westgate Conservation Area and seventeenth century grade II Listed Buildings.

7.55 It should be noted that a landmark development does not necessarily mean high rise. In addition, tall buildings should not be located where they would harm significant views and vistas (as identified on the Policies Map - Landmarks, Vistas and Views) or the character and appearance of historic assets, such as Conservation Areas and Listed Buildings. Developers are advised to contact the Council at an early stage to discuss the design, location and layout of new landmark development.

Policy LP19

Landmark Sites/Development in Wakefield City Centre

The following sites/locations as shown on the Policies Map: Wakefield City Inset Map, Plan No.5 (Landmarks, Vistas & Views) have potential for landmark buildings/developments:

1. Junction of Marsh Way and Northgate;
2. Junction of Marsh Way, Peterson Road and Kirkgate;
3. Chantry Bridge/junction of A61 (Barnsley Road) and A638 (Doncaster Road);
4. Junction of Denby Dale Road and Ings Road;
5. Junction of Stanley Road and the Emerald Ring; and
6. The former Westgate Station.

Landmark development must be of exceptional design quality and use the best quality materials. They must also create active street frontages and provide strong links to the public realm and footpath/pedestrian network.

Proposals for landmark development must also be accompanied by the following information:

- a. An assessment of the townscape setting out how the proposal will contribute to the urban form and character of the city and the built environment. This must include a thorough analysis of the siting and design of the building and its potential effects on both the immediate and surrounding context, including the built form, streetscape, waterways and the distinctive topography of the city;
- b. In the case of tall buildings, details of daylight and sunlight and wind effects to show how the proposal will affect neighbouring buildings and spaces in terms of privacy, levels of sunlight and extent of overshadowing;
- c. An assessment of the effect on the prominence or visibility of the key spires and towers as well as significant views from within the site, especially those identified on the Policies Map: Wakefield City Inset Map, Plan No.5 (Landmarks, Vistas & Views);
- d. An assessment of the effect on character and appearance of the area where it adjoins a Conservation Area or would affect the setting of a Listed Building or group of Listed Buildings;
- e. Architectural models and three dimensional drawings to illustrate how the proposal will appear in the streetscape and how it will relate to other structures and landmarks, such as public spaces, and how the building will shape the city's skyline;
- f. An assessment of how the proposal will improve accessibility for all users, including people with disabilities and how it will be managed and maintained.

7.56 High quality public realm will enhance the appeal of the city centre to potential investors/existing users as part of a hierarchy of public spaces. The following design principles are integral to the design process and implementation of all elements within the public realm, including the spaces between buildings, squares, parks and the waterfront. The public realm is a key component of Wakefield's aspiration to become a successful and vibrant city of international distinction. New development within central Wakefield will not only be expected to enhance the public realm but also make a financial contribution towards its provision, especially within the vicinity of the Emerald Ring.

Policy LP20

Wakefield City Centre Public Realm Principles and Objectives

New development within central Wakefield will be required to make:

- a. A positive contribution to the public realm by virtue of its siting, design and materials; and
- b. A financial contribution towards public realm improvements where appropriate.

The public realm will be developed and enhanced in accordance with the following principles and objectives:

Principles:

1. The creation of a people orientated city;
2. The creation of a sense of identity for Wakefield by enriching the urban fabric; and
3. The creation of a spatial hierarchy that provides a structure for the development of the public realm in a coherent manner over time.

Objectives:

- i. Achieve a high standard and quality of design that will be embraced by Wakefield's inhabitants and instil a sense of pride in the city;
- ii. Enhance the character and usage of a space in a way that complements the rest of the city centre so that the network of streets and spaces are legible and easy to understand;
- iii. Provide a coherent and consistent public realm through the city whilst still allowing the flexibility to respond to the immediate environment and use of a space;
- iv. Reinforce what makes Wakefield distinctive, respecting and reflecting both its heritage and aspirations remaining forward looking while still keeping in touch with its roots;
- v. Create a simple and uncluttered environment and allow the character of the existing buildings to come through;
- vi. Create a public realm that encourages a diverse street culture and a place for people to work, live and visit;
- vii. Create a functional and accessible streetscape;
- viii. Create a robust and durable public realm that promotes cost effective and sustainable maintenance to ensure long term quality; and
- ix. Create a safe and inviting environment for Wakefield's inhabitants and visitors.

7.57 Work on the regeneration of central Wakefield has been underway for many years. A number of studies have been undertaken in this period, some of which have focused on design issues. Important examples include work by Koetter Kim and Associates and the Wakefield Strategy Plan, produced by Gehl Architects in 2004. The Wakefield City Centre Streetstyle Design Guide, produced by Gillespies, was established from the Wakefield Strategy Plan to provide clear guidance for enhancing the streets and spaces within the city centre.

7.58 The principles and objectives set out in the Wakefield City Centre Streetstyle Design Guide have informed the establishment of an ordering/ranking rationale for streets and spaces that guide the quality of the public realm including new spaces and refurbishments within central Wakefield. Public realm improvements should include a strong green element (including trees and landscaping) to soften the townscape and create an attractive setting for development. These principles have informed the Wakefield City Centre Urban Design Framework.

7.59 Wakefield's principal streets and focal spaces, such as Westgate, Kirkgate, Wood Street, Northgate, the cathedral precinct, Bull Ring and the historic yards (which encompass the old part of the city and medieval urban form) will be characterised by very high quality public spaces and natural stone

materials. Public realm projects should reflect the form and scale of the street pattern and enhance the importance of these streets. Emphasis will be placed on the inclusion of public art and innovative design features such as street furniture and water features to enhance the pedestrian environment.

Policy LP21

Wakefield City Centre Public Realm - Hierarchy of Quality

Public realm improvements including the provision of new open spaces and refurbishments must take into account and reflect the ‘hierarchy of quality’ set out below:

Exemplar quality

The city’s principal streets and focal spaces (Westgate, Kirkgate, Wood Street, Northgate, the cathedral precinct, Bull Ring and Westgate Yards) will be characterised by very high quality public spaces and natural stone materials. Public realm projects shall reflect the form and scale of the street pattern and enhance the importance of these streets. Public art and innovative design features such as off the shelf street furniture shall be used to enhance the pedestrian environment.

High quality

All public spaces within the key regeneration areas (i.e. Special Policy Areas) must be treated with high quality materials and detailing and reflect the traditional layout of the street pattern. Major focal spaces must provide meeting spaces or events/activities and place strong emphasis on high quality art work and creative lighting to enhance the character of the public realm.

Good quality

The key linkages through central Wakefield - including the Special Policy Areas - provide a network of spaces that link various parts of the city centre together particularly the waterfront and residential communities to the north and west. In these areas emphasis will be placed on continuity and cohesive design that promotes accessibility, safety and security to provide a network of physical links that are safe and well used. These spaces should reflect the surrounding character of the streetscene and provide links to pedestrian spaces, integrating public art work and high quality street furniture with active frontages and street activity to achieve a safe and accessible pedestrian environment.

The streets and spaces to which these principles apply are shown on the Policies Map: Wakefield City Inset Map, Plan No.4 (Streetstyle Quality). The fabric of public realm improvements shall be maintained and repaired/reinstated as necessary when damage occurs or further works have been carried out.

7.60 The following material matrix table sets out the types of materials that should be used in particular locations, which is taken from the Streetstyle Design Guide.

Table 9 Streetstyle Material Matrix

Public Realm Element	Exemplar Quality		High Quality		Good Quality	
	Principal Streets & Spaces	Historic Yards	Major Streets & Spaces	Key Linkages	Emerald Ring	Standard Streets & Spaces
Surface Materials	Yorkstone paving Wide granite kerbs Granite/sandstone roadway setts Feature materials as highlights	Yorkstone paving Wide granite / sandstone kerbs Granite/sandstone roadway setts Feature materials as highlights	Yorkstone paving Wide granite kerbs Granite/sandstone setts in pedestrian areas Tarmac in vehicular areas with granite / sandstone sett highlights	Yorkstone paving/concrete paving slabs Wide granite kerbs Coloured tarmac with granite / sandstone setts at focal points	Concrete paving slabs Wide concrete kerbs Coloured tarmac with granite / sandstone setts at focal points	Concrete paving slabs Wide granite kerbs Coloured tarmac with granite / sandstone setts at focal points
Street Furniture including safe cycle storage	Exemplar quality 'off the shelf' street furniture including safe cycle storage Possible introduction of alternative materials and finishes, and variations on standard range	Exemplar / high quality 'off the shelf' street furniture including safe cycle storage Variety of contemporary and traditional styles designed sensitively to reflect the character of the area	High quality 'off the shelf' street furniture including safe cycle storage Emphasis on higher quality and variety at focal spaces	High quality 'off the shelf' street furniture including safe cycle storage	High quality 'off the shelf' street furniture including safe cycle storage used only at the focal points	High quality 'off the shelf' street furniture including safe cycle storage used only at the focal points
Trees and Planting	Strong avenues of medium/large street trees Swathes of floral displays Hanging baskets	Small/medium sized street trees Potential for floral displays Hanging baskets Green spaces	Medium/large street trees at focal spaces Swathes of planting at focal points Hanging baskets	Small/medium sized street trees at focal spaces Avenues of trees where possible Hanging baskets	Bold avenues of large street trees Linear green spaces hanging baskets at focal spaces	Trees and hanging baskets at focal spaces
Lighting	Bold avenues of high quality lighting 6-10m high columns, potential for dual columns to provide pedestrian scale lighting Creative lighting throughout	High quality pedestrian scale lighting 4-6m high columns Encourage building mounted lighting Creative lighting at focal points	High quality lighting 6-10m high columns, potential for dual columns to provide pedestrian scale lighting Creative lighting at focal points	High quality lighting 4-6m high columns Emphasise on avenues and well lit spaces	Emphasis on strong avenue of lighting 10-12m high columns Pedestrian scale lighting to footpaths	Good quality lighting 6-10m high columns
Water	Introduction of water features in principal spaces	Possible introduction of water features in focal spaces	Possible introduction of water features in focal spaces	None	None	None
Structures	Potential for canopies along frontages High quality 'off the shelf' bus shelters High quality kiosks	Potential for enclosed spaces through roof canopy	Potential for canopy to frontages High quality 'off the shelf' bus shelters High quality kiosks	Potential for canopies at focal points	High quality 'off the shelf' bus shelters	High quality 'off the shelf' bus shelters
Public Art	Public art integral to space High quality standalone pieces	Public art integral to space High quality standalone pieces	Public art at focal spaces High quality standalone pieces	Public art at focal spaces, potential for cultural trails	Iconic art at gateways into the city	Public art at focal points

7.61 The Local Plan seeks to enhance the city centre living and amenity offer and supports flexible city centre living/working, which will make the Wakefield city centre a more attractive place for office development. Significant office development has come forward at Merchant Gate in recent years, which was identified as a Special Policy Area for redevelopment in the Local Development Framework. The priority going forward is to locate any further significant new office space within the Special Policy Areas, particularly the Waterfront and the Former Westgate Railway Station, and along the Emerald Ring. These areas are well served by public transport along major bus and rail corridors making them suitable for high density office development. This offers the opportunity to strengthen the role of the city centre as a major office destination and make more effective use of land and resources. However, it is recognised that other parts of central Wakefield may generate a demand for new office space, especially where there are existing office uses or clusters i.e. through expansion, relocation or redevelopment. Major office proposals will require a green travel plan.

Policy LP22

New Office Floorspace in Wakefield City Centre

The focus for new office floorspace will be within the Waterfront Special Policy Areas, and the former Westgate Railway Station as identified on the Policies Map and along the Emerald Ring. Outside these areas, small scale office development will be supported (including extensions and/or redevelopment of existing premises and changes of use) provided they:

- relate well to existing streetscene and land use pattern;
- are highly accessible by public transport; and
- have no significant amenity or detrimental effects.

Major office proposals will require a green travel plan.

Development and Design in Pontefract Town Centre

- 7.62** Southgate is an important road in the town centre and carries substantial traffic. However, many of the adjoining properties do not face onto Southgate and there is no clear relationship between the road and these properties or the rest of the town centre. Southgate has assumed the role of an inner relief road with its primary function being to transport traffic past the town centre as quickly as possible. Consequently there has been a deterioration in the quality of the physical environment in the road corridor from Town End to Walkergate. As a result the Council has designated Design Improvement Areas to positively enhance the environment within Southgate. New building work is encouraged with work places at ground floor level and residential accommodation at first floor/ second floor level designed as to allow access to the rear of existing Ropergate properties.

Policy LP23

Design Improvement Areas in Pontefract

Development within the Design Improvement Areas, as identified on the Policies Map: Pontefract Inset Map, will need to make a positive contribution and improvement to the area by:

- a. Ensuring buildings are constructed up to the back of footways, avoiding large areas of car parking or outdoor storage between the road/footway and buildings;
- b. Frontages to Southgate generally being active at ground level;
- c. Retaining the individual historic Burgage Plots.

Works in and adjacent to the highway will need to be designed and implemented in a manner that improves the general environment of the road corridor by:

1. The use of appropriate materials, particularly for footways and other areas of the public realm;
2. The planting of trees and other vegetation;
3. Construction of new, and improvements to existing, walls and entrances.

All the designated Design Improvement Areas are in locations with high archaeological potential. Development proposals in these areas should be accompanied by an archaeological desk based assessment. Redevelopment proposals should also have regard to the relevant Conservation Area Appraisal.

Leisure

Strategic Leisure Corridors

- 7.63** Strategic policy SP12 sets out the principles for leisure, recreation and open space development within the district. Strategic policies SP23 Design, Safety and the Local Environment and SP24 Mitigating and Adapting to Climate Change and Efficient Use of Resources may also be relevant to the consideration of leisure development in the district. The district has around 740 recorded public rights of way covering over 470 kilometres. There are also many other formal and informal routes in use. The rights of way network is often used for leisure but is becoming more important for exercise and health. Paths and cycle routes in urban areas are important as traffic congestion in the district's urban areas is a major issue and people are increasingly encouraged to make short journeys on foot or by bicycle. There are also many attractive paths, cycle routes, canal towpaths and bridleways which give residents and visitors access to the countryside, recreational facilities and visitor attractions such as country parks and historic monuments.
- 7.64** Areas of green space, recreational facilities, visitor attractions, heritage assets and the wider countryside are linked by a strategic network of footpaths, cycle tracks, bridleways, disused railway lines, canal towpaths and quiet country lanes. Improvements to this network for all sections of the community (including people with limited mobility) by increasing access to existing routes and extending or providing new links and routes will be encouraged and supported. Strategic Leisure Corridors are shown on the Policies Map and listed in Chapter 8 of Volume 1 of the Local Plan.

Policy LP24

Strategic Leisure Corridors

New and improved routes for walking, cycling and horse riding will be supported. Within Strategic Leisure Corridors the enhancement of existing routes and creation of new links to improve access and outdoor recreational activities will be prioritised. Development within or adjoining Strategic Leisure Corridors shall maintain public access, contribute to enhancement of the corridor and where appropriate, provide new links and recreational opportunities.

Leisure Opportunity Areas

- 7.65** In order to ensure there is an appropriate mix and range of leisure opportunities within the district the Council has identified Leisure Opportunity Areas which are shown on the Policies Map and listed in Chapter 8 of Volume 1 of the Local Plan. Some Leisure Opportunity Areas are located within urban areas, most are within the Green Belt. Outdoor sport, recreation and countryside activities such as mountain biking, off-road cycling, horse riding, walking, sailing and orienteering are examples of uses which may be appropriate in the Green Belt. Proposals for leisure development will be assessed against national and Local Plan policies, and evidence in the Playing Pitch Strategy. Leisure uses which are defined as main town centre uses in the National Planning Policy Framework will only be appropriate if the Leisure Opportunity Area is within a town centre (Refer to National Planning Policy Framework Annex 2 definition of main town centre uses). The Council has identified some Leisure Opportunity Areas which could provide sports hubs with indoor and outdoor facilities and other community facilities as required. These are in strategic locations to meet requirements for facilities identified in the Playing Pitch Strategy.

Policy LP25

Leisure Opportunity Areas

Within the areas identified as Leisure Opportunity Areas uses for leisure, sport, outdoor recreation and countryside activities will be supported providing it can be demonstrated that:

- a. The development does not have a significant detrimental impact on the open character of the Green Belt and does not conflict with the purposes of including land within it.
- b. Facilities and activities are of appropriate scale, design and intensity which respect the character and amenity of the surrounding area.

Recreational Use of Water Resources

- 7.66** Lakes, canals and rivers offer diverse opportunities for outdoor water based sport and recreation activities. The district's canals are popular for boating and angling, and many angling clubs use private ponds which they help maintain. Sailing clubs are based at Winterset Reservoir, Pugneys Country Park and Horbury Lagoons. Several former minerals working sites have been restored and are now country parks with lakes used for a range of leisure activities. Anglers Country Park and lake is a nature reserve and educational resource with a visitor centre and ranger service offices. At Pugneys Country Park there is a visitor centre offering sailing, windsurfing, canoeing lessons and equipment hire on the main lake, the second nature reserve lake is equipped with birdwatching hides. Pugneys is also used for triathlon, windsurfing and cross country running competitions/events. Horbury Lagoons form a series of lakes, grassland and wet woodland habitat which are used for sailing, angling, and informal recreation such as walking and cycling, and are also managed for wildlife. Potential new water based sport and recreational opportunities arising from mineral working and restoration will be explored as they emerge.
- 7.67** Many of the district's lakes, water bodies and wetlands are designated sites for ecological conservation and the Local Plan policies require development to be carried out in a way which does not damage watercourses and water bodies or their biodiversity. The Waterfront Design policy encourages public access and enhancement of recreational opportunities alongside rivers, canals and other water bodies whilst safeguarding amenity, architectural and landscape character. The Local Plan also safeguards the course and remaining sections of the Barnsley Canal which could be restored in the future. The use of district's rivers and canals for leisure and transport will be encouraged. Generally opportunities to improve the range of water based recreation and the quality of infrastructure such as moorings, towpaths, basins, marinas and visitor facilities will be supported provided they maintain water quality, enhance ecology, and are compatible with any flood management requirements. Increased public access can disturb wildlife or damage habitats, consequently when proposing development alongside watercourses appropriate wildlife refuge areas should be incorporated into the scheme. Development which would result in the loss of facilities for water based freight and which would prevent re-use for this purpose in the future will be opposed.
- 7.68** The Council and the Environment Agency are working to manage current and future flood risks through the adaptation to Climate Change objective. There is a substantial network of flood risk management infrastructure across the district. Creating additional areas for water management will help to further reduce flood risk, whilst also offering opportunities for wider recreational, amenity and biodiversity benefits. The Council's Flood Risk Reduction schemes will provide areas for flood water storage, create areas of wetland, and include flood protection works, culvert improvements,

watercourse improvements and biodiversity enhancement such as planting wet woodland and creating new wildlife habitats. Where appropriate compatible recreational uses and improved public access will be encouraged.

7.69 The Priority Flood Risk Reduction Catchments are:

- Ings Beck (North West & Central Wakefield)
- Oakenshaw Beck (Agbrigg, Crofton, Walton, Sharlston)
- Ea Beck (South Kirkby, South Elmsall, North Elmsall, Hemsworth)
- River Skell (Upper) (Upton, Wrangbrook)
- Carr Beck (Glasshoughton, Cutsyke)
- Lupset Beck (Ossett, Wakefield South, Thornes)
- Hoyle Mill Beck (Kinsley)
- Went Beck (Featherstone, Streethouse)

7.70 Some areas of public open space and recreational land are within flood zones and function as flood storage areas. Any leisure activities within these areas need to be compatible with this function. Recreational developments in flood plains (Flood Zone 3) should not include raising ground levels unless compensatory flood storage can be provided. Any existing flood flow routes should be maintained and wherever possible new flow routes be created to shed flood flows to low vulnerability areas.

7.71 Within new developments areas for surface water drainage and flood management are not normally counted as contributing to usable recreational open space which developers are required to provide. They do however often have amenity value in terms of creating features such as ponds, landscape planting and wildlife habitat. The Environment Agency recommends that consideration is given to sustainable drainage and the use of areas of open space to store surface water by using appropriate topographic landscaping. Where open space is to be provided on a site adjacent to a watercourse it is recommended that it is positioned adjacent to the watercourse to add to the riparian corridor, support biodiversity and aid maintenance activities. In larger developments these areas may also be suitable for compatible informal recreation and could be used to create links with other areas of open space, footpaths and water bodies for example. Mineral working and restoration may also provide opportunities for water management and flood risk reduction along with new water based recreational facilities. Wherever practical the Council will support projects which combine water management and flood risk reduction, ecological enhancement and recreational use of district's surface water resources.

Policy LP26

Recreational Use of Water Resources

Recreational use of the district's rivers, canals, lakes, reservoirs, ponds and flood risk reduction areas will be supported providing it can be demonstrated that:

- a. Activities and any ancillary facilities are of appropriate scale, design and intensity that respect the character of the water body;
- b. There are no significant detrimental impacts on ecology, flood management and landscape quality;
- c. There are no detrimental impacts on water quality;
- d. There are no significant detrimental impacts on amenity or the character of the surrounding area;
- e. The proposals would conserve the significance of any heritage assets;

- f. The development does not have a significant detrimental impact on the open character of the Green Belt and does not conflict with the purposes of including land within it; and
- g. The development will not compromise the ability of navigable waterways to handle the passage of craft.

b) Infrastructure

7.72 Infrastructure is important to support the growth set out on the Local Plan to deliver sustainable development. This section contains detailed policies which address:

- Access and Highway Safety;
- Green and Blue Infrastructure;
- Flood Risk;
- Drainage;
- Renewable Energy, Sustainable Construction and Efficient Use of Resources;
- Minerals; and
- Waste.

Access and Highway Safety

7.73 New development should help to create places that connect with each other sustainably, providing the right conditions to encourage walking, cycling and the use of public transport. People should come before traffic and the Council's aim is to promote designs and layouts which are safe (both in terms of road safety and personal security) and take account of crime prevention and community safety considerations.

7.74 The government places great emphasis on people being able to travel safely whatever their chosen mode. The planning system has a substantial influence on the safety of pedestrians, cyclists and occupants of vehicles through the design and layout of footpaths, cycleways and roads. Planning can also influence road safety through its management of new development. When thinking about new development, and in adapting existing development, the needs and safety of everyone in the community should be considered from the outset taking account of the importance of good design.

7.75 Strategic policies SP13 Sustainable Transport, SP14 Transport Network and SP15 Influencing the Demand for Travel, particularly when considering parking provision, should be considered alongside this policy. Planning applications should be accompanied by Design and Access Statements, which should clearly detail the access and highway issues related to the development proposal, in accordance with the Local Plan policies and the Street Design Guide Supplementary Planning Document. Consideration should be given to West Yorkshire "Green Streets" principles, "Transport for New Homes", including use of the Checklist For New Housing Developments and "Better planning, better transport, better places" advice, referenced in connection with policy SP13.

Policy LP27

Access and Highway Safety

Highway safety, road traffic congestion, and the impact of vehicles on environmental quality and amenity are increasingly of concern within the district. Development proposals shall demonstrate that they can be accessed conveniently and safely and by modes of transport other than the car. In particular proposals shall:

- a. Ensure suitable access to and within the development whilst not presenting an unacceptable impact on highway safety, or severe residual cumulative impacts on the surrounding highway network;
- b. Be supported by travel plans which encourage the use of public transport, cycling and walking, where appropriate;
- c. Allow access and penetration by public transport, where appropriate;

- d. Provide pedestrian and cycling connections within the site and to its surroundings, including linking into existing and proposed pedestrian and cycling routes where appropriate, and ensuring these can be accessed easily and safely by all sections of the community;
- e. Include provision for safe cycle storage;
- f. Provide a level of parking provision appropriate to the proposal and its location (applying the agreed maximum standards set out in current guidance), ensuring that such provision is located in safe and accessible locations, paying particular attention to the needs of wheelchair/pram users which should be located close to entrances;
- g. Take into account changes in site levels to ensure the development can be accessed easily and safely by all sections of the community and by different modes of transport;
- h. Take into account the features of surrounding roads and footpaths and provide adequate layout and visibility to allow the development to be accessed safely; and
- i. Take into account access for emergency, service and refuse collection vehicles.

Green and Blue Infrastructure

- 7.76** Strategic policies SP12 Leisure, Recreation and Open Space and SP23 Design, Safety and the Local Environment should be considered alongside this policy. Green infrastructure has traditionally been perceived as a combination of spatial or linear environmental assets including open green space, amenity space, landscape planting, urban parks and gardens, commons and village greens, natural and semi-natural wildlife habitat such as woodland and heath, country parks, Registered Parks & Gardens, Scheduled Monuments, Local Nature Reserves, Sites of Special Scientific Interest, Local Wildlife Sites, church grounds and cemeteries, allotments, playing fields and sports pitches, public rights of way, the Trans Pennine Trail and other recreational routes. Blue infrastructure is a sub-category of green infrastructure and consists of all types of surface water such as rivers, becks, canals, ponds, lakes and reservoirs, washlands and floodplains together with adjoining banks, towpaths/ footpaths, and flood management infrastructure. Some of these sites are managed not just for conservation and education but also used as a community resource for informal outdoor recreation where appropriate, such as walking and cycling. However, Natural England's Green Infrastructure Framework recognises the contribution to biodiversity, flood management or wellbeing made by other green infrastructure such as street trees, green roofs/walls, private gardens, sustainable drainage, and natural flood management functioning at local and landscape scale, roadside verges, green bridges, and field margins. The Green Infrastructure Framework provides valuable advice for incorporating green infrastructure into development proposals.
- 7.77** The Wildlife Habitat Network connects Sites of Special Scientific Interest, Local Nature Reserves, Local Wildlife Sites and other habitats listed in the Wakefield Local Biodiversity Action Plan. By providing a coherent network linking these sites it makes sites more resilient to changes which may be the result of local developments or international threats such as global warming. It also safeguards a significant proportion of the district's green and blue infrastructure network and Strategic Leisure Corridor allocations. As a consequence, the Local Plan does not have specific green infrastructure allocations.
- 7.78** The Yorkshire & Humber Green Infrastructure Mapping Project identified a network of strategic regional, sub-regional and district green infrastructure corridors. In Wakefield District the Rivers Aire and Calder are regional corridors. The Magnesian Limestone Ridge, River Went, route of the Trans Pennine Trail, and Core Woodland around the Coxley Valley and Bretton Park are sub-regional corridors. District corridors encompass the area of Anglers Country Park, Walton Park and Newmillerdam Country Park. Most of these corridors are incorporated in Wakefield's Wildlife Habitat Network.
- 7.79** A number of established recognisable standards exist which would aid with the creation of multi-functional green and blue infrastructure. These include the National Design Guide and the National Model Design Code, and the Building with Nature and BREEAM assessments.

Policy LP28

Green and Blue Infrastructure

Proposals that help conserve, sustain and enhance the district's green and blue infrastructure assets will be supported. The Council will seek to secure new and enhanced green and blue infrastructure in order to encourage healthy lifestyles and help address climate change. Public access and recreational opportunities will be encouraged where appropriate.

Development proposals shall ensure that:

- a. Green and blue infrastructure assets are, wherever possible, retained. If this is not feasible replacement infrastructure equivalent to or better than that lost in terms of both quantity and quality shall be provided;
- b. New or enhanced green infrastructure is designed and integrated into the development, for example through planting schemes, footpath/cycle corridors, and recreational open space;
- c. The development connects with footpaths and cycling routes, particularly the Strategic Leisure Corridors, by retaining existing links, and providing new links where opportunities exist;
- d. Appropriate protection and enhancement of biodiversity and ecological assets such as natural green space, woodland and water bodies is provided, particularly if development is within the Wildlife Habitat Network or adjoining ecological designations such as Local Wildlife Sites and Local Nature Reserves;
- e. Wherever practical green and blue infrastructure is multifunctional, incorporating measures such as sustainable drainage schemes, tree planting and wildlife refuge areas, that will help reduce the impacts of, and enable the district's communities and wildlife to adapt to, climate change.

Flood Risk

- 7.80** Climate change is likely to mean new and increased risks of flooding. In recent years the Wakefield district has experienced significant flooding caused by large storm events in 2007, 2012, 2014, winter 2015 and early 2020 which are likely to be repeated. As the Lead Local Flood Authority (LLFA) the Council is responsible for managing local flood risk, including from surface water, ground water and ordinary watercourses, and for preparing local flood risk management strategies. The Council will work with its partners, particularly the Environment Agency, to ensure that development proposals do not give rise to an unacceptable level of risk to the safety of existing and future occupants, the wider community and the environment from flooding through the operation of natural forces and human activity.
- 7.81** The Environment Agency publishes Flood Zone maps, which are updated quarterly on-line, showing areas at different degrees of risk from fluvial and tidal flooding. The zones vary between Zone 1 where there is considered to be little or no probability of flooding to Zone 3a where the probability is high, and Zone 3b, which is functional floodplain and identified from the Strategic Flood Risk Assessment, which is managed by the Lead Local Flood Authority (LLFA). A full description of the flood risk zones can be seen in the national planning practice guidance on Flood Risk and Coastal Change, together with the Sequential and Exception Tests which must be considered when allocating land and considering proposals for development.
- 7.82** Development should preferably be located in Flood Zone 1. If this is not possible development in Flood Zone 2, then Flood Zone 3 may be appropriate if the development can be shown to be safe. This risk should be analysed by an appropriate Flood Risk Assessment which also outlines what measures will be taken to ensure that the development will remain safe during flood events throughout its lifetime. An appropriate Flood Risk Assessment will be expected to meet current requirements as set out in national policy and which the Environment Agency advises on.
- 7.83** The Council has undertaken a Strategic Flood Risk Assessment (SFRA) together with Calderdale and Kirklees Councils. The updated SFRA makes use of the most up-to-date flood risk datasets to assess risk to the proposed development allocation sites and key settlements. It has analysed flood risk along the River Calder and other main watercourses. As part of this updated Strategic Flood Risk Assessment, a further indicative flood zone has been delineated called Flood Zone 3ai. Flood Zone 3ai includes developed land with the same level of risk as Flood Zone 3b where water would flow or be stored at times of flooding if not already constrained by development. In national policy terms this is part of Flood Zone 3a. Identification of Flood Zone 3ai allows the Council to assess risk within 3a in more detail showing areas where existing development is likely to be restricting flood flows and water storage that would otherwise be within the functional floodplain. Should sites in Flood Zone 3ai become available for new or further development (e.g. as brownfield sites) then both the risk at the sites and their role in managing flood risk in the surrounding area should be carefully considered with no increase in development footprint or vulnerability. Flood Zone 3ai includes areas of land that would be in Flood Zone 3b if not already developed and should therefore be used as an indicator of flood risk. In determining planning applications the Council will take into account the advice given and considerations identified in the Strategic Flood Risk Assessment. Flood Risk Assessments should take into account the Strategic Flood Risk Assessment and where appropriate other relevant plans, programmes and strategies such as the Aire and Calder Catchment Flood Management Plans.

- 7.84** The Flood Risk Assessment should take into account flooding from all possible sources (surface water, groundwater, ordinary watercourses etc.) and consider all other relevant national datasets. Where development is permitted, the Council will use planning conditions and/or legal agreements to ensure that appropriate flood protection or mitigation measures are undertaken and provision is made for their future maintenance as part of the development.
- 7.85** The National Planning Policy Framework and national planning practice guidance together set out the government's guidance on sustainability and flood risk. Strategic policy SP3 Location of Development sets out the broad policy framework for delivering the spatial development strategy. Strategic policy SP24 sets out the Council's policy for mitigating and adapting to climate change and efficient use of resources, including the need to avoid unacceptable levels of flooding from all sources.

Policy LP29

Flood Risk

Following flooding events in the district the Council is concerned that development proposals are not at unacceptable risk from flooding or give rise to flooding elsewhere. The Council will adopt a sequential approach to discourage development in areas at risk of flooding. The whole of the district should be the starting point for the Sequential Test. Applicants will be required to provide justification where a smaller area of search is proposed. If, after applying the sequential approach, it is not possible to avoid areas of flood risk then the Council will adopt a precautionary approach to managing flood risk by seeking to minimise probability and consequence and ensuring developments are safe.

The Council's Strategic Flood Risk Assessment will be used to inform the Sequential Test and, where development can only be situated in flood risk areas, it must have wider sustainability benefits to the community that outweigh the flood risk and should reduce flood risk overall. The Council will adopt the following approach to determining applications in relation to flood risk:

1. Applicants proposing development in Flood Zones 2 and 3 must provide evidence of the Sequential Test to the Council;
2. An appropriate Flood Risk Assessment will be required, to manage flood risk from all sources, for proposals in:
 - a. Flood Zone 1 (low probability) of 1 hectare or more;
 - b. Flood Zone 1 where there is known to be a risk of localised flooding including from surface water, watercourses and groundwater, proportionate to the size and flood risk of the site;
 - c. Flood Zone 2 (medium probability) following successful completion of the Sequential Test;
 - d. Flood Zone 3 (high probability) following successful completion of the Sequential Test.
 The Flood Risk Assessment will form part of the Exception Test where required;
3. Applicants must demonstrate that developments can be considered safe over their predicted lifetime taking account of climate change and the vulnerability of its users, without increasing flood risk elsewhere, and, where possible will reduce flood risk overall. The Council's Strategic Flood Risk Assessment and national flooding guidance will inform this process;
4. Measures to mitigate the risk of flooding and to manage any residual flood risk must be provided as part of the development and provision must be made for their future maintenance;
5. Within functional floodplain (Flood Zone 3b as mapped in the Strategic Flood Risk Assessment), development will only be permitted where it is water compatible development, or for essential transport or utilities infrastructure for which no alternative location is available, subject to satisfying the Exception Test. The development shall be designed to remain operational at times of flood, shall not result in any net loss of floodplain storage and shall not impede water flow or increase flood risk elsewhere;
6. A sequential approach to site layout will be required to ensure the most vulnerable aspects of a development are sited on the lowest risk areas of the site, and that the least vulnerable are sited on the highest risk areas.

7. Development shall be appropriately flood resilient and resistant designed and give priority to the use of sustainable drainage systems.
8. Flood Zone 3ai includes the areas of land that would be in Flood Zone 3b if not already developed. Therefore, development in Flood Zone 3ai shall take account of the risk at the sites and their role in managing flood risk in the surrounding area. Proposals within Flood Zone 3ai will be assessed in accordance with national policies relating to Flood Zone 3a, but with all the following additional restrictions:
 - a. No new highly vulnerable or more vulnerable uses will be permitted;
 - b. Less vulnerable uses will only be permitted provided that the Sequential Test has been passed and;
 - c. Where extensions are linked operationally to an existing business or, where redevelopment of a site provides buildings with the same or smaller footprint;
 - d. All proposals will be expected to include flood mitigation measures such as compensatory storage which should be identified and considered through a site specific Flood Risk Assessment;
 - e. Development will not be permitted on any part of the site identified through a site specific Flood Risk Assessment as performing a functional floodplain role.

Drainage

7.86 The EU Water Framework Directive applies to surface waters and groundwater. This requires member states to prevent deterioration of aquatic ecosystems and protect, enhance and restore water bodies to 'good' status or good ecological potential by 2027. The Humber River Basin Management Plan fulfils the requirements of the Directive. The priority river basin management issues in the Aire and Calder catchment are to tackle: the effects of heavily modified water bodies; point source pollution, primarily from water company assets; and diffuse pollution, both urban and rural. Adequate water and wastewater infrastructure is needed to support sustainable development. A healthy water environment will also deliver multiple benefits, such as helping to enhance the natural environment generally and adapting to climate change.

Surface Water Drainage

7.87 Many of the major flooding events within the district are as a result of large storm events which cause surface water and sewer flooding. This is a significant issue for the Council and is predicted to get worse with the impact of climate change.

7.88 A range of sustainable techniques are available to tackle flooding from surface water run-off and associated pollution. Sustainable drainage techniques include the use of ponds, reed beds, swales, permeable paved surfaces and soakaways. Developers will be expected to submit an assessment of the feasibility of using sustainable drainage systems with their proposals for development. The government and the Council expect sustainable drainage techniques to be incorporated into the development wherever practical and planning conditions and/or legal agreements may be used to ensure that suitable maintenance plans for sustainable drainage systems are in place.

7.89 In April 2020 Sewers for Adoption was superseded by the Sewerage Sector Guidance, which re-defines what is classed as a sewer to allow many sustainable drainage techniques to be classed as part of the public sewer network. Adoption of qualifying sustainable drainage techniques by Yorkshire Water is preferred to ensure that sustainable drainage techniques are maintained in perpetuity.

7.90 The non-statutory technical standards for sustainable drainage systems guide their design, maintenance and operation (DEFRA, 2015).

- 7.91** Lead local flood authorities are now a statutory consultee to the local planning authority for surface water flood risk for major developments. The lead local flood authority is also consulted by the local planning authority on minor developments where surface water flood risk is an issue.
- 7.92** Developers are expected to reduce run-off rates by at least 30% on brownfield sites, however proposals are expected to achieve betterment run-off rates, closer to greenfield run-off rates where possible. Existing brownfield sites with no formal drainage will be restricted to the greenfield run-off rate and there must not be any increase in existing rates on greenfield sites. Developers will not be expected to reduce run-off rates below the greenfield run-off rate (which is normally 2.5 litres per second per hectare). If a higher flow rate is proposed, the onus will be on the developer to demonstrate as part of a planning application, what the existing run-off rate is and that utilising this flow rate will not have a detrimental effect on the catchment's flood risk. If a new point of discharge to a watercourse is proposed as part of a development, the run-off must not exceed greenfield rate (2.5l/s/ha), regardless of whether the site is brownfield or greenfield.
- 7.93** The restricted flow rates must be applied to a 1 in 1 and 1 in 100 year rainfall event. Developments must also incorporate on-site storage for surface water for a 1 in 100 year event. If a new point of discharge to a watercourse is proposed as part of a development, the run-off must not exceed greenfield rate (which is normally 2.5 litres per second per hectare), regardless of whether this is brownfield or greenfield. Developers will not be expected to reduce run-off rates below the greenfield run-off rate. All calculations for run-off rates and flood storage requirements should be carried out based on the latest government and industry standards. An allowance for climate change in line with the latest government guidance will be required on all new developments.
- 7.94** A drainage strategy will be required for all developments to demonstrate how proposed measures manage surface water close to its source and follow the drainage hierarchy. A strategy should include the following as a minimum:
- The site's characteristics (slope profile, soil geology, existing flood risk);
 - The existing drainage infrastructure (including culverts) and impermeable area plans;
 - The proposed drainage design and impermeable area plans;
 - The calculated existing and proposed surface water runoff rates and required storage volumes;
 - Details of where the runoff is to be discharged to;
 - The sustainable drainage system features proposed; and
 - How the drainage system is going to be managed and maintained.

Foul Water Drainage

- 7.95** New development will be permitted where foul sewers and waste water treatment works of adequate capacity and design are available or will be provided in time to serve the development. When determining proposals the disposal of sewage will be considered in accordance with the following foul water hierarchy:
1. Public Sewer
 2. Package Treatment Plant
 3. Septic Tank
 4. Cesspool
- 7.96** If it can be shown to the satisfaction of the Council that connection to a public sewer is not feasible, a package treatment plant should be used for foul drainage disposal providing it is acceptable to the sewage undertakers and the Environment Agency. Connection to a septic tank should be considered only if it can be demonstrated that a package treatment plant is not feasible, the use of septic tanks will only be acceptable where:

- Mains drainage is not available, and
- Ground conditions are satisfactory and the plot is of adequate size to provide a suitable sub-soil drainage system, and
- There is no risk of pollution by septic tank effluent.

7.97 Cesspools are the least sustainable form of drainage and may only be used in exceptional circumstances for temporary developments. Where developments include a car wash facility, the developer should ensure that consideration is given to the disposal of trade effluent. Car wash liquid waste is classed as trade effluent. Before discharging to a sewer, developers must get a trade effluent consent or enter into a trade effluent agreement with Yorkshire Water. If developers are not able to discharge effluent to the foul sewer it will be classed as waste and developers must then ensure they comply with their duty of care responsibilities.

7.98 The National Planning Policy Framework and national planning practice guidance together sets out the government's guidance on sustainability, the prevention of pollution and protection of the environment. Strategic policy SP24 sets out the Council's policy for Mitigating and Adapting to Climate Change and Efficient Use of Resources, which includes sustainable drainage and flood risk. Strategic policy SP23 sets out the Council's policy for Design, Safety and the Local Environment including pollution control and protection and enhancement.

Policy LP30

Drainage

Major flooding events have occurred within the district caused by surface water and sewer flooding. A drainage strategy will be required for all development.

- Surface water from new developments must be managed using sustainable drainage systems unless it can be demonstrated that they are not technically feasible. New developments on existing formally drained brownfield sites will be expected to reduce run-off rates by at least 30%, and must not increase existing rates on greenfield sites. Change of use developments and conversions will be expected to incorporate sustainable drainage techniques wherever possible.
- Development will only be permitted if infrastructure required to service the development is available or the provision of infrastructure can be co-ordinated to meet the demand generated by the new development.
- Development will only be permitted where it can be demonstrated that it would not result in an unacceptable impact on water quality.

Protection and Improvement of Watercourses and Flood Defences

7.99 The following policy will ensure that new development protects and improves watercourse and flood defences. The opportunities to de-culvert existing water courses and maintain open watercourses through planning applications are more often driven by flood risk, although there may be environmental benefits as well, as picked up in policy LP52.

7.100 As well as planning permission, works within eight metres of main rivers or ordinary watercourses may need additional permits/consents. For works in or around main rivers contact the Environment Agency to check if an Environmental Permit is required and for non-main rivers the applicant may require an Ordinary Watercourse Consent from the Lead Local Flood Authority (Wakefield Council) or the Internal Drainage Board (DANVM Drainage Commissioners) depending on the location of the works.

- 7.101** Where the buffer can sufficiently serve the purpose of maintenance, as required by the Environment Agency and/or the Lead Local Flood Authority and meet policy LP52, it may also be configured to contribute towards green and blue infrastructure, and if not required specifically for drainage management infrastructure, as recreational open space. Other local policies provide the context for the consideration of the land for these uses.

Policy LP31

Protection and Improvement of Watercourses and Flood Defences

The Council considers it beneficial for watercourses to remain in an open state for both flood risk and environmental purposes. Where possible the Council will also encourage the removal of existing culverts.

The Council will only approve an application to culvert a watercourse if there is no reasonably practicable alternative. [Where culverting is proposed as part of a scheme to build over a watercourse the Council would generally be opposed to the proposal because of Health and Safety considerations, increased maintenance costs and because this would likely preclude future options to restore the watercourse].

1. New development must make space for water and not harm the integrity of flood defences. New development should:
 - a. Be set back from main rivers and any associated flood defence structures or culverts, and ordinary watercourses, and in the case of the former, maintain a minimum eight metre buffer strip, which should be free of development and naturalised where feasible. An Environmental Permit will be required for any work within the buffer;
 - b. Maintain an adequate distance between new development and ordinary watercourses (a minimum of eight metres is required for maintenance). The distance applied will be determined by having regard to the nature of the development and the type of ordinary watercourse;
 - c. Adopt a presumption in favour of the removal, where possible, of existing culverts; and
 - d. Not involve the culverting of main rivers and ordinary watercourses.
2. Development on any land required for current and future flood management, which would adversely affect the delivery of flood defence schemes, will be refused.
3. Development on or adjacent to watercourses must not:
 - a. Result in deterioration in a watercourse; or
 - b. Impede existing normal or flood flows;
 - c. Increase flood risk to upstream or downstream properties or land.

Renewable Energy, Sustainable Construction and Efficient Use of Resources

- 7.102** Strategic policy SP24 sets out the overarching approach in the Local Plan to Mitigating and Adapting to Climate Change and Efficient Use of Resources. Increasing the amount of energy from renewable and low carbon technologies will help to make sure the UK has a secure energy supply, reduce greenhouse gas emissions to slow down climate change and stimulate investment in new jobs and businesses. Planning has an important role in the delivery of new renewable and low carbon energy infrastructure in locations where the local environmental impact is acceptable.
- 7.103** The Climate Change Act 2008 created a legally binding target to reduce the net UK carbon emissions to at least 80% below 1990 levels by 2050; and contribute to global emission reductions to limit global temperature rise to as little as possible above 2 °C. Under the Paris Agreement 2015 the UK is committed to following a decarbonisation pathway that aims to limit the global average temperature increase to 1.5 °C, while ensuring it is held to “well below” 2 °C, by taking steps reflecting its “highest possible ambition”. In June 2019 the UK passed the Climate Change Act 2008 (2050 Target Amendments) Order to revise the Climate Change Act carbon emission reduction target to “at least 100%” by 2050 (‘net zero’), in line with the advice of the Committee on Climate Change. The European Union Renewable Energy Directive sets a binding target of 20% final energy consumption from renewable sources by 2020. The UK has committed to a national target of 15%. For the UK to meet its EU goals, electricity generation from renewable sources is likely to have to increase to above 30% by 2020. Micro-renewables will be necessary to meet this target.
- 7.104** Part L of Building Regulations (June 2022) (conservation of fuel and power) sets minimum standards for energy efficiency and target emissions rates working towards 2050 targets for reducing carbon emissions rates. These standards are expected to continue to increase through updates to Building Regulations, following the Government consultation on Future Homes Standards. Provisions in the Planning and Energy Act 2008 allow development plan policies to impose reasonable requirements for a proportion of energy used in development in their area to be energy from renewable sources and/or to be low carbon energy from sources in the locality of the development.
- 7.105** The Leeds City Region Strategic Economic Plan sets out the ambition for the City Region to become a 'resilient zero carbon economy by 2036'. The Council declared a Climate Emergency in May 2019 which committed the Council to being a Carbon Neutral organisation before 2030, and work towards making the entire area zero carbon within the same timescale. This will enable the Council to contribute to limiting global warming to less than 1.5 °C. It is expected that other relevant plans and strategies will contribute to the delivery of this goal, such as the Local Plan, and the Council has prepared a Climate Emergency Action Plan.
- 7.106** The Council's Energy Plan 2017-2020 aims to reduce energy consumption and carbon emissions across the Council and the District. The Council has signed the Clean Energy Pledge and is ambitious to be a Clean Energy District by 2050, improving air quality and health and wellbeing, in support of the UK's commitments to reduce emissions through the Climate Change Act. Local Energy Plan Targets and local policy initiatives in this plan related to emissions from transport, housing and business.
- 7.107** There are a number of micro-generation technologies which developers could install to meet the target in the following policy. These include solar thermal panels, solar photovoltaic panels, combined heat and power plants, wood fuel boilers, ground source heat pumps, small scale hydro turbines and fuel cells. The Council will expect developers to submit supporting information with their proposals and may use planning conditions and/or legal agreements to ensure such technology is provided. Where relevant, schemes must demonstrate how they will conserve any affected heritage asset, in a manner appropriate to its significance, in accordance with national and Local Plan policies on the historic environment.

Policy LP32

Renewable Energy

In order to contribute to the UK 2050 net zero carbon emissions target and the objectives of the Council's Climate Emergency Resolution and Action Plan all developments of 0.5 hectares or more in site area, or 10 or more dwellings, or 1,000 m² or more floor area for employment, commercial, leisure and community development (including conversions) will be required to provide a minimum of 10% of the predicted energy needs of the development from onsite renewable or low carbon energy generation technology, unless it can be demonstrated that it is not technically feasible or financially viable, or there are demonstrable alternative decentralised renewable or low carbon energy services.

If it can be demonstrated that renewable or low carbon energy generation is not practical, it may be acceptable to provide in lieu of provision, a contribution equivalent to the cost of providing the 10%, which the council will use towards off-site low carbon schemes. Wherever possible, the low carbon projects would be linked with local projects that would bring local benefits.

Applicants will be required to submit an Energy Assessment with their application to demonstrate compliance with this policy. Where end user requirements change significantly, an updated Energy Assessment should be submitted prior to construction.

- 7.108** To be sustainable, development should make a contribution towards reducing greenhouse gas emissions, use of or production of renewable energy, waste recycling and moving towards zero carbon development. Buildings account for almost half the UK's consumption of energy and carbon dioxide emissions. The design and layout of buildings can make a significant contribution to sustainable development by reducing greenhouse gas emissions and utilising resources efficiently.
- 7.109** The Planning and Energy Act 2008 allows local planning authorities to set energy efficiency standards in their development plan policies that exceed the energy efficiency requirements of the Building Regulations for new housing or the adaptation of buildings to provide dwellings and for non-housing developments. Part L of Building Regulations (June 2022) now requires all new homes to produce 31% less carbon emissions than the 2013 Building Regulations. As a result, the standard applied in the Residential Viability Evidence, of 20% carbon emissions reduction beyond 2010 Building Regulations, has now been surpassed by the updated Building Regulations. Therefore, only for non-residential developments over 1,000 m² a higher standard will be expected to achieve the BREEAM (Building Research Establishment Environmental Assessment Method) standard of 'excellent'.
- 7.110** Applications should be accompanied by a sustainability statement, which should give details of the sustainable construction techniques and energy and water conservation measures designed into the development. The Council may use planning conditions and/or legal agreements to ensure sustainable construction techniques and energy and water conservation measures are incorporated. These will not duplicate the requirements of the Building Regulations. Where relevant, schemes must demonstrate how they will conserve any affected heritage asset, in a manner appropriate to its significance, in accordance with national and Local Plan policies on the historic environment.

Policy LP33

Sustainable Construction and Efficient Use of Resources

The Council will require that new development within the district shall be energy and water efficient and incorporate built-in conservation measures. Opportunities to conserve energy and water resources through the layout and design of the development shall be maximised. In considering planning applications the Council will require where practical:

- a. The use of solar energy, passive solar gain and heat recycling (such as combined heat and power);
- b. Layouts which reduce wind-chill and maximise the efficient use of natural light;
- c. The use of green roofs, rainwater and grey water storage and recycling, and sustainable drainage systems;
- d. The use of renewable and recycled materials during construction and provision for the recycling of construction, demolition and excavation wastes.

All non-residential developments of over 1,000 m² of floorspace (including conversion), where feasible, will be required to meet the BREEAM standard of 'excellent'.

Electric Vehicle Charging Infrastructure

7.111 The Council undertakes local air quality reviews and assessment in accordance with the Environment Act 1995. Where levels of air pollution exceed national standards and objectives, Air Quality Management Areas are designated by the Council. In Wakefield District there are Air Quality Management Areas, as of 2023, along parts of the M1 and A1 corridors and within Wakefield, Castleford, Pontefract, Featherstone, Knottingley and Hemsworth. These are largely due to pollution caused by road traffic. The Council is concerned to ensure that all new development, particularly commercial, industrial and traffic generating uses, does not result in an unacceptable level of air pollution to the detriment of public health and other land uses. Planning policy has a key role to play in improving air quality through directing new development to sustainable locations where there is a choice of alternative sustainable means of travel other than the private car and supporting the provision of a network of green infrastructure to help to mitigate poor air quality. In addition, supporting the increased provision of electric vehicle charging points in new homes and other development will deliver improvements to local air quality with associated benefits for public health and climate change. This is consistent with the government's strategy for moving away from fossil fuels in vehicles by 2040. As part of the West Yorkshire Combined Authority, the Council is involved with development of an electric vehicle strategy for West Yorkshire to deliver a standardised public electric vehicle charge point network across the region. The network will be critical in supporting both taxi and private hire operations as well as public drivers to ultimately increase the uptake of electric vehicles. Financial contributions from new development in lieu of onsite provision can be used to support this strategy.

Policy LP34

Electric Vehicle Charging Infrastructure

All applications for new development which include provision of parking spaces will be required to meet the minimum standard of provision of electric vehicle charging points.

This requires:

- a. Residential: one charging point per dwelling with an associated dedicated parking space and where parking spaces are unallocated (for example visitor and communal parking) one charging point per 10 spaces;
- b. Office/Retail/Industrial/Education: charging points for 10% of parking spaces ensuring that electricity infrastructure is sufficient to enable further points to be added at a later stage;
- c. Motorway Service Stations: charging points for 10% of parking spaces;
- d. Petrol Filling Stations: provision of fast charge facilities;
- e. Pay and display car parks: charging points for 20% of parking spaces.

If it is not practical or feasible to provide electric vehicle charging within the development then an equivalent contribution will be required to be made towards public electric vehicle charging infrastructure (for example on-street charging or public charge-points on public car parks).

Renewable Energy Generation

7.112 The continuing production of “greenhouse gases” and carbon dioxide in particular, is contributing to the increasing rate of global warming and climate change, contrary to the aims of sustainable development. Energy generated from renewable natural sources such as the sun, wind, water, biomass and energy crops, landfill gas and mine workings makes an important contribution to meeting the requirements to reduce greenhouse gas emissions and tackling climate change.

7.113 Planning policy emphasises the need to balance the need to generate energy from renewable sources with the impact of proposals on the environment. The Council will support proposals which generate energy from renewable sources, but will expect the proposals to be appropriate and suitable for their location. Many renewable energy projects such as wind and hydro will need to be located close to the source of power. Suitable sites will often be within the Green Belt and may also raise important landscape, ecological, archaeological and amenity issues. The Council will consider proposals in terms of their impact on neighbouring land uses and their contribution to cutting greenhouse gas emissions in line with the Climate Change Act.

7.114 Projects of a significant scale, such as wind farms, will be expected to undertake an Environmental Impact Assessment. Developers should contact the Council at the pre-application stage to determine whether an Environmental Impact Assessment is necessary.

Policy LP35

Assessment of Applications for Renewable Energy Generation Developments

Proposals for renewable and low carbon energy development will be supported and planning permission granted provided they will not have an unacceptable impact on:

- a. Landscape character and visual appearance of the local area, including the urban environment;
- b. Protected species or designated sites of importance for biological or geological conservation;
- c. Flood risk or water quality;
- d. Heritage assets and their character, appearance and setting;

- e. The statutory protection of any area;
- f. Transport infrastructure or highway safety;
- g. Local amenity including noise, odour, traffic or other impacts;
- h. The potential for cumulative effects with other existing or proposed energy developments.

The extent to which harm can be reduced to an appropriate level through mitigation will be taken into account when assessing effects.

Proposals must include information to show how the local environment will be protected, and that the site will be restored when production ends.

Priority will be given to:

1. Established and proposed industrial sites; and
2. The use of other previously developed land before greenfield sites

Proposals in the Green Belt will conform to national and local policies relating to the Green Belt.

Where the above criteria are met, the council encourages dialogue with local community groups promoting community renewable and low carbon energy schemes.

As the Local Plan does not identify any areas as suitable for wind energy development the policy does not apply to wind turbines, which will be considered against national planning policy.

District Heating and Cooling

7.115 To help increase the supply of renewable and low carbon energy and heat, local authorities are encouraged to identify opportunities for development to draw its energy supply from renewable, or low carbon energy supply systems and for co locating potential heat customers and suppliers. District heating and cooling infrastructure provide an opportunity for local decentralised renewable and low carbon energy sources. Planning can provide opportunities for, and encourage energy development which will produce waste heat, to be located close to existing or potential users of the heat. Planning can also help provide the new customers for the heat by encouraging development which could make use of the heat. Information on local heat demand is published by the government to assist planners and developers in identifying locations with opportunities for heat supply by using the national heat map and the UK combined heat and power (CHP) development map. The Leeds City Region Strategic Economic Plan (SEP) sets out the ambition for the City Region to become a 'resilient zero carbon economy by 2036', and is in the process of identifying energy opportunity areas for different technologies to support this ambition. The outcome of this study will form part of the evidence base and will inform further policy development in this area.

7.116 New developments provide an opportunity to assess the feasibility and viability of district heating and cooling through masterplanning work. Proposed developments should connect to a network where it exists, or should be designed so that it can connect to a future network where a viable network is identified, where evidence demonstrates it is viable for the developer to do so. In recent years the Council has explored opportunities for networks in Wakefield City, Wakefield East, Castleford and Knottingley. This work should continue to be progressed in line with significant allocations and initiatives for regeneration and redevelopment such as the Knottingley Strategic Development Framework, the River Aire Strategic Growth Corridor, South Featherstone and South Kirkby.

- 7.117** Heat distribution is most likely to be viable in areas of higher density. The potential for networks should be investigated by residential developments of at least 50 dwellings per hectare and/or 300 dwellings/all mixed use developments. Energy Statements should include an assessment of the potential to implement heat networks, or alternatively to design systems so that they are compatible to connect to a network in future.
- 7.118** Feasibility assessments should be in line with Section 2 of the CIBSE Heat Networks Code of Practice, providing rationale for the preferred option and incorporating a high level assessment of the potential to phase the growth of the network beyond the development area in future. For developments for which there are already feasibility studies underway e.g. Castleford, the Council should work proactively with the developer to share information and ensure that these requirements can be met.
- 7.119** The standard parameter to assess the viability of a district heating network is the linear heat density. This is defined as the ratio of the annual heat delivered to the total length of the district heating piping and network. District heating networks are considered to be more viable if the linear heat densities are higher. The greater the dwelling density, the less sensitive the relative heat distribution loss is to linear heat density. An appropriate minimum threshold for linear heat density is 3,000kW per square metre.
- 7.120** Viability assessment should also include the expected heat loads across potential residential and non-residential connections and detailed evidence across the site to determine if there are areas within it that have the right blend to give load diversity and heat density. Economic assessment should compare the cost of district heating against a baseline or “Business As Usual” scenario and produce cash flow statements including the Internal Rate of Return.
- 7.121** Planning conditions could also be used to secure successful delivery of heat networks by: ensuring connection to an existing network/network under construction; requiring connection before a development has been occupied; and requiring connection to future networks.
- 7.122** The Council will need to work proactively with applicants on major developments to support the delivery of district heating and cooling infrastructure.

Policy LP36

District Heating and Cooling Infrastructure

Where Combined Cooling Heat and Power distribution networks already exist, all new developments are required to connect to them, or be connection-ready, unless it can be clearly demonstrated that utilising a different energy supply would be more sustainable or connection is not technically feasible or financially viable.

Where technically feasible and financially viable, and in areas with sufficient existing or potential heat density, developments of 1,000 sqm or more, or residential developments of at least 50 dwellings a hectare, or 300 dwellings or more (including conversions) shall propose heating and cooling systems according to the following heating and cooling hierarchy:

- a. Construction of site wide renewable Combined Cooling Heat and Power,
- b. Construction of site wide gas-fired Combined Cooling Heat and Power,
- c. Construction of site wide renewable community heating/cooling,
- d. Site wide gas-fired community heating/cooling,
- e. Collaboration with neighbouring development sites or existing heat loads/sources to develop a viable shared District Heating network,

- f. Individual building renewable heating,
- g. Individual building heating, with the exception of electric heating

In areas where district heating is currently not viable, but there is potential for future district heating networks, all development proposals will need to demonstrate how sites have been designed to allow for connection to a future district heating network.

All Combined Cooling Heat and Power must be of a scale and operated to maximise the potential for carbon reduction. Carbon savings and renewable energy generation achieved under this policy will contribute to the target set out in policies LP32 Renewable Energy and LP33 Sustainable Construction and Efficient Use of Resources.

Minerals

Mineral Extraction

7.123 Strategic policy SP19 sets out the broad approach to the protection of mineral resources and supporting sustainable mineral production. National Planning Policy requires Local Plan policies to set out criteria or requirements to ensure that permitted and proposed minerals operations do not have unacceptable adverse impacts on the natural and historic environment or human health, taking into account the cumulative effects of multiple impacts from individual sites and/or a number of sites in a locality. This is reflected in the following policy.

Policy LP37

Mineral Extraction

Proposals for mineral extraction will be considered having regard to their impact on the natural and historic environment and human health. Taking into account the cumulative effects associated with all existing and approved developments affecting the locality, proposals to explore for, or extract minerals will be permitted provided they will not have an unacceptable adverse impact in relation to:

- a. Noise and vibration;
- b. Dust, particle emissions and air quality;
- c. Impact on best and most versatile agricultural land;
- d. Light pollution;
- e. Landscape character and visual impact on the local and wider area;
- f. Transport infrastructure or highway safety;
- g. Protected species or designated sites of importance for biological or geological conservation;
- h. Disruption to significant ecological networks;
- i. Increased flood risk;
- j. Impacts on the flow and quantity of surface and groundwater, and the quality of groundwater;
- k. Archaeological and heritage assets and their character, appearance and setting;
- l. Tip and quarry-slope stability;
- m. Differential settlement of quarry backfill;
- n. Mining subsidence;
- o. Geological structure;
- p. Migration of land contamination from the site; and
- q. Public access.

Proposals for mineral extraction must be accompanied by sufficient information to demonstrate that such unacceptable adverse impacts will not occur, or can be satisfactorily controlled.

Proposals for mineral extraction must include information to show how the site will be reclaimed at the earliest opportunity, to provide high quality restoration and aftercare, including the contribution towards enhancement of ecological networks through beneficial biodiversity after-use schemes.

Mineral Safeguarding

7.124 National minerals policy requires the district to contribute to the regional supply of aggregates, and provide an adequate steady supply of minerals, such as limestone and gravel (excluding energy minerals). It is, therefore, important to protect essential mineral infrastructure and safeguard mineral resources from other development. Mineral reserves are relatively scarce in the district, and Wakefield relies on imports from other areas for the majority of aggregate minerals used. It is important that known mineral resources are not sterilised by other forms of development.

7.125 The Local Plan will protect permitted reserves (Mineral Reserves) and safeguard known economically viable deposits of minerals from sterilisation for future working (Mineral Safeguarding Areas). The Local Plan will also safeguard existing planned and potential sites for minerals production (Safeguarding Mineral Production). Non-aggregate mineral resources occur mainly in areas designated Green Belt and this will generally achieve the degree of protection required. However, certain uses acceptable under Green Belt policy could prejudice the possibility of mineral extraction (for example, uses involving new buildings), therefore, a specific designation has been included on the Policies Map to denote protected resources as Mineral Safeguarding Areas. Mineral Reserves by definition have been granted planning permission.

7.126 National planning policy requires local plans to set out policies to encourage the prior extraction of minerals, where practical and environmentally feasible, if it is necessary for non-mineral development to take place. This is reflected in the following policy.

Policy LP38

Mineral Safeguarding

1. All proposals for non-mineral development within Mineral Safeguarding Areas on sites over 2 hectares must be accompanied by supporting information demonstrating that mineral resources will not needlessly be sterilised. Proposals shall satisfy one of the following criteria:
 - a. The mineral can be extracted prior to the development taking place; or
 - b. Mineral resources are not present or have already been extracted; or
 - c. The prior extraction of the mineral resource is not feasible or economically viable; or
 - d. The development will not affect the ability to extract the mineral resource in the future if required; or
 - e. The prior extraction of the mineral resource will have an unacceptable impact on people or the environment; or
 - f. There are overriding economic, environmental or social benefits of the development which justifies the sterilisation of a resource that could otherwise be viable for extraction.
2. Planning permission should not be granted for alternative development within an existing Mineral Reserve unless it can be demonstrated that it will not result in the sterilisation of an economically significant mineral resource.

Oil, Gas and Coal Exploration and Extraction

7.127 National planning policy requires minerals planning authorities to recognise the benefits of on-shore oil and gas development, including unconventional hydrocarbons, for the security of energy supplies and supporting the transition to a low-carbon economy; and put in place policies to facilitate their exploration and extraction. When planning for onshore oil and gas development, minerals planning authorities should clearly distinguish between, and plan positively for, the three phases of development (exploration, appraisal and production), whilst ensuring appropriate monitoring and site restoration is provided for. Minerals planning authorities are expected to include Petroleum Licence Areas on their policies maps and criteria-based policies for each of the exploration, appraisal and production phases of hydrocarbon extraction. These policies should set clear guidance and criteria for the location and assessment of hydrocarbon extraction within the Petroleum Licence Areas. This is reflected in the following policies. Position Statement C of The Environment Agency's approach to groundwater protection (February 2018 Version 1.2) is also relevant to consider in relation to the exploration and extraction of oil, gas and coal.

Policy LP39

Proposals for the Exploration and Appraisal of Hydrocarbons (Oil and Gas)

Within Petroleum Licence Areas, as shown on the Policies Map, proposals for the exploration and appraisal of hydrocarbons will be supported provided they accord with other policies in the Local Plan and national planning policy and guidance, and the following criteria are met:

- a. Any well sites and associated infrastructure are located so as to minimise adverse impacts on people and the environment, whilst allowing access to effectively explore and appraise the potential resource; and
- b. Sufficient evidence has been provided to demonstrate that any adverse impacts on people and the environment can be avoided or adequately mitigated; and
- c. Any boreholes intended to be re-used in production are sited where they can accommodate the necessary scale of future infrastructure and any required mitigation; and
- d. Exploration and appraisal is for a temporary agreed length of time; and
- e. An indication is provided about the extent of the resource and the area of search; and
- f. Proposals for the restoration of the site are included which provide for maintenance or enhancement of the ecological, landscape and/or amenity value at the earliest opportunity if resources are not found to be economically viable, planning permission is not subsequently granted, or they are not developed within an agreed time frame.

Policy LP40

Proposals for the Commercial Production of Hydrocarbons

Within Petroleum Licence Areas, as shown on the Policies Map, proposals for the commercial production of hydrocarbons will be supported provided they accord with other policies in the Local Plan and national planning policy and guidance, and the following criteria are met:

- a. A full appraisal has been completed for the resource to demonstrate that a viable resource exists of a sufficient size to justify its extraction; and
- b. Sufficient evidence has been provided to demonstrate that the scheme will not lead to any adverse impacts on people and the environment or that any such adverse impacts will be adequately mitigated; and
- c. Proposals for the restoration of the site are included which provide for maintenance or enhancement of the ecological, landscape and/or amenity value at the earliest opportunity once production has ceased; and
- d. The proposed extraction and production site is the most appropriate in terms of potential impacts on people and the environment and infrastructure and transportation requirements.
- e. Proposals must include information to show how the site will be reclaimed at the earliest opportunity, to provide high quality restoration and aftercare.

7.128 There are extensive coal measures across the district, and historic areas of deep mine workings. It is important to avoid unnecessary sterilisation of coal and associated mineral resources by other forms of development where these can be extracted, within a reasonable timescale and in an environmentally acceptable way or where local or community benefits clearly outweigh the likely impacts to justify the grant of planning permission. Minerals planning authorities should provide for coal producers to extract separately, and if necessary, stockpile, fireclay so that it remains available for use. Planning permission should not be granted for the extraction of coal unless certain criteria are met, as reflected in the following policy.

Policy LP41

Coal Extraction

Proposals for coal extraction will not be permitted unless the coal resource would otherwise be sterilised by another form of development or all of the following criteria are met:

1. Any viable fireclay resources will also be recovered, and;
2. One of the following circumstances applies:
 - a. The proposals are environmentally acceptable, or can be made so by planning conditions or obligations, or if not;
 - b. The proposal provides national, local or community benefits which clearly outweigh the likely impacts of the development.

Waste

Managing Waste Development

7.129 Strategic policy SP16 sets out the Strategic Approach to Waste Management, policy SP17 provides the framework for providing capacity to meet identified need at Waste Management Facilities and policy SP18 sets the framework for Managing Residual Waste. Applications for waste related developments will be assessed against all relevant policies at national and local level. A number of waste management sites have been completed in recent years and further capacity has been identified in allocations carried forward from the Local Development Framework, where waste management processes are already taking place (WS01, WS02, WS03 and WS04). However, this does not preclude the potential for other waste management sites to come forward during the plan period. Therefore, the following policy provides a positive framework to facilitate the potential development of waste management facilities on non-allocated sites.

Policy LP42

Location of Other Waste Management Facilities

Proposals for the development of waste management facilities other than in allocated sites shall be located in accordance with the spatial development strategy and the settlement hierarchy giving priority to:

- a. Employment Zones and Sites where most modern waste management facilities can be appropriately developed particularly where the co-location of complementary activities, such as “resource recovery” or “sustainable growth” parks is possible;
- b. Previously developed land in sustainable locations, including use of mineral extraction and landfill sites during their period of operation for the location of related waste treatment activities; and
- c. Redundant agricultural and forestry buildings and associated land.

7.130 The following policy will be used to assess all waste proposals, irrespective of their nature or location. The purpose is to assess the potential benefits of waste proposals, against the potential adverse impacts which could arise from the development as well as seeking to ensure the right facility is built in the right location at the right time. All developers are encouraged to engage in pre-application discussions at an early stage with the planning authority, statutory consultees (e.g. the Environment Agency and the Department for Environment, Food and Rural Affairs) and the public.

Policy LP43

New Waste Management Facilities

Proposals for the development of new waste management facilities will be permitted, where it can be demonstrated that:

- a. They are in accordance with the waste hierarchy;
- b. There will be no unacceptable adverse environmental, social or economic effects, particularly in relation to urban regeneration, economic development, environmental improvement, and growth priorities;
- c. The significance of any heritage asset will be conserved;
- d. There will be no unacceptable adverse effect on surface or groundwater. In the floodplain, proposals shall not adversely affect groundwater levels or water quality, impede flood flows, reduce capacity of flood storage or existing flood defence structures;

- e. Adequate means of controlling noise, light, vibration, dust, litter, odours, vermin, birds and other emissions are incorporated in the scheme, such that there would be no unacceptable adverse effects on the amenity of sensitive receptors;
- f. Development will be of a scale, form and character appropriate to its location and landscape setting, and not be visually intrusive in terms of height and size;
- g. There is a high quality of design, particularly in relation to site layout, external appearance of built structures, screening, boundary treatment, and landscaping to ensure that the development is well screened and integrated with the surrounding area and uses;
- h. Safe and convenient access to the strategic road, inland waterway or rail networks can be achieved and it can be demonstrated that the network has adequate capacity to accommodate any additional traffic movements generated by the proposed development;
- i. Adequate space can be provided on site to ensure that vehicles can enter, wait, unload and leave safely;
- j. Where appropriate, details of progressive restoration to a suitable after-use are provided; and
- k. Where appropriate provision is made to recover energy.

Where proposals are not consistent with the Local Plan, they will be required to demonstrate that they serve an identified need.

Planning conditions and, where necessary, legal agreements will be used, as appropriate, to ensure mitigation measures are put in place to manage any effects associated with traffic, noise, odour, visual impact, flooding, dust, air quality and other potential effects.

Waste Facilities within Development

7.131 The re-use, recycling and recovery of waste can be encouraged by ensuring that there are suitable facilities available within all types of developments to store different types of materials (e.g. glass, paper, plastics, etc). In particular, planning applications for significant or large-scale development are expected to integrate or incorporate waste management facilities to minimise, re-use and recycle waste.

Policy LP44

Waste Facilities within Development

All significant development proposals shall make efficient use of resources and integrate waste management facilities. A waste management plan must be provided with all planning applications, which shall consider, where appropriate:

- a. Designs and layouts that allow the effective sorting, recycling and where appropriate composting of waste;
- b. The need to ensure that development can be served by appropriate waste collection methods to support recycling systems;
- c. Design principles and construction methods that, where appropriate, encourage the use of high quality building materials made from recycled and secondary sources;
- d. Construction, demolition and excavation methods using fixed and mobile plant that minimise waste production and re-use/recycle materials, as far as practicable onsite; and
- e. Accommodating community based sorting, recycling and composting facilities within new developments, where appropriate and feasible.

c) Community Facilities, including Open Space and Sports Facilities

Public Services

- 7.132** The sustainable development of the district and its attractiveness as a place to live, work and spend leisure time is influenced by the quality of infrastructure available to residents. National planning policy states that places should be healthy, inclusive and safe and support quality of life and community cohesion. At a time when resources to public providers of infrastructure, particularly public services related to health and social care, are under substantial pressure, it is important that the most effective use is made of those that are available.
- 7.133** The Council is seeking to get a diverse and balanced mix of community facilities across the district to meet the needs of residents and visitors. Generally new community, leisure, cultural and visitor facilities will be located within urban areas taking advantage of existing services and high levels of accessibility and public transport. In Local Service Centres, Villages and smaller settlements development must be appropriate to the size of the settlement, meet identified needs and help create a balanced and sustainable community. Suitable sites for major facilities such as hospitals, leisure centres with swimming pools or stadia cannot always be found in urban areas, in which case they should be located at the edge of the urban area and be accessible by public transport. The co-location of facilities to serve community areas will be encouraged. The council will support proposals that provide a sustainable and community led approach to the management and maintenance of community facilities to encourage local communities to take an active role in looking after services and facilities where they live.
- 7.134** At the district level the Index of Multiple Deprivation 2015 (IMD) lists Wakefield as the 65th most deprived district in England (out of 326 districts). The IMD shows that 47,400 people in the district are living in neighbourhoods amongst the top-10% most deprived in England. This is 14.4% of the district's population. Alongside this, parts of the area's population have significant levels of support needs relating to a range of services provided by the Council or other parts of the public sector including mental health, treatment for substance misuse and adult social care. Of particular concern is the fact that a significant proportion of this demand is from service users who have moved into Wakefield from outside the area.
- 7.135** Policy SP21 provides the strategic context for Community Facilities and Services in the Local Plan. In an era of limited resources, the Council and its partners are keen to focus on meeting local needs in the first instance, and to ensure that the proportion of their overall resources that need to be directed towards providing support services is kept under control. They are concerned about development which ostensibly provides accommodation or services used by vulnerable people, but which is provided in an ad-hoc way with little or no reference to wider strategies for commissioning support services. This can result in users going on to require a wide range of other support services provided by the public sector. This is firstly an undesirable situation for the service users themselves, since development that is not supported by capacity in an appropriate range of services results in them being unable to access the support they require. Secondly, it can have an impact on perceptions of Wakefield more generally, as areas become associated with poor quality accommodation or with perceptions of crime perpetrated by service users who are not receiving proper support. The policy below sets out how we will manage development for these types of facilities.

Policy LP45

The Effect of Development on Public Services

1. Development will be granted planning permission provided that infrastructure, facilities and services exist, or can be provided via the development, which will allow the development to proceed without an unacceptable adverse impact on existing provision.
2. Development likely to cater or provide accommodation for users of publicly provided support services, including but not limited to mental health services, substance misuse treatment and adult social care, will only be permitted where it is clearly demonstrated that:
 - a. A need for the development exists arising from the requirements of people already ordinarily resident in Wakefield or of Wakefield service users currently receiving service outside the authority area;
 - b. Where the development consists of a facility directly providing a support service, the nature and scale of the facility is in line with the Council's commissioning strategies, such that resources are likely to be available to refer individuals to the facility and it can be reasonably expected that people already ordinarily resident in Wakefield, or Wakefield service users currently receiving service outside the authority area will be the principal users of the facility; and
 - c. The development will not lead to an increase in the level of demand for any publicly provided support service, to an extent that is likely to result in a deterioration of the level of service available to existing users.

Open Space

7.136 Policy SP12 provides the strategic context for Leisure, Recreation and Open Space within the Local Plan. Good quality open space enhances the quality of life for citizens, has a positive impact on health and wellbeing and helps promote biodiversity and ecological conservation. The district has nine country parks, most of which are reclaimed former colliery/ mineral extraction sites. There are around 25 urban parks in the district managed by the Council and two managed by town councils, and 140 equipped play areas. Wakefield District has over 1700 accessible open/green spaces consisting of urban parks, country parks, sports fields, amenity areas, playgrounds, kickabout areas, natural areas, cemeteries and churchyards. The district also has areas of Access Land (designated under the Countryside and Rights of Way Act 2000) which includes commons and Betty Eastwood Park.

7.137 Distribution of open space across the district is generally good, but there are areas with under and over provision of certain types of green space where some rationalisation is required. Some areas of open space are poorly distributed in relation to accessibility for residents. The quality and design of recreational areas and open green space often needs improving. The Council is reviewing the open space it owns and maintains, and developing Management Plans for its country parks, urban parks and Local Nature Reserves. The Council has determined not to adopt or maintain any new areas of open space. Developers and land owners will need to find alternative maintenance solutions for open space in new development sites.

7.138 Within the Local Plan open space is defined as publicly accessible land in any ownership consisting of the categories set out below. Open space does not include private open space and land which has no public right of access such as domestic gardens, grounds around buildings, car parks, agricultural land and forestry plantations.

Country Parks & Natural Areas

- Country parks, nature reserves and other natural areas such as woodland, heaths and commons;
- Green corridors such as disused railway lines, footpaths, cycle tracks and bridleways; and
- Blue corridors such as watercourses, canal towpaths, land adjoining rivers, lakes and reservoirs, washland, floodplains, Wakefield waterfront, Castleford waterfront and Knottingley waterfront.

Sports & Recreation Grounds

- Sports grounds, sports pitches and school playing fields (though these are frequently only accessible to club members or school pupils with limited access to the general public); and
- Kickabout areas for casual ball games and other informal recreational activities.

Urban Parks & Amenity Open Space

- Public parks in urban settings such as Thornes Park and Pontefract Park;
- Registered Parks & Gardens and grounds of Scheduled Monuments (though these are frequently only accessible to paying visitors or have limited public access);
- Church grounds, cemeteries and crematoria grounds;
- Amenity areas such as village greens, mown grass, and planted areas to enhance the landscape;
- Paved pedestrian areas such as town squares and precincts;
- Playgrounds, children's equipped play areas, multi-use games areas (MUGAs) and skateboard parks; and
- Allotments (though these are frequently only accessible to plot holders).

Policy LP46

Open Space

Proposals that help conserve, sustain and improve the district's open space will be supported. Areas of open space will be safeguarded from development unless it can be demonstrated that:

- a. There is an identified over provision of that particular type of open space in the community area and the site is not required for alternative recreational uses; or
- b. Suitable replacement open space can be provided to serve the community area which is equivalent to, or better than that lost, in terms of quantity and quality, and
- c. There are no significant detrimental impacts on amenity, the character of the surrounding area or ecology, and
- d. The space does not make a positive contribution to the character or setting of a Conservation Area, Listed Building or other heritage asset.

Requirements for Open Space in New Development

7.139 New housing development should include sufficient recreational open space to meet the needs of residents. Open space must be usable and located where it is easily accessible whilst ensuring adjacent residents do not suffer loss of amenity through inappropriate activities. Major development places greater demand on neighbourhood recreational facilities, so developers may be required to provide additional off-site facilities or contributions to upgrade existing community facilities. The requirement for open space depends upon the size of the development, existing provision within the area and accessibility.

7.140 The type of open green space, its quality and facilities offered determines how far people are prepared to travel to use it. Open space such as kickabout areas for informal ball games and children's play areas need to be close to where people live within easy walking distance. Residents are prepared to travel further for sports pitches, parks and outdoor recreation, but these need to be easy to get to and located within their town or village. Larger destination sites such as country parks, sports hubs and allotments will attract visitors from further afield serving community areas or the district as a whole. Open space should be accessible by public transport and linked by networks of footpaths, cycle routes and bridle ways wherever possible to maximise accessibility and encourage healthier lifestyles.

Policy LP47

Open Space in New Development

The Council will seek to secure well-designed new and improved public open space, sport and recreational facilities in order to encourage everyone in the district to be as physically active as possible and promote a healthy lifestyle for all. New housing developments will be required to provide or contribute towards new recreational open space or the improvement of existing facilities in the area.

1. The Council will require open space to be provided either on-site, or contributions in lieu of on-site provision, or a combination of both, as appropriate. This will be assessed in accordance with the Council's open space standards and the Playing Pitch Strategy on a site specific basis taking account of the needs of new residents and the existing facilities serving the community area. The accessibility, quality, usage, connectivity, type and amount of existing open space will be considered in order to determine the requirements for open space.

- a. In areas where existing open space is insufficient to meet local needs, the provision of on-site open space will be preferred to meet the needs of the development. Where this is not practical developer contributions towards off-site provision and/or enhancement of existing open space serving the community area will be sought.
 - b. In areas where existing provision is sufficient to meet the needs of the development, developer contributions towards off-site diversification and/or enhancement of open space serving the wider community area will be sought.
2. New open space shall complement existing recreational facilities in the vicinity of the development and be designed to enhance the natural landscape and environment. On-site provision shall allow for informal recreation for residents and children's play. Off-site provision may contribute towards any type of open space where there is an identified community need. Amenity landscaping and drainage management infrastructure will not be accepted as recreational open space within new development.

Developer Contributions Towards Open Space

7.141 The Council will assess planning applications to determine whether new open space or a commuted sum is required. This is assessed on a site specific basis taking account of the requirements for new residents and the existing facilities within a community area. For example there may be an over provision of informal recreational areas and amenity open space, but a need for better quality play or sports facilities. Depending on the scale and location of the development provision can be made within the site, off-site, or a combination of both. New open space and commuted sums towards maintenance and enhancements of existing open space and recreational facilities are currently secured through Section 106 agreements. This system allows flexibility to meet needs within communities, however developers often prefer the certainty of open space requirements to be set out in policy documents. Section 106 agreements will continue to be used to secure site specific matters to make development acceptable in planning terms, and will include open space for recreational and amenity purposes within the site. Alternatively developer contributions in lieu of on-site provision to improve existing open space close to the site may be acceptable.

7.142 The Community Infrastructure Levy was adopted on 1 April 2016. It is charged per square metre of floor space of new housing and retail development based on land use and location. The Levy can be collected in addition to the Section 106 commuted sum, and may be used for capital and revenue funding of strategic public open space throughout the district. CIL Regulation 123 restricts the use of Section 106 obligations to ensure no duplication of developers contributions. Section 106 contributions and CIL monies will not be sought for the same infrastructure projects.

7.143 The types of open space and leisure infrastructure that may be funded by CIL are:

- New green infrastructure or improvements to the quality of existing green infrastructure (this excludes provision of on-site and off-site public open space required to make development acceptable that would be obtained through Section 106 agreements);
- Community sports, leisure and recreation facilities;
- Public realm improvements (this excludes provision of on-site and off-site public open space required to make development acceptable that would be obtained through Section 106 Agreements); and
- Pedestrian and cycle networks.

Policy LP48

Requirements for Open Space in New Housing Development

The Council will require open space to be provided for residents of new housing development as set out below.

1. For sites of 15 dwellings and over and between 0.5 to 2 hectares in area, a developer contribution in lieu of on-site provision will be required.
2. For sites of 2 hectares and over the developer will be required to provide either:
 - a. 10% of the site area of the development as open space, or
 - b. A commuted sum for investment in open space to serve the development, or
 - c. A combination of commuted sum and on-site open space, according to local requirements.

Protected Areas of Open Land (Local Green Space)

7.144 The National Planning Policy Framework allows for the allocation of Local Green Space within areas which are of particular local significance to the community because of its beauty, historic significance, recreational value, tranquillity, or ecological value. Local Green Space must be close to the community it serves and policy for managing development in it should be consistent with policy for Green Belts. It must also be local in character and not consist of an extensive tract of land, for example designations of areas of open countryside adjacent to settlements would not be appropriate. Within Wakefield District many valued areas of green space are already protected by ecological or archaeological designations, and are located within the Green Belt. National planning practice guidance makes it clear that where land is already protected by Green Belt and other designations consideration should be given to whether any additional local benefit would be gained by designation as Local Green Space.

7.145 The following policy safeguards Protected Areas of Open Land within urban areas and performs the same function as Local Green Space. Protected Areas of Open Land may consist of parks and public recreational space or open areas of green space of value to local communities. The Council has reviewed open space within the district and considered whether any new Protected Areas of Open Land or Local Green Space should be designated in the Local Plan. It has concluded that land already allocated as Green Belt or safeguarded by designations does not need to be designated as a Protected Area of Open Land/ Local Green Space because it will not confer any additional benefits.

7.146 Local Green Space can also be designated within Neighbourhood Plans. Playing fields, sports facilities, allotments and tranquil urban spaces such as church grounds can be considered as Local Green Space but should demonstrably be special to the local community. There are policies and allocations for recreational open space and playing fields to be safeguarded as Local Green Space in the Walton Neighbourhood Plan. When 'made' (adopted), Neighbourhood Plans will become part of the Wakefield District development plan.

Policy LP49

Protected Areas of Open Land

Protected Areas of Open Land identified on the Policies Map shall be safeguarded from development to maintain local character and amenity of settlements and their communities. Within the areas of open land identified under this policy, development will only be permitted in very special circumstances for purposes other than those which would not substantially affect the openness and character of the land or detract from its amenity value.

Sports Facilities

7.147 Having good quality, accessible sports facilities is crucial to the infrastructure of sport and physical activity to enable participation, rehabilitation, development or improvement. A broad range of facilities provided by the education, public, private and voluntary sectors is required. The Playing Pitch Strategy sets out a strategic approach to the provision of high quality, accessible sport facilities in Wakefield District. It contains an audit, assessment and analysis of sports facilities, and sets out policy options and recommendations. Policies for sports facilities will have regard to the Wakefield Playing Pitch Strategy and any updates or subsequent Playing Pitch Strategy.

7.148 The Playing Pitch Strategy identifies a need for football and rugby pitches which can be met from existing used or partly used playing fields and increased community use of school playing fields. Many pitches also need to be improved with better changing facilities. Within the Local Plan sites which can accommodate new outdoor and indoor sports facilities at various key locations within the district have been allocated as either Sports Facilities or as Leisure Opportunity Areas. All these sites are within existing areas of playing fields or parks which can accommodate expansion of facilities, or are within regeneration areas.

7.149 There are a number of sports clubs, community clubs and miners welfare clubs throughout the district which offer a wide range of good quality club and community facilities. Many professional and semi-professional sports clubs have community links which enable wider access to their facilities. The Council will continue to support clubs in developing their facilities, and will encourage community access wherever practical.

Indoor and Community Sports Facilities

7.150 Large indoor facilities such as sports centres and swimming pools will be located in urban areas in accordance with the spatial development strategy. Sports halls, fitness facilities and club facilities will be located in the communities they serve and must be appropriate to the type and size of settlement. They should also be accessible by public transport, cycling and walking. Most of the district's secondary schools have sports facilities which are available for community use and hire to local clubs. These facilities are generally of good quality and accessible to the communities they serve. The use of junior school facilities will also be encouraged, particularly in areas where there is an identified shortage of facilities such as junior and mini team sports. Villages in the rural areas to the south west of Wakefield have a shortage of accessible sports halls and fitness facilities. Community centres, schools and parish halls provide the most sustainable opportunities to provide these. Often a cluster of neighbouring settlements provides a range of facilities collectively which would not be viable in individual settlements. Accessibility can also be improved by better public transport such as new bus stops and more frequent services to urban areas, which is a more sustainable option than constructing new facilities in isolated locations.

Outdoor Sport Provision

7.151 The Council owns and maintains sports pitches and playing fields across the district. This provision is only part of the available outdoor sports facilities, other providers include semi-professional and private sports clubs, community and miners welfare clubs, and schools. Between all these a good range of accessible sports activities are available across the district. Local sports pitches meet current demand and there is capacity for additional pitches on the Council's playing field sites, if required. The main issue is the need to improve the quality of some facilities and rationalise underused pitches to provide the best facilities for local communities under increasingly difficult constraints. Some Council sites are now leased to sports clubs who have taken on the responsibility for maintenance and operation of the grounds and providing new club facilities, enabling investment and team development. In addition many of the district's secondary schools already have sports facilities which are also used by the wider community and serve local needs. Wherever possible the Council will continue to work with clubs, schools and communities to improve quality and access to local facilities.

Policy LP50

Sports Facilities

1. New and improved sports facilities will be supported providing it can be demonstrated that:
 - a. The intensity of uses will not have a significant detrimental impact on amenity and highway safety;
 - b. Facilities and ancillary buildings are of appropriate scale and design which respect the character of the surrounding area.
2. Existing sports facilities will be safeguarded from development unless it can be demonstrated that:
 - a. There is an identified over provision of that particular type of facility in the community area and the site is not required for alternative sport and leisure uses; or
 - b. Suitable replacement facilities can be provided to serve the community area which are equivalent to, or better than those lost, in terms of quantity and quality;

in accordance with national planning policy.
3. Outdoor sport facilities within the Green Belt will be supported where development does not have a significant detrimental impact on the open character of the Green Belt and does not conflict with the purposes of including land within it, in accordance with national planning policy.

d) Natural, Built and Historic Environment

7.152 The quality and condition of the environment has a direct impact on the quality of life. Policies on design, safety, conservation and control of pollution help maintain and improve the local environment and prevent development which could have detrimental effects on environmental quality. The provision of open space and protection of the Green Belt also make an important contribution to creating high quality environments. Policy SP12 provides the strategic context for Leisure, Recreation and Open Space in the Local Plan and policy SP23 provides the strategic context for considerations of Design, Safety and the Local Environment. This section contains more detailed policies which address:

- Promotion of biodiversity, conservation and enhancement of wildlife species and habitats;
- The need to improve the built and natural environment through good quality design, landscaping, access and protection of open space;
- Safety & security and measures to tackle crime;
- The preservation and enhancement of historic buildings and the archaeological heritage;
- The impact of development on the landscape and protection of the countryside; and
- Prevention of pollution to protect public health and the environment.

Conserving and Enhancing the Natural Environment

7.153 Sites designated for biological and geological conservation within Wakefield District will be identified within the following hierarchy of importance as:

1. International and European Designation: Special Areas of Conservation
2. National Designation: Sites of Special Scientific Interest
3. Regional Designations: Local Geological Sites, Local Nature Reserves, Ancient Woodland and Local Wildlife Sites

7.154 The current designations at the time of adoption are shown on the Policies Map and listed in Chapter 8 d) of this document. The West Yorkshire Ecology Service hosts the West Yorkshire Ecological Record and provide data on protected and notable species and designated sites.

Ecological and Geological Conservation

7.155 The National Planning Policy Framework requires local plans to promote the conservation, restoration and enhancement of priority habitats, ecological networks and the protection and recovery of priority species. Where a proposal for development is likely to affect a designated site for biodiversity or geological conservation, any species protected by law or its habitat, or Biodiversity Action Plan (BAP) priority species and habitats (otherwise known as species and habitats of principal importance), the Council will expect a suitable ecological assessment to be submitted prior to a planning application being determined. With regard to development proposals in proximity to Denby Grange Colliery Ponds Special Area of Conservation, an Appropriate Assessment is required to meet the Habitats Regulations, as set out in paragraphs 8.22 and 8.23. Any necessary measures to protect the species and their habitat are required to be in place before work affecting the site commences. The Council may use planning conditions and/or legal agreements to secure protection and enhancement of biodiversity and positive mitigation measures.

7.156 National planning policy requires a mitigation hierarchy to be applied to ascertain whether planning permission can be granted where firstly significant harm to biodiversity resulting from a development should be avoided, then minimised, mitigated, or, as a last resort, compensated for.

7.157 National planning policy supports minimising impacts on and providing net gains for biodiversity once the mitigation hierarchy has been satisfactorily applied to the relevant site or species. Biodiversity net gain is an approach which aims to leave the natural environment in a measurably better state than before. Net gain delivers measurable improvements for biodiversity by creating or enhancing habitats in association with development, which can be achieved preferably on-site, off-site or through a combination of on-site and off-site measures. Biodiversity offsetting is an important tool to aid the delivery of net gain. It works by using a metric that measures losses and gains in biodiversity enabling an objective measure of changes in biodiversity value to be made. The Department for Environment, Food and Rural Affairs (Defra) has devised and tested a metric which will be applied when considering development proposals. A minimum of 10% net gain in biodiversity is required by the Environment Act. The Council has guidance for developers to achieve Net Gain for Biodiversity through Development.

Policy LP51

Ecological and Geological Conservation

The Policies Map identifies sites designated for biological or geological conservation of international, national, and regional importance within the following hierarchy of importance:

- International and European Designation: Special Areas of Conservation;
- National Designation: Sites of Special Scientific Interest;
- Regional Designations: Local Geological Sites, Local Nature Reserves, Ancient Woodland and Local Wildlife Sites.

Where the Council considers that any designated site or any species of principal importance for conservation may be affected by a development proposal, an appropriate ecological assessment will be required to be submitted with the planning application. An Appropriate Assessment will also be required to be submitted for development in proximity to Denby Grange Colliery Ponds Special Area of Conservation.

1. Development that is likely to have either a direct or indirect adverse effect on a Site of Special Scientific Interest will only be permitted if it can clearly be demonstrated that exceptional reasons of public interest for development clearly outweigh any impact on the features of the site that make it of special scientific interest and any broader impacts on the national network of designated sites.
2. Development resulting in either the loss or deterioration of Ancient Woodland, veteran trees and other irreplaceable habitats or that is likely to have either a direct or indirect adverse effect on a regionally designated site will not be permitted unless a suitable compensation strategy exists and it can clearly be demonstrated that:
 - a. Development cannot reasonably be located on an alternative site; and
 - b. There are exceptional reasons where the public benefit clearly outweighs the loss or deterioration of habitat; and
 - c. There will be an overall net gain for biodiversity of at least 10%, including a positive contribution to the protection, creation and enhancement of habitat and species; and
 - d. Biodiversity enhancement measures are incorporated which reflect the priority habitats and species identified in the Wakefield Biodiversity Action Plan; and
 - e. There are no significant adverse impacts on the integrity of, and connectivity to, the Wakefield Wildlife Habitat Network.
3. Where development is permitted the Council will require developers to:
 - a. Minimise disturbance;
 - b. Protect and enhance the site's ecological value;
 - c. Ensure appropriate management;

- d. Ensure appropriate mitigation measures are designed into the proposal and work on the site does not commence until these measures are in place;
- e. Work to approved methods; and
- f. Create new or replacement habitats with a minimum net gain of 10% of the current ecological value of the site using the Defra Metric.

Protecting Watercourses and Water Bodies

7.158 Proposals for development that affect watercourses must have regard to the corridor and its ecological features. Weirs can act as significant barriers to the passage of migratory fish and other wildlife such as otters. In the first instance where possible, opportunities to remove weirs should be sought. If complete removal is not feasible, options to improve or install fish passes should be taken, especially on the River Aire and River Calder. Proposals affecting watercourses should include an assessment of the riverbank treatments to be included within the development. These shall be undertaken in line with the following hierarchy:

1. Naturalisation
2. Bioengineering
3. Ecologically enhanced hard engineering
4. Hard engineering

7.159 Watercourses and their banks provide valuable habitats. An effective way of protecting these habitats and contributing to wildlife habitat networks and green infrastructure is to retain naturalised buffer strips along watercourses. Development proposals should contain a feasibility assessment of incorporating this buffer strip from the top of the bank to the landward side of the development to allow river and beck corridors to return to their natural state wherever possible. Minimising culverting of water courses and reopening existing culverts is beneficial for ecology and also helps reduce flooding. Within new developments culverts should be avoided unless absolutely necessary for essential access, and existing culverting should be reopened wherever possible, as promoted through policy LP31. Any new development should not be built on top of or within eight metres of an existing culvert, river or smaller watercourse. This ensures that options to reopen existing culverts can be pursued as part of the development and also maintains ease of access for maintenance. Buffer strips to watercourses are required for the following purposes:

- To allow the watercourse to undergo natural processes of erosion and deposition, and associated changes in alignment and bank profile, without the need for artificial bank protection works and the associated destruction of natural bank habitat;
- To provide for the terrestrial life stages of aquatic insects, for nesting of water-related bird species, and for bank dwelling small mammals;
- To provide a "wildlife corridor" bringing more general benefits by linking a number of habitats and affording species wider and more robust and sustainable linked habitats;
- To allow for the maintenance of a zone of natural character with vegetation that gives rise to a range of conditions of light and shade in the watercourse itself. This mix of conditions encourages proliferation of a wide range of aquatic species, including fish;
- To allow, where appropriate, the regrading of banks to a lower and safer profile, in areas with public access;
- To prevent overshadowing of watercourses by buildings; and
- To reduce the risk of accidental pollution from run-off.

Policy LP52

Ecological Protection of Watercourses and Water Bodies

The Wakefield District Local Biodiversity Report identifies watercourses and water bodies as important ecological assets. Development on or adjacent to watercourses and water bodies will not be permitted unless it can clearly be demonstrated that there will be no significant harm to any ecological features. Where development is permitted proposals shall include:

- a. Environmentally sensitive engineering methods;
- b. Appropriate wetland features and landscaping; and
- c. Appropriate management schemes for the planning and use of areas of water; and
- d. Measures to minimise light spillage over the water body.

Wildlife Habitat Network

7.160 The Wildlife Habitat Network connects designated sites of ecological and geological conservation and habitats listed as Biodiversity Action Plan priorities such as watercourses, woodland, natural and semi-natural areas. The creation of the Wildlife Habitat Network is intended to prevent further fragmentation of ecological resources within the district. The network will allow migration, dispersal and genetic exchange of species in the wider environment, and includes links to adjoining districts. Within this network nature conservation interests will be protected and opportunities taken to restore and enhance existing habitats, create new priority habitats and manage the landscape to improve both biodiversity and landscape quality.

7.161 The Leeds City Region Green and Blue Infrastructure Strategy sets out new policy on green infrastructure which requires the provision, protection and enhancement of a network of green space in urban and rural areas that connects ecological, historic, cultural and landscape assets. The Wildlife Habitat Network will provide a major element of green infrastructure throughout Wakefield District.

7.162 The Wildlife Habitat Network will fulfil the following broad functions:

- Protect and enhance areas of wildlife and landscape value, including water, woodland, wetland areas and other priority habitats identified in the Wakefield Biodiversity Action Plan;
- Protect, enhance and develop linkages through the creation of new habitats;
- Connect habitats throughout Wakefield District and provide links to adjoining districts to allow migration, dispersal and genetic exchange of species;
- Increase the district's wildlife resources by preventing further fragmentation of habitats and encouraging appropriate management; and
- Enhance the district's landscape quality.

7.163 The Wildlife Habitat Network will not necessarily preclude development but will seek to ensure that it is carried out in a manner which consolidates the network and does not break its continuity. Where development proposals affect the Wildlife Habitat Network the Council may require an appropriate ecological assessment to be submitted prior to a planning application being determined. Where development is permitted the Council may use planning conditions and/or legal agreements to secure protection and enhancement of biodiversity and positive mitigation measures.

Policy LP53

Wildlife Habitat Network

Development that would adversely affect the integrity and value of the Wildlife Habitat Network across the district or the movement of flora and/or fauna species will only be permitted if it can be demonstrated that reasons of public interest for the development clearly outweigh any significant harm and a suitable compensation strategy exists. Proposals for development shall make provision for the retention of the network and protection of its wildlife links and ecological conservation value. Where development is permitted the Council will require developers to:

- a. Minimise disturbance;
- b. Protect and enhance the site's ecological conservation value;
- c. Contribute towards the objectives of the Wakefield District Biodiversity Action Plan;
- d. Ensure appropriate management; and
- e. Create new or replacement habitats and maintain links for the Wildlife Habitat Network with a minimum net gain of 10% of the current ecological value of the site calculated using the Defra Metric.

Protecting Trees and Woodland

7.164 Trees, woodland and hedgerows are a valuable part of the environment. They provide visual interest, amenity, shade and shelter. They are also a vital part of the ecological balance of the area. Trees can be important individually and within formal groups, copses and woodland. Only 3.8% of Wakefield District is covered with woodland compared to the national figure of 10.5%. Whilst recognising that the quality of Wakefield's woodland will vary, the very low total indicates that all woodland in the district is important for local biodiversity as set out in the Wakefield District Local Biodiversity Report. Priority will be given to the protection and enhancement of trees and woodland throughout the district. The Council will support the planting of new woodland in urban and rural areas where this is sympathetic to local topography, enhances ecology and contributes positively to landscape character. Newly established woodland should have a long term management plan which includes planting native ground flora species.

7.165 Planting woodland provides:

- Environmental benefits including flood risk reduction, carbon sequestration, cleaner air and water and enhanced biodiversity;
- More opportunities to connect green infrastructure within Wakefield District and across the district boundaries;
- More opportunities for recreation and relaxation; and
- New economic opportunities including tourism and wood products.

The Northern Forest

7.166 The Northern Forest is an initiative to improve the environment by creating new woodland, particularly along the M62 corridor linking West Yorkshire, Merseyside and Greater Manchester. It builds on the existing Community Forests partnerships of the White Rose Forest in West Yorkshire, Mersey Forest and Manchester City of Trees. The Leeds City Region Green and Blue Infrastructure Strategy sets a target for the White Rose Forest to increase the regions tree cover by a third by 2036. The 25 year plan to create the Northern Forest includes Wakefield Council, the other local authorities in the Leeds City Region and environmental bodies such as the Woodland Trust, working collectively

under the White Rose Forest joint venture agreement. In addition to planting more trees on Council owned and managed sites, the Council will encourage and support, and may require, woodland planting within regeneration and major development proposals throughout the district.

Ancient Woodland

7.167 Ancient woodland is defined as an area that has been wooded continuously since 1600 AD. It is sub-divided into ancient semi-natural woodland and plantations on ancient woodland sites. Ancient woodland is particularly valuable for its biodiversity because of its longevity and is identified in the Wakefield District Biodiversity Action Plan. Once lost, ancient woodland cannot be recreated. Consequently, development which would destroy or damage areas of ancient woodland will not be permitted unless there are wholly exceptional reasons and a suitable compensation strategy, in accordance with national planning policy.

7.168 Natural England has developed an Ancient Woodland Inventory for England which is available as a national database and will be updated during the plan period. However only sites over 2 hectares are shown on this inventory. As any other ancient woodland becomes known this will also be protected. In Wakefield District all known ancient woodland has been designated for protection in the Local Plan regardless of its site area and is shown on the Policies Map. Developers are advised to consult the Council's Tree Officer prior to submitting any proposals which may affect any type of woodland.

Veteran Trees

7.169 A veteran tree can be defined as a tree that is of biological, cultural or aesthetic interest because of its age, size or condition, and cannot be readily replaced. Veteran trees are important for biological reasons, providing conditions that support a wide range of other plants and wildlife, many of which require the special environment created in an old tree.

7.170 They are also of historic interest, relics of former landscapes such as field boundaries, parkland or woodland and can provide information about management practices and past ways of life, for example coppice and pollards. They are also important for their aesthetic qualities within the landscape where they may be formally designed elements within parkland or semi natural features. Within Wakefield District modern farming practices and the development of land have led to a decline of veteran trees. It is therefore particularly important to protect those veteran trees which survive.

Tree Preservation Orders

7.171 Statutory protection is also given to trees through Tree Preservation Orders which the Council has powers to serve and enforce. Tree Preservation Orders are generally used to secure the retention of trees in urban areas which may be under threat from development.

7.172 The Council has a number of strategies aiming to provide protection and seek enhancement of trees and woodland, including the Wakefield District Local Biodiversity Report. The Council will also protect trees and promote planting through its Local Plan policies.

7.173 Where the Council considers that development might adversely affect trees or woodland it will require the applicant to submit an appropriate tree survey with the planning application. Where development is permitted damage shall be kept to a minimum and the Council will use planning conditions and/or legal agreements to:

- Ensure appropriate replacement trees are planted;

- Ensure appropriate maintenance/management is carried out; and
- Enhance the site's ecological and landscape value by planting native species unless site conditions make non-native species more suitable.

Policy LP54

Protection of Trees and Woodland

The district's woodland, hedgerows and trees are important ecological assets identified in the Wakefield District Local Biodiversity Report. Where the Council considers that trees or woodland may be affected by a development proposal, it will require an appropriate tree survey to be submitted with the planning application.

1. Development that would detrimentally affect or result in the loss of Ancient Woodland and veteran trees will be refused unless there are wholly exceptional reasons and a suitable compensation strategy, in accordance with national planning policy.
2. Development that would damage or result in the loss of trees, areas of woodland or hedgerows, will only be permitted if it can clearly be demonstrated that:
 - a. Development cannot reasonably be redesigned to retain trees and hedgerows or be located on an alternative site; and
 - b. The need for development clearly outweighs any harm to the ecological value and landscape quality of the area; and
 - c. There will be an overall net gain for biodiversity of at least 10%, including a positive contribution to the protection, creation and enhancement of habitat and species.
 - d. They do not contribute to the character of a Conservation Area or setting of a heritage asset.

Landscape Character

7.174 Landscape is a significant element of the district's identity. It provides a setting for day to day life and is essential for the health and well-being of the district's communities. High quality landscape contributes to the economy by attracting business and visitors. The landscape is often a source of enjoyment and inspiration. Proposals for development should not only respect local character, but should incorporate appropriate measures to preserve, enhance or improve the character of the locality.

7.175 Landscape Character Assessment tells us what makes a place distinctive. It is a tool for identifying the features that give a locality its 'sense of place' and pinpointing what makes it different from its neighbouring areas. It provides a framework for describing an area in a systematic way. It allows better judgements regarding development, by knowing what is present and what is distinctive. This information can be used to achieve high quality development that is not only in the right place, but also respects and enhances its surroundings. It can also inform land management decisions that will sustain the environment and help the economy.

7.176 The Landscape Character Assessment of Wakefield District is a background document to the Local Plan and will be used as the basis for determining the appropriateness of development proposals which might have an impact upon the landscape character of the district. It identifies six landscape character types, the Calder Valley, Went River Basin, Northern Coalfield, South East Coalfield, South West Coalfield and Limestone Escarpment. The Landscape Character Assessment can be used to help planning and development by:

- Informing policies in the Local Plan;
- Informing the siting and design of particular types of development, such as housing, minerals and business;

- Assessing land availability for a range of uses, including new development;
- Providing information for Environmental Assessments of plans, policies and individual development proposals, including Flood Risk Assessments; and
- Informing programmes for environmental enhancement, such as woodland expansion, or the regeneration of towns.

Policy LP55

Landscape Character

Landscape is an important and highly valued environmental resource within Wakefield District. Development within the countryside, on the edge of settlements or within areas of open urban green space shall contribute towards the protection, maintenance and enhancement of the character of the district's landscape, its biodiversity, and where appropriate, the recreational quality of the area. The Council may require an evaluation of the impact of development on the landscape to be submitted with development proposals. Impact upon the landscape will be assessed having regard to the extent to which development would:

- a. Adversely affect landscape elements which contribute to landscape character such as landform, field boundaries, or settlement patterns;
- b. Adversely affect vegetation and trees which are characteristic of that landscape type;
- c. Cause unacceptable visual intrusion; and
- d. Introduce or remove incongruous landscape elements.

Conserving and Enhancing the Built Environment

Design and Environmental Quality

7.177 Many of the settlements within Wakefield District have a distinct local character. For example in villages such as Woolley, Heath and Ackworth local stone is the dominant material. In the mining areas and towns such as Castleford, Pontefract and Normanton locally produced brick predominates with blue slate or stone flag roofs, although stone was still favoured for some civic buildings. The rich variety of architectural and historic features in the district needs to be protected and enhanced for future generations. In areas with strong local architectural styles the character and local distinctiveness of the area should be respected so that it is maintained and where appropriate, enhanced. Alterations to existing buildings and new development should be designed to complement the local distinctiveness of an area and make a positive contribution to the quality of the environment.

7.178 The National Planning Policy Framework and National Planning Practice Guidance on Design: Process and Tools provides more information on how design quality should be considered throughout the evolution and assessment of individual proposals and the importance of engaging the community. Area-based character assessments, design guides and codes, and masterplanning can help demonstrate compliance with Policy LP56.

7.179 National planning policy requires development that is not well designed to be refused especially where it fails to reflect local and national design policies. Where local design guidance is absent, local planning authorities will be expected to defer to the illustrated National Design Guide and National Model Design Code. The National Design Guide sets out how well-designed places that are beautiful, enduring and successful can be achieved in practice. The National Model Design Code sets a baseline standard of quality and practice across England which local planning authorities will be expected to take into account when developing local design codes and guides and when determining planning applications.

7.180 Further policy and advice about design is set out in the Supplementary Planning Documents Wakefield District Residential Design Guide 2018 and Wakefield City Centre Urban Design Framework 2017. The use of established recognisable assessments, such as BREEAM or Building with Nature, are also encouraged.

7.181 These national and local documents will all help development of new residential areas to interface positively with surrounding streets and existing development and, where possible, avoid:

- The development of large residential enclaves with a single point of access and no through routes or an excessive proportion of properties access off cul-de-sac streets;
- New housing presenting its back (or poorly fenestrated side elevations) to adjacent streets;
- Unattractive defensible perimeter fencing running alongside streets or large acoustic barrier fencing placed in locations which compromise the design quality of the development;
- An approach to parking which compromises design quality and is likely to lead to the creation of streets which are not pleasant environments for pedestrians and cyclists;
- Developments which do not provide high quality cycle and footpath connections or will not allow new residents to access existing and proposed amenities and services via good quality direct cycling and walking routes;
- Developments which result in ill-defined spaces being created which are not within a residential curtilage and do not fulfil a clear recreational function; and
- Landscaping designs which are likely to lead to future management and maintenance problems, including overgrown hedges and shrubberies in prominent locations.

7.182 These measures support the design of places according with Active Design principles and Streets for People principles, as required by policy LP56. The Development Principles section (Chapter 5 of the plan) sets out the Active Design and Streets for People principles, that should be incorporated in policies, masterplans and development proposals, to deliver sustainable, well-designed, high quality places.

Biodiversity Net Gain

7.183 National planning policy requires planning applications to incorporate biodiversity improvements in and around developments, especially where this can secure measurable net gains in biodiversity. The Environment Act introduces a legal requirement for development to achieve 10% net gain in biodiversity. Local authorities can set their own requirements through local plans, so the Council is requiring a minimum 10% biodiversity net gain prior to the implementation of the Environment Act.

7.184 The only development to be exempt is permitted development and householder development. Habitats surveys are required in order to provide a baseline to inform whether proposed developments provide the 10% net gain in biodiversity. Defra has devised and tested a metric which will be applied when considering the baseline and post-development impacts of development proposals on biodiversity.

7.185 Biodiversity net gain will be delivered on-site, off-site or, with the agreement of the planning authority, by paying for biodiversity units. The Wakefield Residential Design Guide for Housebuilders provides some suggestions for providing net gains for biodiversity, which is applicable to any development. Local Nature Recovery Strategies will guide opportunities for recovering or enhancing biodiversity. The Council has further guidance for householders and developers in relation to biodiversity net gain.

Policy LP56

Design of New Development

Design will be a key consideration when assessing proposals of all scales and types. Innovation, distinctiveness and creativity will be encouraged to ensure the delivery of high quality and sustainable development. The diverse range of settlements in the district and their distinctive local characteristics shall be recognised when preparing proposals.

For residential development across the district (including Wakefield city centre) applicants shall refer to and utilise the guidance in the Residential Design Guide Supplementary Planning Document and any future updates to it.

For development proposals within Wakefield city centre applicants shall refer to and utilise the guidance in the Urban Design Framework Supplementary Planning Document and any future updates to it.

In order to maintain and enhance local diversity all new development shall make a positive contribution to the environment and amenity of its locality by virtue of high quality design, layout and landscaping. The Council will support the enhancement of public spaces, including provision of works of art in public places, and in appropriate cases this may be required as part of major development proposals. In particular proposals shall:

- a. Be designed to accord with Active Design principles and Streets for People principles as set out in Chapter 5 of the Plan;
- b. Use internal and external building design and orientation and signage in order to encourage physical activity within and to and from development;

- c. Respect, and where appropriate enhance the character, function and overall quality of the locality in terms of design, scale, massing, height, density, layout, materials and colour over the lifetime of the development;
- d. Provide a quality setting within the development incorporating, where appropriate, effective landscaping with a consideration for future management, maintenance and personal safety;
- e. Retain, and enhance important ecological and landscape features, including those provided to meet biodiversity net gain requirements;
- f. Provide a minimum net gain of 10% of the current ecological value of the site, except on householder proposals;
- g. Respect, and where appropriate enhance existing natural and built features, skyline, landmarks or key views that contribute to the character and local distinctiveness of the area;
- h. Incorporate high quality landscaping and boundary treatment while relating positively to surrounding streets, services and amenities;
- i. Prioritise access arrangements and facilities for pedestrians and cyclists over vehicles, and facilitate direct walking and cycling connections to surrounding streets, services and amenities outside the site;
- j. Incorporate arrangements for servicing, waste handling, recycling and storage. All schemes that will generate additional waste should incorporate convenient and discrete accommodation for waste storage;
- k. Incorporate sensitive treatment of ancillary development such as parking and service areas and provide satisfactory screening where appropriate;
- l. Incorporate sensitive treatment of wiring, cabling and pipelines either by laying underground or providing adequate screening or landscaping;
- m. Allow for flexibility to adapt non-residential development to alternative uses to meet changing needs and circumstances over the lifetime of the development;
- n. Have no significant detrimental impact on the amenity of neighbouring users or residents and existing or prospective users;
- o. Allow easy access for all members of the community such as disabled people, elderly people and people with pushchairs or young children;
- p. Allow the opportunity for access to adjoining undeveloped land so it may subsequently be developed;
- q. Ensure open space and recreational facilities provided in new residential developments are well designed, using high quality materials. These areas shall be accessible to the whole development, with suitable pedestrian linkages to the rest of the scheme and the surrounding area and have adequate overlooking by adjacent homes; and
- r. New streets are to be tree-lined unless, in specific cases, there are clear, justifiable and compelling reasons why this would be inappropriate.

Where specified in Volume 2, a masterplan will be required to include evidence that the criteria set out in this policy have been considered. For proposals which come forward where a masterplan has not been specified in Volume 2 or for non-allocated sites, a requirement for the site to be masterplanned will be assessed on a case by case basis. Masterplans will demonstrate how the proposal adheres to the principles set out in the National Design Guide, National Model Design Code and any local design guides or codes.

7.186 Although extensions and alterations to dwellings are often small in scale, they can have a significant impact on amenity and the character of the area. Proposals for extensions and alterations to dwellings should respect the design features on the host building and the character of the surrounding area. Some minor extensions or alterations to dwellings will fall into the category of permitted development. Where planning consent is required, the Council will oppose proposals which would have a detrimental impact on the amenity of occupiers or users of neighbouring buildings. Further policy

and advice is set out in the Wakefield District Residential Design Guide 2018. Householders also have an opportunity to increase biodiversity net gain through such measures as bat or bird boxes, swift bricks and fences with pre-cut holes for hedgehogs or appropriate native planting.

Policy LP57

Extensions and Alterations to Dwellings

Throughout the district's settlements are a diverse range of residential neighbourhoods, many of which have distinctive local characteristics which shall be maintained or enhanced. Extensions and alterations to dwellings shall respect residential amenity, the character and scale of the dwelling, and its location. Development will only be permitted if it would not:

- a. Be overbearing or reduce the space about the dwelling resulting in significant harm to residential amenity or character of the area;
- b. Significantly reduce the privacy of occupants of the dwelling or neighbouring properties;
- c. Significantly overshadow neighbouring dwellings resulting in harm to the amenity of occupants of the dwelling or neighbouring properties;
- d. Be discordant with the style of the original dwelling or result in harm to the character of the area.

Waterfront Design

7.187 The Aire and Calder Rivers are important elements in the district's landscape, and flow through the urban areas of the Five Towns and Wakefield. Development along these waterfronts offers unique opportunities to enhance the character of the townscape, improve public access and provide recreation, and enhance biodiversity. Other watercourses and bodies of water also have significant value for amenity, recreation and biodiversity within the district such as the River Went, Calder and Hebble Navigation, Barnsley Canal, Winterset Reservoir and Anglers and Pugneys lakes. The Council will require that development respects and enhances these valuable assets. Developers should also refer to the flood risk and nature conservation policies sections of this document when considering development which affects watercourses and other water bodies.

Policy LP58

Waterfront Design

Development adjacent to the River Aire, River Calder, the district's canals and other bodies of water shall be orientated to face the watercourse or water body and must be designed to enhance the water's edge and biodiversity. The Council will require that public access and recreational opportunities are provided where compatible with the proposed development and the capacity of the site to accommodate them. In particular development along rivers and canals shall:

- a. Conserve any heritage assets, reinforce, and where appropriate enhance, the distinct waterside character of the area;
- b. Improve the visual and physical relationship between the development site, the waterway and any adjoining public areas;
- c. Improve access along and across the river or canal corridor where appropriate;
- d. Be orientated and designed to promote surveillance of the river or canal frontage;
- e. Enhance the public amenity value of the waterway;
- f. Enhance important views outward from the river or canal corridor; and
- g. Enhance recreational opportunities of the waterway, where appropriate.

Landscape Design

- 7.188** Landscaping forms an essential part of the quality of the environment and contributes to the character and identity of local areas. It can also contribute to the successful functioning of areas used by the public and offer opportunities for recreation. The design of landscaping should be an integral part of proposals for development and not treated as an afterthought. Landscaping schemes should be of a quality and type that is appropriate to the development and in keeping with the landscape characteristics of the site and its setting.
- 7.189** Landscaping schemes should include details of existing landscape elements such as trees, water bodies and landform and should indicate which elements will be retained and which will be altered or removed. The Landscape Character Assessment identifies landscape character types which tell us what makes a place distinctive. The Wakefield Historic Landscape Character Assessment held by West Yorkshire Archaeology Advisory Service identifies surviving elements of the district's historic character. Landscaping schemes should also set out the treatment and location of hard and soft landscaping with full details of materials and species. Materials used for hard surfaces should respect local character and complement local materials, for example stone paving flags and setts are commonly used within the district. Planting schemes should use species suitable for the location taking future maintenance and management into consideration. In larger schemes landscaping should be designed to contribute to enhancing biodiversity using native species wherever practical.
- 7.190** The Council will promote and require high quality landscape design for all development throughout the district. Planning applications should be accompanied by sufficient supporting information to demonstrate how landscape considerations have been addressed. Applications for full planning permission shall include a detailed landscape scheme together with details of the protection of existing wildlife habitats and the creation of new habitats where this is appropriate to the development. The Council may use planning conditions and/or legal agreements to ensure that development includes good quality landscape design which protects or enhances the character of the district's settlements and landscape and ensures that schemes are adequately managed and maintained.

Policy LP59

Landscape Design

Landscape is an important and highly valued environmental resource within Wakefield District. New development shall be designed so that important existing landscaping features such as water bodies, trees, hedgerows, stone walls and other elements identified in the Landscape Character Assessment together with any new features are incorporated as an integral part of the proposal. In particular development proposals shall:

- a. Conserve and integrate existing natural and historic features;
- b. Use new landscape features such as planting, shelter belts, and green spaces to integrate development with the wider landscape;
- c. Integrate new and existing development at the boundaries of the site through the continuity of landscape;
- d. Create areas of valuable habitat for wildlife by additional planting of native species rather than by using purely decorative planting; and
- e. Where appropriate allow public access and/or provide opportunities for recreation.

Safety and Security Through Design

- 7.191** Safety and tackling fear of crime is an important issue in Wakefield District. Improving safety and security is a key objective of the Community Strategy. Crime and the fear of crime affects the way people use and enjoy the places they live and work in, and the areas they use for recreation. The

careful consideration of the design, layout, lighting and landscaping of new development can reduce opportunities for crime, deter anti-social behaviour and cut the fear of crime. Proposals for development should incorporate the principles of 'Secured by Design' which is a national police scheme which aims to minimise and reduce the opportunities for crime through employing more security conscious building design methods. Developers are advised to seek the advice of the Police Architectural Liaison Officer at the pre-application planning stage. Further policy and advice is set out in the Wakefield District Residential Design Guide 2018.

Policy LP60

Safety and Security Through Design

Development proposals shall be designed to ensure a safe and secure environment that reduces the opportunities for crime. Development will be permitted where the following have been taken into account:

- a. The use and creation of defensible space;
- b. The creation of opportunities for natural surveillance;
- c. The location and design of lighting;
- d. The location, number and design of footpaths and access points;
- e. The location and design of parking facilities; and
- f. The design of landscaping, in particular maximising opportunities for surveillance to avoid creating hiding places and secluded areas.

Advertisements and Shopfront Design

7.192 Shopfronts, signs and advertisements are an important element in the character and appearance of our town centres. In Wakefield District centres such as Wakefield, Pontefract, Castleford and Normanton still retain many original traditional shopfronts. These make a significant contribution to the distinct local identities of town centres and the Council is keen to preserve this. Traditional shopfronts are increasingly under threat as shops are enlarged, frontages are replaced and modern illuminated signs installed.

7.193 The design of shopfronts and advertisements should respect the architectural style of the host building and the local character of the area. Good innovative designs which would make a positive contribution to the vitality of a centre will be supported, but they must not detract from the quality of the host building or adjacent premises. Shopfronts, signs and advertisements in Conservation Areas or affecting Listed Buildings will be expected to retain and enhance the character of the building, its special historic or architectural elements, and the appearance of the surrounding area. Internally illuminated box signs and neon strip lighting for example, will not be acceptable unless it is compliant with the policy.

Policy LP61

Advertisements and Shopfront Design

Shopfronts, signs and advertisements make a significant contribution to the character and local identity of the district's town centres.

1. The development of new or replacement shopfront units and display of advertisements will only be permitted if they satisfy the following criteria:
 - a. The design is consistent with the character of the existing building in terms of scale, quality and use of materials;
 - b. Proposals respect the character of the locality and any features of scenic, historic, architectural, cultural or other special interest;
 - c. The shop fascia is designed to be in scale, in its depth and width, with the façade and street scene of which it forms part.
2. Proposals for the alteration of existing shopfronts or installation of new shopfronts and display of advertisements on a Listed Building or within a Conservation Area shall preserve and enhance the character and appearance of the building, the area in which it is located and any features of architectural or historical interest. Existing traditional shopfronts shall be retained and restored unless exceptional circumstances apply. Proposals for new shopfronts and advertisements must be of a high standard of design and be appropriate in style, scale and materials to the building and its setting.

Green Belt

Existing Uses in the Green Belt

7.194 Policy SP22 provides the strategic context for Green Belts in the Local Plan. Green Belt policy applies to new buildings, the change of use of buildings and land, and to re-building and redevelopment proposals. Exceptions to this policy will not be justified merely because land is underused, degraded or derelict. Such land will normally be capable of reclamation or re-use for a compatible Green Belt purpose. Even where a Green Belt location is suited in principle to a particular use, it is essential that its openness and character is not adversely affected by development that is out of scale or character by virtue of its visual impact or intensity of use.

Policy LP62

Existing Uses in the Green Belt

Within Wakefield District a number of residential, industrial, educational and community uses are located in the Green Belt that provide local accommodation, employment opportunities or important community facilities. In order to allow for their continued use, limited, small-scale development will be permitted providing the following criteria are met:

1. Proposals for redeveloping existing uses within the Green Belt will only be permitted if very special circumstances can be demonstrated or the proposal meets the criteria set out in national planning policy.
2. Extensions and/or free standing buildings within an existing developed site and extensions and/or alterations to existing dwellings may be appropriate where:
 - a. Extensions and alterations are not disproportionate over and above the size of the existing building(s) when originally constructed;
 - b. Replacement buildings remain in the same use and are not materially larger than the one(s) replaced;
 - c. The scale, materials and general design are in keeping with the character of the buildings and their surroundings; and
 - d. Limited infilling or redevelopment on previously developed land does not have a greater impact on the openness of the Green Belt than the existing development.

Conserving and Enhancing the Historic Environment

7.195 Policy SP23 provides the strategic context for considerations of Design, Safety and the Local Environment in the Local Plan. The historic environment is an important cultural asset and driver for economic growth, which informs the district's identity, helps build social cohesion and provides a better quality of life for all, thereby contributing to the achievement of successful sustainable communities. The historic environment is an irreplaceable finite resource which should be conserved in a manner appropriate to its significance, so it can be enjoyed by the community for future generations.

7.196 The term historic environment includes the following heritage assets in Wakefield District:

- Scheduled Monuments, archaeological sites and landscapes;
- Listed Buildings and Conservation Areas;
- Registered Parks & Gardens;
- Non-designated heritage assets, including those on the Council's list of Buildings of Local Interest, the Council's Local Heritage List or adopted through neighbourhood plans, the site of the Battle of Wakefield and the Historic Landscape of Heath; and
- Historic statues, plaques, memorials or monuments (whether listed or not).

7.197 National planning policy requires that where proposed development may affect heritage assets the developer must submit a suitable assessment which describes the significance of any heritage assets affected, including the contribution made by their setting. The level of detail should be proportionate to the importance of the heritage asset and be sufficient to understand the potential impact of the proposal on its significance.

7.198 The Historic Environment Record (HER) and West Yorkshire Historic Landscape Characterisation are kept and managed by West Yorkshire Archaeology Advisory Service who are the Council's retained professional advisors on all aspects of the historic environment. The Historic Environment Record is a publicly accessible record of West Yorkshire's historic environment and contains information on all known archaeological sites, historic buildings, find-spots and historic landscapes. The detailed Historic Landscape Character Assessment of Wakefield District shows the extent to which the visible character of the past survives in the present anywhere in Wakefield. Both are available to inform the impact of proposals on heritage assets, guide appropriate design and inform planning. Developers should consult the West Yorkshire Historic Environment Record at the early stages of drawing up proposals for development, to understand any potential impact of the development on the historic environment and how this might be suitably mitigated.

7.199 When determining planning applications the Council will take account of:

- The desirability of sustaining and enhancing the significance of heritage assets and putting them to viable uses consistent with their conservation;
- The positive contribution that conservation of heritage assets can make to sustainable communities including their economic viability; and
- The desirability of new development making a positive contribution to local character and distinctiveness.

7.200 National planning policy states that where there is evidence of deliberate neglect of, or damage to a heritage asset, the deteriorated state should not be taken into account in any decision. The Council holds a list of Heritage Buildings at Risk and work alongside Historic England in relation to buildings identified on the National Heritage at Risk Register.

Policy LP63

Conserving the Historic Environment

The District's heritage assets will be conserved in a manner appropriate to their significance.

Developments which will help in the management, conservation, understanding and enjoyment of the District's historic environment, especially for those assets which are at risk, will be encouraged.

Particular attention will be paid to the conservation of those elements which contribute most to Wakefield's distinctive character and sense of place. These include:

- The area's medieval heritage including the fine motte-and-bailey castles at Pontefract and Sandal, and the range of other medieval sites found throughout the District.
 - The archaeological landscapes of the Southern Magnesian Limestone Ridge.
 - Castleford's important Roman heritage.
 - The impressive legacy of Georgian and Victorian architecture and townscape from Wakefield's historical role as County Town of the West Riding especially its distinctive silhouette of spires and towers - a key feature of the distinctive character of the City.
 - The tight knit urban fabric of Pontefract including its medieval street pattern, historic buildings, burgage plots and yards, and the views towards and from the Castle.
 - The legacy of the District's mining industry including the extensive remains of early activity (such as the iron stone pits at Bentley and the wooden headstock of Caphouse Colliery), the planned mining villages, and the associated public buildings and parks.
 - The buildings, bridges, locks and other structures associated with the Aire and Calder Canal.
 - The Grade I Listed Chapel of St Mary on Wakefield Bridge is one of only four (and the best preserved) Bridge Chapel in the country.
 - The distinct Conservation Area of the historic village of Heath with its combination of Common Land, surrounding open fields, and collection of significant 16th to 19th Century buildings.
 - Other locally listed assets, including the Battle site of Wakefield and Buildings of Local Interest because of their local significance in terms of their historical, archaeological, architectural or artistic interest.
1. Proposals shall retain those elements of the historic environment which contribute to the distinct identity of the District and its settlements, and ensure that they are conserved in a manner warranted by their significance, including:
 - a. Open spaces, views, landmarks and landscape that contribute to their character, appearance or setting;
 - b. The character of any buildings or structures having regard to local scale, proportion, details and materials;
 - c. The preservation of features of architectural, archaeological, artistic and historic interest.
 2. The Council will require that plans for development clearly illustrate the impact of the proposal on any features of architectural, archaeological, artistic and historic interest of the area. Such applications must also be supported with full details of the proposal.
 3. A heritage statement or impact assessment will be required to be submitted to accompany planning and listed building applications for development likely to affect heritage assets dependent upon the scale of development and level of harm to the significance of heritage assets. Applicants will be required to record the significance of any heritage assets affected, in a manner appropriate to their importance, with adequate assessment of the nature, extent and significance of the remains present and the degree to which the proposed development is likely to affect them and mitigation measures required should be submitted for consideration. This evidence and any archive generated shall be made publicly accessible.
 4. Where permission is granted for a development which would result in the total or partial loss of a heritage asset, either designated or non-designated, planning permission will be conditional

upon the asset being fully recorded and the record and commentary deposited with Wakefield Council and the Historic Environment Record.

Designated Heritage Assets

7.201 Great weight should be given to the conservation of a designated heritage asset when considering the impact of development proposals on its significance. This is irrespective of whether any potential harm amounts to substantial harm, total loss or less than substantial harm to its significance. Any harm to, or loss of, the significance of a designated heritage asset requires clear and convincing justification, whether this is from its alteration or destruction, or from development within its setting.

Registered Parks & Gardens

7.202 Within the district there are Registered Parks and Gardens of Special Historic Interest which are protected due to their designed landscape's special character. These are shown on the Policies Map. Appropriate assessments may be required to include a landscape and visual impact assessment to assess the impacts of development on key views and vistas, as well as a heritage statement or heritage impact assessment.

Conservation Areas

7.203 The Council is required to have special regard to the preservation and enhancement of the character or appearance of Conservation Areas. These are shown on the Policies Map. The demolition of buildings and works to trees require consent of the Council. The Council will exercise strict control over the siting and design of new development within Conservation Areas. Permitted development rights are more restricted, and the Council may declare an Article 4 Direction to remove permitted development rights in order to avoid piecemeal alterations which might detract from the character or appearance of an area. Proposals for development affecting Conservation Areas will be assessed in accordance with national planning policy. Planning applications will be expected to be submitted with full details to enable an assessment of the impact of the proposed development on the Conservation Area to be made.

7.204 The preservation or enhancement of the special character or appearance of Conservation Areas and their settings will be secured by:

- A programme of Conservation Area Appraisals and management schemes to manage change;
- A presumption in favour of the preservation of buildings and structures, both Listed and unlisted, identified as making a positive contribution to the special character or appearance of that Conservation Area;
- Ensuring that development within or which would affect the setting of a Conservation Area will not have an adverse impact on its special character or appearance; and
- Safeguarding spaces, street patterns, views, vistas, uses and trees which contribute to the special character or appearance of that Conservation Area.

Listed Buildings

7.205 It is a criminal offence to alter a Listed Building in any way which affects its character except in accordance with Listed Building Consent. The Council is required to have special regard to the preservation of Listed Buildings and their settings. Development including extensions, alterations, and changes of use of a Listed Building will only be permitted where there is no adverse impact on its special features of architectural or historic interest, such as original external and internal details. There is a presumption against demolition unless exceptional circumstances of overriding public interest can be demonstrated. Proposals for development affecting Listed Buildings will be assessed

in accordance with national planning policy. Planning applications will be expected to be submitted with full details to enable an assessment of the impact of the proposed development on the Listed Building to be made.

7.206 The conservation of buildings and structures of special architectural or historic interest and their settings will be secured by:

- Having special regard to the desirability of preserving the building or its setting or any features of special architectural or historic interest which it possesses when determining planning applications;
- Ensuring that proposed alterations, extensions or changes of use to Listed Buildings and Buildings of Local Interest, or development within their vicinity, will not have an adverse impact on the special architectural or historic interest of such buildings and their settings within the remits of national and local policy; and
- Taking measures to ensure that neglected Listed Buildings and locally listed assets are appropriately repaired and re-used.

Policy LP64

Designated Heritage Assets

Development proposals affecting a designated heritage asset, including its setting, shall conserve or enhance the significance of the asset.

1. Any harm to, or loss of, the significance of a designated heritage asset will require clear and convincing justification.
2. Where proposals are likely to cause substantial harm or loss, development will not be permitted unless it can be demonstrated that the proposal is necessary to achieve substantial public benefits that clearly outweigh any harm, or all of the following apply:
 - a. The nature of the heritage asset prevents all reasonable uses of the site; and
 - b. No viable use of the heritage asset itself can be found in the medium term through appropriate marketing that will enable its conservation; and
 - c. Conservation by grant funding or some form of not for profit, charitable or public ownership is demonstrably not possible; and
 - d. The harm or loss is outweighed by the benefit of bringing the site back into use.
3. Where a development proposal will lead to less than substantial harm to the significance of a designated heritage asset, any harm will be weighed against the public benefits of the proposal including, where appropriate, securing its optimum viable use.

Non-designated Heritage Assets

7.207 National planning policy requires that the effect of development proposals on the significance of non-designated heritage assets will be taken into account when determining planning applications. In assessing applications, a balanced judgement shall have regard to the scale of any harm and the significance of the heritage asset. The consideration of the level of the significance of the asset should take account of the thematic or historic values unique to the Wakefield district, as set out in policy LP63. Planning applications will be expected to be submitted with full details to enable an assessment of the impact of the proposed development on non-designated heritage assets to be made. The Council also supports measures which ensure that non-designated heritage assets are appropriately repaired and re-used.

7.208 Within the district are buildings which are not on the statutory list of Listed Buildings and may not be in Conservation Areas, but are of local significance and need to be identified as such and protected because of their local interest. The Council already maintains a list of Buildings of Local Interest, which includes buildings of local community interest, individual buildings or groups of buildings that contribute to the character or identity of an area, and buildings which are examples of important work by local architects or builders.

7.209 West Yorkshire has Government funding to develop a county-wide approach to developing or improving local heritage lists. Local lists can cover all types of non-designated heritage assets (buildings, monuments, sites, places, areas or landscapes which have been identified as having a degree of significance meriting consideration in planning decisions, because of their heritage interest), but must include buildings. The local community will be involved in the definition of criteria and the identification of assets for inclusion on the local list. Once complete, the local list will be available via the Council's website and the local Historic Environment Record, and will be updated as new non-designated heritage assets which are not on a "list" per se are identified, including the decision-making process on planning applications and during the preparation of neighbourhood plans.

7.210 The Council has also designated the historic site of the Battle of Wakefield and the Historic Landscape of Heath for protection under this policy. These are shown on the Policies Map. Where development proposals affect sites within historic locations, an archaeological assessment will be required to be submitted as part of the planning application. Planning permission will not be granted without adequate assessment of the impact which the proposed development is likely to have on any historic or archaeological features or their aesthetic value. Where development is acceptable, planning conditions and/or legal agreements may be attached requiring the appropriate archaeological recording of the site before development commences.

Policy LP65

Non-designated Heritage Assets

New development shall preserve, protect or where possible enhance and better reveal the significance of non-designated heritage assets including locally listed assets.

Proposals which would directly or indirectly remove, harm or undermine the significance of a non-designated heritage asset or its setting will be permitted only where the public benefits are considered sufficient to outweigh the harm.

Locally listed non-designated assets have a degree of archaeological, architectural, artistic or historic significance which affords them material weight in any planning decisions. The significance of any previously unconsidered assets will be assessed against the same local listing criteria.

Consideration will be given to the impact on:

- a. any features of special architectural or historic interest; and
- b. the character, appearance and setting of the building, structure or remains.

Archaeology

7.211 There are a number of Scheduled Monuments and other unique archaeological assets within Wakefield District. New development has also led to the discovery and excavation of remains of national, regional and local importance. Archaeological sites designated for special protection will be identified as follows and Class I and Class II sites are shown on the Policies Map:

- Scheduled Monuments (Class I sites).

- Areas of Special Archaeological Value (Class II sites) which are registered in the West Yorkshire Historic Environment Record where evidence exists to indicate the presence or strong probability of remains of regional archaeological importance that are likely to be worthy of preservation in situ.
- Areas of Archaeological Value (Class III sites) which are registered in the West Yorkshire Historic Environment Record where evidence exists to indicate the presence or probability of remains of archaeological or historic importance not defined above. This category includes unlisted buildings of archaeological or historic interest.

Policy LP66

Development Affecting Archaeological Sites

New development shall preserve, protect or where possible enhance the District's archaeological heritage.

1. Where development proposals affect sites of known or potential archaeological interest, an appropriate archaeological assessment and evaluation will be required to be submitted as part of the planning application. Planning permission will not be granted without adequate assessment of the nature, extent and significance of the remains present and the degree to which the proposed development is likely to cause harm to their significance.
2. Development that would harm the significance of a Scheduled Monument (Class I), or other non-designated archaeological sites (Class II and Class III) found to be of demonstrably equivalent significance to Scheduled Monuments, will be considered subject to the policies for Designated Heritage Assets (LP64).
3. Proposals that relate to Class II and III archaeological sites will only be permitted where:
 - a. The archaeological remains will be preserved in situ through careful design, layout and siting of the proposed development; or
 - b. When in-situ preservation is not justified or feasible, appropriate provision is made by the developer for excavation and recording before and/or during development and for the post-excavation analysis, publication, and archive deposition of any findings.

Environmental Protection

7.212 Policy SP23 provides the strategic context for considerations of Design, Safety and the Local Environment in the Local Plan. Pollution causes adverse health risks, damages the environment and amenity. It can detrimentally affect neighbouring land uses, cause long term contamination and hinder urban regeneration. Control of pollution involves several agencies, national regulation and Council powers. The duty for control of pollution lies with the Council's Environmental Health Service and with the Environment Agency providing a regulatory and advisory role.

7.213 Development has the potential to harm the environment in a variety of ways, including the emission of pollutants to the air, water courses and soils. The Council will consider the possible polluting effects of a development proposal on aspects such as amenity and surrounding land uses. These considerations will be complemented by legislation outside the planning process, such as the Pollution Prevention and Control Regulations.

Water Quality

7.214 Safeguarding water supplies and their quality now and for the future is essential. It is a legal duty not to cause or allow water pollution. The Environment Agency has powers to control discharges into watercourses and to prevent pollution. Proposals likely to have an impact on water quality will receive careful consideration by the Council in consultation with the Environment Agency. Where development proposals have the potential to result in pollution of the environment, including at the demolition or construction phase, the Council will expect details of appropriate mitigation measures to be submitted with the planning application.

7.215 The Water Framework Directive aims for all waterbodies to achieve 'good status' or 'good ecological potential' by 2027 and to prevent the deterioration in their current status. The Humber River Basin Management Plan sets out the current status of the waterbodies, identifies the significant water management issues and sets out the actions needed to meet the objectives under the Water Framework Directive. The status is determined by an assessment of chemical, physical and biological parameters and ranges from bad through poor moderate, and good to high. There is still a large proportion of water bodies not achieving the Water Framework Directive target. Where a development or activity has been established as having the potential to be in breach of the Directive, applicants must show that the planned activity will not be in contravention of the legislation, i.e. that it will not cause deterioration of any waterbody or prevent the achievement of good ecological status/potential.

Surface Water Management - Construction

7.216 The Environment Agency advise that developers should consider both prior to and during construction:

- Pollution prevention, in particular, management of site water should be considered before development commences and appropriate design, mitigation, phasing and permits should be in place well in advance of construction.
- Phased soil stripping and retention of grassed areas and buffer strips; it is common for the whole development area to be stripped of topsoil at the outset of the development, leaving huge areas of exposed ground, which can generate significant amounts of sediment-contaminated water. Developers should consider minimising the areas of soil strip at any one time and work in a phased manner.
- Understanding the site topography and geography, and designing appropriate water management strategies: Relatively simple calculations can be made of the likely runoff from the site and the scale of any necessary mitigation measures such as settlement lagoons or tanks. Experience has showed that developers seriously underestimate the volume of water

to be treated and the level of treatment required. Retrofitting such treatment into an existing development can be extremely difficult and expensive.

- Keeping clean water clean: Identifying areas of clean water ingress to the site such as runoff from adjacent land, land drains, groundwater etc. and intercepting these to divert flows away from working areas.
- Understanding the nature of the sediment runoff: Clay solids, if present may be very difficult to settle, resulting in the need for large settlement areas or chemical treatment.
- Education of site managers, staff and contractors: Many incidents result from pumping or discharging contaminated water from excavations without any form of treatment. Site staff need to be aware of the pollution potential and if necessary “permit to work” type arrangement put in place for pumping activities.

Noise Pollution

7.217 When considering a proposal for development the presence of noise generating uses close to the site, and the potential noise generated by the proposal will be taken into account. Some uses are particularly sensitive to noise. Examples include housing, educational establishments, care establishments such as hospitals and nursing homes, public buildings such as libraries and museums, and offices. Planning conditions and/or legal agreements may be used to control the impact of noise in relation to the proposed development or to the benefit of the wider community.

7.218 Highways, railways and aircraft are a major source of noise nuisance. Noise generated may vary at different times, and there are maximum levels set out in government regulations that are considered to be reasonable. Measures can sometimes be incorporated into development to reduce noise to acceptable limits. Buildings can be sited away from the noise and constructed with materials that reduce noise. External recreation areas and gardens can be sited away from highways, and protected by planting, mounding or fencing. Where a development proposal is acceptable in principle, and appropriate noise reduction measures are incorporated to achieve an acceptable degree of amenity for occupiers, permission may be granted. However, sites that are adjacent to existing noisy transport uses will generally not be acceptable for noise sensitive development.

7.219 Proposals for industrial development or other uses which have implications for generating noise will be assessed on their circumstances. Locational characteristics will be taken into account and consideration given to appropriate noise reduction. The applicant will be required to demonstrate that the development is constructed to a standard and/or incorporates noise reduction measures which will ensure that the resulting noise levels at specified locations will not exceed acceptable maximum levels.

Air Quality

7.220 The Environment Act 2021 strengthens the air quality management framework on air quality for local action and collaboration. In Wakefield District there are Air Quality Management Areas, as of 2023, along the M1 and A1M corridors and within Wakefield, Castleford, Pontefract, Featherstone, Knottingley and Hemsworth. These are largely due to pollution caused by road traffic. The Council is concerned to ensure that all new development, particularly commercial, industrial and traffic generating uses, does not result in an unacceptable level of air pollution to the detriment of public health and other land uses. Developers will be expected to take proper account of air quality issues when drawing up their proposals. Within Air Quality Management Areas an air quality assessment will be required to be submitted with proposals for development. In addition, proposals for new development will be required to contribute to air quality improvement measures. Development outside Air Quality Management Areas may also require an air quality assessment. Developers will be expected to provide mitigation measures which accord with the Council's Air Quality Action Plan and the West Yorkshire Low Emissions Strategy, and associated planning technical guidance.

Light Pollution

7.221 Floodlighting and other forms of artificial lighting are often a key component of security, safety and design. Illuminated advertising, external lighting and security floodlights can however also cause significant amenity problems. Poorly situated or badly designed lighting can have an adverse impact on residential amenity, the sky at night and wildlife such as birds. In Wakefield District there is significant public concern about this issue. In order to balance the requirements for security whilst protecting amenity and the environment generally, the Council will require that proposals for development include adequate information about floodlighting and other external lighting. Planning conditions and/or legal agreements may be used to control the effects of external lighting that are particular to the proposed development or to the benefit of the wider community. National planning practice guidance on Light Pollution points to available information which could inform approaches to lighting and help reduce light pollution. Further advice is available from the Defra and Natural England websites on handling the impact on wildlife, including from artificial light, where protected sites or protected species could be affected.

Policy LP67

Pollution Control

Within the district there is a legacy of activities such as mining, quarrying, heavy industrial processes and chemical works which have resulted in the degradation of environmental quality in the past and have potential to cause further pollution or damage to amenity. Air pollution from road traffic is also an increasing problem. In order to protect public health and the environment, and to encourage regeneration, the Council will require that:

1. Development proposals which are likely to cause pollution or are likely to be exposed to potential sources of pollution will only be permitted if it can be demonstrated that measures can be implemented to minimise emissions to a satisfactory level that protects health, environmental quality and amenity. In determining proposals particular consideration will be given to:
 - a. The likelihood of emissions which may have an unacceptable effect on the amenity of the local area;
 - b. Where there is an identified risk that public health may be affected;
 - c. Where there is a possibility that any proposed development will lead to a breach of national air quality objectives or lead to a deterioration of local air quality;
 - d. There would be no adverse impact on water bodies and groundwater resources, in terms of their quantity, quality, the important ecological features that they support and their current status or ability to achieve “good” status or potential under the Water Framework Directive;
 - e. An appropriate impact assessment is submitted with the planning application; and
 - f. Approved mitigation measures are carried out prior to occupation or operation of the development commencing.
2. Where the Council considers that an Air Quality Management Area may be affected by development, it will require the proposal to be consistent with the aims and objectives of the Council's Air Quality Action Plan.
3. Development proposals that include external artificial lighting which would cause unacceptable light pollution in the form of sky glow, glare or intrusion onto other property and land will only be permitted if the Council is satisfied that adequate and reasonable controls can be put in place to protect dwellings and other sensitive property, the rural night sky, observatories, road users, and designated sites for conservation of biodiversity or protected species from the intrusive effects of the light pollution.

7.222 Where hazardous processes are carried out the implications extend beyond the boundaries of the site. The release of toxic chemicals or effects of an explosion could be serious not only for those people working on the premises, but to the wider community living and working in the vicinity. The Health and Safety Executive has identified a number of Major Hazard Installation Consultation Zones in the district within which development proposals need to be assessed in terms of their location and proximity to hazardous operations. It will not be appropriate for new development to be permitted which could result in significant numbers of people living, working or congregating close to hazardous operations. Sensitive development such as housing, educational establishments, hospitals, places of worship and community facilities are generally considered to be incompatible with hazardous processes or activities. Development within Major Hazard Installation Consultation Zones will not normally be permitted if the Health and Safety Executive advise against its approval.

7.223 Some development within Major Hazard Installation Consultation Zones may be appropriate however, and in these circumstances the Council may use planning conditions and/or legal agreements to prevent or control risk to public safety. In the exceptional circumstances of a proposal for development making a significant contribution to the regeneration of a town centre or local community, the Council may determine that a level of risk is outweighed when all relevant planning considerations are taken into account.

Policy LP68

Protection from Hazardous Operations

There are a number of sites and pipelines within the district which are designated as dangerous substances establishments and major accident hazard pipelines by virtue of the quantities of hazardous substances present. Whilst they are subject to stringent controls under existing health and safety legislation, it is considered prudent to control the kinds of development permitted in the vicinity of these installations. Development proposals which involve either:

- a. Notifiable quantities of hazardous substances or which are in the vicinity of notified sites or other known hazards; or
- b. Sensitive development which is likely to be exposed to hazardous processes or other potentially hazardous activities will only be permitted if it can be demonstrated that measures can be implemented to protect public health and safety.

7.224 Redevelopment of previously developed land is an important element in the plan to achieve regeneration and sustainable development objectives and to improve the environment generally. Much has been done to improve environmental quality within the district such as restoration of collieries, decontamination and redevelopment of sites, however there are a few remaining areas where significant improvements are still required. The Council, under its obligations from Part 2A of the Environmental Protection Act 1990, has since 2003 published a Land Quality Inspection Strategy which has identified potentially contaminated sites across the district based on historic uses and potential environmental risk. The Strategy is regularly reviewed with the most recent review for 2020-2025 completed and published in September 2020.

7.225 Contaminated Land is a material planning consideration when determining planning applications and national planning policy sets out the overarching planning policy on land potentially affected by contamination and instability. Government guidance is that, where possible, remediation of contaminated land should be secured through the planning process. Planning policies and decisions should ensure that a development site is suitable for its proposed use taking account of ground conditions and any risks arising from land instability and contamination. This includes risks arising from natural hazards or former activities such as mining, and any proposals for mitigation including

land remediation (as well as potential impacts on the natural environment arising from that remediation). Where a proposed development site is known or suspected of being contaminated, developers will be expected to provide a full assessment of the contamination and proposals for any necessary remediation work. Development will be supported where it can be demonstrated that the contamination will not cause a threat to health, safety or the environment following the implementation of remedial measures. After remediation, as a minimum, newly developed land should not be capable of being determined as contaminated land under Part 2A of the Environmental Protection Act 1990. Development should:

- Follow Land Contamination Technical Guidance published by the government on the management of contaminated land including how to investigate, assess and manage the risks.
- Refer to the Environment Agency guiding principles for land contamination for the type of information that is required in order to assess risks to controlled waters from the site. The local authority can advise on risk to other receptors, such as human health.
- Consider using the National Quality Mark Scheme for Land Contamination Management which involves the use of competent persons to ensure that land contamination risks are appropriately managed.

Policy LP69

Contaminated Land and Unstable Land

Within the district are areas where there are adverse ground conditions caused by unstable or contaminated land, including the presence of methane gas, as a result of past activities such as mining, quarrying, heavy industrial processes and chemical works.

- a. Development on or adjacent to land where there are adverse ground conditions will not be permitted unless it has been adequately demonstrated that these conditions have been properly identified and safely treated. Proposals for development should include a desk study of the previous uses of the site identifying possible ground contamination or land instability. Where contamination or instability has been identified or is strongly suspected, a full site investigation shall be submitted with the planning application. This investigation shall clearly identify the contamination and/or land instability, assess the risk to human health and controlled waters, and propose remediation requirements where necessary.
- b. Development proposals that lie within 250 metres of a former or current landfill site shall be accompanied by an assessment of the likelihood of gas migration affecting the development. Where necessary, remediation measures shall be identified to ensure the safety of the development and its occupants. Where development proposals are within 50 metres of a landfill site development will only be permitted if suitable investigations indicate there is no risk to people or property or where mitigation measures will provide suitable protection.

Protection of Agricultural Land and Soil Quality

7.226 It is national policy that the protection of the best and most versatile agricultural land (grades 1, 2 and 3a) should be taken into account alongside other sustainability considerations. In Wakefield District the best land is generally grade 3a, although there are areas of grade 2 land in the north western and eastern parts of the district. There is increasing concern over climate change and its impact on world food shortages, which is being exacerbated by production of cereals for biofuels rather than for food. Some of the best agricultural land in the district is under pressure from proposals for urban growth. In view of these concerns the Council considers that it is prudent to ensure that the most productive agricultural land within the district is safeguarded for the future.

7.227 Proposals which would result in the loss of agricultural land of grades 2 and 3a in the district will not be acceptable unless it can be demonstrated that there is a particular need for the development, that no alternative site of a lower grade is available, and the proposal would not result in the severance, fragmentation or reduction in the size of agricultural holdings which would prejudice their continuing viability. These considerations will be applicable to all proposals including those with little or no built development such as golf courses and minerals workings, because restoration of the land back to agricultural use may not be capable of reproducing the original soil quality.

Policy LP70

Protection of Agricultural Land

Agricultural land within the district is under pressure from proposals to work minerals, to plant crops for biofuel and from urban expansion. As the climate is changing it is prudent to ensure that the most productive agricultural land is safeguarded for the future. The best and most versatile agricultural land within the district will be protected from irreversible development. In particular, development involving a significant loss from agricultural land graded 3a or higher will not be permitted where land of a lower quality could be developed for the particular purpose. Proposals to work minerals on the best and most versatile agricultural land will only be permitted if it can be demonstrated that a high standard of restoration to good quality agricultural land can be achieved.

7.228 The National Planning Policy Framework states that the planning system should protect and enhance valued soils and prevent the adverse effects of unacceptable levels of pollution. This is because soil is an essential finite resource that provides important 'ecosystem services', for example as a growing medium for food, timber and other crops, as a store for carbon and water, as a reservoir of biodiversity and as a buffer against pollution. Soil also has a large social function, through providing the basis for green space. The development of greenfield sites within the district provides an opportunity for the re-use of soil for the restoration of former minerals extraction sites, waste management sites and industrial sites to areas with ecological value for conservation, agriculture and other ecosystem services. Brownfield sites can also have reserves of reusable soils. Soil surveys should be carried out prior to any earthworks operations on new major developments of 0.5 hectares or more in site area, or 10 or more dwellings, or 1,000 m² or more floor area for employment, commercial, leisure and community development.

7.229 The formation of soil can take several hundred to thousands of years and is locally distinct as a result of minerals, climate, topography and local organisms such as fungi, bacteria, animals and vegetation. For this reason soil can contain valuable local seed banks. In view of this soil should be managed through the development of sites to enable its productive re-use within the locality and the district. Construction activity can have adverse impacts on soil. The Department for Environment Food and Rural Affairs (Defra) has produced a *Construction Code of Practice for the Sustainable Use of Soils on Construction Sites* (September 2009) to guide the process of soil management on construction sites. Developers should refer to this when considering soil management for development sites.

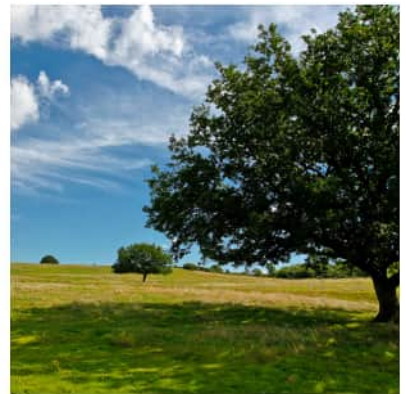
Policy LP71**Soil Conservation**

The protection, use and movement of soil shall be considered from the outset of a development project's planning, through its design and construction phases and on into future maintenance.

- a. Development proposals shall protect and enhance soil as a local resource and shall adhere to the Construction Code of Practice for the Sustainable Use of Soils on Construction Sites guidance.
- b. A soil resource survey will be required prior to any earthwork operations on new major development sites, particular greenfield sites. This shall inform the materials and/or waste management plan with a planning application.
- c. Planning conditions or a Section 106 agreement will be used to ensure developments are carried out in accordance with the materials and/or waste management plan(s).

In addition to the Defra Construction Code, the use of sustainable drainage systems on sites shall be considered which provide more long term protection of soils beyond the construction phase.

Local Policies District-wide Allocations and Designations



8 Local Policies District-wide Allocations and Designations

8.1 This chapter contains district-wide designations and allocations for:

- Green Belt - Infill Settlements
- Strategic Leisure Corridors
- Leisure Opportunity Areas
- Transport Schemes
- Minerals
- Waste
- Sports Facilities
- Ecological Designations
- Historic Designations
- Major Developed Sites in the Green Belt

a) Housing, Employment, Retail, Leisure and Commercial Development

Infill Housing in Green Belt Settlements

8.2 The main purpose of the Wakefield Green Belt is to keep land open and free from development, to maintain the character and identity of individual settlements, and to make a clear distinction between town and country. The spatial development strategy set out in strategic policy SP3 aims to create sustainable communities by concentrating new development in Urban Areas and Local Service Centres based on the settlement hierarchy in strategic policy SP2. The Green Belt's role is to help reinforce this strategy by strictly controlling development in the open countryside. The Green Belt adjoins the edge of the settlements within the district. The precise line of the Green Belt boundary follows the urban side of the boundary line as shown on the Policies Map.

Small Settlements in the Green Belt

8.3 Policy SP22 provides the strategic context for Green Belts in the district and policy SP5 provides the strategic context for the expected scale and distribution of additional housing in the district. The Local Plan identifies a number of small settlements located within the Green Belt, where limited infill housing development may be acceptable. The list of settlements is set out below and their boundaries are defined on the Policies Map. Policy LP1 provides the context for considering proposals within these boundaries. The Green Belt Infill Settlements have been carried forward from the Local Development Framework Site Specific Policies Local Plan 2012 although their boundaries have been re-aligned to reflect real world changes on the latest Ordnance Survey mapping.

GBS

Green Belt Infill Settlements

Green Belt Settlements where infill may be acceptable are identified in the following table and are shown on the Policies Map:

Reference	Description
GBS01	Carr Gate
GBS02	Warmfield
GBS03	Old Snydale

Reference	Description
GBS04	East Hardwick
GBS05	Wentbridge
GBS06	North Elmsall
GBS07	Wragby
GBS08	Chapelthorpe
GBS09	Midgley

Leisure

- 8.4** This section contains site allocations for Strategic Leisure Corridors and Leisure Opportunity Areas, which were allocated in the Local Development Framework Leisure, Recreation and Open Space Local Plan and Development Policies document. They have been updated where necessary, and carried forward into the Local Plan. Policy SP12 provides the strategic context for Leisure, Recreation and Open Space within the district. Policy LP24 provides the specific local policy relating to Strategic Leisure Corridors and Policy LP25 provides the local policy on Leisure Opportunity Areas.

Strategic Leisure Corridors

- 8.5** The network of Strategic Leisure Corridors includes safeguarded existing routes and proposed new links for cycle routes, footpaths and bridleways. The majority of the Strategic Leisure Corridors are existing rights of way, with some permissive routes. Some new links may require access agreements to be made with landowners before they can be opened, including Nostell Park for example. There are numerous other rights of way, cycle routes and potential new links connecting into the network of Strategic Leisure Corridors. The Wakefield Cycle Strategy and Rights of Way Improvement Plan identify proposed new/enhanced routes. It is impossible to allocate all these in the Local Plan but they will be enhanced and developed as transport funding becomes available and wherever opportunities arise through the planning process.
- 8.6** The safeguarded alignment of HS2 Phase 2b rail line passes through Wakefield District. Its construction would have an impact on existing Rights of Way along the route. Wakefield, Leeds and Barnsley Councils and consultants working on the government's behalf are investigating potential routes which link into the existing national and local networks which include the Trans Pennine Trail and some of the Strategic Leisure Corridors identified below.

LC

Strategic Leisure Corridors

The routes in the following table are designated as Strategic Leisure Corridors and are shown on the Policies Map:

Reference	Description
LC01	River Aire
LC02	Aire and Calder Navigation
LC03	River Calder

Reference	Description
LC04	Calder and Hebble Navigation
LC05	River Went Valley (Wentbridge - Ackworth - Nostell)
LC06	Trans Pennine Trail and Methley Line
LC07	Wheldale - Fryston Park - Pontefract
LC08	Pontefract - Knottingley
LC09	Pontefract - Pontefract Park - Glasshoughton
LC10	Methley Line Castleford
LC11	Castleford - Allerton Minerals Railway
LC12	Normanton Bypass - Glasshoughton
LC13	Normanton Altofts
LC14	Normanton - Sharlston - Nostell - Crofton
LC15	Feathertone - Nostell Park - Wragby
LC16	Purston - East Hardwick - Darrington - Pontefract
LC17	Normanton - Featherstone - Pontefract - Glasshoughton
LC18	Newland - Normanton Goosehill - Wakefield
LC19	Winterset - Anglers - Haw Park - Nostell Park (Ninelakes)
LC20	Dearne Valley Jn Ryhill & Havercroft - Crofton - Walton CP
LC21	Chevet Branch Line and Newmillerdam
LC22	Pugneys - Newmillerdam
LC23	Newmillerdam CP - Seckar Lane - Woolley - West Bretton
LC24	Woolley - Notton Park - Notton - Chevet Branch Line
LC25	Bretton Park - Top Lane - Stocksmoor Lane - Carr Lane Middlestown
LC26	Overton - Middlestown - Netherton (Hayne Lane, Chapel Hill Lane, Danes Lane)
LC27	Caphouse Railway (Mining Museum) - Calder Grove - Crigglestone Greenway - Horbury
LC28	Ossett and Dewsbury Branch Line (Kirklees Greenway)
LC29	Gawthorpe Lane Ossett - Kirkhamgate - Wrenthorpe - Carr Gate
LC30	Horbury - Ossett - Flanshaw
LC31	Lawns Lane - Castle Head Lane - Lofthouse Colliery - Lingwell Gate Outwood
LC32	Lindale Lane - Wrenthorpe Park - Balne Lane - Thornes Park - Lupset GC
LC33	Outwood Station - Stanley Ferry - Nagger Line
LC34	Redhall Lane - Newton Avenue - Fieldhead - City Fields Wakefield
LC35	Cold Hiendley - Ryhill & Havercroft Heritage Trail - Anglers Coal Disposal Point
LC36	Ryhill & Havercroft - Fitzwilliam CP - Ackworth Moor Top

Reference	Description
LC37	South Hiendley - Kinsley
LC38	Hemsworth - Ackworth Moor Top
LC39	Hemsworth - South Kirkby - North Elmsall - Upton
LC40	South Elmsall - South Kirkby
LC41	Upton - East Hardwick

Leisure Opportunity Areas

- 8.7** In order to ensure there is an appropriate mix and range of leisure opportunities within the district the Council has identified Leisure Opportunity Areas which are strategic sites where a combination of sports, recreational and community facilities can be provided. Some Leisure Opportunity Areas are located within urban areas, most are within the Green Belt. Outdoor sport, recreation and countryside activities are examples of uses which may be appropriate in the Green Belt. Proposals for leisure development will be assessed against policies in the Local Plan, and evidence in the Playing Pitch Strategy. Leisure uses which are defined as main town centre uses in the National Planning Policy Framework will only be appropriate if the Leisure Opportunity Area is within a town centre (Refer to National Planning Policy Framework Annex 2 for the definition of main town centre uses).

LA

Leisure Opportunity Areas

The following sites are allocated as Leisure Opportunity Areas and are shown on the Policies Map:

LA01

[Ferry Lane Leisure Opportunity Area, Stanley](#)

Playing fields with potential to be enhanced/developed for sport and community leisure uses. The site adjoins the Trans Pennine Trail Strategic Leisure Corridor link to Stanley Ferry waterside and the City Fields Special Policy Area. The site is within the Green Belt and partly within flood zones 2, 3a and 3b.

Water Management: The developer must provide a drainage strategy/scheme to deal with surface water flood risk within the site which does not increase flood risk elsewhere.

Historic Environment: Proposals will need to safeguard those elements which contribute to the significance of Stanley Ferry Aqueduct which is both a Scheduled Monument and a Grade I Listed Building.

Contaminated Land: The developer should ensure that appropriate assessments are undertaken to assess any potential contamination and instability risks.

LA02**Minsthorpe Leisure Opportunity Area, South Elmsall**

Playing fields and swimming pool with potential to be developed for sport/fitness facilities and community leisure uses. The site adjoins Minsthorpe College sports complex offering opportunities to enhance the range and quality of facilities serving the South East Area. The site is within a flood zone.

Ecology: The beck is UK BAP priority habitat. Dual purpose ecological enhancement and flood risk mitigation along the beck corridor is required.

Water Management: Parts of the site lie within Flood Zones 3b, 3a and 2 and the site has localised flooding issues. Proposals in these zones have been subject to the sequential test and, as required, exception test. A site specific flood risk assessment is required which accords with local and national policy. An 8 metre buffer along the beck is recommended. The developer must provide a drainage strategy/scheme to deal with surface water flood risk within the site which does not increase flood risk elsewhere.

Contaminated Land: The developer should ensure that appropriate assessments are undertaken to assess any potential contamination and instability risks.

LA03**Ryhill & Havercroft Leisure Opportunity Area**

Extension to Ryhill and Havercroft Sports Centre and playing fields. The site is within the Green Belt and is bisected by the Dearne Valley Junction Strategic Leisure Corridor. Potential to be enhanced/developed for sport and community leisure uses.

Ecology: The beck, woodland and hedgerows are UK BAP priority habitats. Ecological enhancements along the beck and railway corridors are required.

Transport: A contribution towards enhancing the Strategic Leisure Corridor along the railway to provide a combined pedestrian and cycleway is required.

Water Management: The developer must provide a drainage strategy/scheme to deal with surface water flood risk within the site which does not increase flood risk elsewhere.

Contaminated Land: The developer should ensure that appropriate assessments are undertaken to assess any potential contamination and instability risks.

LA04**Fairies Hill Leisure Opportunity Area, Castleford**

Canal basin and adjoining land on the Aire and Calder Navigation. Potential to be developed for canal related leisure uses and ecological enhancements to support species such as otters and water voles. The site is within the functional floodplain.

Ecology: The site contains UK BAP priority habitat and species. Dual purpose ecological enhancement and flood risk mitigation is required.

Water Management: The site is within functional floodplain and a flood risk assessment will be required. As the site is within 8 metres of a main river, an 8 metre buffer along the river is recommended and an environmental permit will be required. The developer must provide a drainage strategy/scheme to deal with surface water flood risk within the site which does not increase flood risk elsewhere.

Historic Environment: Proposals will need to safeguard those elements which contribute to the significance of the Listed railway viaducts.

Contaminated Land: The developer should ensure that appropriate assessments are undertaken to assess any potential contamination and instability risks.

LA05

Pontefract Prince of Wales Leisure Opportunity Area

A key regeneration and land reclamation area on the Former Prince of Wales Colliery with potential to be developed for sport and leisure facilities to serve Pontefract and the Five Towns Area. The site has planning consent for coal extraction and restoration to a country park and sports pitches. The regeneration area includes the new northern link road with access to the M62 and adjoins new Housing and Employment sites. The site is within the Green Belt. Fryston Beck runs along the north and west boundaries.

Ecology: The beck is UK BAP priority habitat. Dual purpose ecological enhancement and flood risk mitigation along the back corridor is required.

Water Management: The developer must provide a drainage strategy/scheme to deal with surface water flood risk within the site which does not increase flood risk elsewhere.

Transport: A transport assessment will be required for proposals for further intensification of leisure activities or new leisure development within the site.

Contaminated Land: The developer should ensure that appropriate assessments are undertaken to assess any potential contamination and instability risks.

LA06

Knottingley Hill Top Leisure Opportunity Area

A key regeneration area including Greenhouse Park, Knottingley Sports Centre and Library, Kellingley Miners Welfare, cricket club, sports pitches and playing fields. The northern part of the site including the leisure centre, library and miners welfare is within Knottingley town centre and has potential to be redeveloped to provide a new community leisure facility which could include a community centre, library and indoor sport facilities/leisure centre. The existing outdoor sports facilities have potential to be enhanced and could include a new all-weather pitch, creating a sports hub to serve the Knottingley area. Several small areas within the site are at risk from surface water flooding.

Water Management: The developer must provide a drainage strategy/scheme to deal with surface water flood risk within the site which does not increase flood risk elsewhere.

Contaminated Land: The developer should ensure that appropriate assessments are undertaken to assess any potential contamination and instability risks.

LA07

Spring Mill Leisure Opportunity Area, Ossett

Spring Mill is a large site within the Green Belt which is a sports hub with sports pitches and a clubhouse. The former golf course has a network of informal recreational open space and semi-natural areas with paths and cycle ways. There is potential to develop the area for community clubs to provide an all-weather pitch, a football/rugby ground and/or other sports facilities. The Horbury - Ossett – Flanshaw Strategic Leisure Corridor passes through the site.

Ecological enhancements will also be a significant element in any development, there is potential to create ecological based activities such as nature trails and conservation areas.

Ecology: An Ecological Assessment will be required for proposals for further intensification of leisure activities or new development within the site.

Water Management: The developer must provide a drainage strategy/scheme to deal with surface water flood risk within the site which does not increase flood risk elsewhere. An assessment of the potential impact on groundwater is required which must set out mitigation if an impact is identified.

Contaminated Land: The developer should ensure that appropriate assessments are undertaken to assess any potential contamination and instability risks.

LA08

Pugneys Leisure Opportunity Area

This is a key area of countryside adjoining Wakefield South, Sandal, Kettlethorpe, Crigglestone and Durkar. It includes Pugneys Country Park and Local Nature Reserve, Sandal Castle and site of the Battle of Wakefield, Durkar Lows Local Wildlife Site, and Strategic Leisure Corridors. Pugneys lake is used for water sports with a visitor centre offering tuition and hire facilities which attracts visitors from across Wakefield and neighbouring districts. The Reserve lake is used for conservation and has bird watching hides. A network of footpaths and cycle routes link Pugneys to other strategic sites in the Calder Valley. It is proposed to enhance/develop countryside recreation and outdoor sports including improvements to the visitor centre and new outdoor sport facilities to serve Wakefield District. Ecological enhancements will also be a significant element in any development, there is potential to create ecological based activities such as nature trails, and improve links to the adjoining Calder Valley Leisure Opportunity Area. This area is within the Green Belt and partly within the functional floodplain and flood zones.

Ecology: An ecological assessment will be required for proposals for further intensification of leisure activities or new development within the site.

Water Management: Part of the site is within Zone 3 floodplain and a flood risk assessment will be required. The developer must provide a drainage strategy/scheme to deal with surface water flood risk within the site which does not increase flood risk elsewhere.

Transport: A transport assessment will be required for proposals for further intensification of leisure activities or new leisure development within the site, to identify the level of impact from the site, and where appropriate, suitable mitigation measures implemented to ensure there is no detriment to the strategic road network.

Historic Environment: Proposals will need to ensure that they safeguard those elements which contribute to the significance of the Scheduled Monument at Sandal Castle, the Site of the Battle of Wakefield and the Listed Buildings in this area.

Contaminated Land: The developer should ensure that appropriate assessments are undertaken to assess any potential contamination and instability risks.

LA09

Calder Valley Leisure Opportunity Area

This is a key area along the River Calder and Calder & Hebble Navigation adjoining Wakefield South, Pugneys Country Park and Calder Park Special Policy Area. It includes Horbury Lagoons and the Soap Tips and part of Hartley Brooks Netherton Woods Local Wildlife Site designations, and Strategic Leisure Corridors. There is potential to enhance/ develop the area for countryside recreation and

water based recreational activities relating to the canal and lagoons. Ecological enhancements will also be a significant element in any development, there is potential to create ecological based activities such as nature trails, bird watching hides and conservation areas together with links to Pugneys Leisure Opportunity Area. This area is within the Green Belt and partly within the functional floodplain and flood zones.

Ecology: An ecological assessment will be required for proposals for further intensification of leisure activities or new development within the site.

Water Management: Part of the site is within Zone 3 floodplain and a flood risk assessment will be required. The developer must provide a drainage strategy/scheme to deal with surface water flood risk within the site which does not increase flood risk elsewhere.

Transport: A transport assessment will be required for proposals for further intensification of leisure activities or new leisure development within the site, to identify the level of impact from the site, and where appropriate, suitable mitigation measures implemented to ensure there is no detriment to the strategic road network.

Contaminated Land: The developer should ensure that appropriate assessments are undertaken to assess any potential contamination and instability risks.

LA10

Ninelakes Leisure Opportunity Area

This is a key area of countryside containing Anglers Country Park, Winterset and Cold Hiendley Reservoirs, Nostell Priory, and Strategic Leisure Corridors. It also adjoins other designated ecological conservation sites including Haw Park Wood, the Trans Pennine Trail and Barnsley Canal. Nostell Priory is a Registered Park and Garden containing a number of important Listed Buildings. There is potential to enhance/ develop the area for countryside recreation. It is proposed to improve the visitor facilities at Anglers County Park to create a countryside activity hub with improved links to Nostell Priory, Newmillerdam, Walton Nature Park, Barnsley Canal and the Trans Pennine Trail. Ecological enhancements will also be a significant element in any development, there is potential to create ecological based activities such as nature trails, bird watching hides and conservation areas. This area is within the Green Belt and partly within a flood zone.

Ecology: An ecological assessment will be required for proposals for further intensification of leisure activities or new development within the site.

Water Management: Part of the site is within Zone 3 floodplain and a flood risk assessment will be required. The developer must provide a drainage strategy/scheme to deal with surface water flood risk within the site which does not increase flood risk elsewhere.

Transport: A transport assessment will be required for proposals for further intensification of leisure activities or new leisure development within the site, to identify the level of impact from the site, and where appropriate, suitable mitigation measures implemented to ensure there is no detriment to the strategic road network.

Historic Environment: Proposals will need to ensure that they safeguard those elements which contribute to the significance of the heritage assets in the area including the Registered Park and Garden and buildings at Nostell Priory.

Contaminated Land: The developer should ensure that appropriate assessments are undertaken to assess any potential contamination and instability risks.

b) Infrastructure

Transport

- 8.8** Policies SP13 Sustainable Transport, SP14 Transport Network and SP15 Influencing the Demand for Travel provide the strategic context for transport considerations in the district. This section sets out transport infrastructure allocations which affect more than one settlement in the district. The allocations relate to the Department for Transport proposal for a new high speed rail line between London and the North, a revised local road network scheme relating to Featherstone, Pontefract and Ackworth, and the Barnsley Canal.
- 8.9** Other transport infrastructure allocations relating to individual settlements are set out in Volume 2 Settlement Specific Policies.

High Speed Rail

- 8.10** The Local Plan incorporates the safeguarded alignment of HS2 Phase 2b rail line through the district. The Council is required to consult HS2 Ltd as a statutory planning consultee on any planning applications involving development proposals impacting on the safeguarded alignment.

HSR

[HS2 Phase 2b](#)

A safeguarded alignment is shown on the Policies Map.

Local Road Network Scheme

- 8.11** The following local road network scheme is required to improve environmental conditions in Ackworth, Featherstone and Pontefract. Part of the scheme south of Featherstone from the A645 in the west is also required to allow the development of 1,000 homes on Special Policy Area SPA24 'Land South of Featherstone'. The other elements are not required to allow development to occur in the plan period.

TS01

[South Featherstone Link Road](#)

An indicative safeguarded alignment is shown on the Policies Map. This scheme will provide a series of link roads and local bypasses of Ackworth, Featherstone and Pontefract. It will remove through traffic, improve road safety and the environment for these communities, as well as open up land for development within the Special Policy Area SPA24 'Land South of Featherstone'.

The scheme will be funded from developer contributions and future transport funds and it is the Council's aspiration to deliver the link road in the plan period. The exact route of the road will be subject to further assessment and evaluation as the business case process advances. Construction is likely to be from 2024 onwards for the part of the scheme south of Featherstone, from the A645 in the west, required to allow development of up to 1,000 homes within Special Policy Area SPA24 'Land South of Featherstone'.

The construction of the other parts of the South Featherstone Link Road are an important longer term objective for the district. The indicative route of the link road is safeguarded from development.

Sustainable Transport

The development shall incorporate active design and streets for people principles to allow pedestrian and cycle permeability with the surrounding area.

Ecology

Part of the scheme is within the Wildlife Habitat Network and its southern boundary is in close proximity to Ancient Woodlands. The scheme would overlap slightly with a Local Wildlife Site and a Local Nature Reserve. Appropriate ecological assessments and a habitat survey are required to identify the level of impact from the development on ecology and to determine biodiversity net gain required. Provision shall be made for the retention and enhancement of the Wildlife Habitat Network and protection of its wildlife links and ecological conservation value.

Water Management

Flood Risk: Parts of the site lie within Flood Zone 3a and the site has localised flooding issues.

Proposals in these zones have been subject to the sequential and exception tests. A site specific flood risk assessment is required which accords with local and national policy.

Drainage: A drainage strategy/scheme is required to deal with surface water flood risk within the site which does not increase flood risk elsewhere.

Watercourse buffer/source protection zone: An assessment and mitigation of the potential impact on groundwater is required.

Historic Environment

There are a number of designated heritage assets in the vicinity of this route whose significance could be harmed by this proposal. This includes the Grade II* Registered Park and Garden at Nostell Priory. An assessment of the potential impact upon the historic environment, especially views to and from Nostell Priory, will be required. Any scheme will need to conserve the significance of any heritage assets.

Archaeology

The route crosses areas of archaeological potential therefore a desk based archaeological assessment will be required, but if this cannot assess the interest a field evaluation will be required.

Safeguarded Line for Canal Restoration

8.12 An authoritative study has found the restoration of the Barnsley Canal from the River Calder to the River Don is feasible, but at a very high cost. The study dealt with economic, environmental, and managerial matters and considered both costs and benefits. The restoration is likely to be undertaken incrementally over a long period, but the study indicated it could be substantially progressed within the plan period. This route has been carried forward into the Local Plan from the Local Development Framework Site Specific Policies Local Plan 2012. The following route is allocated as a Safeguarded Canal Route and is shown on the Policies Map:

TS02

Barnsley Canal Restoration

The opportunity is taken to safeguard the route from development, so the feasibility of implementing a scheme at any time in the future is not undermined, by new development taking place across the proposed line. As detailed restoration schemes for sections are proposed, environmental impact assessments will be required to accompany planning applications as necessary, and environmental impacts will need to be satisfactorily mitigated. Parts of the canal are designated as Local Nature Reserves, Ancient Woodland and Local Wildlife Sites.

A corridor up to 50 metres wide, 25 metres either side the centreline of the route, is safeguarded from development. The more exact and necessary corridor width at any particular point on the route, will be determined in consultation with the Barnsley Canals Consortium and the Barnsley, Dearne and Dove Canals Trust as development proposals arise.

Land occupied by and adjacent to the former Barnsley Canal will be protected from other forms of development, in order to safeguard its potential to be reinstated to its former use for commercial or leisure purposes, or to extend the cycling or footpath networks.

Minerals

8.13 Policy SP19 provides the strategic context for minerals in the district. The following mineral safeguarding areas, safeguarding areas for minerals production, minerals reserves and land reclamation sites include sites which were allocated in the Local Development Framework Site Specific Policies Local Plan 2012. They have been updated where necessary, and carried forward into the Local Plan. There are also a number of new mineral reserves, safeguarding areas for mineral production, land reclamation and hydrocarbons sites.

Mineral Safeguarding Areas

MSA

Mineral Safeguarding Areas

The sites in the following table are allocated as Mineral Safeguarding Areas and are shown on the Policies Map:

Reference	Description
MSA01	South Knottingley/Darrington - <i>Limestone</i> To safeguard limestone reserves in the east of the district - south of Knottingley.
MSA02	The Wyke, Horbury - <i>Sand and Gravel</i> The site will contribute towards the regional supply of aggregates and provide an adequate and steady supply of sand and gravel. The whole of this site is also designated as The Wyke Local Wildlife Site. Any development would need to meet the tests set out in policy LP51 and LP37.
MSA03	Stanley Ferry, Wakefield - <i>Sand and Gravel</i> The site will contribute towards the regional supply of aggregates and provide an adequate and steady supply of sand and gravel.
MSA04	Limits of the Surface Coal Resources To safeguard potentially economically viable deposits of coal in the district. The limits of the shallow coal resources are shown to safeguard coal mineral resources as far as possible. The limits of the coal resources do not necessarily identify economically viable deposits.

Safeguarding Areas for Mineral Production

8.14 The following areas as shown on the Policies Map have allocated as Safeguarding Areas for Mineral Production, processing and distribution. These include railheads, wharves, stocking grounds, concrete manufacture and roadstone plants.

SMP

Safeguarding Areas for Mineral Production

The sites in the following table are allocated as Safeguarding Areas for Mineral Production and are shown on the Policies Map:

Reference	Description
SMP01	Redland Tarmac, Express Way, Castleford
SMP02	Redland Aggregates, Wakefield Road, Ackworth

Reference	Description
SMP03	Plasmor Concrete Products, Womersley Road, Knottingley
SMP04	Ibstock Brick Ltd, Swine Lane, Nostell
SMP05	Hanson Concrete Works and Railhead, Calder Vale Road, Wakefield
SMP06	Siniat Gypsum Works, Willow Garth Park, Kirkhaw Lane, Knottingley
SMP07	Healey Mills, Sidings, Ossett

Mineral Reserves

MR

Mineral Reserves

The sites in the following table are allocated as Minerals Reserves and are shown on the Policies Map:

Reference	Description
MR01	Foxholes, North of Altofts - <i>Sand and Gravel</i>
MR02	Penbank, Castleford - <i>Sand and Gravel</i>
MR03	Newland Lane, Normanton - <i>Clay</i>
MR04	Nostell Brickworks (North), Wragby - <i>Clay</i>
MR05	Nostell Brickworks (South), Wragby - <i>Clay</i>
MR06	Crofton Triangle, Shay Lane, Crofton - <i>Ash and Shale</i>
MR07	The Strands, Horbury Bridge - <i>Sand and Gravel</i>
MR08	Darrington Quarries, M62 North Extension, Ley Lanes, Knottingley - Active Permian Limestone Quarry
MR09	Bracken Hill Quarry (Part) Green Lane, Ackworth - Sandstone Blockstone Reserve for Heritage Materials
MR10	Ash and Brick Clay Quarry, Field Lane South Elmsall - <i>Ash and Brick Clay</i>

Land Reclamation

LR

Land Reclamation Sites

The sites in the following table are allocated for Land Reclamation and are shown on the Policies Map:

Reference	Description
LR01	Former Prince of Wales Spoil Tip, Reclamation, Pontefract
LR02	Former West Riding Colliery Spoil Tip, Express Way, Whitwood, Castleford

Reference	Description
LR03	Welbeck Landfill Reclamation Site, Boundary Lane, Normanton
LR04	Former HWS site at Shawcross Colliery, Owl Lane, Ossett
LR05	Former Spoil Tip, Bottom Boat, Stanley The whole of this site is also designated as The Former Newmarket Colliery Local Wildlife Site. An ecological assessment will be required prior to any further reclamation work taking place. Any development would need to meet the tests set out in policies LP51 and LP37.

Hydrocarbons

- 8.15** Minerals planning authorities are expected to identify existing hydrocarbon extraction sites in their Local Plan. The following sites are active areas where mine gas and landfill gas is being captured in the district as an energy source.

EG

Mine and Landfill Gas Extraction Sites

The sites in the following table are allocated as Mine and Landfill Gas Extraction Sites and are shown on the Policies Map:

Reference	Description
EG01	Newmarket Lane, Stanley: Energy Generation - Mine Gas Extraction
EG02	Prince of Wales Colliery Reclamation, Skinner Lane, Pontefract: Energy Generation - Mine Gas Extraction
EG03	Former HWS site at Shawcross Colliery, Owl Lane, Ossett: Energy generation - Landfill Gas Extraction
EG04	Land at Welbeck Landfill Site, Boundary Lane, Normanton: Energy Generation - Landfill Gas Extraction
EG05	Wheldon Road, Castleford: Energy Generation - Mine Gas Extraction

- 8.16** Where mineral planning authorities consider it is necessary to update their Local Plan and they are in a Petroleum Licence Area, they are expected to include the Petroleum Licence Areas on their Policies Map. These licences are granted by the North Sea Transition Authority. Further information is available on their website which should be consulted for the most up to date information.

PLA

Petroleum Licence Areas

Petroleum Licence Areas have been shown on the Policies Map for information. These licences are granted by the North Sea Transition Authority and are not designated by the Council.

Waste

WS

Waste

The following sites are allocated for waste management to meet the future identified need during the plan period.

Strategic Municipal Waste Management

The following site is allocated to contribute to meeting the need for future capacity for strategic municipal waste management and is shown on the Policies Map:

WS01

[South Kirkby Business Park \(part\) South Kirkby](#)

The site is allocated for strategic municipal waste management and is in active use for this purpose. Other development within/adjacent to this site will not be permitted if it would prevent or restrict the extent to which it may be used for waste management purposes.

Commercial and Industrial Waste Management

The following sites are allocated to contribute to meeting the need for future capacity for commercial and industrial waste recovery and are shown on the Policies Map:

WS02

[South Kirkby Business Park \(part\) South Kirkby](#)

The site is allocated for commercial and industrial waste recycling, composting and recovery and is in active use for these purposes. Other development within/adjacent to this site will not be permitted if it would prevent or restrict the extent to which it may be used for waste management purposes.

WS03

[Welbeck, Normanton](#)

The site is allocated for commercial and industrial waste recycling, composting and recovery and is in active use for these purposes. Other development within/adjacent to this site will not be permitted if it would prevent or restrict the extent to which it may be used for waste management purposes.

Residual Waste

The following site is allocated to contribute to meeting the need for future capacity for residual waste and is shown on the Policies Map:

WS04

Welbeck Landfill site, Normanton

This is an existing operational site where landfill capacity will be safeguarded as a means of final disposal of residual waste at Welbeck Landfill Site, Normanton. Other development within/adjacent to this site will not be permitted if it would prevent or restrict the extent to which it may be used for waste management purposes.

c) Community Facilities, including Open Space and Sports Facilities

Sport Facilities and Open Space

8.17 This section contains site allocations for Sports Facilities and Protected Areas of Open Land, which were allocated in the Leisure, Recreation and Open Space Local Plan 2017 and the Site Specific Policies Local Plan 2012 of the Local Development Framework. They have been updated where necessary, and carried forward into the Local Plan. Policy SP12 provides the strategic context for Leisure, Recreation and Open Space within the district. Policy LP50 provides the specific local policy relating to Sports Facilities and policy LP49 provides the local policy on Protected Areas of Open Land.

Sports Facilities

8.18 In order to ensure there is an appropriate mix and range of sport facilities within the district the Council has allocated sites for Sports Facilities where there are proposals to enhance existing facilities and/or provide new facilities. The Council is also developing improved facilities at some of its larger sport and recreational sites such as Wakefield Thornes Park and Pontefract Park where there is capacity for new sports pitches, tennis courts and other recreational facilities. The Council has also identified some Leisure Opportunity Areas which could also provide sports hubs with indoor and outdoor facilities together with other community facilities as required. These sites combined with the sport facilities allocations provide sufficient land in strategic locations to meet requirements for facilities identified in the Leisure Review and Playing Pitch Strategy.

SF

Sports Facilities

The following sites are allocated as Sports Facilities and are shown on the Policies Map:

SF01

Featherstone Rovers Sports Hub, Featherstone

Proposals include improving the rugby league stadium with new stands and all weather pitch, creating sport related small business units, and providing new community sports facilities, and providing associated development which will only be located on land outside the Green Belt. The playing field to the rear of the stadium will be improved and a new access off Post Office Road to Featherstone Miners Welfare and Featherstone Cricket Club is proposed, enabling the railway crossing to be closed. There is also potential to enhance the sports facilities at the miners welfare and cricket club.

Water Management: A watercourse runs through the site. The developer must provide a drainage strategy/scheme to deal with surface water flood risk within the site which does not increase flood risk elsewhere.

Contaminated Land: The developer should ensure that appropriate assessments are undertaken to assess any potential contamination and instability risks.

SF02**Minsthorpe Community College Sports Hub, South Elmsall**

Minsthorpe College sports complex provides an important community sports hub. The Council will support proposals which enhance the offer and quality of facilities serving the college and the communities in the South East Area.

Water Management: The developer must provide a drainage strategy/scheme to deal with surface water flood risk within the site which does not increase flood risk elsewhere. An assessment of the potential impact on groundwater is required which must set out mitigation if an impact is identified.

Contaminated Land: The developer should ensure that appropriate assessments are undertaken to assess any potential contamination and instability risks.

SF03**Balne Lane Playing Fields, Wakefield**

Proposals include creating new rugby and football pitches and ancillary facilities for Wakefield College and wider community use. The Strategic Leisure Corridor running through the site, linking Thornes Park, Wrenthorpe Park and Alverthorpe Meadows will be retained and improved as required. There is potential to develop other community facilities within the site and provide some ecological enhancements along Balne Beck.

Ecology: The Beck is a UK BAP priority habitat. Enhancement of the Beck is required to augment the corridor with dual purpose ecological and flood risk mitigation habitat such as wetland.

Water Management: Part of the site is within Flood Zone 3a. The developer must provide a drainage strategy/scheme to deal with surface water flood risk within the site which does not increase flood risk elsewhere. An assessment of the potential impact on groundwater is required which must set out mitigation if an impact is identified.

Contaminated Land: The developer should ensure that appropriate assessments are undertaken to assess any potential contamination and instability risks.

Protected Areas of Open Land

8.19 Within some settlements in the district there are areas of open land which need to be safeguarded from urban encroachment, to preserve the identities of settlements and amenity of their communities. These may consist of parks and public recreational space or open areas of green space of amenity value. Proposals for development that would detract from the open character or amenity value of the landscape will not be supported, unless exceptional circumstances of community benefit can be demonstrated. Proposals for recreational and amenity uses may be acceptable, providing that the open character of the land remains substantially unaffected.

OL

Protected Areas of Open Land

The following site is allocated as a Protected Area of Open Land and is shown on the Policies Map:

Reference	Description
OL01	Wrenthorpe Valley, Wakefield

d) Natural, Built and Historic Environment

Natural Environment

8.20 This section deals with designations for conserving and enhancing the natural environment. These include international and European designations, such as Special Areas of Conservation, national designations, such as Sites of Special Scientific Interest, and local designations, such as Local Nature Reserves, Local Geological Sites, Ancient Woodland, Wakefield Local Wildlife Sites and the Wildlife Habitat Network. The designations and their boundaries are established outside of the Plan process by bodies such as Natural England and West Yorkshire Ecology Service therefore the lists may alter during the Plan period. Policy SP23 provides the strategic context in the Local Plan on Design, Safety and the Local Environment, policy LP51 provides local policy on Ecological and Geological Conservation, policy LP52 provides local policy on the Ecological Protection of Watercourses and Water Bodies, policy LP53 provides local policy on the Wildlife Habitat Network and policy LP54 provides local policy on Protection of Trees and Woodland.

Special Area of Conservation

8.21 The most important sites for biodiversity are those identified through international conventions and European directions. The Local Plan does not contain specific protection policies for international and European designations, as they are protected by law. In Wakefield district there is one European designation, Denby Grange Colliery Ponds Special Area of Conservation.

8.22 The Habitats Regulations require that, if development is likely to significantly affect an international or European site, an Appropriate Assessment must be carried out to assess the implications of the development for the site's conservation objectives. As part of the Local Plan process the Council assessed the potential impact of all Local Plan policies and proposals on the Special Area of Conservation. An Appropriate Assessment will be required for development proposals which are likely to have a significant effect on the Special Area of Conservation (including the area within a 2 km buffer zone round it) unless the proposals are directly connected with or necessary to the management of the Special Area of Conservation. The applicant will be required to provide adequate information for the Council to assess the impact of the development on the Special Area of Conservation. Developers should refer to Guidance: Habitat Regulations Assessments: protecting a European site and the National Planning Policy Framework.

SAC

Special Areas of Conservation

The site in the following table as shown on the Policies Map is designated as a Special Area of Conservation:

Reference	Description
SAC01	Denby Grange Colliery Ponds And New Hall Wood, Netherton

Ancient Woodland

8.23 Ancient woodland is defined as an area that has been wooded continuously since 1600 AD. National policy requires the Council to identify and protect ancient woodlands, which do not enjoy statutory protection. As any other ancient woodland becomes known this will also be protected. Ancient woodland is particularly valuable for its biodiversity, because of its longevity, and is identified in the Wakefield District Biodiversity Action Plan. Once lost, ancient woodland cannot be recreated.

Consequently, development that would destroy or damage areas of ancient woodland will not be permitted, unless there are overriding exceptional circumstances. Areas of known ancient woodland are shown on the Policies Map.

AW

Ancient Woodland

The sites in the following table as shown on the Policies Map are designated as Ancient Woodland:

Reference	Description
AW01	Ackton Pasture And Houghton Woods, Castleford
AW02	Hagg Wood And The Snipery, Hemsworth
AW03	Priory Wood, Nostell
AW04	Low Wood, Kirkthorpe
AW05	New Hall, Stony Cliffe And Perkin Woods, Netherton
AW06	Dial Wood, New Hall, Midgley
AW07	Bank Wood, Midgley
AW08	Bentley Spring, West Bretton
AW09	Bullcliff North Wood, West Bretton
AW10	Bullcliff Wood, West Bretton
AW11	Jenkin Wood, West Bretton
AW12	Gate Royd Wood, Woolley
AW13	Woolley Edge, Woolley
AW14	Totty Spring, Woolley
AW15	Jobson Wood, Woolley
AW16	Windhill Wood, Woolley
AW17	Seckar Wood, Newmillerdam
AW18	Newmillerdam Woods, Newmillerdam
AW19	Notton Park Wood, Notton
AW20	Haw Park Wood, Walton
AW21	Brockdale Wood, Wentbridge

Local Geological Sites

8.24 Local Geological Sites are the most important places for geology and geomorphology outside statutorily protected areas, such as Sites of Special Scientific Interest. The designation of Local Geological Sites is one way of recognising and protecting important earth science and landscape features for future generations to enjoy. The West Yorkshire Local Sites Partnership designates Local Geological Sites.

LGS

Local Geological Sites

The sites in the following table as shown on the Policies Map are designated as Local Geological Sites:

Reference	Description
LGS01	Knottingley Canal, Knottingley
LGS02	Mill Hill Road And Dark Lane, Pontefract
LGS03	Wentbridge Road Cutting, Wentbridge
LGS04	Wrangbrook Railway Cutting, Upton
LGS05	Upton Railway Cutting, Upton
LGS06	Upton Recreation Ground, Upton
LGS07	Ackworth Moor Top Quarry
LGS08	Nostell Priory Medieval Quarry
LGS09	Barnsley Canal, Old Royston
LGS10	Sandal Castle
LGS11	Barnsley Canal at Waterton Hall
LGS12	Woolley Edge Quarry, Near Woolley
LGS13	Coxley Quarry
LGS14	Dewsbury Road Recreation Ground, Wakefield
LGS15	Holywell Wood, Glasshoughton
LGS16	Horbury Quarry, Horbury Bridge

Sites of Special Scientific Interest

8.25 Sites of Special Scientific Interest are wildlife and geological sites of national importance. They are afforded legal protection under Wildlife and Countryside Act 1981, as amended by the Countryside and Rights of Way Act 2000 and the Natural Environment and Rural Communities Act 2006.

SSSI

Sites of Special Scientific Interest

The sites in the following table as shown on the Policies Map are designated as Sites of Special Scientific Interest:

Reference	Description
SSSI01	Nostell Brickyard Quarry, Wragby
SSSI02	Seckar Wood, Newmillerdam
SSSI03	Denby Grange Ponds And New Hall Wood, Netherton

Reference	Description
SSSI04	Wentbridge Grassland (Brockadale), Wentbridge
SSSI05	Wentbridge Ings, Wentbridge
SSSI06	South Elmsall Quarry, South Elmsall

Local Nature Reserves

8.26 Local Nature Reserves are Wakefield local wildlife sites designated by the Council, in consultation with Natural England under Section 21 of the National Parks and Access to the Countryside Act 1949.

LNR

Local Nature Reserves

The sites in the following table as shown on the Policies Map are designated as Local Nature Reserves:

Reference	Description
LNR01	Stanley Marsh, Wakefield
LNR02	Southern Washlands, Wakefield
LNR03	Haw Park, Walton
LNR04	Anglers Country Park, Winterset
LNR05	Seckar Wood, Newmillerdam
LNR06	Newmillerdam Country Park, Newmillerdam
LNR07	Notton Park, Notton
LNR08	Bretton Park, West Bretton
LNR09	Chevet Branch Line, Newmillerdam
LNR10	Pugneys Reserve Lake And Country Park, Wakefield
LNR11	Well Wood, Castleford
LNR12	Pontefract Park, Pontefract
LNR13	Fitzwilliam Country Park, Fitzwilliam
LNR14	Former Upton Colliery, Upton
LNR15	Alverthorpe Meadows And Wrenthorpe Park, Alverthorpe
LNR16	Walton Colliery Nature Park, Walton
LNR17	Former Lofthouse Colliery, Outwood

Wakefield Local Wildlife Sites

8.27 Local Wildlife Sites are designated by the West Yorkshire Local Sites Partnership. Wakefield Local Wildlife Sites are sites of local wildlife value containing habitats and species identified in the Wakefield District Local Biodiversity Report.

LWS

Wakefield Local Wildlife Sites

The sites in the following table as shown on the Policies Map are designated as Wakefield Local Wildlife Sites:

Reference	Description
LWS01	Foxholes/Altofts Ings, Normanton
LWS02	Vale Head Marsh, Hemsworth
LWS03	Stanley Marsh, Wakefield
LWS04	Newmillerdam Lake, Newmillerdam
LWS05	Nostell Priory Lakes, Wragby
LWS06	Willowgarths, Knottingley
LWS07	Bretton Lakes, Bretton Park, West Bretton
LWS08	Barnsley Canal, Cold Hiendley
LWS09	Bulcarr Mires And Pothills Marsh, Upton
LWS10	Anglers Country Park, Winterset
LWS11	Ashfields And Half Moon, Kirkthorpe
LWS12	Barnsley Canal, Notton
LWS13	Winterset And Cold Hiendley Reservoirs
LWS14	Haw Park Wood And Brickyard Plantation, Walton
LWS15	Went Hill Grassland, Wentbridge
LWS16	Stanley Ferry Flash, Wakefield
LWS17	Moorhouse Lane Ponds And Railway, Winterset
LWS18	Fryston Park, Castleford
LWS19	Southern Washlands, Wakefield
LWS20	Holywell Wood, Castleford
LWS21	Pugneys Reserve Lake And Country Park, Wakefield
LWS22	Goosehill Common, Normanton
LWS23	Altofts Ings, Normanton
LWS24	Wheldale, Castleford
LWS25	Hare Park Wood, Walton
LWS26	Stocksmoor Common, Midgley

Reference	Description
LWS27	Bullcliff, West Bretton
LWS28	Emroyd Common, Middlestown
LWS29	Pitts Beck Wood, Netherton
LWS30	Bush Wood, Havercroft
LWS31	Park Baulk Quarry, Knottingley
LWS32	South Hiendley Common, South Hiendley
LWS33	Hessle And Brackenhill Commons, Ackworth
LWS34	Walton Wood, Upton
LWS35	Barnsdale A1M Junction, Barnsdale Bar
LWS36	Johnny Brown's Common, South Elmsall
LWS37	Former Frickley Colliery, South Elmsall
LWS38	Mutton Flatts, South Kirkby
LWS39	South Kirkby Fort, South Kirkby
LWS40	British Oak, Calder Grove, Wakefield
LWS41	Adjacent School Hill, Newmillerdam
LWS42	Warmfield Common, Normanton
LWS43	Heath Common, Heath
LWS44	Former Upton Colliery And Railway Cutting, Upton
LWS45	Mill Pond Meadow, Featherstone
LWS46	Walton Park, Walton
LWS47	Railway Sidings, Normanton
LWS48	Hartley Bank Wood, Netherton
LWS49	Former Lofthouse Colliery, Outwood
LWS50	Ellis Laithe, Cold Hiendley
LWS51	Hull To Barnsley Railway, South Elmsall
LWS52	Former South Kirkby Colliery Tip, South Kirkby
LWS53	Sharlston Common, Sharlston
LWS54	Fitzwilliam Country Park, Hemsworth
LWS55	Former Calder Drift Colliery, West Bretton
LWS56	Former Fryston Colliery, Castleford
LWS57	Former Newmarket Colliery, Stanley
LWS58	Bretton Country Park, West Bretton
LWS59	Harewood Park, Pontefract

Reference	Description
LWS60	Orchard Head, Pontefract
LWS61	Stansfield Road, Castleford
LWS62	Smawthorne Marsh, Castleford
LWS63	Lupset Golf Course, Wakefield
LWS64	Soap Tip, Calder Bridge, Wakefield
LWS65	Horbury Lagoons, Horbury Junction
LWS66	The Wyke, Horbury
LWS67	Kettlethorpe Wood, Crigglestone
LWS68	Durkar Lows And Cow Field, Crigglestone
LWS69	Headfield Quarry, Castleford
LWS70	Stony Cliffe Wood, Netherton
LWS71	Well Wood, Castleford
LWS72	Alverthorpe Meadows And Wrenthorpe Park, Alverthorpe
LWS73	Walton Colliery Nature Park Walton
LWS74	Former Upton Colliery, Upton
LWS75	Chevet Branch Line, Newmillerdam
LWS76	Notton Park Notton
LWS77	Pontefract Park

Wildlife Habitat Network

8.28 The Wildlife Habitat Network will not necessarily prevent development but the Council will seek to ensure that development is carried out in a manner which consolidates the network and does not break its continuity. Within this network nature conservation interests will be protected. An ecological assessment will be required to be submitted with development proposals which should include appropriate mitigation and enhancement measures. The Wildlife Habitat Network is shown on the Policies Map.

WHN

Wildlife Habitat Network

The Wildlife Habitat Network connects designated sites of ecological and geological conservation and habitats listed as Biodiversity Action Plan priorities, such as watercourses, woodland, natural and semi-natural areas. The creation of the Wildlife Habitat Network is intended to prevent further fragmentation of ecological resources within the district. The network will allow migration, dispersal and genetic exchange of species in the wider environment, and includes links to adjoining districts. Within this network nature conservation interests will be protected and opportunities taken to restore and enhance existing habitats, create new habitats and manage the landscape to improve both biodiversity and landscape quality.

Historic Environment

8.29 This section deals with designations for conserving and enhancing the historic environment. The term 'historic environment' includes Registered Parks and Gardens, Historic Landscapes, Historic Battle Sites, Conservation Areas, Scheduled Monuments and archaeological sites. The designations and their boundaries are established outside of the Plan process by bodies such as Historic England and the Council's Conservation team therefore the lists may alter during the Plan period. Policy SP23 provides the strategic context in the Local Plan on Design, Safety and the Local Environment and policy LP63 provides local policy on Conserving the Historic Environment.

Registered Parks and Gardens, Historic Landscapes and Battle Sites

8.30 Historic England maintains a national register of Parks and Gardens of Special Historic Interest of which there are four in Wakefield. The Council has also designated the Historic Battle Site of the battle of Wakefield and the Historic Landscape of Heath for protection.

HL

Registered Parks and Gardens, Historic Landscapes and Battle Sites

The sites in the following table are shown on the Policies Map and are designated as Registered Parks and Gardens, Historic Landscapes and Historic Battle Sites:

Reference	Description
HL01	Grade II Registered Park/Garden, Friarwood Valley Gardens, Pontefract
HL02	Historic Landscape, Heath
HL03	Historic Battle Site, Sandal Castle, Sandal
HL04	Grade II* Registered Park/Garden, Nostell Priory, Wragby
HL05	Grade II Registered Park/Garden, Bretton Hall, West Bretton
HL06	Grade II Registered Park/Garden, Thornes Park, Wakefield

Conservation Areas

8.31 The National Planning Policy Framework requires the Council to have special regard to the preservation and enhancement of the character or appearance of Conservation Areas.

CA

Conservation Areas

The sites in the following table are shown on the Policies Map and are designated as Conservation Areas:

Reference	Description
CA01	St Johns Wakefield
CA02	South Parade Wakefield
CA03	Pontefract Castle, Pontefract
CA04	Pontefract Market Place, Pontefract

Reference	Description
CA05	Chapelthorpe
CA06	West Bretton
CA07	Woolley
CA08	Newmillerdam
CA09	Badsworth
CA10	Heath
CA11	Sandal
CA12	Horbury
CA13	Normanton
CA14	Whitwood
CA15	Ackworth
CA16	Wragby
CA17	Wakefield Cathedral
CA18	Wood Street Wakefield
CA19	Lower Westgate Wakefield
CA20	Upper Westgate Wakefield
CA21	Wentworth Terrace Wakefield
CA22	Knottingley
CA23	Home Farm, Woolley
CA24	Ossett
CA25	Kirkthorpe
CA26	Wentbridge
CA27	Wakefield Waterfront
CA28	The Mount, Pontefract
CA29	Friarwood and Button Park, Pontefract

Archaeological Sites

8.32 Within the district are a number of Scheduled Monuments, and other unique archaeological assets. West Yorkshire Archaeology Advisory Service maintains the County Historic Environment Record of archaeological remains and sites of archaeological interest, and are the Council's retained professional advisors on all aspects of the historic environment. This document identifies Scheduled Monuments (Class I sites) and Areas of Special Archaeological Value (Class II sites), where evidence exists to indicate the presence or strong probability of remains of particular archaeological importance that are worthy of preservation in situ.

AS

Archaeological Sites

The sites in the following table are shown on the Policies Map and are designated as Archaeological Sites:

Reference	Description
AS001	Class I Moat and Fishpond, Kinsley Carr Farm, Kinsley
AS002	Class I Medieval Buildings, Priory Farm, Nostell, Wragby
AS003	Class I Cross, St Luke and All Saints Church, Darrington
AS004	Class I Bridge and Medieval Gateway, Walton Hall, Walton
AS005	Class I Aqueduct, Stanley Ferry
AS006	Class I Henge, Birkwood Common, Normanton
AS007	Class I Post Medieval Tannery, Cawker Wood, Felkirk
AS008	Class I Dovecote Hall Farm, Sharlston
AS009	Class I Moat and Fish Pond, New Hall Farm, Sitlington
AS010	Class I Site Of Hodroyd, Felkirk
AS011	Class I Perceptory, Newland Hall, Normanton
AS012	Class I Iron Age Earthwork, South Kirkby
AS013	Class I Old Facade of Chantry Chapel, Kettlethorpe Hall
AS014	Class I Lowe Hill Castle Mound, Clarence Park, Wakefield
AS015	Class I Stumpcross, Ferrybridge Road, Pontefract
AS016	Class I Site Of St John's Priory, Pontefract
AS017	Class I Bridge, Old Great North Road, Ferrybridge
AS018	Class I Pontefract Castle, Pontefract
AS019	Class I Sandal Castle, Sandal
AS020	Class I Sharlston Common, Sharlston
AS021	Class I Chantry Bridge and Chapel, Wakefield
AS022	Class I Roman Fort, Standing Flat, Doncaster Road, Thorpe Audlin
AS023	Class I Roman Bath House, Savile Road, Castleford
AS024	Class I Ferrybridge Henge Stranglands Lane, Knottingley
AS025	Class I Land at Notton Park, Notton
AS026	Class II Land near Winterset Reservoir, Cold Hiendley
AS027	Class II Barnsley Canal Lock, Walton
AS028	Class II Land Off Common Road, South Kirkby
AS029	Class II Land Off Castleford Lane, Ackton

Reference	Description
AS030	Class II Land Off Cutsyke Road, North Featherstone
AS031	Class II Mosley Mires, North Elmsall
AS032	Class II Land at Upton Moor Top Farm, Badsworth
AS033	Class II Rectory Farm, Wentbridge
AS034	Class II Land South of Spital Gap Lane, Darrington
AS035	Class II Land north Of Spital Gap Lane, Darrington
AS036	Class II St James's Monastic Church Grounds, Nostell, Wragby
AS037	Class II All Saints Church, North Featherstone
AS038	Class II Land Adjacent to Aqueduct, Stanley Ferry
AS039	Class II Nostell Priory, Wragby
AS040	Class II St Peter's Church, Kirkthorpe
AS041	Class II Land at Dunsley, South Kirkby
AS042	Class II St Peter's Church and Cross, Felkirk
AS043	Class II St Helen's Church, Hemsworth
AS044	Class II St Cuthbert's Church, High Ackworth
AS045	Class II St Mary's Church, Badsworth
AS046	Class II All Saints Church, South Kirkby
AS047	Class II Land at Pontefract Infirmary, Southgate, Pontefract
AS048	Class II Site of Parish Church of St Andrew and Cemetery, Ferrybridge
AS049	Class II All Saints Church, Castleford
AS050	Class II Land at Church Street, Castleford
AS051	Class II Land Adjacent to Pontefract Castle, Pontefract
AS052	Class II Fairies Hill, Whitwood, Castleford
AS053	Class II St Botolph's Church, Chapel Street, Knottingley
AS054	Class II Old Grammar School, Brooke Street, Wakefield
AS055	Class II Fall Ings Lock, Aire and Calder Navigation Canal, Wakefield
AS056	Class II Packhorse Bridge, Doncaster Road, Wakefield
AS057	Class II St Johns Church and Grounds, Wakefield
AS058	Class II Wakefield Cathedral and Grounds Wakefield
AS059	Class II St Peter's Church, Church Street, Woolley
AS060	Class II All Saints Church, Harrison Road, Crofton
AS061	Class II Land north Of Kingsley Avenue, Crofton
AS062	Class II Land Off Marlpit Lane, Darrington

Reference	Description
AS063	Class II Land at Mill Hill Fields, Darrington
AS064	Class II St Luke and All Saints Church, Darrington
AS065	Class II Land near Bank's Croft, Darrington
AS066	Class II Land at Royd Moor, North Elmsall
AS067	Class II Land off Roydmoor Lane, North Elmsall
AS068	Class II Land north-east of South Hiendley
AS069	Class II Land east of South Hiendley
AS070	Class II Land east of South Hiendley
AS071	Class II Land east of South Hiendley
AS072	Class II Land east of South Hiendley
AS073	Class II Land east of South Hiendley
AS074	Class II Land east of South Hiendley
AS075	Class II St Helen's Church, Barnsley Road, Sandal
AS076	Class II Land off Long Lane, Carleton
AS077	Class II All Saints Church, North Baileygate, Pontefract
AS078	Class II All Saints Church, High Street, Normanton
AS079	Class II Registry of Deeds, Newstead Road, Wakefield
AS080	Class II Heath Old Hall, Warmfield cum Heath
AS081	Class II Bridge over Oakenshaw Beck, Heath
AS082	Class II Castleford Roman Fort (Lagentium)
AS083	Class II Land off Cutsyke Road, North Featherstone
AS084	Class II Angel Moon Field, Ferrybridge
AS085	Class II Land East of Marlpit Lane, Darrington
AS086	Class II Land South of Leys Road, Darrington
AS087	Class II Land off Havercroft Lane, Darrington
AS088	Class II Land south of Darrington
AS089	Class II Land south of Darrington
AS090	Class II Land south of Darrington
AS091	Class II Land off Moat Close, Purston Jaglin
AS092	Class II Land east of Rose Lane, Ackworth
AS093	Class II Land off Garmill Head Lane, Wragby
AS094	Class II Land off Harewood Lane, Upton
AS095	Class II Roman Road Barnsdale Bar, Upton

Reference	Description
AS096	Class II Land off Common Lane, South Kirkby
AS097	Class II Land at Bierley Common, South Kirkby
AS098	Class II Land east of Crown Farm, Ryhill
AS099	Class II Land off Ryhill Pits Lane, Ryhill
AS100	Class II Land off Hawpark Lane, Winterset
AS101	Class II Land east of Chevet Lane, Walton
AS102	Class II Haw Park Wood, Walton
AS103	Class II Waterton Park Wall, Walton
AS104	Class II Haw Park Wood, Walton
AS105	Class II Waterton Park, Walton
AS106	Class II Stubbs Wood, Walton
AS107	Class II Land west of Chevet Lane, Notton
AS108	Class II 14-16 Tithe Barn Street, Horbury
AS109	Class II Nostell Priory, Wragby
AS110	Class II Land west of Castle Syke Lodge, Ackworth

Built Environment

Major Developed Sites in the Green Belt

8.33 Major Developed Sites in the Green Belt are substantial sites that pre-date the Town and Country Planning Legislation and the Green Belt designation. Within these defined sites limited infilling or redevelopment is not inappropriate development subject to criteria in national planning policy. There are also a number of industrial, educational and community uses in the Green Belt and policy LP62 sets out the Council's approach to assessing development proposals within these sites. Policy SP22 provides the strategic context for Green Belts in the Local Plan.

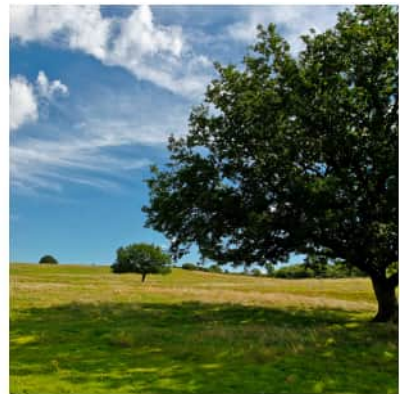
MDS

Major Developed Sites in the Green Belt

The following sites are designated as Major Developed Sites within the Green Belt and are shown on the Policies Map:

Reference	Description
MDS01	New College, Park Lane, Pontefract
MDS02	St Wilfrid's Catholic High School, North Featherstone
MDS03	Bretton Hall, West Bretton
MDS04	Ackworth School, Ackworth
MDS05	West Yorkshire Police Training and Development Centre, Bradford Road, Carr Gate

Appendix 1 Settlement Appraisal



Appendix 1 Settlement Appraisal

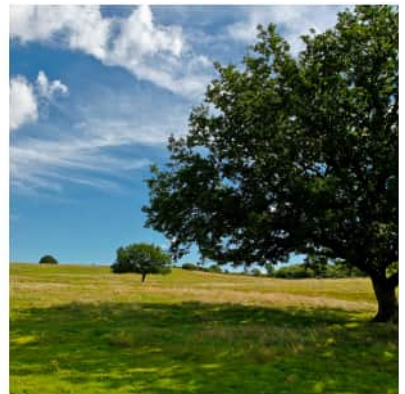
The settlement appraisal shows the resident and workplace population, the level of accessibility and the availability of a range of key facilities in each settlement in the district. It helps define the role and function of each settlement, which is reflected in the settlement hierarchy.

Figure 6 Settlement Appraisal

[illegible]

Appendix 2

Housing Delivery - Phasing



Appendix 2 Housing Delivery - Phasing

It should be noted the phasing information is indicative and some figures have been rounded. It is included to demonstrate an adequate supply of housing can be delivered over the plan period. It should not be used for Development Management purposes in relation to individual sites. Similarly, the housing capacity information included in the trajectory is based on a set of assumptions. The actual density of development will vary according to the characteristics of an individual site at the time of a planning application.

Table 10 Housing Trajectory

Reference	Site Name	Greenfield/ Brownfield	Housing Capacity	Area (Ha)	Year 1 17/18	Year 2 18/19	Year 3 19/20	Year 4 20/21	Year 5 21/22	Year 6 22/23	Year 7 23/24 (Adopted)	Year 8 24/25	Year 9 25/26	Year 10 26/27	Year 11 27/28	Year 12 28/29	Year 13 29/30	Year 14 30/31	Year 15 31/32	Year 16 32/33	Year 17 33/34	Year 18 34/35	Year 19 35/36	Total	Remainder to be built out after 35/36
Sub Regional City - Wakefield																									
HS01	Land At Snowhill, Wakefield	Brownfield	181	5.66	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	36	36	36	37	36	0	0	0	181	0
HS02	Rear Of Milton Crescent, Snapethorpe	Greenfield	0	6.67	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
HS03	Walton Lane, Sandal	Greenfield	171	7.13	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	50	50	50	21	0	0	0	0	0	0	171	0
HS04	Warburton's, Westgate End	Brownfield	0	0.75	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
HS05	Former Waterton J&I School Lupset, Wakefield	Brownfield	29	0.96	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	10	10	9	0	0	0	0	0	29	0
SPA01	The Waterfront Land East of A638 Doncaster Road	Greenfield/ Brownfield	0	6.65	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
SPA02	The Waterfront Stennard Island	Brownfield	0	1.88	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
SPA03	Ings Road Land West of Derby Dale Road	Brownfield	0	1.74	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
SPA04	Ings Road Land to South	Brownfield	0	5.72	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
SPA05	Kirkgate Land to North East	Brownfield	0	1.84	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
SPA06	Ings Road Land North of Ings Road	Brownfield	0	5.08	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
SPA07	Kirkgate Land to South East	Brownfield	43	7.34	0	0	0	0	0	0	13	30	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	43	0
SPA08	The Waterfront Land South of Fall Ings	Greenfield	0	2.02	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
SPA09	The Waterfront Land alongside Doncaster Road	Brownfield	0	1.98	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
SPA10	The Waterfront Land South of Wakefield Lock	Brownfield	0	9.49	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
SPA11	The Waterfront	Brownfield	0	7.16	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
SPA12	Thornes Wharf	Brownfield	0	20.28	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
SPA13	The Waterfront Land North of Chantry Bridge	Brownfield	0	6.27	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
SPA14	Calder Park, Wakefield	Greenfield/ Brownfield	0	54.68	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
SPA15	Merchant Gate	Brownfield	0	1.79	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
SPA16	Wakefield East, Wakefield	Greenfield/ Brownfield	957	157.91	0	0	0	0	0	0	50	50	50	50	50	50	50	50	50	50	50	50	50	650	307

Reference	Site Name	Greenfield/ Brownfield	Housing Capacity	Area (Ha)	Year 1 17/18	Year 2 18/19	Year 3 19/20	Year 4 20/21	Year 5 21/22	Year 6 22/23	Year 7 23/24 (Adopted)	Year 8 24/25	Year 9 25/26	Year 10 26/27	Year 11 27/28	Year 12 28/29	Year 13 29/30	Year 14 30/31	Year 15 31/32	Year 16 32/33	Year 17 33/34	Year 18 34/35	Year 19 35/36	Total	Remainder to be built out after 35/36
SPA17	Civic Quarter Wakefield	Brownfield	0	1.37	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
SPA18	Land at Junction 39 (M1) Durkar	Greenfield	100	14.13	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	33	33	34	0	0	0	0	0	0	100	0
DEV01	Borough Road Car Park	Brownfield	0	0.96	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
DEV02	Wakefield College, Sandy Walk	Brownfield	19	0.39	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	9	10	0	0	0	0	0	19	0	0
DEV03	Clayton Hospital	Brownfield	0	1.62	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
DEV04	Former Indoor Market Union Street Wakefield	Brownfield	0	0.61	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Sub Total			1500	332.08	0	0	0	0	0	0	63	80	50	100	133	188	161	95	87	86	50	50	1193	307	
Principal Town - Castleford																									
HS06	Land North of St Andrews Road, Fryson	Greenfield	61	2.49	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	20	20	21	0	0	0	0	0	0	61	0
HS07	Flass Lane, Cutsyke	Greenfield	50	29.7	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	25	25	0	0	0	0	0	50	0	0
HS08	Land at Ackton Pastures, Castleford	Greenfield	246	7.7	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	7	50	50	50	50	39	0	0	0	0	0	246	0	0
HS09	Land at Cutsyke Avenue, Castleford	Greenfield	62	1.56	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	21	21	20	0	0	0	0	0	62	0	0
SPA19	Castleford Riverside, Castleford	Greenfield/ Brownfield	0	179.95	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
SPA19	- Main site	Brownfield	0	16.71	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
SPA19	- Nestle	Brownfield	0	3.44	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
SPA19	- Lock Lane	Brownfield	0	2.52	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
SPA19	- Arriva	Brownfield	50	1.39	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	25	25	0	0	0	0	50	0	0
SPA19	- Castleford Tigers	Brownfield	106	3.85	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	26	52	54	0
SPA19	- Headfield North	Brownfield	30	0.92	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	15	15	0	0	0	0	0	30	0	0
SPA19	- Pemberton Road	Brownfield	0	2.23	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
SPA19	- Wheldale Farm	Brownfield	871	31.35	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	35	35	35	35	35	35	35	280	591	0
SPA19	- Stansfield Road	Brownfield	510	11.27	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	35	35	35	35	35	35	35	35	315	195	0
DEV05	Bridge Street Castleford	Brownfield	0	0.52	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
DEV06	Aire Street Castleford	Brownfield	0	1.44	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
DEV07	Castleford Waterfront	Brownfield	0	2.26	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0

Reference	Site Name	Greenfield/ Brownfield	Housing Capacity	Area (Ha)	Year 1 17/18	Year 2 18/19	Year 3 19/20	Year 4 20/21	Year 5 21/22	Year 6 22/23	Year 7 23/24 (Adopted)	Year 8 24/25	Year 9 25/26	Year 10 26/27	Year 11 27/28	Year 12 28/29	Year 13 29/30	Year 14 30/31	Year 15 31/32	Year 16 32/33	Year 17 33/34	Year 18 34/35	Year 19 35/36	Total	Remainder to be built out after 35/36
DEV08	Albion Street/Powell Street Castleford	Brownfield	0	2.09	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Sub Total			1986	301.39	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	7	50	50	126	201	215	95	70	70	96	96	1146	840	
Principal Town - Pontefract																									
HS10	Land at Holme Farm, Carleton, Pontefract	Greenfield	240	7.5	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	20	53	53	53	53	8	0	0	0	0	0	0	240	0
HS11	Land North of Moor Lane, Carleton, Pontefract	Greenfield	13	0.97	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	7	6	0	0	0	0	0	0	13	0	0
HS12	Former Prince of Wales Colliery, Pontefract	Greenfield/ Brownfield	150	4.49	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	30	30	30	30	0	150	0	0
HS13	Former factory Monkhill lane Pontefract	Greenfield/ Brownfield	89	2.78	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	30	30	29	0	0	0	0	0	89	0	0
HS14	Friarwood Lane Car Park	Brownfield	0	0.83	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
HS15	Land East Of Cobblers Lane, Pontefract	Greenfield	0	19.61	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
HS16	Land Between Knottingley Road/Ferrybridge Road (North of Railway), Pontefract	Greenfield	0	6.28	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
HS17	Land Between Knottingley Road/Ferrybridge Road (South of Railway), Pontefract	Greenfield	0	2.91	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
HS18	Land North of De Lacy Way - Monkhill Triangle, Pontefract	Greenfield	56	1.59	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	30	26	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	56	0	0
HS19	Land South of De Lacy Way - Monkhill Triangle, Pontefract	Greenfield	70	2.04	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	30	40	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	70	0	0
HS20	Land To South Ackworth Road/Hardwick Road , Pontefract	Greenfield	400	12.27	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	20	40	40	40	40	40	40	60	20	0	0	400	0	0
SPA20	South of Stuart Road Pontefract	Brownfield	0	1.82	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
SPA21	Tanshelf Industrial Estate, Pontefract	Brownfield	0	4.57	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
SPA22	Former Pontefract General Infirmary Friarwood Lane Pontefract	Brownfield	66	1.66	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	22	22	22	0	0	0	0	0	66	0	0
SPA23	Land around Horsefair Pontefract	Brownfield	0	8.54	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
DEV09	North of Stuart Road Pontefract	Brownfield	0	0.39	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Sub Total			1084	78.25	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	70	149	133	152	151	99	70	90	90	50	30	1084	0	0
Urban Area - Featherstone																									

Reference	Site Name	Greenfield/ Brownfield	Housing Capacity	Area (Ha)	Year 1 17/18	Year 2 18/19	Year 3 19/20	Year 4 20/21	Year 5 21/22	Year 6 22/23	Year 7 23/24 (Adopted)	Year 8 24/25	Year 9 25/26	Year 10 26/27	Year 11 27/28	Year 12 28/29	Year 13 29/30	Year 14 30/31	Year 15 31/32	Year 16 32/33	Year 17 33/34	Year 18 34/35	Year 19 35/36	Total	Remainder to be built out after 35/36
HS21	North Of Pontefract Road, Featherstone	Greenfield	0	14.95	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
HS22	Former Featherstone Junior School Pontefract Road Featherstone	Brownfield	0	1.16	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
SPA24	Land South of Featherstone	Greenfield	1000	64.42	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	58	108	112	105	114	109	120	118	119	37	1000	0
DEV10	Wilson Street Featherstone	Brownfield	0	0.45	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Sub Total			1000	80.98	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	58	108	112	105	114	109	120	118	119	37	1000	0
Urban Area - Hensworth																									
HS23	Land East of Wakefield Road, Hensworth	Greenfield	266	11.03	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	35	35	35	35	35	35	35	21	0	0	0	0	266	0
HS24	Kirkbygate, Hensworth	Greenfield	24	0.84	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	12	12	0	0	0	0	24	0
HS25	Sports Ground, Hensworth	Greenfield	143	5.92	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	29	29	29	28	28	0	0	0	143	0
HS26	Land At Common End, Hensworth	Greenfield	202	8.4	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	33	33	34	34	34	0	0	202	0
HS27	Land at Hightfield Road, Hensworth	Greenfield	185	10.5	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	37	37	37	37	37	0	0	185	0
DEV11	The Market Kirkby Road Hensworth	Brownfield	0	0.57	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Sub Total			820	37.26	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	35	35	35	35	64	134	146	132	99	71	34	0	820	0
Urban Area - Horbury																									
HS28	Land At Horbury Quarry, Horbury	Greenfield/ Brownfield	20	0.75	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	10	10	0	0	0	0	0	0	20	0
HS29	Benton Hill, Horbury	Greenfield	15	0.67	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	15	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	15	0
SPA25	Wakefield Commercial Park, Bridge Road, Horbury	Greenfield/ Brownfield	147	12.21	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	29	29	29	30	30	0	0	147	0
Sub Total			182	13.63	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	15	0	0	0	10	39	29	29	30	30	0	0	182	0
Urban Area - Knottingley (inc Ferrybridge)																									
HS30	Land West of Middle Lane, Knottingley	Greenfield	135	5.92	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	27	27	27	27	27	0	0	135	0
HS31	The Yard England Lane	Greenfield/ Brownfield	85	3.3	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	28	28	29	0	0	0	0	0	0	85	0
HS32	Womersley Road, Knottingley	Brownfield	0	5.76	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
HS33	Land East Of Cattlelaith Lane, Knottingley	Greenfield	0	21.38	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0

Reference	Site Name	Greenfield/ Brownfield	Housing Capacity	Area (Ha)	Year 1 17/18	Year 2 18/19	Year 3 19/20	Year 4 20/21	Year 5 21/22	Year 6 22/23	Year 7 23/24 (Adopted)	Year 8 24/25	Year 9 25/26	Year 10 26/27	Year 11 27/28	Year 12 28/29	Year 13 29/30	Year 14 30/31	Year 15 31/32	Year 16 32/33	Year 17 33/34	Year 18 34/35	Year 19 35/36	Total	Remainder to be built out after 35/36
HS34	Land Adjacent A1 Business Park, Knottingley	Greenfield	0	1.09	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
HS35	Land rear of Park Balk Farm Womersley Road Knottingley	Greenfield	180	7.44	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	36	36	36	36	36	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	180	0
SPA26	Oxitis Chemical Works And Land Adjoining Common Lane, Knottingley	Greenfield/ Brownfield	309	39.13	0	0	0	0	0	0	25	55	55	55	55	55	9	0	0	0	0	0	0	309	0
Sub Total			709	84.02	0	0	0	0	0	0	25	91	91	91	119	119	65	27	27	27	27	0	0	709	0
Urban Area - Normanton (inc Altofts)																									
HS36	Land at Church Lane Normanton	Greenfield	53	1.56	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	18	18	17	0	0	0	0	0	0	53	0
HS37	Land West of Wakefield Road, Normanton	Greenfield	345	16	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	40	55	55	55	55	55	30	0	0	0	0	0	345	0
HS38	Former Brickworks and Land to West, Wakefield Road, Normanton	Greenfield/ Brownfield	67	6.7	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	22	22	23	0	0	0	0	0	0	67	0
HS39	Land At Altofts Hall Farm, Normanton	Greenfield	450	18.81	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	75	75	75	75	75	75	0	450	0
HS40	Ashtfields, Normanton	Greenfield	0	1.82	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
HS41	Ashtfields, Normanton	Greenfield	0	4.69	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
HS42	Station Road, Normanton	Brownfield	0	5.4	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
HS43	Ashtfields, Normanton	Greenfield	132	15.88	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	40	40	40	12	0	0	0	0	0	0	132	0
Sub Total			1047	70.86	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	40	55	95	135	135	182	105	75	75	75	75	0	1047	0
Urban Area - South Elmsall/South Kirkby																									
HS44	Land at Quarry Works Field Lane South Elmsall	Brownfield	44	1.45	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	14	15	15	0	0	0	0	0	44	0
HS45	Land South of Mayfields Way and Parkgate South Kirkby	Greenfield	120	4.49	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	15	28	28	28	21	0	0	0	0	0	0	120	0
HS46	Land South of Common Road, South Kirkby	Greenfield	24	2.24	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	24	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	24	0
HS47	Diamond Jubilee Club White Apron Street	Brownfield	0	0.1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
HS48	Rowley Lane, South Elmsall	Greenfield	21	0.7	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	10	11	0	0	0	0	0	0	21	0
HS49	Land At Grove Drive, South Kirkby	Greenfield/ Brownfield	6	0.5	0	0	0	0	0	0	6	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	6	0
HS50	Former Scrap Yard, South Elmsall	Brownfield	24	0.98	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	12	12	0	0	0	0	0	0	24	0

Reference	Site Name	Greenfield/ Brownfield	Housing Capacity	Area (Ha)	Year 1 17/18	Year 2 18/19	Year 3 19/20	Year 4 20/21	Year 5 21/22	Year 6 22/23	Year 7 23/24 (Adopted)	Year 8 24/25	Year 9 25/26	Year 10 26/27	Year 11 27/28	Year 12 28/29	Year 13 29/30	Year 14 30/31	Year 15 31/32	Year 16 32/33	Year 17 33/34	Year 18 34/35	Year 19 35/36	Total	Remainder to be built out after 35/36
HS51	Land Off Field Lane, South Elmsall	Brownfield	67	2.81	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	22	22	23	0	0	0	0	0	67	0
HS52	Land off High Street, South Elmsall	Greenfield/ Brownfield	39	0.97	0	0	0	0	0	0	39	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	39	0
HS53	Adjoining Station, South Elmsall	Greenfield	80	2.48	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	40	40	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	80	0
HS54	Former Common Farm, South Elmsall	Greenfield/ Brownfield	30	1.37	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	15	15	0	0	0	0	0	30	0
HS55	Land off Broad Lane South Elmsall	Greenfield	61	2.22	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	20	20	21	0	0	0	0	61	0
SPA27	Land North of Broad Lane South Kirby	Greenfield	606	50.51	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	75	75	75	75	75	75	75	75	600	6
SPA28	Land at Field Lane and Hacking Lane South Elmsall	Greenfield	467	29.17	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	83	83	83	83	83	52	0	467	0
DEV12	Exchange Street South Elmsall	Brownfield	0	1.6	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Sub Total			1589	101.59	0	0	0	0	0	0	45	64	55	28	28	161	274	231	179	158	158	127	75	1583	6
Urban Area - Stanley/Outwood																									
HS56	Land off Lingwell Gate Lane, Lofthouse Gate, Wakefield	Greenfield/ Brownfield	74	2.39	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	25	25	24	0	0	0	0	0	0	74	0
HS57	Land At Leeds Road, Newton Hill	Greenfield	0	2.77	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Sub Total			74	5.16	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	25	25	24	0	0	0	0	0	0	74	0
Local Service Centre - Crofton																									
HS58	Land at Bedford Farm, Crofton	Greenfield	118	4.92	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	23	23	24	24	24	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	118	0
HS59	Land South of Doncaster Road Crofton	Greenfield	49	2.04	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	16	16	17	0	0	0	0	0	0	49	0
Sub Total			167	6.96	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	23	23	24	40	40	17	0	0	0	0	0	0	167	0
Local Service Centre - Fitzwilliam/Kinsley																									
HS60	Land Adjacent To Farmers WMC Kinsley	Brownfield	36	1.2	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	12	12	12	0	0	0	0	0	0	36	0
HS61	Land at Farm Lane Fitzwilliam	Greenfield	80	3.5	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	27	27	26	0	0	0	0	0	0	80	0
HS62	Farm Lane, Kinsley	Greenfield	90	3.07	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	45	45	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	90	0
HS63	Land West of Newstead View Fitzwilliam	Greenfield	18	0.59	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	9	9	0	0	0	0	0	0	18	0
SPA29	Land at Club Terrace Allotments Wentworth Terrace Fitzwilliam	Greenfield/ Brownfield	150	7.99	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	30	30	30	30	30	0	0	150	0

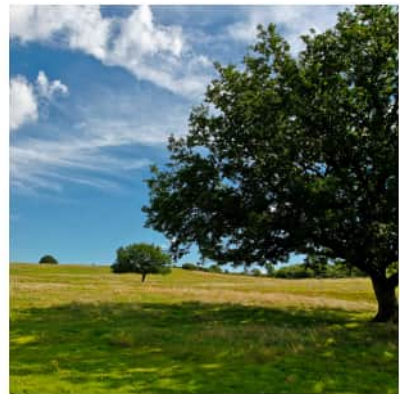
Reference	Site Name	Greenfield/ Brownfield	Housing Capacity	Area (Ha)	Year 1 17/18	Year 2 18/19	Year 3 19/20	Year 4 20/21	Year 5 21/22	Year 6 22/23	Year 7 23/24 (Adopted)	Year 8 24/25	Year 9 25/26	Year 10 26/27	Year 11 27/28	Year 12 28/29	Year 13 29/30	Year 14 30/31	Year 15 31/32	Year 16 32/33	Year 17 33/34	Year 18 34/35	Year 19 35/36	Total	Remainder to be built out after 35/36
Sub Total			374	16.35	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	45	45	0	39	48	77	30	30	30	30	0	0	374	0
Local Service Centre - Ryhill/Havercroft																									
HS64	The Scotsman (land within curtilage) Cow Lane	Brownfield	15	0.5	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	8	7	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	15	0
HS65	Land At Highfields, Havercroft	Greenfield	74	3.07	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	25	25	24	0	0	0	0	0	74	0
HS66	Land To Rear Of Liberal Club, Mill Lane, Ryhill	Greenfield	26	0.84	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	17	9	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	26	0
Sub Total			115	4.41	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	17	9	8	32	25	24	0	0	0	0	0	115	0
Local Service Centre - Upton																									
HS67	Former Allotments Bell Street Upton	Greenfield	150	4.18	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	30	30	30	30	30	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	150	0
HS68	Land at Waggon Lane, Upton	Greenfield	56	2.48	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	18	18	20	0	0	0	0	0	56	0
HS69	Waggon Lane, Upton	Brownfield	39	1.63	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	13	13	13	0	0	0	0	0	0	39	0
Sub Total			245	8.29	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	30	30	30	43	61	31	20	0	0	0	0	0	245	0
District Totals																									
			10892	1141.23	0	0	0	0	0	0	133	500	600	653	991	1347	1448	986	828	785	679	531	288	9739	1153

Table 11 Housing Delivery Summary

Summary	Year 1 2017/ 2018	Year 2 2018/ 2019	Year 3 2019/ 2020	Year 4 2020/ 2021	Year 5 2021/ 2022	Year 6 2022/ 2023	Year 7 2023/ 2024	Year 8 2024/ 2025	Year 9 2025/ 2026	Year 10 2026/ 2027	Year 11 2027/ 2028	Year 12 2028/ 2029	Year 13 2029/ 2030	Year 14 2030/ 2031	Year 15 2031/ 2032	Year 16 2032/ 2033	Year 17 2033/ 2034	Year 18 2034/ 2035	Year 19 2035/ 2036	Total	Remainder to be built out after 2035/36
District Gross Commitments (U/C and PP)	0	0	0	0	0	1839	1458	706	295	204	197	114	114	75	75	75	75	75	75	5376	
District Gross Completions	1811	2150	1806	1267	1566	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	8600	
Windfall	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	300	300	300	300	300	300	300	300	300	300	300	3300	
District Gross Allocations (Including LDF)	0	0	0	0	0	0	133	500	600	653	991	1347	1448	986	828	785	679	531	258	9739	1153
District Gross Supply	1811	2150	1806	1267	1566	1839	1591	1206	1195	1157	1488	1761	1862	1361	1203	1160	1054	906	633	27015	1153
Losses and Demolitions	-52	-36	-48	-40	-69	-84	-84	-84	-84	-84	-84	-84	-84	-84	-84	-84	-84	-84	-84	-1421	
Net District Completions/Supply	1759	2114	1758	1227	1497	1755	1507	1122	1111	1073	1404	1677	1778	1277	1119	1076	970	822	549	25594	
Annual Requirement	1400	1400	1400	1400	1400	1400	1400	1400	1400	1400	1400	1400	1400	1400	1400	1400	1400	1400	1400	26600	
Requirement																					
Net District Completion/Supply	1759	2114	1758	1227	1497	1755	1507	1122	1111	1073	1404	1677	1778	1277	1119	1076	970	822	549	25594	
Annual Net District Requirement	1400	1400	1400	1400	1400	1400	1400	1400	1400	1400	1400	1400	1400	1400	1400	1400	1400	1400	1400	26600	
District Annual Net Surplus/Deficit	359	714	358	-173	97	355	107	-278	-289	-327	4	277	378	-123	-281	-324	-430	-578	-851	-1006	
District Annual Net Surplus/Deficit %	126%	151%	126%	88%	107%	125%	108%	80%	79%	77%	100%	120%	127%	91%	80%	77%	69%	59%	39%	96%	
District Cumulative Annual Net Surplus/Deficit	359	1073	1431	1258	1355	1710	1817	1539	1250	923	927	1203	1581	1458	1177	853	423	-155	-1006	-1006	
District Cumulative Annual Net Surplus/Deficit %	126%	138%	134%	122%	119%	120%	119%	114%	110%	107%	106%	107%	109%	107%	106%	104%	102%	99%	96%	96%	
Previously Developed Land																					
PDL Completions	740	763	749	596	684	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	3532	
PDL Commitments	0	0	0	0	0	896	658	243	116	51	101	75	75	75	75	75	75	75	75	2863	
PDL Allocations	0	0	0	0	0	0	133	135	105	105	300	462	510	332	246	246	210	176	146	3106	
PDL Windfalls	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	240	240	240	240	240	240	240	240	240	240	240	2640	
Greenfield Completions/Supply	1071	1387	1057	1267	1566	943	800	829	735	761	847	984	1037	714	642	599	529	415	172	16355	
PDL Total Completions/Supply	740	763	749	596	684	896	791	378	461	396	641	777	825	647	561	561	525	491	461	11941	
PDL Percent of Total Supply	41%	35%	41%	47%	44%	49%	50%	31%	39%	34%	43%	44%	44%	48%	47%	48%	50%	54%	73%	47%	

Appendix 3

Employment Land Supply



Appendix 3 Employment Land Supply

3.1 The table below sets out the proposed Employment Sites, Special Policy Areas and Employment Zones which contribute to the 508 hectares of developable land identified for employment in the plan and set out in strategic policy SP10 Local Economy. It also identifies the 390 hectares of prime employment land in the supply. It should be noted that some of these sites are already partially developed. Employment Zones are areas of existing employment use which are protected from other forms of development. Some of these zones do have developable land within them and this is set out in the table.

3.2 Under the 'type' column:

- 'New' refers to a site newly allocated by the Wakefield District Local Plan.
- 'Carried Forward' refers to a site carried forward from the Local Development Framework Site Specific Policies Local Plan.

Table 12 Employment Land Supply (at 1st April 2022)

Reference	Site Name	Prime Land	Settlement Name	Type	Site Area (ha.)	WDLP Supply at 01/04/2022 (ha.)
ES01	Land adjoining Silkwood Business Park, Wakefield	Prime	Wakefield	Employment Site (new)	10.04	10.04
ES02	Silkwood Park, Wakefield	Prime	Wakefield	Employment Site (Carried Forward)	28.7	4.44
ES03	Former Glasshoughton Colliery	Prime	Castleford	Employment Site (carried forward)	28.19	22.23
ES04	Land At Ferrybridge C Power Station		Knottingley (inc. Ferrybridge)	Employment Site (new)	162.56	42
ES05	Land to the North-East of Former A1-M62 Interchange (North Side), Knottingley	Prime	Knottingley (inc. Ferrybridge)	Employment Site (Carried Forward)	4.42	4.42
ES06	Land at Shilling Hill Extension, Knottingley	Prime	Knottingley (inc. Ferrybridge)	Employment Site (Carried Forward)	2.17	2.17
ES07	Land to the North-East of Former A1-M62 Interchange (South Side), Knottingley	Prime	Knottingley (inc. Ferrybridge)	Employment Site (Carried Forward)	2.83	2.83
ES08	Land At Shilling Hill, Knottingley	Prime	Knottingley (inc. Ferrybridge)	Employment Site (Carried Forward)	21.7	21.7
ES09	Land South Of Knottingley	Prime	Knottingley (inc. Ferrybridge)	Employment Site (new)	156.39	136.68
ES10	Land at Havertop Lane Normanton	Prime	Normanton	Employment Site (new)	15.86	15.86

Reference	Site Name	Prime Land	Settlement Name	Type	Site Area (ha.)	WDLP Supply at 01/04/2022 (ha.)
ES11	Land at Field Lane, South Elmsall	Prime	South Elmsall / South Kirkby	Employment Site (new)	51.3	31.07
ES12	Langthwaite Grange Extension, South Kirkby	Prime	South Elmsall / South Kirkby	Employment Site (Carried Forward)	9.7	9.7
ES13	Former Newmarket Colliery, Stanley	Prime	Other	Employment Site (Carried Forward)	57.21	17.96
ES14	Land South of J30 M62, Castlegate, Wakefield	Prime	Other	Employment Site (new)	47.9	41.9
ES15	Former South Kirkby Colliery / Ferrymoor Ridings, South Kirkby	Prime	Other	Employment Site (Carried Forward)	28.94	7.87
SPA14	Calder Park, Wakefield	Prime	Wakefield	Special Policy Area (Carried Forward)	54.68	7.71
SPA16	Wakefield East, Wakefield (City Fields)		Wakefield	Special Policy Area (Carried Forward)	157.91	14.88
SPA18	Land at Junction 39 (M1) Durkar	Prime	Wakefield	Special Policy Area (new)	14.13	11.45
SPA19	Castleford Riverside		Castleford	Special Policy Area (Carried Forward)	179.95	15.91
SPA20	South of Stuart Road, Pontefract		Pontefract	Special Policy Area (Carried Forward)	1.82	0
SPA21	Tanshelf Industrial Estate, Pontefract		Pontefract	Special Policy Area (Carried Forward)	4.57	0
SPA25	Wakefield Commercial Park, Bridge Road, Horbury		Horbury	Special Policy Area (new)	12.21	6.11

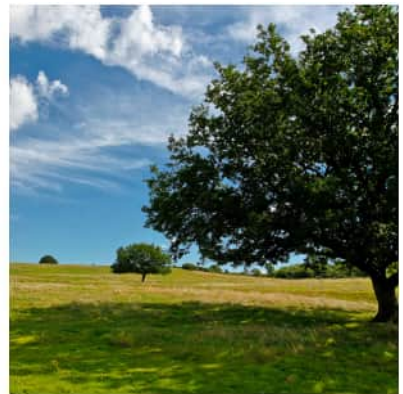
Reference	Site Name	Prime Land	Settlement Name	Type	Site Area (ha.)	WDLP Supply at 01/04/2022 (ha.)
SPA26	Oxiris Chemical Works and Land adjoining Common Lane, Knottingley		Knottingley (inc. Ferrybridge)	Special Policy Area (Carried Forward)	39.13	20.6
SPA27	Land North of Broad Lane, South Kirkby		South Elmsall / South Kirkby	Special Policy Area (new)	50.51	10
SPA28	Land at Field Lane and Hacking Lane, South Elmsall		South Elmsall / South Kirkby	Special Policy Area (new)	28.33	13.73
EZ01	Portobello / Fall Ings		Wakefield	Employment Zone (carried forward)	3.35	0
EZ02	Roundwood		Wakefield	Employment Zone (carried forward)	5.56	0
EZ03	Crigglestone Industrial Estate		Wakefield	Employment Zone (carried forward)	6.15	0.78
EZ04	Thornes		Wakefield	Employment Zone (carried forward)	43.3	0.38
EZ05 (part)	Westgate End		Wakefield	Employment Zone (carried forward)	2	0.06
EZ05 (part)	Calder Vale		Wakefield	Employment Zone (carried forward)	1.73	0
EZ06	Flanshaw		Wakefield	Employment Zone (carried forward)	26.36	3.58
EZ07	Calder Vale	*	Wakefield	Employment Zone (carried forward)	20.39	0
EZ08	Whitwood / Willowbridge Lane		Castleford	Employment Zone (carried forward)	19.74	0

Reference	Site Name	Prime Land	Settlement Name	Type	Site Area (ha.)	WDLP Supply at 01/04/2022 (ha.)
EZ09	Methley Road Area		Castleford	Employment Zone (carried forward)	22.62	0.13
EZ10	Castleford Ings		Castleford	Employment Zone (carried forward)	2.83	0
EZ11	Whitwood - Europort		Castleford	Employment Zone (carried forward)	201.7	10.55
EZ12	Carr Wood Road		Castleford	Employment Zone (carried forward)	16.47	0.46
EZ13	East of Pontefract Town Centre		Pontefract	Employment Zone (carried forward)	4.03	0
EZ14	North of Wakefield Road		Featherstone	Employment Zone (carried forward)	18.85	0
EZ15	Former Ackton Hall Colliery Yard & Green Lane		Featherstone	Employment Zone (carried forward)	33.89	1.81
EZ16	Bombardier		Horbury	Employment Zone (carried forward)	14.97	0.39
EZ17	Hawkingcroft		Horbury	Employment Zone (carried forward)	3.31	0
EZ18	Banks of the Aire & Calder Navigation, Ferrybridge to Willow Island, Knottingley		Knottingley (inc. Ferrybridge)	Employment Zone (carried forward)	11.09	0
EZ19	Headlands Lane / Hazel Road, Knottingley		Knottingley (inc. Ferrybridge)	Employment Zone (carried forward)	27.14	0

Reference	Site Name	Prime Land	Settlement Name	Type	Site Area (ha.)	WDLP Supply at 01/04/2022 (ha.)
EZ20	Weeland Road / Womersley Road, Knottingley		Knottingley (inc. Ferrybridge)	Employment Zone (carried forward)	8.56	0
EZ21	Land at Forge Hill Lane, Knottingley		Knottingley (inc. Ferrybridge)	Employment Zone (carried forward)	2.64	0
EZ22	A1 Business Park		Knottingley (inc. Ferrybridge)	Employment Zone (carried forward)	6.86	0.71
EZ23	Knottingley East		Knottingley (inc. Ferrybridge)	Employment Zone (carried forward)	26.84	4.89
EZ24	Trinity Farm, Knottingley		Knottingley (inc. Ferrybridge)	Employment Site Zone (New)	32.37	0
EZ25	Normanton Industrial Estate	Prime	Normanton (inc. Altofts)	Employment Zone (carried forward)	192.3	0.64
EZ26	Dewsbury Road, Ossett		Ossett	Employment Zone (carried forward)	47.72	0
EZ27	Langthwaite Grange		South Elmsall / South Kirkby	Employment Zone (carried forward)	57.29	4.52
EZ28	Dale Lane		South Elmsall / South Kirkby	Employment Zone (carried forward)	69.41	2.95
EZ29	Wakefield 41 Business Park		Stanley / Outwood	Employment Zone (carried forward)	110.6	4.19
EZ30	Kinsley Industrial Estate		Fitzwilliam / Kinsley	Employment Zone (carried forward)	16.3	1.05
EZ31	Waggon Lane, Upton		Upton	Employment Zone (carried forward)	3.11	0

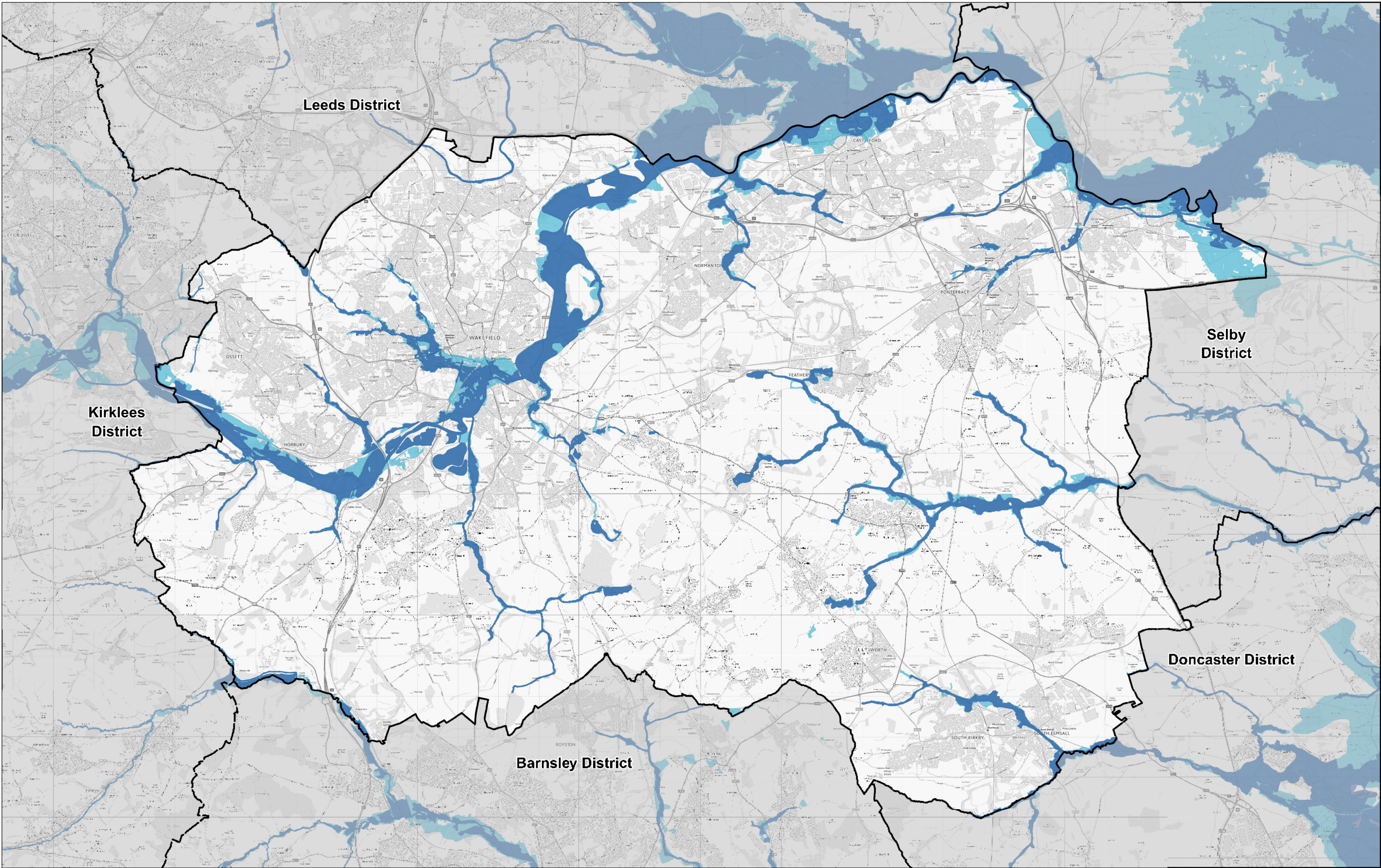
Reference	Site Name	Prime Land	Settlement Name	Type	Site Area (ha.)	WDLP Supply at 01/04/2022 (ha.)
EZ32	Healey		Other	Employment Zone (carried forward)	13.82	0
EZ33	Castlegate, Patrick Green		Other	Employment Zone (carried forward)	7.77	0
Totals					2252.22	508.35

Appendix 4 Environment Agency Flood Zone Map



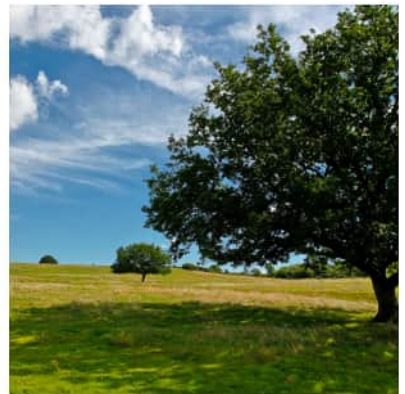
Appendix 4 Environment Agency Flood Zone Map

The Environment Agency Flood Map is updated quarterly and can be found on-line. The Wakefield District extract is below as dated.



Appendix 5

Strategic Flood Risk Assessment Map



Appendix 5 Strategic Flood Risk Assessment Map

[View Interactive Map](#)

